

The
History
Compendium

- **Head Office** : B-32, Shivalik Main Road, Malviya Nagar, New Delhi-110017
- **Sales Office** : B-48, Shivalik Main Road, Malviya Nagar, New Delhi-110017
Tel. : 011-26691021 / 26691713

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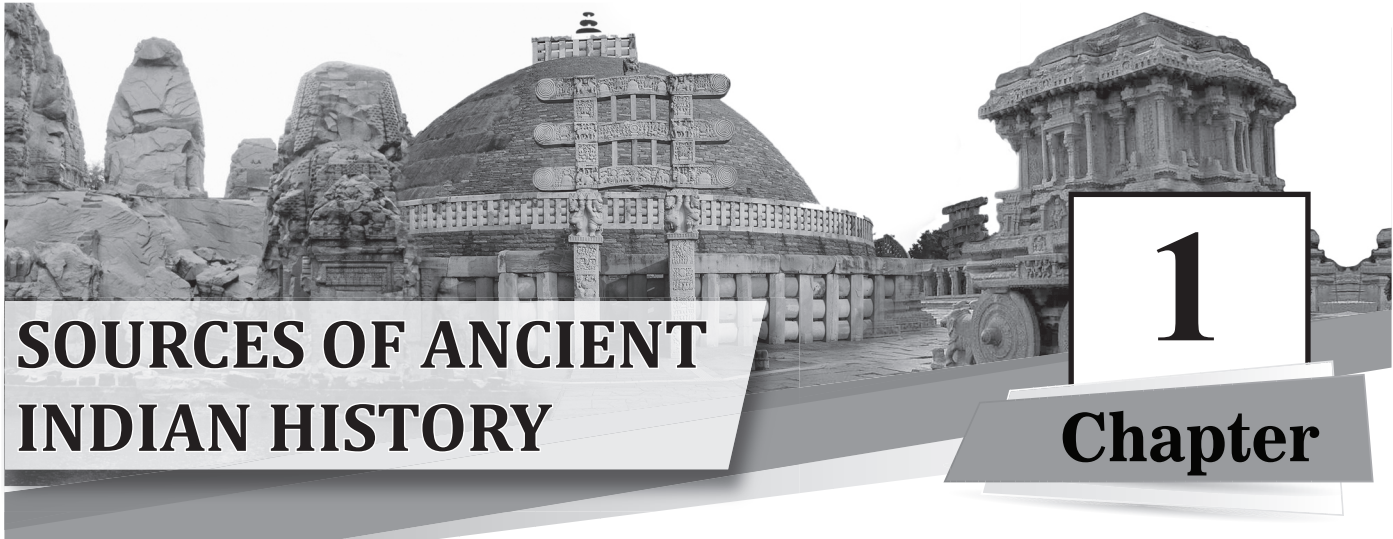
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HISTORY

UNIT-I : ANCIENT HISTORY OF INDIA

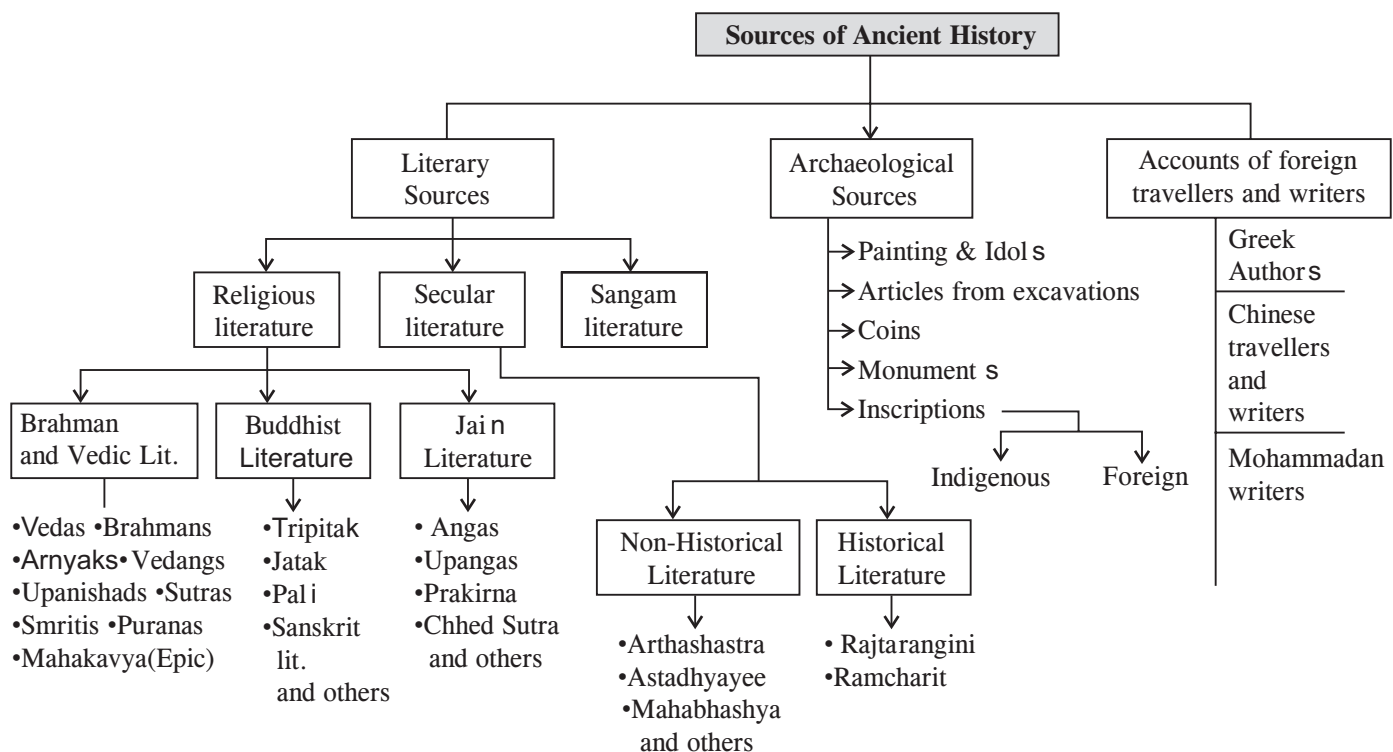


SOURCES OF ANCIENT INDIAN HISTORY

Chapter

Introduction

Generally, Ancient History of India is divided into three periods - **Palaeolithic period** (pre-historic period); **Mesolithic period** (Prime historic period) and **Neolithic period**. The three stone ages (old, middle and new) are known as pre-historic period and there is no written evidence found for the study of that period. Though with the help of different sources we are able to study it in a chronological order. These sources include coins, monuments, old weapons, toys and ornaments, etc. For the study of ancient history in a good chronological order we need to divide the different sources into three broad divisions - (1) **Literary sources** (2) **Archaeological sources** (3) **Accounts of foreign travellers and writers**.



LITERARY SOURCES

RELIGIOUS LITERATURE

Brahmans and Vedic literary Source

The Vedas

The word 'veda' originated from the root 'vidi', i.e. to know, signifying knowledge. It is also known as *Shruti* (to hear). There are four vedas - the *Rigveda*, *Samaveda*, *Yajurveda* and *Atharvaveda*.

Rigveda

The Rigveda is the oldest one, and therefore, is also known as 'the first testament of mankind'. It must have been composed around 1700 B.C. The first three vedas are known as 'Trayi'. It has 1017 hymns (Sukta) and is divided into ten *mandalas*. After the addition of the eleven Bal Khilya Sutra the total no. of hymns becomes 1028. The tenth mandala, said to have added later as its language differs from the other nine mandalas, contains the famous *Purushasukta* explaining the four *varnas* (*Brahmana*, *Kshatriya*, *Vaishya* and *Shudra*) born from the mouth, arms, thighs and feet of the creator. Thus, the Rigveda has 10 Mandalas, 1028 Suktas and 10,580 Richas.

The 7th and 2nd Mandalas were the very first composition, later on the other mandalas were composed. The 7th and 2nd Mandalas are called '*Vansha Mandal*'; the handwritten script of 8th mandal is called 'Khila' and the 1st and 10th are known as 'Kshepak'.

Yajurveda

It has 40 chapters and 2000 hymns. It is a *ritual veda* and has two main texts: Krishna Yajurveda and Shukla Yajurveda. It is also called the book of sacrificial *prayers*. Krishna Yajurveda contains *mantras* (*hymns*) and the Shukla has commentary *in prose*. Kasthanak, Kapishtal, Maitrayani, Taittiriya and Vajasnayei are the five branches of Yajurveda in which the first four are related to the Krishna Yajurveda and the last one is to Shukla Yajurveda. Yajurveda is a good collection of hymns composed in both prose and poetry. *Ishopanishad*, the last chapter of Yajurveda, is philosophical and metaphysical whereas the rest of all parts of Yajurveda's subject matter is the law and legislation of various yajanas.

Samaveda

The Samaveda is a collection of *melodies*. It has 1549 Shlokas (richas) but except 78 all the rest of the hymns have been borrowed from the Rigveda. These were meant to be sung at the time of soma sacrifice. Samaveda has two parts: *Purvachika* (having six subdivisions called '*Apathaka*') and *Uttarachika* (having nine subdivisions called '*Prapathaka*'). To the historical point of view the Samaveda has less importance.

Atharvaveda

It is the latest of the four. It describes the popular *beliefs* and *superstitions* of the humble folk. It is divided into 20 books volumes. It contains 731 hymns and 5,987 mantras.

About 1200 **Mantras** have been taken from the Rigveda. The hymns of Atharvaveda tell how to overcome the evil spirit. *Shaunk* and *Pippalad* are the two available branches of this veda. The Atharvaveda is also known as *Brahmaveda* or *Atharvagirasveda*. For a very long time it was not considered in the category of the Vedas. It is a book of *magical formulae*.

Points to Remember

- In Rigveda we have 40 rivers and the *Saraswati* river is called the *mother of rivers*.
- The name of four oceans found in the Rigveda are Apar, Purva, Saraswat and Sharyajavat.
- 6 mandals from 2nd to 7th of Rigveda are called *Gotra Vamsha Mandalas* (*Kula Grantha*).

Vedas	Upvedas	dealing with
Rig	Dhanurveda	Archery
Sam	Gandharva	the art of music
Atharva	Ayurveda	the medical science
Yaju	Sthapatyaved	Architecture

The Brahmanas

The Brahmanas were composed after the vedas to explain the hymns of the vedas. Every veda has several Brahmanas attached to it. **Kausitiki** and **Aitareya** are the Brahmanas books of the Rigveda composed by **Hotri priests**. Aitareya has 40 chapters. Kausitiki is also called *Sankhyayan Brahman*. 'Taittiriya' is the Brahman of Krishna Yajurveda and Shatpath is attached to shukla Yajurveda composed by Adhvaryu priest Yagyavalka. It narrates the progress of culture from Kuru-Panchal to Videha. The one hundred chapters of Shatpath are divided into 14 sections which are very exhaustive and important of all the Brahmanas. The Samaveda has three Brahmanas i.e. Tandayamaha Brahman, Khadvisha Brahmana and Jaiminiya Brahman were composed by **Udgatri priests**. The Gopath Brahman is attached to the Atharvaveda.

In his Mahabhashya, Patanjali has described thousands of branches of Samveda but only three branches, i.e. Kauthum, Ranayaniya and Jaimaniya are available.

The name of Rishabha and Arishtanemi (Jaintirthankar) are found in the Rigveda environment of jungles were called *Aaranyak* (the word *aranyak* means 'the forest'). They deal with philosophical doctrines and mysticism to answer the various complex questions, related to human life. In fact, these are the concluding portion of the Brahmanas. There are seven Aranyakas, i.e. **Aitareya**, **Sankhyayana**, **Taittiriya**, **Maitrayani**, **Madhyandini**, **Talvaka** and **Jaiminiya**. These books are *opposed to sacrifices and rituals* and lay emphasis on *meditation* and *moral virtues* to form a bridge between the Karma Marga (way of work) and the Gyan Marga (way of knowledge).

The Upanishads

The word upanishad is a combined form of the two sanskrit word, *i.e. upa* and *nishad* which means *to sit down near someone* (here, the Guru) and get the secret knowledge by him. There are 108 upanishads, *e.g. Jesh, Kath, Ken, Mandukya, Brihadaranyaka, Mundaka, Chhandogya, Taittiriya, Aitareya and Kaushitiki* are some important upanishads. The Upanishads are anti-ritualistic discussing the theories of creation of the universe and defining the doctrine of action with the goal to attain salvation through meditation and self-control. The Upanishads were composed by several learned saints between 800 and 500 B.C. The famous doctrine of Advaitavada is ascertained in the Upanishads. The famous national statement '*Satyameva Jayate*' has been taken from the *Mundaka Upanishad*.

All the works referred above are known as *shrutis*, which means '*revelation*'. The word shruti means '*hearing*' and refers to the rhythms of the infinite hearing by the soul.

Vedangas

The six vedangas - **Shiksha, Kalpa, Vyakarana, Nirukta, Chhanda and Jyotisha** were composed in the later Vedic period. Shiksha deals with the appropriate pronunciation of the Mantras. Kalpa is related to rituals, duties and sanskara. Vyakarana deals with grammar and the science of language, Nirukta with etymology. Yaskacharya's Nirukta is very famous. Chhanda deals with rhyming scheme. Chhandasutra was composed by Acharya Pingel. Jyotish deals with astronomy in which we find the proper calculation of the right position of the sun and the moon and various heavenly bodies to perform rituals and ceremonies. Jyotish vedanga is a famous book for it in which we get as many as 400 slokas.

Sutras

Kalpasutra is quite famous among Sutra Literature. It has three parts - Srauta, Grihya and Dharma. Srauta Sutra explains the subjects of rituals and various types of yajnas ceremonies. **Sankhyanan, Aashvakayan, Latkayan, Kattyayana and Bodhayana** are the chief compositions of Sutra literature. Griha Sutra deals with various sanskaras and the four *Ashramas*, *i.e. Brahmacharya, Grihastha, Vanprastha* and *Sannyasa* of human life. Dharmasutra deals with the social life of the Vedic era in which various code of conduct and religious matters are explained. Besides these we have Kaushiki sutra (Medical science and remedies) and Sulva sutra.

Smritis

Smriti means '*remembrance*'. Smritis, the auxiliary treatises of the vedas, are regarded as a part of the revelation. There are six famous smritis: Manu smriti (of pre-Gupta period), Yajnavalkya smriti (of Pre-Gupta period), Narad smriti (of Gupta period), Parashara smriti (Gupta period) Brihaspati smriti (Gupta period) and Katyayana smriti (Gupta period).

Points to Remember

Name of the Smritis	Chief Commentators
Manu	Vishwarupa, Medghatithi, Govindraj Kulluk Bhatt
Yajnavalkya, Narad	Vishwarupa, Vijnyaneshwar, Apararka
Parashar	Madhavacharya

Assess Yourself

Match the Column		
A.	Srauta	1. Geometrical construction & making of canopy
B.	Grihya	2. Therapeutic
C.	Dharma	3. Ceremonics and sacrifices
D.	Kaushiki	4. Husbandry
E.	Sulva	5. Social behaviour and religious matters and Varnasramas

Puranas

The 'Purana' means 'the old'. There are 18 '*Puranas*' in which the *Matsya purana* is the oldest puran. These puranas describe the genealogies of various royal dynasties, *i.e. Maurya, Andhra, Shishunag, Gupta*, etc. The name of puranas are: Brahma, Padma, Vishnu, Shiva, Bhagvat, Narad, Markandey, Agni, Bhavishya Brahma-vaivartya, Linga Varah, Skanda, Vaman, Kurma, Matsya, Garur and Brahmand. Besides these there are 19 Upapuranas. Lomharsha or his son Ugrashrava is said to be the compiler of puranas.

Mahakavya (Epics)

There are two Mahakavyas (Epics), *i.e. the Ramayana* (Valmiki) and the *Mahabharata* (Ved Vyasa). **The Ramayana** the oldest epic of the world, is known as '*Adi Kavya*'. It consists of 24,000 shlokas divided into 07 **Kandas** (Bal Kand, Ayodhya Kand and Aranya Kand, Kishkindha Kand, Sundar Kand, Lanka Kand and Uttar Kand). The 1st and 7th Kand were the latest additions to the Ramayana. The Ramayana is said to be composed in 5th century B.C. Originally it had only 6, 000 verses. Later on it became 12,000 and finally it has 24,000 shlokas.

The Mahabharat of Ved Vyasa is the longest epic of the world consisting of 1,00,000 shlokas in 18 parvans or chapters in which shanti parvan is the largest parvan. The *Bhagavad Gita* is extracted from the Bhishma Parvan of the Mahabharata. The Mahabharata is said to be composed between 400 B.C. to A.D. 400. Originally it had only 8,800 shlokas under the name of *Jay Samhita*, later on it was called *chaturvinshati sahastri samhita* or *Bharat* consisting of 24,000 shlokas and finally it became *Mahabharata* or *Shatasahasri Samhita* with 1,00,000 shlokas. It is also called '*Panchamveda*'.

Darshans

Like Smritis, Vedangas and Upvedas, Darshans are also the auxiliary treaties of the vedas. There are six schools of Indian philosophy known as *Shad-Darshans*. These are Sankhya (Kapil), Yoga (Patanjali), Nyaya (Akshapad Gautam), Vaisheshika (Uluka Kanada), Purva Mimansa (Jaimini) and Vedanta or Uttar Mimansa (Badarayana).

Buddhist Literature

Tripitaka

There are three tripitak - Vinay Pitaka, Sutta Pitaka and Abhidhamma Pitaka. *Pitaka* means 'basket'. The original texts were written on palm-leaves and kept in baskets. Therefore these works were called Pitaka. *Sutta Pitaka* is the *gist* of Buddha's sayings, *Vinay Pitaka* explains the *code and conduct* of Buddhist organization. Abhidhamma Pitaka is divided into seven parts. Digha Nikaya, Majjhima Nikaya, Samyutta Nikaya, Anguttara Nikaya and Khuddaka (Kshudraka Nikaya) are the chief divisions of sutta-pitaka. *Sutta Pitaka* deals with the *religions discourses* of Buddha.

Deepvansha and **Mahavansha** present the chronicles of Sri Lanka dealing with the important events related to the various rulers and their administrations.

Milindapanha (i.e. questions of Milinda, the gando-greck rules) presents dialogues between Menander and Buddhist saint Nagsen.

Sanskrit Texts

Buddha charitya, Saundarananda, Sutralankar, Sariputra Prakaran and Vajra suchi are famous books written by *Ashwaghosha*. Pragyaparimita Karika are the sources of the contemporary historical materials. Visudhamagga, Atthakatha, Vasumitra's Mahavibhasha Shastra and Nagarijuna's Madhyamika Kuria are Sumangalvasini by Buddhaghosa supply us some important historical material with doses of religious messages.

Jatak Kathas

There are 549 or 547 tales describing the pre-birth stories of Buddha. These are the parts of art and literature and useful for the historical study of 3rd century B.C. They present a socio-economic conditions of Mauryan Period.

Assess Yourself	
Match the column	
A. Indian Buddhist text	1. Jatakas
B. Ceylonese Buddhist Chronicles	2. Dipavansha
C. Tibetan Buddhist text	3. Mahavansha
	4. Divyavadana

Jain Literature

The literature of the Svetambaras is written in Ardhamagadhi Prakrit including 12 Angas, 12 Upangas, 10 Prakirnakas, 06 Chhedasutras, 04 Mulasutras and 02 Sutra Granthas. All the Jain granthas were compiled in the Council of Vallabhi in A.D. 516 in which we can find the exposition of about Prasenjit, Ajatshatru, Vibishar etc. Parishtaparvan and Bhadrabahu Charit supply the descriptions about Chandragupta Maurya. Parishistaparvan, Trishishta Shalaka, Purusham Choritra, Dwayashray Mahakavya, Mahaveer Charit, Kumarpal Charit are the important religious books helpful for the study of ancient history.

Assess Yourself

Match the column	
A. Navasahasanka charit	1. Jai Singh
B. Kumarpal charit	2. Nyaya Chandra
C. Hampir kavya	3. Ballal
D. Bhoja prabandh	4. Aswaghosha
E. Buddhacharita	5. Bhadrabahu
F. Kalpa sutra	6. Sarvanandin
G. Loka vibhanga	7. Padmagupta

Secular Literature

Non-historical Sources

Arthashastra: It was composed by *Kautilya (Chanakya)*. It gives a methodological analysis of political and economic conditions of the Mauryan period.

Mudra-rakshasa: It was written by **Vishakh Dutt** during Gupta Period. It explains the destruction of the Nandas by Chandra Gupta Maurya with the help of **Chanakya**.

Astadhyayee composed by Panini, is a grammar on which Patanjali has written annotation. Its name is **Mahabhashya**. This book explains the conditions of Mauryan Period. Gargi Samhita describes the onset of the yavanas in India. Similarly, Kalidash's Abhijnayan Shakuntalam and Malvikagnimitram explain the conditions of society and culture of the Gupta's period. The fight between the Yavan and Pushyamitra Sunga is also mentioned in it. The Swapnavasavadutta of Bhasa throws light on the various events of the Gupta period. Buddha swami's, 'Vrihadkata', 'Kshemendra's. Vrihatkathamamjari, Somdeva's, 'Kathasaritsagar' are the important books describing the ancient society and culture of India.

Mudrarakshasa and **Devichandraguptam** are the compositions of the Gupta period. The establishment of the Maurya dynasty, the fall of the Nanda Vansha, Ramgupta as well as **Dhruvadevi's** story, all are explained by Vishakhadutta. King Harshavardhana of 7th century A.D. wrote Naganand, Priyadarshika and Ratnavali. In the very period his courtier poet *Banabhatta* wrote '*Harshacharita*'. In all these compositions we gain the knowledge of Harsha's kingship and administration.

Gaudvaho by Vakpatiraj explains the victory of king Yashovarman of Kannauj and the subjugation of Gauda. Padmagupta Parimal wrote Navsahasanka Charit. It describes the various events of the Parmara of Malva. Vilhana in his epic **Vikramank dev charitam** has described the achievements of the King of Chalukya Vikramaditya (VI). **Chand Bardai's (Prithviraj Raso)**, Jayanaka's Prithviraj Vijay and Kumarpal Charit, Jaganakas' Parmal Raso are some important compositions through which we understand the various events of Rajputana Period.

Historical Literature

In 12th century A.D *Kalhana* wrote '*Rajtarangini*' describing about the rulers of Kashmir. *Rajtarangini* is considered to be the **first historical book of India**. Sandhyakar Nandi's Ramcharit is also a historical creation describing the works and achievements of Rampal, the pal ruler of Bengal.

Assess Yourself

Match the column	
A. Ramcharit	1. Kalhan
B. Rajtarangini	2. Vakpatiraj
C. Parmal Raso	3. Vilhan
D. Prithviraj Vijay	4. Jayanak
E. Vikrmankdev Charit	5. Jagnik
F. Gandvaho	6. Sandhyakar Nandi

Assess Yourself

Match Box	
A. Arthashastra	1. Harshvardhana
B. Astadhyayee	2. Chanakaya
C. Mahabhashya	3. Panini
D. Malvikagnimitram	4. Patanjali
E. Swapnavasavdutta	5. Bhash
F. Ratnavali	6. Kalidas

Sangam Literature

Sangam was a college or assembly of Tamil poets held under Royal patronage of Pandayan Kings in Madurai. It is said that the assembly lasted for 9,990 years and was attended by 8,598 poets and 197 pandyas. The narrative texts are called **Melkannakku** (consisting of 18 major works and 10 idylls) show that the early Tamil people were pastoral. These are heroic poetry giving ideas of the state formation in which the army consisted of the groups of warriors, and the taxation system and judiciary.

The didactic texts cover the early centuries of the Christian era. **Padnekilkanakku** is called **Kilakanakku** (18 minor works) describes the code of conduct and occupations of various social groups. Kural or Muppai, a part of Padnekilkanakku, was written by Tiruvalluvar is called 'The Bible of Tamil Land'.

The Three Sangam at a glance				
Sl. No	Venue	Chairmanship	Available texts	No. of patron
I Sangam	Ten-Mudurai (South) (Old-Capital) of Pandayas	Agattiyar	×	89
II Sangam	Kapatapuram/Alvai (engulfed in sea)	Agastaya Tolakapiyyar (grammar & poetics)	Tolkappiyam	59
III Sangam	North Madurai	Nakkirar	Ettutogai, Pattu-Pattu* Patinenkanakku	49

*Ettutogai and Pattu-Pattu are called Melakanakku.

Sangam Epics: Silappadikaram, Manimekalai, Sivaga Sindamani, etc. Around the 6th century A.D. the two epics, *i.e.* Silappadikaram (the story of the Anklet) and Manimekalai were composed. The first was written by **Ilango Adigal** which deals with the story of Kovalan and Madhavi of Kaveripattinam. Kovalan falls in love with Madhavi and forgets his noble wedded wife Kannagi. This epic is called '*Illiad of Tamil poetry*'. The Manimekalai, written by a grain merchant named **Sittalai Sattanar**, deals with the adventures of Manimekala, the daughter born of Kovalan and Madhavi. The authors of the two epics were friends who were the contemporaries of the Chera King Senguttuvan, who ruled in the 2nd century A.D. These epics reflect the social and economic life of the Tamils upto about the 6th century A.D. The Manimekalai is strongly tinged with Buddhism whereas the Sivaga Sindamani (Jivaka Chintamani), written by Jain Tiruttakradevas, is tinged with Jainism. Sivaga Sindamani shows the dominance of Sanskrit style over the indigenous style of the previous epics. Bharatam, a Tamil epic, was composed of Perudevanar. It also has great importance in Tamil literature.

Sangam Literature and their authors	Authors	Subject/nature/Hint
Agattiyam	Agastya	A work on grammar of letters
Tolkappiyam (Tamil grammar)	Tolakapiyyar	A treatise on grammar & poetry
Ettutogai (8 anthologies)	- -	Melkannakku combined form.
Pattu Pattu (10 idyls)	- -	Melkannakku combined form.
Patinenkilakanakku (18 minor works)	- -	A didactic work.
Kural (Muppai)	Tiruvalluvar	A treatise on polity, ethics, social norms.
Silappadikaram	Ilango Adigal	A love story of Kovalan and Madhavi
Manimekalai	Sittalai Sattanar	The adventures of Manimekalai

Sivaga Sindamani	Tiruttakadevar	A sanskrit treatise
Bharatam	Perudevanar	The last epic
Pannirupadalam (grammar)	12 disciples of Agastya	A grammatical work on puram literature
Kakkipadiniyam (Prosody)	- -	A work on prosody

Assess Yourself

Match the Column	
A. The earliest tamil work	1. Kural or Muppall
B. The Bible of Tamil land	2. Agattiyam
C. The Illiyad of Tamil poetry	3. Silappadikaram
D. A book of Philosophy & Maxims	4. Tirukkural

Know more about Literature	
Some important Literature/Books	Writer
Anekant Vijay	Haribhadra Suri
Kuvalaymala	Udyaodan Souri
Kalpasutra	Bhadrabahu
Nyaya Bhasya	Vatsyayana
Mudra Rakshas	Vishakha Dutt
Malvikagnimitram	Kalidas
Raghuvamsam	Kalidas
Meghdootam	Kalidas
Ritusamahar	Kalidas
Mrichcha katikam	Shudrak
Kam Sutra	Vatsyayana

Kadambari	Banbhata
Ballal Charit	Anand Bhatt
Katha Sarit Sagar	Somadeva
Kavya Darsha	Dandin
Kirartarjunyam	Bharavi
Nitishatakma	Bhartahari
Vikramovarshiyam	Kalidas
Charudatta	Bhasa
Pratigya Yaugan dharayana	Bhasa
Prayag Prasasti	Harisena
Sankhya Akarika	Ishwar krishna
Padartha Dharma	Sangraha
Vyasa Bhasya (A yogopphi)	Acharya Vyasa

ARCHAEOLOGICAL SOURCES

The systematic study of ancient buildings, monuments and work of art present evidences and knowledge about the ancient world. Coins, Inscriptions, Monuments and Material from excavations are the great sources through which we study about the old civilization and culture of ancient time.

Excavations

The credit for excavating the Pre-Aryan past goes to *Sir William Jones* of Asiatic Bengal Society (established on 1st Jan 1784). James Prinsep, the Secretary of ABS succeeded for the first time in deciphering the Brahmi script. Sir Alexander Cunningham, the *father of Indian archaeology*, arrived India in 1831. He judged out the ruins of ancient site of Pre-Aryan Civilization. He judged out the ruins of ancient side of pre-Aryan culture. He was appointed Archaeological surveyor by the Indian Government.

Later on, in 1901, Lord Curzon revived this work and John Marshall was appointed as its director general and he discovered

the cities Harappa and Mohenjodara. Rakhal Das Banerji, in 1922, found seals at Mohenjodaro. It was the remains of pre-Aryan civilization. Later on the sites were excavated under the direction of Marshall from 1924 to 1931.

Sir R.E. Mortimer Wheeler made important discoveries at Harappa after the Second World War. Indian epigraphists as Bhanu Daji, Bhagavanlal Indraj, Rajendralal Mitra and R.G. Bahndarkar contributed in the excavations of new sites.

12 Angas – (Acharang Sutta, Suyagandang Sutta, Thanang, Samvayang Sutta, Bhagvati Sutta, Nayadhammakaha Sutta, Uvasagdasao Sutta,) etc. **11 Upangas** - (Aupapatik, Rajprashniya, Jeevabhigham, Pushya Chulika, etc). **10 Prakirnanas**-(Bhati Pariksha, Sanstar, Tandul Vaitalik, etc.) **06 Chhed Sutras**-(Nisheeth, Mahanisheeth, Vyavahar, Panchkalpa, etc.) **04 Mula Sutras** Uttradhyayan, Khadavshyak, Dashvaikali, Pakshik, Sutta, etc.).

Coins

- The study of coins is called *numismatics*. Important historical facts are obtained through it. Samudragupta's Aswamedha coins, lion slayer coins reflect his ambitions and love of hunting. He has been seen playing on a lyre in a coin that gives an idea of his love of music. The **Punch Mark Coins** (of silver and copper) are the *earliest coins of India*. The Kushanas issued Gold coins depicting many deities on their coins. The coins of Vima Kadphises bear the figure of Lord Shiva. Thus, coins are helpful in discovering ideas about the complementary economic condition and provide facts with date that help us in fixing chronology. In *Panini's Astadhyayee*, Brahmin literature and Upanishadas we find the descriptions of Vedic coins or currency named Nishka, Shatman, Suvarna, and Panishka. The Gold coins of Gupta's period are quite important in this context.
- Inscriptions:** Inscriptions are the words cut on stone or metals. The study of inscriptions is called *epigraphy*. Inscriptions are the most reliable evidence and are free from interpolations. Ashoka's rock-cut edicts, pillar edicts, inscriptions of Kharvela and Allahabad Prasasti by Harisena and the inscriptions found at Khalimpur and Bhagalpur of the Gupta Age are important evidences.

Important Inscriptions
Samudragupta ⇒ Prayag Prasasti
Eran Prasasti
Nalanda Copper Plate.
Chandragupta II ⇒ Mehrauli Iron pillar
Skandagupta ⇒ Junagarh Prasasti
• Bhitari Prasasti
• Indore Royal Charter
Buddhagupta Paharpur ⇒ Copper Plate (R.C.)
Bagaz Kui ins. ⇒ Rigvedic Indian Gods, <i>i.e.</i> Indra, Varun, Mitra, etc.

Monuments

Monuments and buildings reflect the growth of material prosperity and the development of culture. The ancient monuments of Taxshila provide information about the Kushanas and its sculpture imparts the knowledge of Gandhar Kala. The Mauryan history is known by the *Stupas*, *Chaityas* and *Vihars*.

Famous Ancient Monuments (Indian and Foreign)	
Monument	Place
Sarnath	Varanasi
Ajant-Alora	Aurangabad
Dashavatar Mandir	Devgarh, Lalitpur
Bhitargaon's brick temple	Kanpur
Parvati Mandir	Nachan Kuthar
Shiva Mandir	Donda Plature, Java
Angkorvat Mandir	Cambodia
Borobudoor	Java
Bogajkoi and Percipolus	Turkey
Vaishnan Mandir	Kano Mountain Malaya

Some important literature/Books	Writer
Amarkosha	Amarsimha
Chandrvyakarana	Chandragomin
Panchatantra	Vishnu Sharma
Hitopadesha	Narayan Bhatta
Aryabhattachiya	Aryabhattacha
Dasajitika Sutra	Aryabhattacha
Aryashtashata	Varahmihira
Brihatsamhita	Varahmihira
Panchasidhantika	Varahmihira
Laghu and Brihat Jataka	Varahmihira
Nitisastra	Kamandaka
Natya Darpan	Ramchandra
Kavyalankara	Bhamaha
Dashpadarthashastra	Dignaga
Brahma Sidhanta	Brahmagupta
Charak Samhita	Charak
Astanga hridaya	Vagbhata
Shalya Shastra	Sushruta
Ashwashastra	Shalihotra
Nayayavatar	Sudhasena
Visuddim agga	Buddhaghosa
Praman samuchchay	Ignaga
Nyayapranesh	Dingnath
Bhattikavya	Bhatti
Tatvarthadhigham sutra	Umashwati
Mitakshara	Vigyaneshwar
Setubandh	Pravarsen
Abhinav bharti	Abhinav Gupta
Shringar Prakash	Bhoj

ACCOUNTS OF FOREIGN TRAVELLERS AND WRITERS

Before the arrival of Alexander, some Greek authors like Herodotus, Ktesia, Hikeitios and Skylax wrote some scripts of information about India. With the expedition of Alexander the great some men of letters came to India and took interest in Indian philosophy and culture. Among them Aristobolus, Anesicritus and Neorkus are very famous. Megasthenes, the ambassador of Seleukos Nikator to Chandragupta Maurya, wrote a highly valuable account of India, in his book 'INDICA'. This book was translated by Maicrindal.

Tsumachin (100 B.C.) , the *father of the history of China*, was the first Chinese historian describing about India. Tibetan writer **Lama Taranath** wrote Kangyur and Tangyur through which we know about Shaka, Kushan and Parthians. In about 8th century A.D. close relationship sprouted between India and Arab countries. Arab writers and travellers started taking interest in writing about Indian society and its code and conducts which became a source of knowledge through which a datewise history could be constructed. Let us study the following chart.

Books of Foreign Travellers

Author	Book	Subject
↓ Greek Mega sthenese . . . Ptolemy 2nd cent A. D. . . Ariens 2nd cent A.D. . . Pliny 1st cent A.D. . . Anonymous (A.D. 80) . .	Indica Geography Indica, Invasion of Alexander Natural historia Per iplus of the Erythreans Sea	• Information of Mauryan India. • Geographical treatise on India. • Based on the contemporary authors of Alexander • Trade relation between Rome and India, Indian animal and plants. • Personal Voyage of Indian Coasts.
↓ Chinese Tsumachi n 1st cent. B.C. . . Fa-Hien (A.D. 399) . . Hieun-Tsang (A.D. 629) . . Itsing (A.D. 670) Hwuili . .	Recor doft he Buddhist Countries Buddhi st record of the western world A record of Buddhistic religion Life of Hieun Tsang	• Personal opinion about India. • The Gupta Emperor - the 5th cent .A.D • Condition of India in the period of Harshavardhan. • The Guptas under Sri Gupta in the 7th Cent .AD. • Accounts of Hiuen Tsang's travel in India.
↓ Mohammadan Writer Ibne Khurdadab . . . 9th Cent.A .D. Suleiman . . Almasudi . . Albiruni . . Ibna-Batuta . .	Kita bul Masalak wal Mamalik Silsija-ul -Tavarish Muruj-ul-Jahan Tarikh-ul-Hind Rihla	• Indian society and trade ways. • Indian sea coast, conventions, culture. • Indian society. • Contemporary Indian history. • India under the Kingship of Muhammad Tughlaq

Some Remarkable Facts

1. *Beal* and *waters* translated the work of Hiuen-Tsang.
2. *Herodotus* is regarded as the father of History wrote '**Historica**'.
3. *Hiuen-Tsang* is called the *King of travellers* who wrote '**Si-Eu-Ki**'
4. *Takkusu* translated 'Si-Eu-Ki' under the name of **A record of the Buddhist region**.

Exercise -1

1. Who among the following is known to have regulated the course of Vitasta in Kashmir by his engineering operations?
(a) Vajraditya (b) Damodargupta
(c) Sura (d) Suyya
2. The Sangam text Tolkappiyam is a work on
(a) Astronomy (b) Grammar
(c) Music (d) Medicine
3. The earliest evidence of Silk in India comes from the archaeological site of
(a) Bhagwanpura (b) Nevasa
(c) Rangpur (d) Ropar
4. An upper Palaeolithic Mother Goddess made of bone has been obtained from
(a) Godavari valley (b) Narmada valley
(c) Son valley (d) Belan valley
5. The Third Tamil Sangam was held at
(a) Tanjore (b) Madurai
(c) Kanjeevaram (d) Mahabalipuram
6. The earliest inscriptions were written in which language?
(a) Pali (b) Prakrit
(c) Sanskrit (d) Tamil
7. The ancient Indian play Mudrarakshasa of Visakhadutt has its subject on:
(a) a conflict between Gods and Demons of ancient Hindu lore
(b) a romantic story of an Aryan prince and a tribal woman
(c) the story of the power struggle between two Aryan
(d) the court intrigues at the time of Chandragupta
8. From among the following, which pair is not matched?
(a) Patanjali – Mahabhashya
(b) Hala – Gatha Saptshati
(c) Bhadrabahu – Brihat Katha Manjari
(d) Ashvaghosa – Harsh Charit
9. The objects like pottery, tools and ornaments that humans made in the past are called
(a) Monuments (b) Coins
(c) Inscriptions (d) Artifacts
10. Which one of the following is not a part of early Jains literature?
(a) Therigatha (b) Acaranga sutra
(c) Sutrakritanga (d) Brihat kalpasutra
11. The famous Vedic saying, “War begins in the minds of men”, is stated in the :
(a) Upanishad (b) Atharvaveda
(c) Samaveda (d) Yajurveda
12. Which of the following does the Puranas contain?
(a) Laws of Manu and the history on various dynasties
(b) Hymns in favour of the Gods
(c) Thoughts on the mystery of life and universe
(d) Mythology
13. Most of the Upanishads seem to have been composed by whom?
(a) Brahmins (b) Kshatriyas
(c) Buddhists (d) Non-aryans
14. Who wrote a book ‘Return of the Aryans’ ?
(a) Bhagvan Das Gidvani
(b) L.D. Kalla
(c) Avinash Chandra Das
(d) D.S. Trivedi
15. Which of the following Brahmana texts belongs to Atharvaveda?
(a) Shatapatha (b) Aitareya
(c) Gopatha (d) Panchavinsh
16. The expounder of Yoga philosophy was :
(a) Patanjali (b) Shankaracharya
(c) Jaimini (d) Gautam
17. The famous dialogue between Nachiketa and Yama is mentioned in the :
(a) Chhandogyopanishad
(b) Mundakopnishad
(c) Kathopanishad
(d) Kenopanishad
18. Which of the following pairs indicating the contents of the sacred Buddhist Pitakas is not correctly matched?
(a) Vinaya Pitaka — rules of monastic discipline
(b) Abhidhamma Pitaka — philosophical development of the Buddha’s teachings
(c) Sutta Pitaka — Stories of the Buddha’s previous births (Jataka stories)
(d) Dhammapada — The original sermon of the Buddha of Sarnath
19. Robert Bruce foote, who discovered first palaeolithic tool in India, was originally a
(a) Palaeobotanist
(b) Geologist
(c) Archaeologist
(d) Historian
20. The earliest Buddhist literature which deal with the stories of the various birth of Buddha are
(a) Vinaya pitakas (b) Sutta pitakas
(c) Abhidamma pitakas (d) Jatakas

Exercise -2

1. Consider the following statements :
 1. Historians use the word source to refer to the information found from manuscripts, inscriptions and archaeology.
 2. Ramayana and Mahabharata are also important source of ancient Indian history.
 Which of the above is / are correct?
 - (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
 - (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
2. Mrichhakatikam, written by Shudraka deals with
 1. The love affair of a rich merchant with the daughter of a courtesan.
 2. The military expedition of Samudragupta.
 Which of the above is correct?
 - (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
 - (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
3. Consider the following statements: Al-Beruni's Kitab-ul-Hind is
 1. A sympathetic study of Indian civilization.
 2. Mainly a political history of India.
 3. Critical of Mahmud Ghaznavi's plundering raids of India.
 4. Mainly a study of India's cultural, social and intellectual history.
 Which of the above statement(s) is/are correct?
 - (a) 1, 3 and 4 (b) 1 and 4
 - (c) 2 and 4 (d) Alone
4. With reference to the Jambudvipa, consider the statements
 1. Bharatvarsha was also called Jambudvipa.
 2. Early Buddhist evidence suggests that Jambudvipa was a territorial designation from the third century BC.
 Which of the above is / are correct?
 - (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
 - (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
5. Who among the following teachers were visited by Siddhartha Gautama in the quest of knowledge before his enlightenment?
 1. Alara Kalama 2. Udraka Ramaputra
 3. Makkhali Gosala 4. Nigantha Nataputta
 Indicate your answer from the codes given below:

Codes:

 - (a) 1 and 4 (b) 4 and 2
 - (c) 2 and 3 (d) 1 and 2
6.

List-I A. Tirukkural B. Shilpadikaram C. Manimakhilai D. Tolkappiyam	List-II 1. Ilangoadigal 2. Sattanar 3. Tolkappiyar 4. Tiruvalluvar
--	--

Codes:

A	B	C	D
(a) 4	1	2	3
(b) 1	4	3	2
(c) 4	1	3	2
(d) 1	4	2	3
7.

List-I A. Abhidhamma Pitaka B. Sutta Pitaka C. Vinaya Pitaka D. Mahasanghika	List-II 1. Matters of doctrine and ethics 2. Rules of monk order 3. Members of great community 4. Matters of psychology and metaphysics
--	---

Codes:

A	B	C	D
(a) 2	4	1	3
(b) 3	1	4	2
(c) 2	1	4	3
(d) 4	1	2	3
8.

List-I (Author) A. Sudraka B. Visakhadatta C. Kalidasa D. Bhavabhuti	List-II (Work) 1. Mrichhakatikan 2. Mudrarakshasa 3. Vikramorvasiyam 4. Uttara Ramacharita
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Codes:

A	B	C	D
(a) 1	2	3	4
(b) 2	3	1	4
(c) 4	2	3	1
(d) 3	1	4	2
9.

List-I A. Time taken by the Earth to orbit the sun B. Calculation of the value of π (pi) C. Invention of the digit Zero D. The game of snakes & ladders	List-II 1. Aryabhata 2. Bhaskaracharya 3. Budhayana 4. Gyanadev
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Codes:

A	B	C	D
(a) 2	4	1	3
(b) 1	3	2	4
(c) 2	3	1	4
(d) 1	4	2	3
10. Which of the following statements is/ are correct?
 1. Early Buddhist literature is generally composed of the canonical text.
 2. The Buddhist schools classify their canonical literature as only the Pitakas.
 Select the correct answer using the code given below:
 - (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
 - (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
11. Consider the following statements relating to Jain literature :
 1. The sacred books of the Jainas are known as Siddhanta or Agama.
 2. The language of the earliest Jain texts is eastern dialect of Pali known as Ardha Magadhi.
 Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
 - (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
 - (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Hints and Explanations

EXERCISE-1

1. (d) Suyya is known by his engineering operations regulated the course of the Vitasta in Kashmir, thereby arresting the devastating periodical floods and consequent famine and promoted irrigation and agricultural operations over an extensive area.
2. (b) The Tolkappiyam is a work on the grammar of the Tamil language and the earliest extant work of Tamil literature written by Tholkappiyar.
3. (b)
4. (d) Mother goddess of bone has been obtained from the upper Palaeolithic level of the Belan valley.
5. (b) 6. (b)
7. (d) The Mudrarakshasa ("The Signet of the Minister"), a historical play in Sanskrit by Vishakhadatta (4th century CE) narrates the ascent of the king Chandragupta Maurya to power in Northern India.
8. (c) 9. (d)
10. (a) Therigatha was a part of the Buddhist literature.
11. (d) 12. (d) 13. (b)
14. (a) The book 'Return of the Aryans' was written by Bhagvan S. Gidvani. This book tells the epic story of the Aryans – a gripping tale of kings and poets, seers and gods, battles and romance and the rise and fall of civilizations.
15. (c) The Gopatha Brahmana is the only Brahmana, a genre of the prose texts describing the Vedic rituals, associated with the Atharvaveda.
16. (a) The ancient Sage Patanjali was an expounder of the Yoga Sutras one of the most important text of yoga covering all aspects of life. Patanjali's Yoga Sutras describe the working of the mind and emotions.
17. (c) The famous dialogue between Nachiketa and Yama about transmigration of soul is mentioned in the Kathopanishad.
18. (d) 19. (b)
20. (d) Jatakas are the stories that tell about the previous lives of the Buddha, in both human and animal form.

EXERCISE-2

1. (c)
2. (a) Mrichchhakatikam is attributed to Sudraka it is a ten act drama. It deals with the love story of a rich merchant with the daughter of a courtesan.
3. (a) 4. (c)
5. (d) Gautama studied under various teachers and followed their practices until he mastered them all. His first teacher was Alara Kalama who taught a form of meditation leading to an exalted form of

absorption called "the state of no-thingness", a state without moral or cognitive dimension. Gautama saw this was not going to solve suffering, and continued his search.

The next teacher was Udraka Ramaputra who taught him meditative absorption leading to "the state of neither perception nor non-perception". Again, Gautama realised this was not the state he was looking for. (Both Alara and Udraka are by some scholars considered to be Jain followers.)

6. (a) Correctly matched pairs are:

Tirukkural — Tiruvalluvar
Shilpadikaram — Ilangoadigal
Manimekhalai — Sattanar
Tolkappiyam — Tolkappiyar

7. (d) The Abhidhamma Pitaka is the last of the three Pitakas constituting the Pali Canon, the scriptures of Theravada Buddhism. Abhidhamma has been variously described as philosophy, psychology, metaphysics, etc. Sutta Pitaka matches with matters of doctrine and ethics.

The Vinaya Pitaka is a Buddhist scripture, one of the three parts that make up the Tripitaka. Its primary subject matter is the monastic rules for monks and nuns.

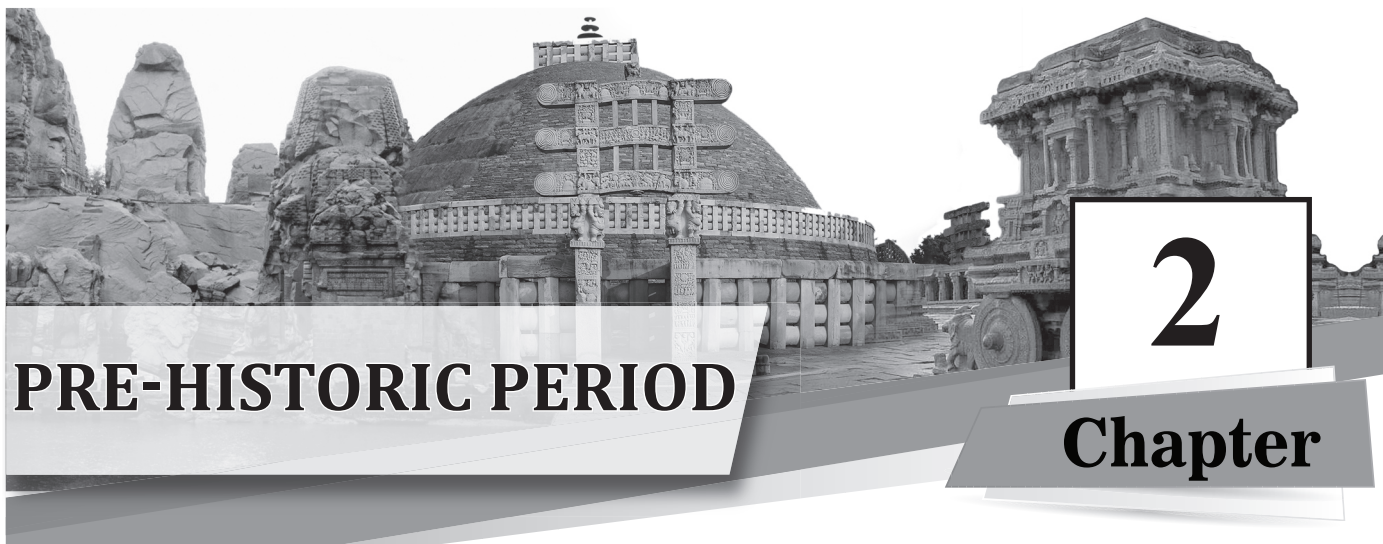
Mahasanghika matches with members of great community.

8. (a) The Correct match list of author and their works is :

Author	Work
Sudraka	Mrichhakatikam
Visakhadatta	Mudrarakshasa
Kalidasa	Vikramorvasiyam
Bhavabhuti	Uttara Ramacharita

Sudraka's Mrichhakatikam (The little clay Cart) is unquestionably a master piece in the realm of ancient Sanskrit drama. If we expect literature of the time to faithfully represent the age then the little clay cart has achieved this criterion more than any other plays of ancient Sanskrit tradition. The Mudrarakshasa ("Signet Ring of the Rakshasa, the Chief Minister of the last Nanda King"), a historical play in Sanskrit by Visakhadatta (4th century CE) narrates the ascent of the king Chandragupta Maurya to power in Northern India with the aid of Chanakya, his Guru and Chief Minister. Vikramorvasiyam (Urvasi won Through valor) is based on the old legend of the love of the mortal Pururavaas for the heavenly damse Urvasi. Uttara Ramacharita (The story of Rama's later life), depicts Rama's coronation, the abandonment of Sita, and their reunion.

9. (c) The correct match list is:
- Aryabhatta — Invention of the digit zero.
 Bhaskaracharya — Time taken by the earth to orbit the sun.
 Budhayana — Calculation of the value of π (Pi)
 Gyandeva — The game of snakes and ladders
- Zero was invented in India by Indian mathematicians dating as early as 5th century. They widely used it in calculations, astronomy and astrology. Zero was spread by Arabians to the Europe and thereon it was spread all over. The famous Hindu mathematician, Bhaskaracharya, in his treatise Surya Siddhanta, calculated the time taken for the earth to orbit the sun to nine decimal places (365.258756484 days). Bhaskaracharya rightly calculated the time taken by the earth to orbit the sun hundreds of years before the astronomer Smart. His calculations was – Time taken by earth to orbit the sun (5th century): 365.258756484 days. The value of Pi was first calculated by Budhayana, and he explained the concept of what is known as the Pythagorean Theorem. The game of snakes and ladders is most popular in almost all houses and across all countries of the world. The credit for the game should go to the 13th century Marathi saint poet composer Gyanadev, Jnanadeva, also known as Jnanashwar. When the saint invented the game it was called Mokshapat.
10. (c) Canonical texts are those that are linked to Gautama Buddha in one way or another. Canonical texts comprise three different kind of texts - the sutras (discourses), vinaya (discipline) and abhidharma (analytical texts), together they are called the 'Three Baskets' or Tipitaka (in Pali language) and Tripitaka (in Sanskrit).
11. (a) **Agam Literature**-This consists of original scriptures compiled by Gandharas and Srut-kevalis. They are written in the Prakrit language.
Non-agam Literature-This consists of commentary and explanation of Agam literature and independent works, compiled by elder monks, nuns, and scholars. They are written in many languages such as Prakrit, Sanskrit, Old Marathi, Gujarati, Hindi, Kannad, Tamil, German, and English.



PRE-HISTORIC PERIOD

2

Chapter

Introduction

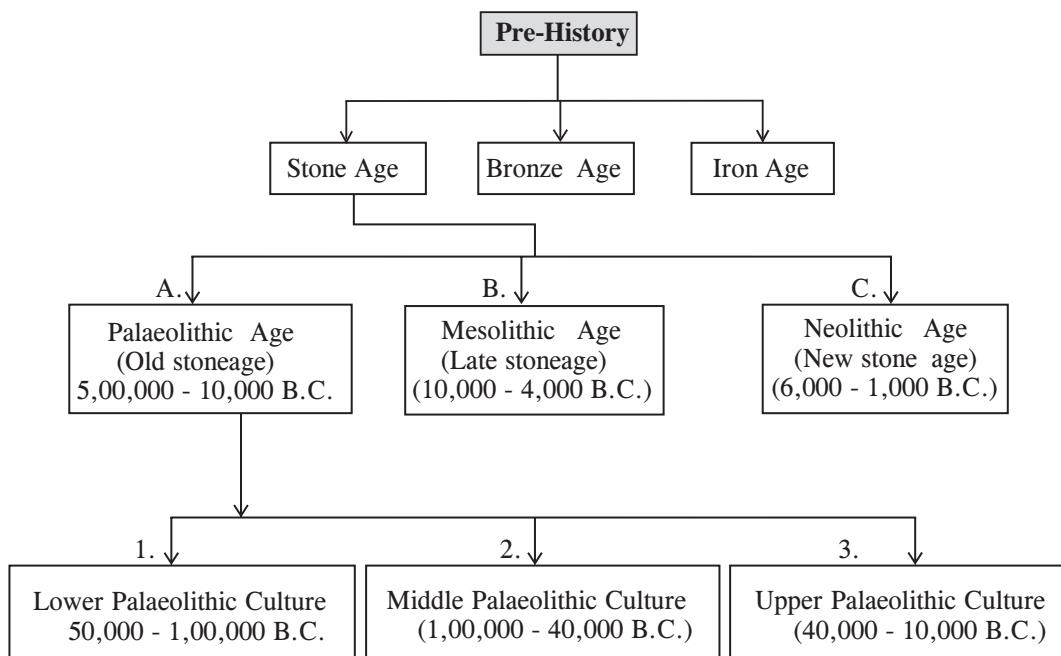
The credit for the rediscovery of Indian pre-history goes to **Dr. Primrose**, an Englishman, who was the first person to discover pre-historic implements (*stone knives and arrow-heads*) in 1842 at *Lingsugur* (Karnataka). However *John Evans* was first to publish discovery of *flints* on the bed of the Narmada river near Jabalpur in 1853.

In 1930, M.C. Burkitt published an account of collection from the *Krishna basin* and in 1935 H.de Terra of T.T. Paterson studied the glacial sequence of *Kashmir* and *Punjab*. The efforts of the 1940s resulted in the publication of *Stuart Piggott's Prehistoric India* in 1950.

Historians divide the Pre - historic period into three sections-

1. Stone age
2. Bronze age
3. Iron age

For the study of these ages we have nothing except fossils and some tools and paintings left by them. We *do not have any written record* as the primitive people were unaware of pen and papers. The primitive people were shorter in height and had a smaller brain. They did not have a social life like us. The *earliest human fossils* has been found in *Africa* dating about *4.2 million* years. No easily *human fossils* have been found in India except a ***hominid fossil*** from ***Hathnawia*** in the Narmada valley dating back to 1.4 million years ago. The stone age is divided into three parts, i.e Palaeolithic, Mesolithic and Neolithic ages. Let us study this chart.



STONE AGE

A. Palaeolithic (Old Stone) Age

In 1930, **Gabriel de montillet**, a french investigator, started naming the cultural divisions in the manner of compartments or stages. In this context the Palaeolithic age (old stone age) comes first. It was an age of hunting and food gathering culture. *Palaeo* means 'old' and '*lithic*' means 'stone'. For this it is called palaeolithic which is divided into three phases Lower, Middle and upper Palaeolithic culture.

1. Lower Palaeolithic Age (5,00,000-1,00,000 B.C.)

It covers the greater part of the *Ice Age*. The people were wanderers. They did not know how to grow food. They used to eat fruits, birds and raw animal flesh, etc. The tools were usually made of hard rock, '*Quartzite*' and therefore the man of Palaeolithic age is called '*Quartzite Man*'. For hunting they used hand-axe, cleavers, flaxes and chopper of irregular shapes. Fossil of "Homo Erectus", from Hathnaura (Narmada basin), of this age has been found. This age is represented by *Sohan culture* (Now in Pakistan).

Important Sites:

Sohan Valley (Punjab), Belan Valley (Mirzapur), Narmada Valley (Madhya Pradesh), Didwani (Rajasthan), and Bhimbetka (M.P.), Singrauli basin (U.P), Chhotanagpur (Jharkhand), Assam, Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka and in whole India except Sind Kerala.

2. Middle Palaeolithic Age (1,00,000 - 40,000 B. C.)

It was an *age of flakes*. A bit change in the shape of tools made of stones or bones is remarked. Now they started using blades, points and scrappers made of flakes. Still they had no house to live in. They lived under the rocks in caves and hollow tree trunks. They were afraid of wild creatures. *Neanderthal* man dominated this stage of human evolution.

Important Sites:

Bankura and Purulia (West Bengal), Nevasa, Nodur Madhmeshwar, Suregaon and Nevasa (Maharashtra), Malprabha and Ghatprabha basin (Karnataka). Narmada valley, etc. In Bhimbetka (M.P) 200 rock shelters, caves and thousands of paintings have been traced which are of middle Palaeolithic age, i.e scrapper and borer culture.

3. Upper Palaeolithic Age (40,000 - 10,000 B.C.)

In this period, human lived as *nomadic* hunter-gatherers. The traces of *Homo sapiens* have been discovered. Rock paintings and carvings have been found in Bhimbetka that reflect art and rituals of this period. The animals

depicted in these are mostly bisons, elephants, tigers, boars, rhinoceros, etc. The upper Palaeolithic art is characterised by red and green colours.

Important Sites:

Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Bhopal (Bhimbetka) and Chhotanagpur (Jharkhand).

Points to Remember

- P.F. Shum Designated the cultural past of man in as early as 1776.
- In 1836. C.J. Thomson arranged the exhibits in Danish museums.
- Lubbock of France divided the stone age into Palaeolithic & Neolithic in 1865.
- The Palaeolithic culture of India developed in Pleistocene period.
- First of all Robert Bruce discovered a Palaeolithic stone tool in India in 1863.
- With the coming of Yale Cambridge Expedition in 1935, led by Deterra and Paterson the research for the Palaeolithic got a new height in India.

B. Mesolithic Age (10,000 - 4,000 B.C.)

It was an intermediate stage in the stone age ended with the introduction of agriculture. It is also known as late stone age or Microlithic age. The domestication of animals have been witnessed from M.P and Rajasthan. Men were still savage but pottery making (Tilwara) and permanent habitation were in existence.

Tools: Microliths (tools) were very small in size and length varies from 1 to 8 cm. Backed blade, core, point, triangle, lunate and trapeze were the main tools. Some of earlier used were continued like scraper, burin, choppers, etc.

Important Sites:

Bagor, Tilwara (Rajasthan), Akhaj, Valasana, Langhnaj, Hirpur (Gujarat), etc. The earliest evidence for the domestication of animals has been founded in Bagor. It has provided stone paved habitational floors, human burials besides some tiny pieces of handmade potsherds. Langhnaj has three cultural phases. The first produced microliths, burials and animal bones, the second phase has two ground axes and a ring stone and the third phase is remarkable for potsherds.

In central and North India we have Bhimbetka (M.P) where many rock shelters with microliths on floor and paintings on walls have found. In Adamgarh we have got signs of animals domestication. Sarai Nahar Rai Morhana Pahar and Lekhani are some important sites. Burnt clay lumps and fire hearths have been discovered from these sites.

Coming towards the eastern part of India we have so many places from where microliths (fairly large and prepared on block chlorite stone) have been discovered. Burdwan, Purulia Bankura (West Bengal); Mayurbhanj, Keonjhar, Sundergarh and Kuchai in Orissa and Chhota Nagpur in Jharkhand and Sehargigi in Meghalaya are the important sites of this location. In South, 11 sites of microlithic clusters have been found in Tinnevely district of Tamil Nadu, 25 microlithic sites are reported in the area between Krishna and Bhima rivers in Shorapur doab.

C. Neolithic Age (6,000 - 1,000 B.C.)

It was an age of polished tool culture. Men started living a settled life. Agriculture and domestication of animals were started. They discovered the art of producing fire by the friction of stones and got the taste of cooked flesh. For hunting bows and arrows were invented. They learnt the art of pottery. Their pots were well made and decorated with paintings. They had the knowledge of boat making for journey. They also learnt the art of spinning and weaving clothes. Tool making became an important profession and a variety of polished tools were manufactured. Picks, scrapers, bodkins, chisels, mortars, eyed needles and pierced batons were the important tools. Neolithic men started respecting their ancestors. They offered honourable burial for the dead and constructed tombs for them. These tombs were called Dolmens. It was an age of revolution, i.e. neolithic revolution of stone age. The wheel was an important discovery of this age.

Important Neolithic Sites

Sites/State

- | | |
|------------------------------|-----------------------|
| • Chirand, Chechar | - Bihar |
| • Kuchai | - Mayurbhanj (Orissa) |
| • Taradih & Singhbhum | - West Bengal |
| • Uthur, Nagarjunakonda | - Andhra Pradesh |
| • Maski, Brahmagiri, Hallur, | - Karnataka |
| • Tekkalakota, Sanganakallu | |
| • Paiyampalli | - Tamil Nadu |
| • Burzahom & Gufkral | - Kashmir |
| • Bellan, Chopani Mando | - Uttar Pradesh |

M.H. Krishnan has found some polished tools in Mysore. Burzahom is remarkable for pit-jewellery houses.

Points to Remember

- The word 'neolithic' was coined by John Lubbock in 1865.
- In 1860, Le Mesurier made the discovery of neolithic tools.
- In South India, Fresher discovered neolithic tools in Bellary.
- The microliths were discovered by Carlyle in 1867 from Vindhya Rock shelters.
- Subbarao excavated, in 1948, at Sangankallu in Bellary.
- Palaeolithic man in India is also called 'Quartziteman'.

CHALCOLITHIC (BRONZE) AGE

This age is marked by the use of copper as copper was the first metal used by the man of this age. The economy was based on subsistence agriculture, stock-raising, hunting and fishing. The dead were buried in North-South position in Maharashtra but in South India it was in East-West direction. The chalcolithic people slaughtered animals for food. Some perforated stone disc are found which were used for *jhum-cultivation*. The supply of copper was limited. People did not know the art of mixing tin with copper. The decline in rainfall from about 1200 B.C. led to the decay of this culture. Due to the agitation of epidemics the culture of chalcolithic people came to an end. Transitional stage between stone age and humans started living settled life.

Important sites:

Probably, this culture was extended from the Chhotanagpur plateau to the upper Gangetic basin. Some sites are found at Brahmagiri near Mysore and Navada Toli on the Narmada.

Copper hoards have been found in a wide area from West Bengal, Orissa, Haryana, Andhra Pradesh and Uttar Pradesh. From Gungeria (M.P) we have found 424 copper tools and weapons and 102 thin sheets of silver objects. Stone tools have also been found in excavations. Mostly the copper hoards

were supplemented by stone tools that paved the way of a settled life in a good portion of the Ganga - Yamuna doab. Besides these, the two types of pottery, i.e. O.C.P. (Ochre Coloured Pottery) and B.R.W. (Black and Red Ware), showing Harappan influence, have been excavated from various sites.

O.C.P. (2000 BC - 1500 B.C) : It is essentially a red-slipped ware. From a trial excavation carried out in Bisauli (Badaun) and Rajpur Parsu (Bihar). It was revealed that the ochre coloured pottery wares occurred below the early Iron Age levels. The copper hoard culture represents one of the transitional phases of the Harappan intrusion into the Gangetic Valley.

B.R.W. (1000 B.C) : The O.C.P culture was succeeded by B.R.W which was an attractive variety of ceramics prepared by a fringing technique. From the inside and around the rim on the outside these are completely black and the rest of the outer surface is brick red. Chemical studies show that the black colour is caused by carbon. It is concluded that the some dried pot must have been given a coating of some organic resin, oil or some other matter, before firing. During firing the organic material on the surface is burnt leaving the carbon free. Black and Red wares are usually medium to small in size which can be called 'Table wares' usually limited to bowls and dishes.

Some Important Features of Chalcolithic Age

- Both Kharif and Rabi crops were cultivated
- Barley was the main crop.
- A highly specialised store blade industry of siliceous stone is found.
- Cotton was produced first time in this period.
- First village communities in Peninsular India was found.
- Jhum cultivation was practised.
- First time fortified settlements were built, e.g. sites of Daimabad, Inamgaon, Nagada, etc.

Chalcolithic Culture at a Glance

Culture	Period	Ware-features	Grown crops	Sites
Ahar Culture	2800-1500 B.C	White designed black and red ware.	rice, ragi, gram, jwar, bajra, kulthi, lentil.	Ahar, Balahal, Gilund. (Rajasthan)
Kayatha culture	2450-1700 B.C	Chocolate coloured slipped ware, red painted buff ware, combed ware.	rice, ragi, gram, jwar, bajra, kulthi, lentil.	Chambal and its tributaries. (Madhya Pradesh)
Malwa Culture	1900-1400 B.C	The walwas ware is coarse in fabric with thick buff surface.	Wheat & barley.	Narmada and its tributaries, Navada toli, Eran, Nagada. (The largest chalcolithic settlement) in M.P.
Savaldia Culture	2300-200 B.C	-	-	Dhuria (Maharashtra)
Jorwe Culture	1500-900 B.C	painted black on red with matt surface dishes on stand, sprouted vases, stemmed cups, jars, basins etc.	rice, ragi, gram, jwar, bajra, kulthi, lentil.	Maharashtra, Prakash, Daimabad and Inamgaon.
Prabhas Culture	2000-1400 B.C	Lustrous Red Ware (Harappan / Indus civilisation) belonged to this culture)	-	-
Rangpur Culture	1700 - 1400 B.C	Lustrous Red Ware (Harappa Indus belong to this culture civilisation)	-	Gheol and Kallubhar rivers in Gujarat

IRON AGE

The 'Iron Age' in the *world context* began about 1300 B.C. Its use in India also began around this period. But *Gordon* could find no evidence for the use of iron in India before 250 B.C. and *Wheeler* thought that the knowledge was introduced by *Achaemenids* in 500 B.C. However, Banerjee opined that Iron working began as early as 1000 B.C. and became common around 800 B.C.

We have evidence of Iron at Pirak (1000 B.C.); at Mundigak and in the graves of Gandhara (1000 B.C.). In South India also Iron appeared around 1000 B.C. in Dharwar (Karnataka).

Iron age is usually associated with the painted grey ware (P.G.W.) the ceramics which have been fired grey and then painted with black designs. Thus, the grey colour was obtained by firing thin clay pots to as high a temperature as 800°C. For these wares no grey colour was used for making them attractive.

Pre-Historic findings

• Atranjikhhera	– Textile printing.
• Burzahom	– Pit-dwelling.
• Chirand	– Serpant cult.
• Bhimbetka	– Caves of Homo Sapien, 500 painted rock shelter
• Nevasa	– Evidence of cotton.
• Hastinapur	– Wild sugarcane.
• Inamgaon	– Statue of mother goddess.
• Koldihva	– Earliest evidence of rice.
• Bagor and Ajamgarh	– Evidences of domestication of animal.
• Mehargarh	– Earliest evidence of agriculture.
• Bhimbetka & Ajamgarh	– Mesolithic rock and cave paintings.
• Uthur	– Hoof impression from cattle pen ash mound.
• Vindhya rock shelter	– First discovered microliths.

In short, we can say that copper was the first metal used by the primitive people but the use of iron gave them a complete new turn in their development. The adoption of Iron brought various changes in society including agricultural practices, religious beliefs and attractive artistic styles. Sanskrit and Chinese literature said to have been flourished in this age. *Hittatiets* or the *Hittomus* discovered the metal Iron through which primitive people peeped into a new world, i.e. the agrarian world.

Some Pre-historic sites & their nature

	Sites	Phase	Location & Excavator	Finds
1.	Adamgasr	Mesolithic (5500 B.C.)	Narmada valley, Hoshangabad, M.P.	Rock-shelters, animal bones & pottery
2.	Anjira	Neolithic	Surab Valley, Central Baluchistan	Chert blade industry, bone awls
3.	Atranjikheda	Iron Age	Uttar Pradesh	Iron objects, burnt bricks
4.	Birbhanpur	Mesolithic	Damodar river (W.B)	Post-holes, combined factory
5.	Brahmagiri	Neolithic/Megalithic	Karnataka, <i>S.M. Wheeler</i>	South Indian Neolithic sites
6.	Burzahom	Neolithic (3000-1700 B.C)	Kashmir, <i>Yale</i>	Two occupation levels
7.	Chandoli	Chalcolithic (1500-1050 B.C)	Maharashtra	Evidence of tin and lead alloying
8.	Chechar-Kutubpur	Neolithic	Biddupur-on the bank of Ganga	Red, grey, spouted and black wares
9.	Chirand	Neolithic and Chalcolithic (2000-1000 B.C)	Allahabad (U.P) / Allahabad University	Crude hard made pottery
10.	Diamabad	Chalcolithic (1400-1000 B.C)	Parvar valley (Maharashtra)	Jorwe culture site
11.	Gumla	Neolithic/Bronze Age	Indus & Gomol rivers by Peshawar University	Aceramic, microliths, cattle bones
12.	Hastinapur	OCP & PGW	Uttar Pradesh	Two glass bangles, cultivated crops, bone dice, glass beads
13.	Lekhania	Mesolithic (1710 B.C.)	Mirzapur (U.P.) / Allahabad University	Rock-shelters
14.	Morhana Pahar	Mesolithic	Narmada Valley, U.P. / A.C. Carlleyle	Rock-paintings & shelters
15.	Waltgal	Southern Neolithic (3000-2000 B.C)	Raichur Doab	Microlithic Industry, handmade pottery

Keep in Memory

• First metal used by man	– Copper
• Iron was brought (discovered) by	– Hittites
• Iron age began	– 1000 B.C
• Excellent Mesolithic cave painting	– Bhimbetka
• Evidence of dog burial along with human beings	– Burzahom
• Inamgaon is belonging to	– Jorwe culture
• Eran is belonging to	– Malwa culture
• Man appeared on the earth in	– Quarternary period
• The largest Mesolithic site	– Kothari river
• The Goddess of vegetative fertility of Jorwe culture	– Sakambhari
• Main foodcrop of Chinese civilization	– Millet
• Pre-historic India's gift	– Domestic fowl.
• Earliest grown up cereals	– Wheat and Ragi
• First thing learnt by primitive man	– Making fire
• Pottery first appeared in	– Neolithic age
• First animal tamed by Neolithic man	– Dog
• Tools made of flakes appeared in	– Middle stone age
• The Palaeolithic men	– Quartzite men
• Mesolithic period	– Microlithic industry
• Palaeolithic period	– Nomadic culture
• Neolithic period	– Settled life
• Homo sapiens appeared in	– Upper Palaeolithic period
• Chalcolithic age	– Stone copper tools
• Neolithic age	– Polished stone tools

Exercise -1

1. Which one of the following sites is famous for prehistoric paintings?
(a) Bagh (b) Ajanta
(c) Bhimbetka (d) Amrawati
2. The first metal to be used by man was
(a) bronze (b) iron
(c) copper (d) stone
3. Iron was brought to many civilization by the
(a) Turks (b) Greeks
(c) Hittites (d) Huns
4. The Megaliths of South India are mainly associated with
(a) Mesolithic age (b) Neolithic age
(c) Chalcolithic age (d) Iron age
5. Which of the following is not a feature of Neolithic cultures?
(a) Cultivation of Plants
(b) Domestication of animals
(c) Use of Iron for agriculture
(d) Sedentary farming
6. Archaeological evidence from which Chalcolithic site shows evidence of corporation, harvesting and irrigation?
(a) Daimabad (b) Inamgaon
(c) Navdatoli (d) Rangpur
7. Inamgaon is a chalcolithic site belonging to which culture?
(a) Jorwe culture (b) Malwa culture
(c) Ahar culture (d) Kayatha culture
8. Eran is a Chalcolithic site belonging to which culuture?
(a) Jorwe culture (b) Mahwa culture
(c) Ahar culture (d) Ganeshwar culture
9. Pick out the wrong statement with respect to the Neolithic sites of Burzahom and Gufkral.
(a) The excavations yield lots of bone tools
(b) Bones of animals such as goat, sheep, cattle are seen
(c) Pit dwellings were seen in both the sites
(d) The sites were predominantly pastoral economics
10. From which of the following hoards were four massive copper replicas – of a rhinoceros, an elephant, a chariot, and a buffalo – typical or a Chalcolithic culture obtained?
(a) Prakash (b) Daimabad
(c) Inamgaon (d) Navdatoli
11. The goddess of vegetative fertility, worshipped during the Chalcolithic period of Jorwe culture, was
(a) Sakapurni (b) Satakarani
(c) Sambhuti (d) Sakambhari
12. Which one of the following species of fauna has been widely appreciated as pre-historic India's gift to the world?
(a) Peacock (b) Domestic fowl
(c) Water buffalo (d) Humped bull
13. Doojali Hudizg is an important Neolithic site in
(a) Tripura (b) Manipur
(c) Nagaland (d) Assam
14. Stone and copper were used in
(a) Chalcolithic age (b) Neolithic age
(c) Mesolithic age (d) Paleolithic age
15. The earliest 'man like creature' which racially differed from 'Homo sapiens' is generally known as
(a) Hominid (b) Pithecanthropus
(c) Sinanthropus (d) Eoanthropus
16. Which one of the following statements is not correct?
(a) The palaeolithic man in India know the use of fire
(b) Palaeolithic granes have been found in Guntur and Kurnool Districts in South India
(c) Prehistoric paintings have been found in Kaimur ranges and Mirzapur District
(d) The Copper Age and the Early Iron Age can be distinguished in North India. However, the Iron Age immediately succeeds the Stone Age in South India.
17. In palaeolithic society all men and women were
(a) treated as of equal importance
(b) men were higher status than women
(c) women were higher status than men
(d) none
18. Which of the following ages the Homo Sapiens the human being for the first time appeared?
(a) In the Mesolithic age
(b) In the upper Palaeolithic age
(c) In the middle Palaeolithic age
(d) In the lower Palaeolithic age
19. Which of the following statements is/are correct about the Neolithic culture?
(a) The Neolithic age marks the concluding phase of the stone tools culture
(b) The evidence of productive economy or food producing culture is an essential prerequisite for the attestation of this age
(c) The presence of pottery is taken to be more conclusive diagnostic speciality of this age
(d) All of the above
20. Who is known as the father of Indian prehistory?
(a) Le Mesurier (b) Miles Burkit
(c) Subba Rao (d) Robert Bruce Foote

21. Which of the following statements is/are correct about the people of stone age?
 - (a) They had to depend entirely on tools and weapons made of stone
 - (b) They settled down only on the slopes of the hills, in rock shelters and the hilly river valley
 - (c) They could not produce more than what they needed for this bare subsistence
 - (d) All of the above
22. The credit of the discovery of the first Palaeolithic in India which opened the field of prehistoric studies in the country goes to
 - (a) Burkitt
 - (b) De Terra and Paterson
 - (c) Robert Bruce Foote
 - (d) H D Sankalia
23. Who among the following cultures were the first to paint their pottery?
 - (a) Mesolithic
 - (b) Chalcolithic
 - (c) Neolithic
 - (d) Iron age
24. Which of the following statements is/are correct about the chalcolithic settlement?
 - (a) They domesticated cattle most probably for food and not milked for drink and dairy products
 - (b) They did practice cultivation but not on large scale
 - (c) The pre-Harappan phase at Kalibangan in Rajasthan and Banawali in Haryana is distinctly chalcolithic
 - (d) All of the above
25. The people of the chalcolithic phase used different type of pottery, one of which is called black and red seems to have been widely prevalent from nearly
 - (a) 3000 BC onwards
 - (b) 2000 BC onwards
 - (c) 1000 BC onwards
 - (d) 500 BC onwards
26. The widespread using of Black and Red ware (BRW) and Painted Grey Ware (PGW) mark the
 - (a) coming of Iron Technology in India
 - (b) coming of Copper Technology in India
 - (c) end of using bronze
 - (d) none of the above
27. The copper boards are associated with the
 - (a) Lustrous red ware
 - (b) Ochre-coloured ware
 - (c) Black and red ware
 - (d) Painted grey ware
28. The Nagara, the Dravida and the Vesara are the
 - (a) three main racial groups of the Indian subcontinent
 - (b) three main linguistic divisions into which the languages of India can be classified
 - (c) three main styles of Indian temple architecture
 - (d) three main musical Gharanas prevalent in India

Exercise -2

Statement Based MCQ

- Which were the earliest cereals grown by human?
 - Wheat
 - Barley
 - Maize
 - Millets
 - 1 only
 - 1 and 2
 - 3 and 4
 - Neither of them
- Consider the following statements on Neolithic settlements in South India.
 - Lapidary art and domestication of animals are the remarkable features of the first phase of the South Indian Neolithic settlements.
 - The red coloured pottery were discovered in the Neolithic settlements.
 - Millet was the main crop harvested by Neolithic farmers of south India.
 - Crop rotation technique was started in the field of agriculture.

Which of the above is / are not correct?

 - 1, 2 and 3
 - 2, 3 and 4
 - 1 and 2
 - 3 and 4
- Consider the following :

At which of the following places has the largest belt of painted rock - shelters of pre - historic period been discovered?

 - Bhaja
 - Bhimbetka
 - Jaora
 - Ajanta

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

 - 1, 2 and 3
 - 2, 3 and 4
 - 2 and 3
 - 3 and 4
- With reference to Neolithic culture, consider the statement :
 - The earliest Neolithic settlement is at Mehrgarh, Baluchistan around 7000 BC.
 - V Gordon Childe defined the Neolithic chalcolithic culture as a self sufficient food economy.

Which of the above is / are correct ?

 - 1 only
 - 2 only
 - Both 1 and 2
 - Neither 1 nor 2
- Which of the artifacts given below could be used as source material for the prehistoric period in India?
 - Fossils
 - Hand axes
 - Pottery
 - Remains of bones

Select the correct answer using the given below

 - 1, 2 and 4
 - 1, 2 and 3
 - 1, 3 and 4
 - 2, 3 and 4

- Consider the following representatives of different cultures:

- Arretine ware
- Northern black polished ware
- Painted grey ware
- Ochre coloured pottery

Their correct chronological sequence is

- 3, 4, 1, 2
- 4, 3, 1, 2
- 3, 4, 2, 1
- 4, 3, 2, 1

Matching Based MCQ

- | List-I | List-II |
|---------------|---------------------------|
| A. Birbhanpur | 1. Banas culture |
| B. Ujjain | 2. Copper hoard |
| C. Kayatha | 3. Ochre-coloured pottery |
| D. Ahar | 4. Microliths |

Codes:

A	B	C	D
(a) 3	4	2	1
(b) 4	3	2	1
(c) 2	3	4	1
(d) 1	4	2	3
- | List-I | List-II |
|-----------------|----------------------|
| A. Mando | 1. Jammu and Kashmir |
| B. Sutkangendor | 2. Baluchistan |
| C. Daimabad | 3. Maharashtra |
| D. Alamgirpur | 4. Uttar Pradesh |

Choose the answer from the codes given below:

Codes:

 - 1, 3 and 4
 - 2, 3 and 4
 - all of these
 - none of these
- | List - I | List - II |
|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| A. Palaeolithic | 1. Ground stone tools |
| B. Mesolithic | 2. Rock painting |
| C. Neolithic | 3. Flaked stone tools |
| D. Upper Palaeolithic | 4. Microlithic tools |

Codes:

A	B	C	D
(a) 1	4	2	3
(b) 3	1	4	2
(c) 3	4	1	2
(d) 2	3	4	1
- | List I | List II |
|-----------|--|
| A. Nagara | 1. Fortified settlements in Vedic literature |
| B. Pura | 2. Town in Pali literature |
| C. Nigama | 3. Fortified capital of a king |
| D. Durga | 4. City/town first mentioned in Taittiriya |

 - A - 2, B - 3, C - 4, D - 1
 - A - 4, B - 3, C - 2, D - 1
 - A - 2, B - 1, C - 4, D - 3
 - A - 4, B - 1, C - 2, D - 3

Hints and Explanations

EXERCISE-1

1. (c) The rock shelters of Bhimbetka are a repository of rock paintings within natural rock shelters with archaeological evidences from the Palaeolithic and Mesolithic periods through the Chalcolithic to the Medieval period.
2. (c) 3. (c) 4. (d) 5. (c) 6. (b) 7. (a)
8. (b) 9. (d) 10. (b) 11. (d) 12. (b) 13. (d)
14. (a) 15. (a) 16. (a) 17. (a) 18. (a)
19. (d) 20. (d)
21. (d)
22. (c) Robert Bruce Foote was a British geologist and archaeologist who conducted geological surveys of prehistoric locations in India for the Geological Survey of India.
23. (b) Chalcolithic Cultures were the first to paint their pottery.
24. (d) 25. (b) 26. (a) 27. (b)
28. (c) Nagara, Dravida and Vesara are three main styles of Indian temple architecture.

EXERCISE-2

1. (b) 2. (c) 3. (b) 4. (c) 5. (a)
6. (d)
7. (b) The correct matching pairs are Birbhanpur and microliths, Ujjain and ochre-coloured pottery, Kayatha and copper hoard and Ahar and Banas culture.
8. (c) All the matches are correct which are paired — Mando and Jammu and Kashmir, Sutkangedor and Baluchistan, Daimabad and Maharashtra, Alamgirpur and Uttar Pradesh.
9. (c) 10. (d)



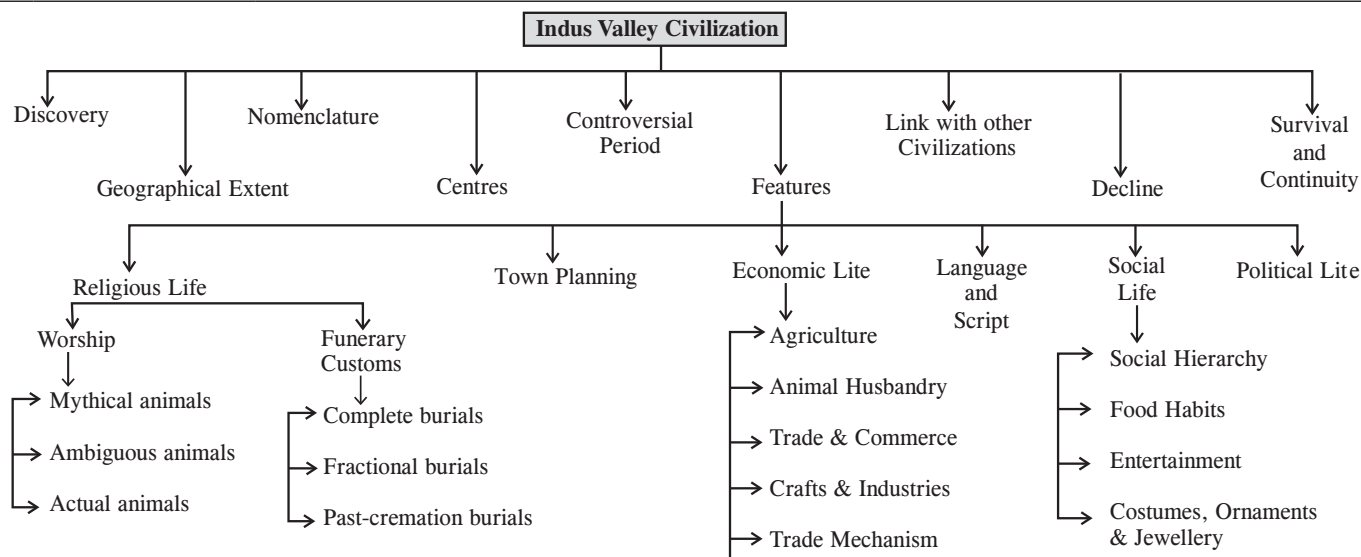
INDUS VALLEY CIVILIZATION

3

Chapter

Introduction

Excavation of Harappa and Mohenjodaro in Punjab and Sind, now in Pakistan, awared the world about an ancient most advanced civilization contemporary to Egypt, Mesopotamia and Sham civilisation of China.



DISCOVERY

Scholar believed that the history of India began with the coming of the Aryans. When *Sir John Marshal* announced the discovery of a new civilization named Indus Valley civilization in a *London weekly* in 1924, a great sensation was created among the world archaeologists. Though, in 1826 an English man named *Charles Masson* had got large number of bricks from a place named Harappa. Later on in 1831, when Colonel Burnes was going to meet Maharaja Ranjeet Singh, he visited the Wreckage of Harappan. Similarly, in 1853 and 1856 Alexander Cunningham supervised the ruins of Harappa. In 1856 the English government started making railway track from Karachi to Lahaur. For this the work of excavation was started and many mysterious objects were obtained but on seeing those objects from ruins the workers

became frightened and the work was postponed.

It was in **1921 Daya Ram Sahni** got the site excavated at **Harappa** in the Montgomery district of the **Punjab** (now in Pakistan) on the left bank of **Ravi**. Just after one year in 1922, **Rakhal Das Banerjee** discovered the remains of civilization at **Mohenjodaro** in the *Larkana* district of **Sindh**, now in Pakistan. These two excavations prepared the foundation of a new chapter in history which is studied under the name of **Indus Valley Civilization**. Now Let us study more about it.

GEOGRAPHICAL EXTENT

Discoveries have extended the area of the Indus Valley. The 1400 settlements, discovered so far are distributed over a very wide geographical area. It is known extent in the

West upto Sutkagendor in Baluchistan; Alamgirpur (Meerut, U.P.) in the East, Daimabad (Ahmadnagar, Maharashtra) in South and Manda (Akhoor, J & K) in the North. Thus, From West to East the **Indus Civilization covered an area of 1600 km and from North to South of 1100 km**. All the settlements are mostly located on the river banks of **Indus and Saraswati**. In 1947, after the partition of India, all the well known Harappan sites, Mohenjodaro, Harappa, Chanhudaro and Jhukar (near Larkana) went to Pakistan. The shape of the civilization was triangular covering an area of about 12,50,000 sq. km. Let's see the areas in Maps and chart.

Map of Indus Valley Civilization

Sites	Regions
Harappa	Punjab (Pakistan)
Mohenjodaro	Sindh (Pakistan)
Chanhudaro	Sindh (Pakistan)
Lothal	Gujarat

Kalibangan	Rajasthan
Banwali	Haryana
Rangpura Rojdi	Gujarat
Dholavira	Kutch (Gujarat)

NOMENCLATURE

The two names, Harappan civilization or Indus civilization are used interchangeably. The first one is derived from an *academic* tradition used in *archaeology*. Thus, *Harappan civilization* based on a notion that it began at a site which best represents the *ancient urban system* of South Asia.

Whereas, the **Indus civilization** began from the river valley of the Indus river with the largest concentration of settlement sites along the course of this river. **John Marshall** was first scholar to use this term.

CENTRES OF INDUS VALLEY CIVILIZATION

All the sites were situated on the banks of rivers:

	Name of sites	Year of excavation	Excavator	River/Region	Archaeological Findings
I.	Harappa	1921 - 1926 - 1946 - 1856- 1986-90	Daya Ram Sahni Madho SwaroopVatsa, . S.M Wheeler, A. Cunningham R.H. Meadow	Ravi, Montgomery of Punjab (Pakistan) (Sahiwal) between Lahaur and Multan	• Six Granaries in row. • Grid planned city. • Coffin burial • Cemetery-H of alien people • Virgin-Goddess • Stone symbols of Lingam and Yoni. • Clay figures of mother Goddess; Wheat and Barley in wooden mortar; Copper scale; Dice, Vanity box; Copper made mirror; workmen's quarter
II.	Mohenjodaro (Nakhlistan, i.e. Oasis of Sindh)	1922 - 1927 - 1930-31, 1947, 1964-66	R. D. Banerjee Mackay, E. J. H. Wheeler, S.M. S. J. Marshall G.F. Dales	Indus Larkana district in Sindh. (Pakistan)	• City followed by grid planning. • Great Granary; Great Bath (the largest building) • Assembly hall; shell strips; Pashupati Mahadev; Bronze image of a nude woman dancer, steatite image of bearded man, human skeletons showing invasion and massacre. Painted seal (Demi God) Clay figure of mother goddess.
III.	Chanhudaro	1925 - 1931 - 1935-36	Macky N. Gopal Majumdar E.J.H. Mackay	Indus Nawabshah District in Sindh(Pakistan)	City without a citadel, Inkpot, Lipstick, Metal works, Shell-ornament makers, bead makers, shops, dog's paw imprint on a brick, Terracotta (bullock cart) Bronze toy cart with created drivers
IV.	Kalibanga	1951. The Ghaggar is known as 1961 Saraswati in Rajasthan	Amalananda Ghosh B. B. Lal and B. K. Thapar G. Dales, S.M. Wheeler	Ghaggar-river Rajasthan (India) Hanumangarh District	• Shows both Pre-harappan & Harappan phase. • Furrowed land (pre-harappan) • 07 fire altars; camel bones; well; wheels of a toy cart; Mesopotamian cylindrical seal, gram; tiger marked coin.

V.	Lothal (It was surrounded by a wall)	1954-58	S. R. Rao	Between Bhogava & Sabarmati rivers Ahmedabad district (Gujarat)	First manmade port in the world , dockyard made by burnt bricks, painted jar (bird-fox) Bead makers factory, rice husk, fire altars; a measuring scale, chess playing; terracotta figurines of a horse and a ship, etc. Double burial (Male & Female), Dying Vat, Persian/Iranian seal, Bharaian seal.
VI.	Banwali	1973	R.N. Bisht (Ravindra Nath) Bisht.	Ghaggar Hisar district Haryana (India)	Shows both pre Harappan & Harappan phase. Toy plough, Clay figures of mother Goddess, Good quantity of barley and rice. Lack systematic drainage system.
VII.	Surkotada	1964	J. P. Josi (Jagpati) Josi	Luni Kutchh Gujrat (India)	Bones of horses, Bead making shops, oval grave, pot burials.
VIII.	Sutkagendor	1927 1962	R.L. Stein George Dales	Dasht river Baluchistan (Pakistan)	Port city. Trade point between Harappa and Babylon. Human bones copper axe, an ashfullpot.
IX.	Amri	1935 1959-61	N.G. Majumdar J.M. Casal	Indus river Sindh (Pakistan)	Evidence of Antelope
X.	Dholavira	(1967-68) 1985-90	J.P. Joshi R. N. Bisht	Luni Rann (Kutchh) Gujarat (India)	• Unique water management • Largest site of large well and a bath. • Three parts of city. • Seven cultural stages. • Largest Harrappan inscription used for civil purposes, A stadium
XI.	Rangpur	1953	M. S. Vats B. B. Lal S. R. Rao	Mahar Gujarat (India)	Cultivation of rice
XII.	Kot Diji	1955-57	Faizal Ahmed Khan	Indus Sindh (Pakistan)	• Wheel made painted pottery, 16 layers of culture. • defensive wall and aligned streets. • Metallurgy and artistic toys. • 05 figurines of Mother Goddess.
XIII.	Ropar	1955-56 1953-56	Y.D. Sharma S.S. Talwar R.N. Bisht	Sutlej Punjab India	Burying a dog with master rectangular mudbrick chamber. Scented soil five fold cultures. (Harappa, Kushan, Gupta and Medieval)
XIV.	Balakot	1963-76 1963-79	J.P. Joshi G.F. Dales	the Arabian sea Las Bela Valley	• Remain of Pre-Harappan & Harappan Civilization • The mounds (9.7 mts (H) 2.8 sq. hectare of area)
XV.	Alamgirpur	1958	Y. D. Sharma (Yagya Dutta)	Hindon Meerut (U.P)	Eastern side of Civilization. Impression of cloth on a trough.
XVI.	Manda	1975-76	J.P. Joshi & Madhu Bala	Chenab river Akhnoor (Jammu)	Northern site of civilization Copper pin, Saddle querns
XVII.	Ganweriwala		Rafeeq Mugal	Pakistan	
XVIII.	Rakhi Garhi		Rafeeq Mugal	Jind (Haryana)	

CONTROVERSIAL PERIOD

To make a precise date for the beginning of Indus Valley Civilization scholars differ in opinions.

Scholars	Period
Marshall	3250-2750 B.C.
Mackay	2800-2500 B.C.
M.S. Vats	3500-2500 B.C.
C.J. Gaddis	2350-1770 B.C.
S. Piggott & S.M. Wheeler	2500-1500 B.C.
Allbright	around 1750 B.C.
D.P. Agarwal	2300-1750 B.C.
Dales	2900-1900 B.C.
R.H. Brunswig	2800-2000 B.C.
J.P. Joshi	2550-2050 B.C.
G. Possehl	2867-2000 B.C.
Rafiq Mughal	3500-2900 B.C.

Difference between pre-harappan and proto-Harappan cultures :

All the cultures existing before the Harappa culture are called pre-harappa culture whereas proto-Harappa cultures are those pre-harappa cultures which take some close similarities with the Harappa-culture. Here it would be pertinent to indicate that the Harappa civilization belongs to the Bronze Age (during the year 2500 to 1750 B.C.) extending from Baluchistan (Pakistan) to Gujarat in India.

Comparison with others: According to Sir John Marshall that the standard of civilized life reached by the people of Harappa and Mohenjodaro was higher than that of the ancient Babylonians and Egyptians and equal to that of Sumerians.

BASIC FEATURES OF INDUS VALLEY CIVILIZATION

Town Planning

- The most striking feature of Harappan civilisation is its town-planning and sanitation.
- Harappan cities such as Mohenjodaro, Harappa, Kalibangan, Dholavira & Surkotada, were divided into **two parts** - a **fortified settlement** on the high mounds called '**citadels**' and the main residential areas called '**lower town**'. 'Citadel' was smaller in area than the 'lower town' and located to the west of the cities.
- Houses were built of *Kiln-burnt bricks*. At Lothal and Kalibanga residential houses were made of sun-dried bricks.
- The drains, wells, bathing platforms were made of Kiln-burnt bricks.
- Most of the houses had wells within them and a **drainage system** carried the waste water to the main underground drain of the street. The covered drains had **soak-pits** and **manholes** for clearing.
- The arrangements for street lighting were available for the people.
- The main streets ran from North to South varied from 9 ft to 34 ft in width.
- Municipal authority controlled the development of the city.
- The streets ran in straight lines crossing one another at right angles. Houses stood on both sides of the streets. The street and lanes were not paved but a famous street called '**The first street**' of Mohenjodaro was surfaced with broken bricks and potsherds.
- Harappa and Mohenjodaro were built entirely of burnt bricks. All the bricks were well proportioned measuring $26 \times 12.5 \times 5.5$ cm. Large bricks (51 cm) were used to cover drains. The bricks were made of **Alluvial soil**. Wedge-shaped bricks were used in the lining of wells. Small bricks were used for making the bathroom pavements watertight. L-shaped bricks were preferred for corners.
- The buildings (dwelling house, larger buildings and public baths, granaries, etc.) were mostly plain without plasters. At Kalibanga, ornamental bricks were used in the floor of a house. The ground floor of a small house measured 8×9 metres and the large one was double of its size.
- Some of the houses were double storeyed. Wooden beams were used in making the roofs. The roofs were made of reed matting covered with thick coating mud. A few staircases have been discovered. Wooden staircase with high narrow steps (38 cm high, 13 cm wide) were used in general. The roofs were flat and enclosed by a parapet.
- Gutters of pottery (found at Chahundaro) were made for draining the rainwater. The entrance to the house was made from the street side.
- The open court was the basic feature of house planning. The courtyard (paved with bricks) was laid flat and surrounded by chambers. Doors and windows opened into it. Doors were placed at the ends of the walls, not in the middle and outer walls from the roadside had no windows.
- Perforated lattices were used as windows or ventilators. Houses had *stairways* made of solid masonry. In some buildings, the stairways led to the upper storeys which contained the bath and the living and sleeping apartments.
- An average house had besides kitchen and bath, four to six living rooms. Some large houses had near about thirty rooms. The kitchen was small and fuel was placed on a high platform.

- Cooking was done in the courtyards in the open. Sometimes an aperture in the wall was made between the kitchen and the larger room for making a '**serving hatch**'. The waste water ran into the earth through a pottery vessel with a hole sunked in the kitchen.
- Every house had its bathroom on the side of the street.
- Latrine found between the bathroom and the street. The bathroom had brick pavement sloping towards one corner. Pottery rasps were used to remove thickened cuticle.
- From Mohenjodaro large **khans (inns)**, stone houses and watch towers have been unearthed. This is an extensive building on the West of the stupa measuring 69×23.5 metres. It was a priestly corporation containing the **Great Bath**. The whole complex is a single unit which is named the '*Collegiate Building*'. At that time bathing was a ritual and the Great Bath (12×7 metres) made of burnt brick, was used only on ceremonial occasions. It has *staircases* on both sides. Below the staircases is a broad platform (01 m wide, 41 cm high). It was a safe bathing place for children. There are eight bathrooms on the North of the Great Bath. This building was for priests.
- There was a large oval well which supplied water. A hall (8 metres square) has been discovered on the South of the stupa. It was used for some religious assembly. John Marshall compares it with a Buddhist rock-cut-temple while Mackay calls it a large market hall with lines of permanent stalls along the aisles. There are four well-paved aisles which are separated by rows of pillars. At Harappa a building has been discovered measuring 50×40 metres with a central passage of 07 metres wide. It was a store house for grain.
- Near the 'First street' there was a palatial building with two spacious *courtyards*, *servant quarters* and *store rooms*. It was either a temple or the residence of the Governor.
- The entire city was protected by a '*city wall*'. A small fort has been laid bare in most of the important cities.
- Like Babylonia and Egypt, Harappans did not use any foundation deposits. For this nothing is known about the ceremonies associated with the laying of foundation that can help the excavator to know about the history of the building.
- The Harappan **fortifications** were not meant to defend the township from strong attacks by enemies. It was constructed for the protection against **floods**, **robbers** and **cattle raiders**. It was also a hallmark of social authority over the area they commanded.
- The Harappan towns were encompassed by walls with gateways, the simple entry points to the town. Some of the gateways had attached guard rooms.

Do you know ?

- | | |
|---|-----------------------|
| • Two important Harappan crops | → Wheat, barley |
| • The most widely used metal by the Indus Valley people | → Bronze |
| • Harappan trading station | → Lothal. |
| • The most important industry | → Bead at making. |
| • Station of Harappan cattle breeders | → Nesadi |
| • The largest Harappan settlement in India | → Kuntasi |
| • Traces of rice cultivation have been found at | → Lothal and Rangpur. |

Religious life

- Harappan people had features of *Hinduism*, such as worship of the mother Goddess, Pashupati, Shiva, Sacred animals, trees, etc.
- *Clay figures* of the mother goddess as the symbol of fertility have been found.
- The three-faced deity wearing a horned head-dress, seated cross-legged on a throne, and surrounded by elephant, tiger, buffalo and rhinoceros, with deer appearing under the seat is the representation of Lord Shiva.
- Marshall has discovered some conical and cylindrical stones which indicate the *phallic worship*, i.e. *lingam worship*. Similarly, on the basis of small ring stones, Marshall suggested them the female generative organ (yoni) which indicate the worshipping of the Mother Goddess.
- At Kalibangan, fire altars have been discovered.
- We do not find any tracer of temple or places for worship at any of the Harappan sites.

Worship

- Harappans believed in animal worship. The animals fall into three groups :
 - (1) **Mythical animals** or complex animals, e.g. a semi human, semi-bovine creature
 - (2) **Ambiguous creature**, e.g. the strand unicorn accompanied with manager or incense-burner and
 - (3) **Actual animal** including the rhinoceros, the bison, the tiger, the humped bull, etc.
- The most common animal found on the Harappan seals is the **bull** which has been referred to as '**a unicorn**'.
- The cow is not depicted or introduced anywhere.
- Tree worshipping was a culture in this civilization. **Pipal tree** was the most worshipped tree.
- Indus people believed in armlets and Talisman. On a seal, a six-rayed motif is depicted signifying the sun. Clay models of oxen were used as motive offerings. Tablets of clay and copper were used as armlets.

- Swastik and cross signs were **harbingers** of good luck.
- Daya Ram Shahni has discovered the famous dancing girl called '**Devadasi**' which is depicted on a seal.
- The offering of animals in **sacrifice** was a Harappan practice which have been discovered from Mohenjodaro and Kailangan. In a 'fire-altar' bovine, bones and outliers were discovered which represent some kind of animal sacrifice.

Funerary Customs

Three forms of burials have been found at Mohenjodaro, viz, **complete burials**, **Fractional burials** (only, a collection of bones are buried after the exposure of the body of wild beasts and birds) and **part - cremation burials**.

At **Kalibangan** three types of burial practices are noticed:

1. Extended inhumanion in rectangular or oval graves,
2. Pot-burial in the circular pit containing pots and grave goods like beads and
3. Pottery deposit in rectangular or oval graves.

At **Lothal**, two types of burial practices were followed the first type contained the grave goods and a single skeleton, the other contained two skeletons buried together.

Economic Life

Harappan people were comfort living and prosperous. Their richness was due to surplus agriculture, cattle rearing, proficiency in various crafts and trade.

Agriculture

- Agriculture was the **backbone** of the Harappan people. Sindh was a fertile part of country.
- The Indus people sowed seeds in the flood plains in November when the flood water receded, and reaped their harvests of wheat and barley in April, before the advent of the next flood.
- They produced wheat, barley, peas, kodon, sanwa, jowar, ragi, etc.
- Two types of wheat – the club wheat campactum and the Indian **dwarf wheat** (*Triticum sphaerococcum*) were grown.
- Barley (*hordeum vulgare*, probably of a small-seeded six-rowed variety, was also sound at Kalibangan. *Barley* and wheat have been the most important crops at all Harappan sites.
- Other crops include **dates**, **seasam** and **mustard** were also grown.
- It seems that as early as 180 B.C. the people of Lothal used **rice** whose remains have been found.
- *The evidence of the sugarcane has not been found yet. Though its presence is to be expected. At Lothal and*

Rangpur, rice husks and spikelets were found embedded in clay and pottery.

- A fragment of woven cotton cloth has been found at Mohenjodaro. *The Indus people were the earliest people to produce cotton.*
- The Harappans used the wooden plough with wooden or copper plough share.
- Stone and Copper sickles may have been used for harvesting the crops.
- Gabar bands or nalas enclosed by dams were used for storing the water which are found at Baluchistan and Afghanistan. *No evidences of channel or canal irrigation has been discovered from the sites of this civilization.*

Animal Husbandry

- Animals were kept on a large scale and *oxen*, *buffaloes* (*Bubalus bubalis*), *goats* (*Sus cristatus*), *sheep*, and *pigs* were domesticated.
- *Dogs* and *cats* were also domesticated. The *humped bulls* were favoured by the Harappans.
- *Asses* and *Camels* were used as *beasts of burden*. Camel bones are reported at Kalibangan.
- The only plausible evidence of the horse comes from Surkotada belonging to around 2000 B.C.
- *Elephants* were well known to the Harappans. They were also acquainted with the rhinoceros, spotted deer, hog deer, wild pig, etc.

Trade and Commerce

- The cities like Mohenjodaro, Harappa and Lothal were the important centres for **metallurgy**, producing **tools** and **weapons** as well as **kitchenware**.
- **Rice** seems to have been imported to Punjab from Gujarat.
- Lothal and Surkotada filled a large gap in the growing demands for **cotton**.
- Sea-shells were exported from Balakot and Lothal to Baluchistan as well as the Indus.
- **Dates**, **Shilajeet** were found at Mohenjodaro.
- The Harappans imported **metals** and semi precious **stones**, **ornaments** of gold and silver from the subcontinental areas like Lapis Lazuli from Kashmir and Afghanistan
- **Turquoise** and **jade** from Central Asia or gran, amethyst from Maharashtra and agate, Chalcedony and Carnelian from Saurashtra.
- *Gold, silver, Tin and Lead were imported from Iran and Afghanistan. Precious stones were imported from Badakhshan and copper from Khetri (Rajasthan).*

- The Products of Indus have been found in Mesopotamia. Its seals and products were also discovered at Sumer.
- The chief merchandise *cotton* was *exported from Lothal Harbour*. The Harappan had trading relations with the West and Central Asian sites.

Trade Mechanism

- A copper scale has been found from Harappa. This scale is divided into many parts. All the parts are same in size measuring 0.3676 inch. At that time one foot are equal to 13.2 inch.
- *The sexagesimal and decimal system were known to the Harappans.*
- The weights were made of stone and they were of cubical and spherical in shape. They followed the series in doubling from 1, 2, 4, 8, 16, 32, 64 and then 160, 320, 640 and so forth. The smallest weights are found of 13.64 grams.
- The unit of ratio was 16 equivalent to 13.64 grams. *16 chhatank made a ser and 16 annas made one rupee.*

Crafts and Industries

- **Weaving** was the chief industry at Mohenjodaro.
- **Pottery** was an important industry. They were also acquainted with the **art of dying** and the art of **smelting** metals.
- Balakot and Chanhudaro were for shell working and **Bangle** making Charnudaro was centre for the manufacture of **beads** of carnelian.
- **Bronze Smiths** produced images, utensils, tools and weapons.
- **Brick-laying** was an important craft of that time.
- The Harappans had the knowledge of **boat-making**, **seal-making** and terracotta manufacturing.
- The Harappans had experts beadmakers and Goldsmiths

Transport and Communications

- Harappans had good transporting system for trade.
- They used **bullock carts** and rarely horse carts for onland journey.
- They practised **navigation** on the coast of the Arabian sea. Representation of **ships** and **boats** are found on seals or graffiti at Harappa, Mohenjodaro, etc. and a terracotta model of a ship comes from Lothal.
- *Caravans of pack-oxen* were the chief means of transport for longer journeys through rougher and wooded country.

Language and Script

- The language of the Harappan is still unknown. The number of **pictorial signs** in the script vary according

to different archaeologists. For examples G.R. Hunter (1932)-149 signs, A. H.Dani (1963) - 537, Asko Parpola (1973)-396, etc. Those symbols were not alphabetic in their order.

- Their language is closer to **Dravidian** than to any other known languages.
- Their scripts were pictographic.
- The script was written **from right to left** like modern **urdu**. These scripts are found on various seals, pottery copper tablets, tools, etc.
- The script is not related to any of the contemporary Egyptian, Sumerian or Babylonian script. Some scholars call it the parent of the Brahmi Script.
- All the inscriptions discovered till now are short, with an average of half a dozen letters, the longest has seventeen. It will be a turning point in the history of India when this Indus script is deciphered.

Social Life

Social Hierarchy

- Indus people believed in simple living and high thinking.
- Traditional family was the unit of the society.
- Women were given high honour in society. Family was regulated in the name of mother.
- The Indus Civilization had four different classes in which the *society was divided* - *Scholars, warriors, businessman and labourers.*
- No evidence of caste system has been found yet.

Food habits

- The Harappans were *non-vegetarians*. Wheat, barley and bread were commonly used. They used to eat *fish, beef, mutton, poultry* occasionally.
- Coconut, dates, pomegranate, lemon and watermelon were the chief fruits they ate.

Entertainment

- They preferred indoor hobbies to outdoor amusements.
- **Dance** and **music** were their popular amusements.
- Dices, chess, fishing, hunting and swimming were the sources of entertainment.
- Gambling was also in vogue.
- On some occasions they made animals or birds fight together for their entertainment.
- Marble dolls and animals toys show that the children of Mohenjodaro were well supplied with playthings.

Costumes, ornaments and Jewellery

- The ladies were scantily dressed. They wore a short skirt that reached up to the knee; and it was held by a girdle - a string of beads.
- The male used a **robe** with or without embroidery. It was worn over the left shoulder and under the right arm.
- **Dhoti** wearing was also in practice. Perhaps they did not use footwear. Cotton was used. There is no evidence of linen or wool.
- Different types of **hair styles** were used but very long beards were not preferred. The dancing girl from Mohenjodaro has a pony tail. Some females have a plait tied with a bow at the end.
- Men's hair was parted in the middle and tied with a fillet. Sometimes the hair was gathered up in a bun or coiled in a ring on top of the head.
- Beards were trimmed and upper lips were shaven. Completely shaven faces with a small beard on the chin are also noticed.
- Mirrors of bronze were very common.
- The people followed the **veil system** in the society. Women used a special cloth over their heads which were flying from the backside of their heads.
- Man and woman both were fond of **ornaments**. Women wore a fan-shaped head-dress. Small cones of Gold, Silver, Copper and Faience were worn on the sides of the head.
- The Forehead was decorated with a **fillet** or a **headband**. **Ear-rings** were made of coils of gold, silver, copper or faience. Probably no nose ornaments were used.
- Necklaces, fillets, armlets, finger rings and bangles were used by both the sexes.
- Girdles, nose -studs, ear-studs, anklet, etc. may have been worn by woman only as are proved by the statues.
- They used some sorts of collyrium, face-powders, lip-sticks, face paints and perfumery which were also exported.

Political life

- Urbanization represents radical socio-political change.
- Harappan political system was organised on the pattern of '*city states*', which were highly disciplined on account of dominant social controls.
- Harappan rulers were more concerned with commerce, than with conquests, and Harappa was possibly ruled by a class of merchants.
- Harappa was ruled by the two capital cities. The distance between the two capitals was 350 mile.
- Sir Mortimer Wheeler writes, "the lords of Harappa administered their city in the fashion not remote from that of the priest-kings or governors of Sumer and Akkad."

LINKS WITH OTHER CIVILIZATIONS

- Harappans had close trade relations with submarine. The Sumerian Civilization was a part of Mesopotamian Civilization. Mangol and Dravid were the progeniar of Sumer. The presence of a cuneiform inscription at Mohenjodaro witnesses the links with the Mesopotamians (area between Dajla and Furat).

DECLINE OF INDUS CIVILIZATION

- The Harappan Culture lasted for around 1000 years.
- *Invasion of the Aryans*, Mortimer Wheeler says, destroyed the Indus settlements.
- Men and women were massacred in the streets and houses.
- They were left lying covered without last rites.
- *E. J. H. Mackay*, Lambric and John Marshall are of the view that the decline of the Harappan Civilization was mainly due to the vagaries of the Indus river.
- Some evidence of devastation by floods is to be found at Mohenjodaro and Lothal.
- According to Thus, numerous causes, natural and human, as the **invasion of nomadic** outsiders (B.C. 1500), flood, social breakup of Harappans, the decline in trade and commerce were the major causes of its decline.

SURVIVAL AND CONTINUITY OF THE INDUS CIVILIZATION

The decline does not mean the total eclipse of all. For this, we can find the historical continuity from the Harappan period to the later periods of Indian history.

- The **worship** of '**Pashupati Shiva**' and '**Lingam**' is survived in these days.
- Similarly Mother Goddess, sacred tree, animals, serpent, different religious symbols such as Swastik, etc. which were prevalent in the Harappan religion, were adopted in later Hinduism and are in Vogue in present time.
- In the field of **Science and Technology**, the Indus Civilization greatly contributed to the similar future developments.
- Harappan civilization was the *womb of mathematics*.
- The **numerical** and **decimal system** were evolved there from which 'the vedic mathematics' is based.
- **Punch marked** coins is an important survival of the Indus Valley.
- The art of making pottery, baked bricks, beads, jewellery, different utensils, was adopted in the vedic civilization.

Indus Civilization at a Glance (2500 B.C. - 1750 B.C.)

- First discovered site of the civilization ⇒ Harappa (1921) by D. Sahani.
- The oldest name of the civilization ⇒ Indus civilization.
- The most suitable name (Geographical) ⇒ Indus-saraswat civilization.
- John Marshall was the first to use the term Indus Civilization (1924)

• **Different sites :**

- (I) $\left[\begin{array}{l} \text{Ropar (Sutlej / Punjab)} \\ \text{Manda (Chenab / J.K)} \end{array} \right\} \text{The Northern – most site}$
- (II) $\left[\begin{array}{l} \text{Bhagatrap (Kim / Gujarat)} \\ \text{Daimabad (Pravar / Maharashtra)} \end{array} \right\} \text{The Southern – most site}$
- (III) [Aiimgirpur] (Hindon/U.P) – The eastern – most site
- (IV) Sutkagendar (Dashk)/Makran Coast - The Western most site.

Other important sites : Harappa, Mohenjodaro and Dholavira (The nucleus cities); Suktagendor, Balakot, Allahdino (near karachi), Lothal (The coastal towns and ports); Chanhudaro, Kotdiji, Surkotada, Desalpur, Rojdi, Manda, Ropar, Kalibangan, Banwali, Balu and Rakhi Shahpur (other cities and township). Harappa (North) and Mohenjodaro (South) (The two capital cities)

- Latest Harappan site discovered Dholavira
- The largest site - Mahenjodaro
- The largest Indian site - Rakhigarhi.
- Indus sites found in Afghanistan - Shatughai and Mundigah.
- The makers of the Indus Civilization – Dravidian.
- Contemporary Civilizations ⇒ Mesopotamia (Dajla-Furat) at Nile and China at Whang Ho & Yang-si.
- The entry port for trade between Indus and Mesopotamia - Bahrain
- Close commercial and cultural contacts with ⇒ Sumer, Elam, Mesopotamia, Iran, Bahrain and Central Asia.
- The two most thickly populated cities - Mohenjodaro and Harappa.
- The two main trade routes:
 - I. The northern route linked North Iran and oxus region with Kabul and the central reaches of the Indus.
 - II. The southern route linked central and south Iran with Kandhar, north Baluchistan and the more southerly regions of the Indus.
- The Indus Civilizations belongs to Chalcolithic or Bronze Age. ('Chalco' means copper and lithic means stone).
- The heartland of the Indus civilization - Harappa - Ghaggar - Mohenjodaro axis.
- **Common features of major cities :** Grid system in town planning; sanitation (underground drainage system); Fortified Citadel (Exception-Chanhudaro); use of burnt bricks; dwelling houses (kitchen, bathroom and toilet); larger buildings; public baths and grainaries, etc. Assembly hall; palace of the Governor, Collegiate building gateways.
- **Main crops :** Wheat and barley; Evidence of rice in Lothal and Rangpur only. Main fruits-Coconut, Dates, Pomegranate, Watermelon, Lemon, etc. Other crops-mustard, sesame, cotton, etc. Indus people were the **first to produce cotton** in the world.
- **Animals (Domestic and wild) :** Sheep, buffalo, goat, dog, cat, pig, fowl, deer, tortoise, bull (humped and humpless), camel, elephant, tiger, rhinoceros, etc. They were not acquainted with 'Lion', trace of horse is rarely discovered. Surkotada (Kutchh, Gujarat) is the only site where the remains of a horse have been found. Camel bones are reported at Kalibangan. From Amari, a single instance of the Indian rhinoceros has been reported and of elephant from Rojdi (Saurashtra).
- **Trade :** Foreign trade with Mesopotamia or Sumeria (Nowgraa), Bahrain.

Major Imports

Material	Source
Gold	Kolar (Karnataka, Afghanistan, Persia (Iran))
Silver	Afghanistan, Persia (Iran)
Copper	Khetri (Rajasthan), Baluchistan, Arabia
Tin	Afghanistan, Central Asia, Bihar
Agates	Western India.
Chalcedony	Saurashtra
Lead	Rajasthan, South India, Afghanistan, Iran
Lapis Lazuli & Sapphire	Badak-shan (Afghanistan)
Torquise	Central Asia, Iran.
Amethyst	Maharashtra
Jade	Central Asia
Carnelian	Saurashtra

Some Important names/facts of I.V. Civilisation

- The Sumerian texts refer to two intermediate station - Dilmun (Bahrain) and Makan. It also refers to trade relation with 'Meluha' - the name given to the Indus region.
- Harappan cotton was called '*Sindon*' by the Greeks.
- A community who worshiped rivers was called '*Dariyapanthi*' in Indus civilization.
- '*Boustrophendon*' is name of Indus script. It is written from right to left and then left to right.
- English Bound System : The way of fitting the bricks in making walls. In this system one large of bricks is placed in length and the other layer is made by placing the bricks widthwise.

- Ziggurat : The temples of Sumeria.
- The traces of **Sati system** is found in Lothal (Joint buria).
- First of all **Sweden** tries to read the script of Harappan Civilization.
- **Lipistic** has been discovered from Chahundaro and Black eastern bangles from Kalibangan. **Pastry** rollar and board and bowls have been discovered from Alamgirpur Meerut.
- The evidence of coins is not found. **Barter** is assumed to have been the method of exchange of goods.
- Merchants were the ruling class of Indus Civilization.
- The Harappan did not worship their gods in temple. They did not worship the cow as we do today. They worshipped Matridev Shakti, Yoni, Pashupati, Lingam, Naga (Serpent), trees (Peepal and acacia), humped bull, the sun, water, etc. They believed in paganism and sacrificed animals in religious ceremonies.
- **Steatite** was used in seals manufacturing.
- The origin of '**swastika**' is discovered from the Indus Civilization.
- **Indra**, the commander of Aryan, is accused of causing the decline of their civilization.
- The battle of '**Hariyumpia**' (in Rigveda) has been identified with Harappa. (M. Wheeler)
- '**Susa**' are Mesopotamian places where Harappa seals were found.

Exercise -1

1. The earliest evidence of settled agriculture from the sub-content comes from
 - (a) Kalibangan
 - (b) Amri
 - (c) Mehrgarh
 - (d) Inamgarh
2. Which of the following valleys is known for having a continuous succession of palaeolithic paintings of different periods?
 - (a) Buharbulang valley
 - (b) Bhimbetka
 - (c) Sohan valley
 - (d) Bhader valley
3. Indus valley civilization is an example of
 - (a) Pre-history
 - (b) Proto-history
 - (c) Continuous story
 - (d) History
4. The first cereals that early men grown were
 - (a) wheat and rice
 - (b) wheat and barley
 - (c) barley and maize
 - (d) barley and rice.
5. Two most important Harappan crops were
 - (a) Wheat and barley
 - (b) Sesamum and mustard
 - (c) Rice and peas
 - (d) Cotton and Sugarcane
6. Which one of the following is not one of the Harapan sites related to the maritime activities of the Harappan people?
 - (a) Lothal
 - (b) Balakot
 - (c) Sokta Kob
 - (d) Patliputra.
7. Which of the following was not the likely purpose of the Great Bath in the citadel at Mohenjodaro?
 - (a) Community bathing
 - (b) Swimming exercises and water sports
 - (c) Some elaborate ritual of vital importance, including a corporate social life
 - (d) Storage of water to be used during drought or emergency
8. Almost all Harappan towns had large granaries because
 - (a) Taxes were paid in kind, and therefore, granaries acted as a sort of public treasuries
 - (b) Surplus produce of the countryside was stored in the towns
 - (c) Food-grains were stored for the purpose of trade
 - (d) All of the above
9. From the scattered skeletal remains of the Harappans found at different sites, the most appropriate conclusion to be drawn would be that there was
 - (a) Some kind of military assault
 - (b) Mass execution or human sacrifice
 - (c) Casual burial of human bodies
 - (d) Malaria or any other pathogenic condition
10. One of the Harappan deities not represented in later Hindu religion is
 - (a) Pashupati Siva
 - (b) Seven mothers (Sapta mariksa)
 - (c) Compound creatures
 - (d) Unicorn
11. Which one of the following sites of the Indus Valley Civilization had an ancient dockyard?
 - (a) Kalibangan
 - (b) Lothal
 - (c) Rangpur
 - (d) Harappa
12. The primary purpose of a seal in the Indus Valley Civilization was probably
 - (a) to signify royalty
 - (b) as a medium of exchange in trade
 - (c) to signify ownership of property
 - (d) to indicate social status
13. Manda, the northern-most site of Indus Civilization in Jammu and Kashmir is located on the banks of which river?
 - (a) Jhelum
 - (b) Sutlej
 - (c) Chenab
 - (d) Zaskar
14. Pick out the incorrect statement about Town planning in Indus Civilization?
 - (a) There was systematic town planning on the lines of grid system.
 - (b) There was a fortified citadel on the western site and a lower town on the eastern side.
 - (c) The windows of the houses opened onto the main streets.
 - (d) There was remarkable and well developed underground drainage system.
15. Evidence of mixed cropping is seen from which site of Indus Civilization?
 - (a) Lothal
 - (b) Dholavira
 - (c) Chanhudaro
 - (d) Kalibangan
16. A circular button shaped seal called the Persian gulf seal has been obtained from which Harappan site?
 - (a) Lothal
 - (b) Mohenjodaro
 - (c) Banwali
 - (d) Kalibangan
17. Cylindrical seals of Mesopotamia have been recovered from which two Harappan site?
 - (a) Lothal and Kalibangan
 - (b) Lothal and Rangpur
 - (c) Mohenjodaro and Kalibangan
 - (d) Ropar and Rojdi
18. Which of the following types of burial is not observed at Mohenjodaro?
 - (a) Complete burial
 - (b) Fractional burial
 - (c) Post-cremation burial
 - (d) Double burial

19. Two terracotta models of Egyptian mummies have been recovered from which Harappan site?
 - (a) Dholavira (b) Lothal
 - (c) Kalibangan (d) Chanhudaro
20. Which of the following sites is the largest of all Indus settlements excavated?
 - (a) Dholavira (b) Mohenjodaro
 - (c) Lothal (d) Kalibangan
21. Almost all the people of Indus Valley Civilization were:
 - (a) Nigroid (b) Proto-Australoid
 - (c) Mediterranean (d) Nordic
22. Which metal was unknown to Indus Valley Civilization?
 - (a) Gold (b) Silver
 - (c) Copper (d) Iron
23. A statue of bearded man was found at
 - (a) Harappa (b) Mohenjodaro
 - (c) Chanhudaro (d) Dholavira
24. In Indus Valley Civilization, the script was:
 - (a) Kharosthi (b) Brahmi
 - (c) Boustrophedon (d) None of these
25. Which one of the following Indus Valley Civilization sites gives evidence of a dockyard?
 - (a) Harappa (b) Mohenjodaro
 - (c) Lothal (d) Dholavira
26. Which one of the following Indus Valley Civilization sites gives evidence of a stadium?
 - (a) Harappa (b) Kalibangan
 - (c) Mohenjodaro (d) Dholavira
27. A seal depicting Mother Goddess with plant growing from the womb, has been found from:
 - (a) Harappa (b) Mohenjodaro
 - (c) Kalibangan (d) Dholavira
28. Indus Valley Civilization was discovered by:
 - (a) Dayaram Sahni (b) R.D. Banerji
 - (c) Cunningham (d) Wheeler
29. Harappan people had a common burial system, which is proved by
 - (a) The earth burials with the head of the dead normally laid towards the north
 - (b) The burial of commonly used items with the dead
 - (c) Both (a) and (b) above
 - (d) The burial of the dead body in the sitting posture
30. The use of lime and costly burnt bricks, instead of sundried bricks, by the Indus Valley people for construction purposes is a proof of
 - (a) A moist climate on account of the close proximity of the civilization to the river valleys
 - (b) Advanced technology
 - (c) Better planning
 - (d) Knowledge of the manufacture of lime
31. On the basis of available evidence, the Harappan civilization contributed two important things to mankind which were
 - (a) Growing wheat and cotton
 - (b) Knowledge of mathematics and decimal system
 - (c) Copper and bronze smelting technology
 - (d) Making soak-pits and earthen pipes
32. The Harappan towns and cities were divided into large _____ blocks
 - (a) Square (b) Rectangular
 - (c) Circular (d) Semi-circular
33. Which of the following toilet and cosmetic objects were not perhaps known to Indus Valley people ?
 - (a) Copper mirrors (b) Ivory combs
 - (c) Antimony rods (d) Hair-dyes
34. Which of the following was not one of the tools and implements used by Indus Valley people?
 - (a) Needles and razors
 - (b) Sickles and plough
 - (c) Forks and spoons
 - (d) Grindings stones for flouring wheat, pestles and querns
35. Which of the following features of modern Hinduism is not derived from the Harappan cults?
 - (a) Shakti worship
 - (b) Worship of Siva as Pashupati
 - (c) Worship of Siva-linga in the form of conical and cylindrical stones
 - (d) Dedication of temples to a particular deity
36. In the Harappan buildings mostly burnt bricks were used, not stones, because
 - (a) Without iron tools stone-cutting was difficult
 - (b) Bricks provided better flood defence
 - (c) Bricks were ideally suited for the moist climate
 - (d) Stone was not readily available
37. Which of the following is not a feature of the religious life of the Indus civilization?
 - (a) Pipal and Acacia trees were regarded as celestial plants
 - (b) The tree of life figures with great frequency on the seals
 - (c) The Indus deities, like the Vedic deities, were predominantly male
 - (d) The people had faith in amulets and charms, which shows that they were afraid of demons
38. From a large number of seals discovered from almost all the Harappan sites, it appears that they were used for _____ purposes.
 - (a) ritualistic and religious
 - (b) Commercial
 - (c) Both (a) and (b) above
 - (d) Symbolic
39. Which of the following is not one of the proofs of maritime activities of the Indus Valley people ?
 - (a) The discovery of a dockyard at Lothal
 - (b) The drawing of a ship on a seal
 - (c) Discovery of a number of articles which were not produced or found in the country
 - (d) Commercial links of the Harappans with the West Asian countries

40. On what evidence is South Russia/Central Asia regarded as the original home of the Aryans?
(a) Anthropological (b) Philological
(c) Racial (d) Archaeological
41. The Aryans came to India as
(a) Invaders (b) Immigrants
(c) Refugees (d) Merchants and nomads
42. Which of the following is not considered an Indo-Aryan language?
(a) Avesta (b) English
(c) Arabic (d) Persian
43. According to the theory of double invasion of India by the Aryans, the first group inhabited the Punjab, and the second group pushed its way through Gilgit and Chitral and settled in the midland country. Who put forward this theory?
(a) Dr. Giles
(b) Dr. Hoernle
(c) Sir George Grierson
(d) C.V. Vaidya
44. The chief opponents of the Aryans were the indigenous people of non-Aryan origin known as Panis and Dasas or Dasyus. The factor which enabled the Aryans to emerge victorious in the struggle against the indigenous tribes was
(a) Lack of unity among the indigenous tribes
(b) Better organization among the Aryans
(c) Superior military equipment of the Aryans
(d) Cultural superiority
45. Which of the following correctly describes the land of the Seven Rivers (Sapta Sindhu) where the initial Aryan settlements were located?
(a) The Indus Valley region
(b) The Punjab and Delhi region
(c) The region from Eastern Afghanistan to the upper valley of the Ganges
(d) The land of the Indus and its principal tributaries
46. The geographical knowledge of the early Aryans did not extend beyond
(a) Indus (b) Ganga
(c) Yamuna (d) Ghaggar
47. Which of the following was not a major industrial town of the Harappan civilization?
(a) Lothal (b) Chanhudaro
(c) Harappa (d) Kalibangan
48. Which one of the following statements regarding Harappan civilisation is correct?
(a) The standard Harappan seals were made of clay
(b) The inhabitants of Harappa had neither knowledge of copper nor bronze
(c) The Harappan civilisation was rural based
(d) The inhabitants of Harappa grew and used cotton
49. The site of Harappa is located on the bank of river
(a) Saraswati (b) Indus
(c) Beas (d) Ravi
50. The polity of the Harappan people, as derived from the material evidence, was
(a) secular-federalist (b) theocratic-federalist
(c) oligarchic (d) theocratic-unitary
51. Which one among the following is not the characteristic feature of the Harappan settlement?
(a) Doorways and windows generally faced the side lanes and rarely opened onto the main streets
(b) Houses generally had separate bathing areas and toilets
(c) The citadel was walled but the lower town was not walled
(d) Drains and water chutes from the second storey were often built inside the wall
52. The terra-cotta plough of the Harappan civilization was found at
(a) Mohenjo-daro (b) Banawali
(c) Kalibangan (d) Lothal

Exercise -2

Statement Based MCQ

1. The Indus valley civilization is called non - Aryan because
 1. Indus people worshipped mother Goddess.
 2. It is a pictographic script.
 Which of the above statement is/are true ?
 - (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
 - (c) 1 and 2 (d) None of these
2. Consider the following statements regarding Indus Culture -
 1. It arose in the north-western part of the Indian subcontinent.
 2. It is older than the chalcothic cultures.
 3. No other cultural zone in the third and second century BC was as large as the Harappan.
 4. It was not as advanced as the chalcothic cultures.
 Which of the above is/are correct ?
 - (a) 4 only (b) 1 and 2
 - (c) 2 and 4 (d) 1 only
3. With reference to Great Bath of Mohenjodaro, consider the following statements -
 1. It was built by baked bricks.
 2. The length of the Bath is 12 metres, breadth 7 mtrs and depth is around 2.5 metres.
 3. The outer walls of the Bath are plastered by on inch thick plaster of paris.
 4. By the side of the Bath there were residence of priests who use to come down for bath on special occasions.
 Which of the above is/are correct ?
 - (a) 1 and 4 (b) 1, 2 and 4
 - (c) 2 and 3 (d) 1 and 2
4. How the Indus valley civilization declined? Give correct reasons contributed to the decline of civilization.
 1. Due to fall in foreign trade continuously
 2. Due to changing monsoon, the scarcity of rains.
 3. Due to ruling of weak foreign powers.
 4. Due to the animals used the pasturs in excess.
 Which of the above is / are correct
 - (a) 1 and 4 (b) 1, 2 and 4
 - (c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) 2 and 3
5. Which of the following were common features of both Harappan and Mohenjodaro ?
 1. Citadel mounds with a retaining wall
 2. Public Baths
 3. Rows of granaries
 4. Rows of circular blocks for pounding grains.
 Choose the correct answer from the codes given below :
 - (a) 1, 2 and 4 (b) 1, 2, 3 and 4
 - (c) 1 and 2 (d) 2 and 3
6. What are the evidence found regarding the decline of Harappan civilization ? Consider the statements :
 1. Silt is there is Harappa because of wind scion which brought sand and slit. Houses and streets covered by slit deposits upto 30 ft above ground level.
 2. Human skeletons have been found lying on the streets.
 Which of the above is/are correct ?
 - (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
 - (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
7. Consider the following statements :
 1. The Harappan economy was based on agriculture, cattle rearing and crafts.
 2. The Indus valley people had an elaborate drainage system.
 3. In kot Diji pre-Harappan settlement has not been found.
 4. Sugarcane was not grown in Indus civilization.
 Which of the above is/are correct ?
 - (a) 1, 3 and 4 (b) 2 only
 - (c) 3, and 4 (d) 1 only
8. Consider the following statements :
 1. The inhabitants of Harappa grew and used cotton.
 2. The inhabitants of Harappa had no knowledge of copper and bronze.
 3. The standard Harappan seals were made of clay.
 Which of the statements given above is / are correct ?
 - (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2
 - (c) 2 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3
9. With reference to the Harappan civilization, consider the following statements :
 1. The city of Dholavira was in the form of a parallelogram guarded by a fortification.
 2. A ploughed field, showing a grid of furrows, located outside the town wall has been discovered at Kalibangan.
 Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
 - (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
 - (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
10. Consider the following statements :
 1. Lime mortar was never used at Mohenjodaro in the construction of dwellings.
 2. At Dholavira, stone was never used in the construction of dwellings.
 Which of the statements given above is / are correct ?
 - (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
 - (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
11. Consider the statements regarding the effects of Harappan civilization in modern era :
 1. House plans, disposition of water supply and attention to bathing have survived till today.

2. The techniques of making a potter's wheel is similar to those used by the Harappans.
3. The election system of recent time is borrowed from Harappan political system.

Which of the above is / are correct ?

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 2 only (d) 3 only

12. Which of the following statements are correct with regard to the Indus valley civilisation?

1. The people of this civilisation were the earliest to make use of cotton.
2. They did not cremate their dead.
3. A grid system was followed in city planning.
4. Stone was the chief building material.

- (a) 1, 2, 3 and 4 (b) 1 and 4
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 2 and 3

13. Which of the following animals as figures surround the male deity in the Indus Valley Civilizations?

1. Elephant 2. Tiger
3. Rhinoceros 4. Buffalo
5. Deer

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Codes:

- (a) 1, 2, 3 and 4 (b) 1, 2, 3, 4 and 5
(c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) 1, 3 and 5

14. The tank of Great Bath complex at Mohenjodaro had stairs on

1. Northern side 2. Southern side
3. Eastern side 4. Western side

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Codes:

- (a) 1 only (b) 3 only
(c) 1 and 2 (d) 3 and 4

Matching Based MCQ

15. **List I** **List II**
- | | |
|--------------|--|
| A Lothal | 1. Ploughed field |
| B Kalibangan | 2. Dockyard |
| C Dholavira | 3. Terracotta replica of a plough |
| D Banawali | 4. An inscription comprising ten large sized signs of the Harappan script. |
- (a) A - 1, B - 2, C - 3, D - 4
(b) A - 2, B - 1, C - 4, D - 3
(c) A - 1, B - 2, C - 4, D - 3
(d) A - 2, B - 1, C - 3, D - 4

16. **List I (Place)** **List II (Ex cavators)**
- | | |
|---------------|---------------------------------|
| A Harappa | 1. Rakhal Das Banerjee |
| B Chanhudaro | 2. Daya Ram Sahni |
| C Kalibangan | 3. N.G. Majumdar |
| D Mohenjodaro | 4. B.B. Lal and Kamlanand Ghose |

- (a) A - 3, B - 1, C - 2, D - 4
(b) A - 1, B - 4, C - 3, D - 2
(c) A - 2, B - 3, C - 4, D - 1
(d) A - 4, B - 3, C - 1, D - 2

17. **List-I** **List-II**
- | | |
|---------------------------|----------------|
| A. Cemeteries H and R 37 | 1. Daimabad |
| B. Dockyard | 2. Mohenjodaro |
| C. Pashupati Mahadev Seal | 3. Harappa |
| D. Copper chariot | 4. Lothal |

Codes:

- | | | | |
|-------|---|---|---|
| A | B | C | D |
| (a) 3 | 4 | 2 | 1 |
| (b) 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| (c) 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| (d) 1 | 3 | 2 | 4 |

18. **List-I** **List-II**
- | | |
|----------------|-----------------------|
| A. Harappa | 1. Workmen's quarters |
| B. Lothal | 2. Dockyard |
| C. Kalibangan | 3. Dancing girl |
| D. Mohenjodaro | 4. Furrowed land |

Codes:

- | | | | |
|-------|---|---|---|
| A | B | C | D |
| (a) 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| (b) 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| (c) 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |
| (d) 1 | 2 | 4 | 3 |

19. **List-I (Harappan settlement)** **List-II (River)**
- | | |
|----------------|------------|
| A. Lothal | 1. Indus |
| B. Kalibangan | 2. Satlej |
| C. Ropar | 3. Ravi |
| D. Harappa | 4. Ghaggar |
| E. Mohenjodaro | 5. Bhogao |

Codes:

- | | | | | |
|-------|---|---|---|---|
| A | B | C | D | E |
| (a) 5 | 4 | 2 | 3 | 1 |
| (b) 2 | 5 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| (c) 4 | 5 | 2 | 3 | 1 |
| (d) 5 | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |

20. **List-I** **List-II**
- | | |
|----------------|-----------------------|
| A. Harappa | 1. Daya Ram Sahni |
| B. Mohenjodaro | 2. Rakhal Das Banerji |
| C. Lothal | 3. Amalanand Ghosh |
| D. Kalibangan | 4. S.R. Rao |

Codes:

- | | | | |
|-------|---|---|---|
| A | B | C | D |
| (a) 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| (b) 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| (c) 1 | 2 | 4 | 3 |
| (d) 4 | 2 | 1 | 3 |

Hints and Explanations

EXERCISE-1

1. (c) 2. (b) 3. (b) 4. (b) 5. (a)
6. (d) 7. (d) 8. (d) 9. (a) 10. (d)
11. (b) Lothal, a site in Gujarat of Indus valley civilization had an ancient dockyard. The large dockyard reflects a high degree of sea trade in this period.
12. (c) 13. (c) 14. (c) 15. (d) 16. (a)
17. (c) 18. (d) 19. (b) 20. (a)
21. (c) Indus Valley Civilization had been a combination of diverse racial elements. Certain anthropological investigations and examinations of the human remains show that four racial types existed in this civilization namely Proto-Australoid, Mediterranean, Alpinoid and the Mongoloid. Most of the people belong to Mediterranean race.
22. (d) Iron was not known to Indus Valley Civilization people. The first evidence of Iron is found about 1000 B.C. from Ataranjikhhera in Etah district.
23. (b) A well-known piece of art of the Harappan period is a stone sculpture of a bearded man discovered at Mohenjodaro. His eyes are half closed indicating a posture of meditation. Across the left shoulder is an embroidered cloak. In the opinion of some scholars, it could be a bust of a priest.
24. (c) Indus Scripts are popularly known as Boustrophedon scripts which are still not deciphered by the historians, researchers and scholars.
25. (c) The Indus Valley Civilization site Lothal gives evidence of a dockyard. Lothal was discovered by S.R. Rao in 1954 A.D. The dockyard is located in eastern side of Lothal.
26. (d) Recent excavations at the small township of Dholavira, in Kutch, Gujarat (India) have presented to the world some of the oldest stadiums and sign board, built by the Harappan civilization. One of the stadiums, with terraced seats for spectators, around 800 feet in length (around 283 metres) can accommodate as many as 10,000 persons. The other stadium is much smaller in size.
27. (a) Plant growing from the womb of women has been found from Harappa on a seal. That represents Earth Goddess.
28. (a) Harappan civilization was discovered in 1921–22 when two of its most important sites were excavated. The first was excavated by Dayaram Sahni and the second by R.D. Banerji.
29. (c) 30. (a) 31. (a) 32. (b) 33. (d)
34. (c) 35. (d) 36. (d) 37. (c) 38. (c)
39. (b) 40. (b) 41. (c) 42. (c) 43. (b)
44. (c) 45. (d) 46. (c) 47. (a)
48. (c) Harappan civilization was rural based civilization.
49. (d) The site of Harappa was located on the banks of river Ravi.
50. (d) The polity of the Harappan people as derived from the material evidence was a theocratic-unitary.

51. (b) Harrapa is an archaeological site in Punjab, Pakistan. It is ruin of bronz age satisfied city It had 23,500 inhabitates which was very large for its times people from this civilization had common toilets and bathing areas.

52. (b)

EXERCISE-2

1. (c) 2. (d) 3. (b) 4. (b) 5. (a) 6. (c)
7. (b) 8. (b) 9. (c) 10. (d) 11. (a) 12. (c)
13. (b) The Pashupati is the only possibly male deity of Indus Valley Civilization, as depicted on various seals. This deity is surrounded by 4 wild animals and this gives an indication that it is Pashupatinath or a prototype of Lord Shiva. The deity is surrounded by 4 animals viz. an elephant, a tiger, a buffalo and a rhinoceros. Apart from this, there are 2 deers beneath the seat of the deity. The headdress of the deity has two horns. It wears as number of bangles and has a pectoral round the neck, and an inscription of seven letters appears at the top.
14. (c) The Great Bath is one of the best-known structures among the ruins of the ancient Indus Valley Civilization at Mohenjodaro in Sindh, Pakistan. Archaeological evidence indicates that the Great Bath was built in the 3rd Millennium BCE, just sometime after raising of the 'citadel' mound on which it is located. The Great Bath of Mohenjodaro is called the "earliest public water tank of the ancient world". The Great Bath measures 11.88 metres × 7.01 metres, and has a maximum depth of 2.43 metres. Two wide staircases, one from the north and one from the south, served as the entry to the structure. A 1 metre wide and 40 centimetres mound is present at end of these stairs.
15. (b) 16. (c)
17. (a) The correct matching pairs are—cemeteries H and R37 with Harappa, Dockyard and Lothal, Pashupati Mahadev Seal and Mohenjodaro, Daimabad with copper chariot.
18. (d) The correct matching pairs are—Harappa and workmen's quarters, Lothal and Dockyard, Kalibangan and furrowed land and Mohenjodaro and dancing girl.
19. (a) The correct matching pairs are – Lothal and Bhogao, Kalibangan and Ghaggar, Ropar and Satluj, Harappa and Ravi, Mohenjodaro and Indus.
20. (c) The correct matching pairs are – Harappa and Daya Ram Sahni, Mohenjodaro and Rakhaladas Banerji, Lothal and S. R. Rao, Kalibangan and Amalanand Ghosh.



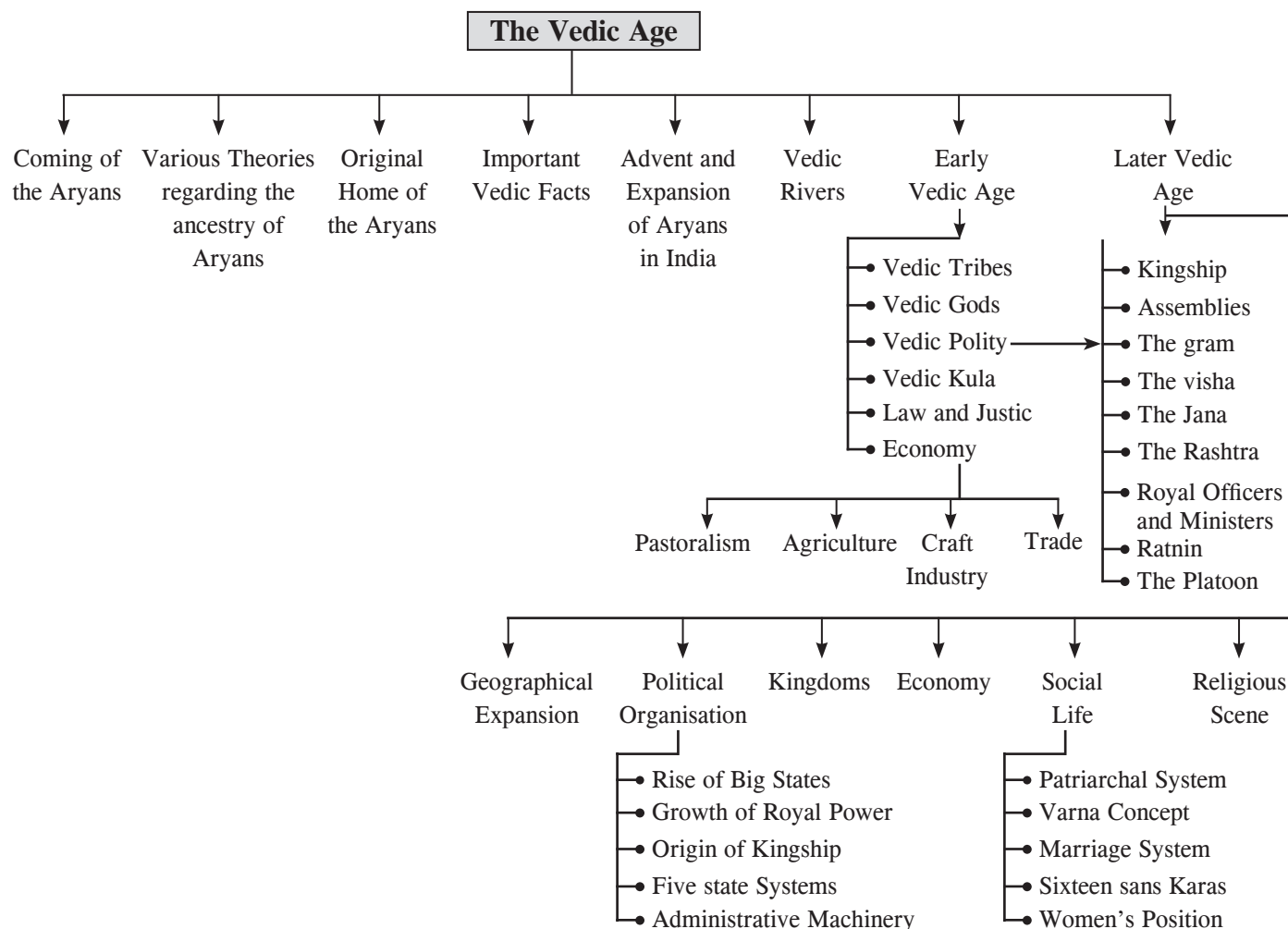
4

Chapter

THE VEDIC AGE

Introduction

After the decline or destruction of the Indus Civilization a new civilization came into existence, but between these two major events there must have been a gap of period and about which we know nothing. The Indus civilization was declined between 1750 B.C. to 1500 B.C. and so the Aryans are supposed to have migrated from Central Asia into the Indian Subcontinent in several stages during 2000 B.C. - 1500 B.C. Moreover the Aryans were the founder of Vedic culture.



COMING OF THE ARYANS

Some scholars believe that the Aryans were native to the Soil of India while others believe that the Aryans were migrated from outside, i.e. *Central Asia* (Max Muller); *Europe Arctic region* (B.G. Tilak) and so on.

- In fact, the group that came to India first settled in *Sapta Sindhu*. They lived here and gradually pushed into the valleys of the Ganges and the Yamuna.
- The earliest wave of Aryans is called the *Rig vedic people* who appeared in about 1500 B.C.
- It is believed that before the coming of the Aryans in India, the greater part of the Northern-Western India was covered by **Dravidians**. After the arrival of the Aryans they moved southwards.
- Literally 'Aryans' means - the best or *eminent*.
- In order to prove their supremacy the Aryans took this name and called themselves 'the Aryans' and they called their opponents 'Anarya', 'Dasy' or 'Das'.
- The Aryans were handsome, fair and slim shape persons.
- Their minds were filled with natural imaginations.
- They were brave and laborious with highly developed attitude.
- They were farmers peasant and loved nature in the form of god.
- They linked milk and wheat bread.
- The Aryan chief was soft towards the dasas, but bitterly hostile to the dasyus. The term dasyuhatya, slaughter of the dasyus, is repeatedly mentioned in the Rig veda. *Yadu, Turvasu, Druhyu, Anupuru, Panchala, Bharata and Tritsu* were the chief tribes of the period.

VARIOUS THEORIES REGARDING THE ANCESTRY OF ARYANS

The subject matter of the original home of Aryans attracted many scholars to present their views but all the opinions given by them became a matter of discussions.

- Many scholars, such as Ganganath Jha, D. S. Trivedi, L. D. Kalla, etc. tried to prove that the Vedic Aryans were neither foreigners nor did they migrate into India. They were the indigenous people, who regarded **Sapta-Sindhu** as their original home.
- Some European scholars assigned the **Baltic sea** region as the original home of the Aryans.
- **B.G. Tilak** suggested the **polar region**.
- Some **inscriptions** of about 1440 B.C. found at Boghaz koi in Cilicia (Asia minor), the capital of the ancient **Hittites**, mention some Aryan deities such as Indra, Varuna, Mitra and the Nasatyas (Aswins) which proves **Central Asian** theory as their homeland.

- However the region of *Sapta-Sindhu* (the land of the seven rivers) witnessed the composition of the sacred hymns which describe the early growth and development of the vedic culture. Let us see the various interpretations in the chart.

Original Home of the Aryans	
Asia	Theorists
Central Asia	Max Muller.
Tibet	Dayanand Saraswati
Pamirs	Mayor
Steppes	Brandenstein
Turkistan	Hurz Feld
Bactria	J. C. Road.
Europe	Theorists
Germany plains	Prof. Penka Sheart
Hungary	Giles
Southern Russia	Nehring
West Baltic	Mach
Arctic Region	B. G. Tilak
Russian Steppes	Prof. Belfy
India	Theorists
Central India	Rajbali Pandey
Kashmir	L. D. Kala
Sapta Sindhu	A. C. Das
Himalayan	Pt. Laxmidhar
Foothills	Shastri

Important Vedic Facts

- Vedic literature had grown up in course of time and was passed from generation to generation by word of mouth. Hence these are called **Shruti** (to hear).
- Some historians regard the Later Vedic period as the **Period of epics (long poems)**.
- The Aryans, First of all, settled in The Sapta Saindhava (**Jambudupa**).
- According to the Rigveda, The **Saraswati** was the most pious river.
- The most mentioned river – Sindhu.
- Mention of the Ganges – 01 time.
- Mention of the Yamuna - 03 times.
- Rigveda mentions 40 rivers.
- Sindhu and its seven tributaries are called **Sapta Sindhu**.
- The arc of Ganga-Yamuna is called **Brahmarshi Pradesh**.
- Land between the Saraswati and Drishadwati is called **Brahmavarta**.
- The Nadi sukta hymns mentions 21 rivers.
- From the Himalayas to the Vindhya mountains and between the Eastern sea and Western sea there was a special part of land which was called '**Aryavarta**'.
- '**Gandhar**' was famous for woolen articles.
- '**Bhujvant**' was famous for Somaras (wine).
- In the Dashrajan, **Vashistha** helped Sudas and **Viswamitra** helped the Union of ten kings and instigated them to fight with Sudas.

ADVENT AND EXPANSION OF ARYANS IN INDIA

Rig Veda says that there were various groups of Aryans and they came to India in search of food and habitation and later on they settled here. Some famous groups were Panchajan (the most famous group), **Bharat**, **Trissu**, **Kriva**, etc.

The Panchajan consisted of Anu, Druhalaya, Yadu, Turvas and Puru. In between 2000 BC and 1000 BC the Aryans would have arrived in India. It is supposed so.

- The Expansion of the Aryans was started from Afghanistan and were expanded up to the Western coast of Ganga river.
- The Aryans were aware of the Himalayas but they did not know Vindhya, Aravali, Satpuda, and Southern Plateaus. So, we can say that in Rig Vedic period the Aryans were expanded from Himalaya to Malva in North-South direction and from the Western coast of Ganga to Afghanistan in East-West direction.
- In Rig Veda period they had no approach in the Southern and Eastern parts of India.
- They lived in *Saptasindh* area for a long period and later on, during post-vedic era they started reaching towards the East and South.
- Gradually, they established their sovereignty in Kurukshetra, Kashi, Koshal, Videh, Panchal and the coastal area of Ganga and Yamuna.
- In the beginning of the 8th century B.C. they organised Magadh, Anga, Paundra, Kaling, Shabar-pulind and Southern India.

VEDIC RIVERS

Altogether 99 rivers are referred to in the Rig Veda of mostly from Afghanistan. The 15 principal rivers are given in the table. In Rigveda we find the descriptions of the various rivers of Afghanistan. They are **Kubha**, **Suvastu**, **Gomati** and **Kramu**. The **Saptasindhu's** rivers, i.e. Saraswati, Sindhu, Vitasta, Asibini, parushini, vapasa and shatudri are also explained in the Rigveda. In it, Ganga is named only once where as Yamuna is repeated thrice. It reflects that earlier they were expanded in the area of Saptasindhu and till then unaware of the Ganga-Yamuna's plain.

Some of the minor rivers were Rasa, Anumati, Asuniti, Raka, Gungu, Susoma, Marud-Vrdhas, etc.

Name of the rivers illustrated in the Rigveda		
Rigveda	Modern Name	Region
Sindhu	Indus	Punjab
Vitasta	Jhelum	Punjab

Asikani	Chenab	Punjab
Vipasa	Beas	Punjab
Parushni	Ravi	Punjab
Satudri	Sutlej	Punjab
Saraswati	Sarsuti	Rajasthan
Drishadvati	Ghaggar/Chitang	Rajasthan
Kubha	Kabul	Afghanistan
Suvastu	Swati	Afghanistan
Krumu	Kurram	Afghanistan
Gomal	Gomati	Afghanistan
		Punjab
Ganga	Ganga	Uttar Pradesh
Yamuna	Yamuna	Uttar Pradesh

To conclude, we can say that the Aryans were living in the east of Caspian sea in Aukus river's reign. Dr. Hormely is of the opinion that the Aryan came to India into two groups. The first was of **Manav** dynasty and the other was 'L' dynasty. During this vedic period they did not enter ahead from Punjab.

RIGVEDIC/EARLY VEDIC AGE (1500 B.C. - 1000 B.C.)

Aryan Civilization of Rigveda Period

The Rig Veda is the main source of the Aryan Civilization, i.e. the early vedic era. At that time Afghanistan was a part of India. It is known through the Rig Veda as the names of Aryan rivers are illustrated in Rig Veda. These rivers are Kubha, Krumu, Gomati, Suvastu, etc.

- Sindhu, Vitasta, Askini, Parushni, Vipasha, Shatudri, Saraswati, Yamuna and Ganga are clearly illustrated in the Rigveda which confirms the area of Punjab and some parts of northern India to be the livings of the Aryans.
- The illustration of cloud, lightening, torrent raining and great mountains prove that the areas of Punjab and Brahmavarta were fertile and verdant. According to the Rigveda this area was divided into many parts called **Vedic Jana**. Gandhari, Bhujvant, Anu, Druhalay, Turvas, Puru and Bharat were some famous Janas.
- The Rig Veda explains that the Puruvanshi Arya lived on the banks of the river saraswati.
- Similarly Yaduvanshi on the bank of Sindhu and Chinab, the **Sanjay Vanshi** in Panchal, Anuvanshi, Druhalay and Turvas in the various areas of Punjab. Thus, from the names of rivers, mountains [Himvant, i.e. Himalaya, Munjavant i.e.

Hindukush] and ocean we are informed about the geographical area in which Rigvedic people lived. The Nadisukta of the Rigveda mentions 21 rivers which include the Ganges in the east and the Kubha (Kabul) in the West.

The Vedic Tribes

The Vedic territories mentioned in the Rig Veda was divided into various tribal principalities, ruled by tribal kings. These are given in the table.

According to Rigveda, the famous Dasrajan Yoddha or the battle of ten kings was fought between Sudas, a Bharat King of the Tritsu family, and the confederacy of ten well-known tribes - **Puru, Yadu, Turvasa, Anu, Druhyu, Alina, Paktha, Bhalnas, Siva** and **Vishanin**. In the bloody and decisive battle on the banks of river Parushni, the Bharatas emerged victorious.

These are given in the table.

Vedic Aryan Tribes	Region
• The Bharatas	Between Saraswati-Yamuna
• The Purees	Saraswati
• The Yadu & Turvasa	Southern Punjab
• The Gandharis	North-West of India
• Matsyas & Chedis	Rajasthan & Malwa
• The Srinjaya	Punjab
• The Bhalanas	Bolan Pass
• The Paktha	Basin of Kurram
• The Vaikarnas	Kashmir
• The Krivi	The Sindhu Asikni
• The Sivas	Hydispes Acesine (Chanab)
Non-Aryan Tribes (Dasas of Dasyus)	
• Sambara	
• Kikatas	Saraswati-Yamuna
• The Panis	Rase (Syr Dariya)

Important Vedic Gods

Gods/Deities	Association with
A. Highest Position (Male)	
• Indra	War God
• Agni	Fire God, Intermediate between Gods & men
• Varuna	God of waters, clouds, Oceans & rivers regulates Sun, Dawn, day & night, ritu (seasons)
B. Others (Male) Gods	
• Sun/Surya	God of Light
• Savitri	God of Light (Gayatri Mantra)

• Pusan	Guarding roads, herds men & stray-cattles, light
• Rudra	Storm, epidemics, disasters
• Yama	Lord of the dead
• Soma	Divine drink (milk+curd+ barley)
• Vayu	Wind God
• Vishnu	Activities of the Sun
• Dyaus	God of heaven
• Pushan	God of Marriage
C. Female Divinities	
• Ushas	The Goddess of Dawn
• Prithvi	The Goddess of Earth
• Aditi	Mother of Surya & other gods
• Ratri	The spirit of the night
• Aranyani	The goddess of the forest
• Ila	The Goddess of offerings
• Dishana	The Goddess of vegetation

The Vedic Polity

- The land of the vedic Aryans was divided into several small tribal principalities. Each tribe had its own monarch. There were constant wars among these tribes.
- There were a few non-monarchical states as well. These states were called *gana*.
- The ganapati or *tyestha* (elder) was the head of a non-monarchical state.
- The area ruled by the Aryans was known as '*Aryavarta*'. 'Bharat' was the most important tribe after whom this country has been named 'Bharat'.
- **Divodas** and **Sudas** were the two renowned ruler of the Bharat race.
- Divodas fought against Turuvasas, Purus and Yadus.
- Sudas had to fight the 'war of ten kings'.

Kingship

- The Kingship in the vedic period seems to be hereditary but king did not enjoy unlimited powers.
- The King was responsible for the protection of the tribe. **Aitarey Brahman** denotes that the Kingship in the vedic age originated as a result of human needs and military necessity.
- In times of peace the king dispensed justice and performed sacrifice.
- The ideal of Kingship was very high. He was called '**Mitra** in Kindness, **Varuna** in virtues and **Indra** in Valour'.
- His coronation oath before the people was "May my life and offspring be cut off if I work against your interests".
- According to Manu "King is the god of gods, May be a child king, doesn't matter, he should not be disregarded.

Popular Assemblies

- **Sabha** and **Smiti** controlled the affairs of vedic states. These two assemblies were called the two **daughters of Prajapati**.
- The **Sabha** was the body of the elders and was constituted mainly of the Brahmanas and rich patrons who controlled the vagrancy of the King and used to advise the King. Its male members were called '**Sambhay**' and female '**Sambhavati**'.
- Sabha can be compared with the *Council of States* (Rajya Sabha) of these days.
- **The Samiti** was the '*House of common people*' and its members were called '**vishah**'. Its head was called '*Ishan*' or '*pati*'.
- They were responsible to the people for their work and were elected by the common people.
- Samiti controlled the King and participated in the election of the King. It can be compared with today's Lok Sabha (House of commons).
- The Sabha was an older institution and it existed in the early vedic age. The samiti was the product of development and it emerged during the late vedic period.

Atharvaveda

- In the Atharvavedha these two assemblies are described as the **uterine sisters**, the daughters of Prajapati. Later vedas record that the Sabha functioned as a court of justice.
- Besides these two assemblies there were **Vidath** and **Gana** which also are described in the Rigveda.

The Gram (the village)

- A group of Kula formed a gram. Its chief was called 'Gramin' or 'Gramini'. In the Rigveda the word 'Gram' was used for the villagers.
Gramini was the head of the village. The Gramini was also called '**The vrajapati**'. He worked as an important chain between the King and the subjects.

The Visha (the clan)

- Its functions are not clearly described in the Rigveda. In fact, it was an organisation larger than the Gram. Its head was called '*Vishpati*'.

The Jana (the people)

- It was also a company of people but larger than the Visha. The Rigveda reflects that the administrator of the Jana was called '**Rajan**' and the commander of the Jana was called '**Gopa**' or '**Gopta**'.

The Rashtra (the nation)

- According to the Rigveda 'Rashtra' was a term used for the whole nation or the state. Some scholars have said that 'the Rashtra' was the indication of confederate administration. The Rashtra consisted of several '**Janas**'.

The Royal officials and Ministers

- Purohit, Senani, Gramini, Doot, etc. were some important officials. The King had to maintain a Council of Ministers which included a Purohit. Purohit (the priest) advised the king in the state-

affairs and in all religious matters. He accompanied the King even to battle. We have seen it already how Vishwamitra and Vashistha had exercised their powers in the **Dasrajan war**.

The Supreme Commander of the armed forces was called **Senani**. There were spies (spasas) employed to collect information about the Kingdom and the people. In Rigveda we have a number of personalities who were laborious, Veridical (true speaking) and expert. They were Mitra, Varuna, Agni, Aditya, etc. These were called the *dutas* who acted as ambassadors between the different states.

Ratnin (the minsters and advisors)

- Suta, Rathkar, Purap, Spash, etc. which are important officials. Collectively they are called **Ratnin**. All the royal officials were responsible to the King.

The platoon (The sepoy organisation)

- The Aryans were great warriors. The King had trained an regular military forces. The cavalry with chariot was called the *Rathin* and the forces fought on foot were called '**The Padati**'. They used sword, bow and arrows, Javelin, Shield, buckle and helmet. In Rigveda the illustration of secured forts on the borders is also found. Most wars were fought from **bullock-driven** chariots.

Law and order : The protection of the people was the sacred duty of the King. In return the people paid him *bali* (tributes or tax). The *Bali* was a kind of tax paid in both by **chash** and **kind**.

Law and Justice

- Justice was based on Dharma. The King administered Justice with the assistance of legal advisors including his Purohita. Punishment was not so heavy and the main emphasis was on the satisfaction of the person wronged. Only Hard-core criminals were given the capital-punishment. General conflicts were solved by the Gramini and arbitrators of the Gram Panchayat. The criminals were subjected to fire (Agni pariksha or acid test) and water (jal pariksha) deals.
- A number of crimes such as theft, burglary, highway robbery, cheating (specially at gambling), etc. are mentioned. Cattle-lifting was the commonest of all.
- There was a system of blood-money (*vairadey*-through which enmity can be recompensed) and the punishment for murder was *shatadaya* (equal to one hundred cows or coins).
- All the above words indicate that the laws of justice and the quality or magnitude of punishment were fixed according to classes.
- Money was frequently borrowed (*rina*) and lent and often it was never repaid. The debtor had to serve as a bounded servant of the creditor for a certain period. Interest was paid in kind.
- Property was inherited by sons. Individual ownership of land (*urvara* or *kshetra*) had begun.
- The king was not the owner of all land - its ownership was with the people.

- Everything was fair in war - raid, night attacks and kidnapping. The palaces were set to fire and the winning booty was shared by the King and the soldiers.

Some Words mentioned in Rigveda	
Word	Times mentioned
Om	1028
Brahmana	14
Kshatriya	09
Vaishya	01
Shudra	01
Ashwa	315
Gau	176
Ganga	01
Samudra	01
Yamuna	03
Kulpa	01
Rajya	01
Vis	171
Jana	275

The Kula (the family)

- Social life was the basis of both social and political organisations. It was the **smallest unit** of the social and political organisations. Its head was called '*Kulap*' or '*Grihapati*'.

Early Vedic Economy

The early vedic economy was mostly based on cattle breeding and agriculture. In addition people were engaged in crafted trade.

Pastoralism

- The early Vedic Aryans were pastoralists. For milk products, wools, leather, agriculture, drawing chariots, the animals were raised. The Early Vedic people's total culture was revolved around the wealth in the form of cattle. Hence, the unit of family was called as 'Gotra'.
- Ceremonies were performed at the time of returning of cattle from pastures, called as 'Goraja Muhurta'
- A large number of words are derived from the word 'go' meaning cow. A wealthy person was known as gomati and the daughter called duhitri which means one who milks the cow.
- The word gaveshana literally means search for cows, but it also means battle since many battles were fought over cattle.

Agriculture

- The evidence for agriculture in comparison with pastoral activities in the portions is meager and mostly late insertions.
- The Vedic Aryans know basic agricultural techniques, like to add fertilizers, to cut crops with the help of sickles, to arrange water sources etc. They produced yava (modern jowar or barley), which was rather a generic word for cereals.

- Simple agricultural tools, namely the langala or sira (the plough), the wooden phala (ploughshare), the Khanitra (hoe), the datra (sickle) and the parasua (axe), were made use of, probably used for shifting cultivations.

Craft-Industry

- People were engaged in many other economic activities. Hunting, carpentry, tanning, weaving, chariot-making, metal smelting, etc. were some such activities.
- Vedic Aryans used to wear colorful cloths of cotton and wool. Such colorful cloths were embroidered by women, known as 'Peshaskari'. The weaver is called as 'Vaya', whereas the Charakha is called as 'Tasar'.
- The Goldsmith was called as 'Hiranyakar' the used make jewellery of gold, both for human and horses.
- The smelting was related to copper only. Iron was not entirely unknown (krishna-ayas), however, the metallurgy was not known.

Trade

- The trade was on the levels of exchanges only that was of 'barter-system'.
- The people involved in trade was called as 'Pani'.
- Cows were the most favoured medium of exchange. The priests received cows, horses and gold ornaments as fees for performing sacrifices.

LATER VEDIC AGE (1000 - 600 BC)

The period that followed Rig Vedic Age is known as later Vedic Age. This age witnessed the composition of three Veda samhitas namely, the samveda samhita, the Yajurveda samhita, the Atharvaveda samhita along with the Brahmanas and the Upanishads of all the four Vedas. This period is also marked as Iron- PGW Age because of the use of iron in agriculture and painted grey ware (PGW).

Geographical Expansion

All later vedic text were compiled in the upper Gangetic basin during 1000-600 BC. During the later Vedic period, the Aryans moved into East ward and southward areas. The literature of this period mentions about the Arabian sea, the vindhyan range and the Northern plains of the Ganga-Yamuna Doab.

In the East Aryans habituated the Awadh region after that they entered into Bihar. A proof of the Eastward march was given in the satapatha Brahmana through the story of **Agni** and **Videha**.

The Later **Vedas** give three broad divisions of India

- Aryavarta (Northern India)
- Madhyadesa (Central India)
- Dakshina Patha (Southern India)

Political Organisation

(1) Rise of Big States

The small tribal states of Rig Vedic period were replaced by powerful states. Many famous tribes of

Rig Vedic period like Bharatas, Parus, Tritsus and Turvasas passed into oblivion and new tribes like the Kurus and Panchalas rose into prominence. There was the transformation of the **Rigvedic Jana** (meaning, people or tribe) into the janapada (meaning the area where the tribe settled). The **rajanyas** of the Rigvedic age now became the **kshatriyas** of their territories.

(2) Growth of Royal Power

In **later Vedic** period, Rigvedic popular assemblies lost their importance and royal power increased. The **Vidhata** completely disappeared.

The sabha became more powerful than the samiti and was now dominated by the **Nobles** and the Brahmins. Now women were not allowed to attend the Sabha.

(3) Origin of Kingship

There were two theories regarding the origin of kingship. The **Aitareya Brahmana** explained the rational theory of election by common consent of origin of kingship and the Taittiriya Brahmana explained the divine origin of kingship.

(4) Five Types of State System

- i) Rajya (Central kingdom) → Ruled by the Raja
- ii) Bhojya (Southern kingdom) → Ruled by the Bhoja
- iii) Swarajya (Western kingdom) → Ruled by the Svarat
- iv) Vairajya (Northern kingdom) → Ruled by the Virat
- v) Samrajya (Eastern kingdom) → Ruled by the Samrat

(5) Administrative Machinery

In the work of administration the king was assisted by a group of officers who were known as **Ratnins** (Jewels). The king realized taxes like “bali”, “sulka” and “bhaga”.

Important **Ratnins** and other Important officials.

Purohita	- Chief priest, also called the Rastra gopa.
Senani	- Supreme Commander of the Army
Vrajapati	- Officer-in-charge of the pasture land
Jivagribha	- Police officer
Spasas/Dutas	- Spies, who sometimes worked as messengers
Gramani	- Leader of the village
Madhya masi	- Mediator of disputes
Kulapati	- Family head
Bhagadugha	- Tax collector
Sangrahitri	- Treasurers
Mahishi	- The Chief Queen
Suta	- Charioteer
Govikartana	- King's companion in games
Palogala	- Courtier and messenger
Takshan	- Carpenter
Kshatri	- Chamberlain
Akshavapa	- Accountant

Sthapati	- Chief Judge
Gramyavadin	- Village Judge
Rathakara	- Chariot marker
Adhikrita	- Village officer (lowest in the rank)

Kingdoms of the Later Vedic Period

Kingdom	Location
1. Panchal	- Bareilly, Badayun & Farrukhabad in U.P.
2. Kushinagar	- Northern region of Uttar Pradesh
3. Kashi	- Modern Varanasi
4. Koshal	- Faizabad in Uttar Pradesh
5. Southern Madra	- Near Amritsar
6. Uttara Madra	- Kashmir
7. Eastern Madra	- Near Kangra
8. Kekaya	- On the bank of Beas river east of Gandhar kingdom
9. Gandhar	- Rawalpindi & Peshawar

Later Vedic Economic Condition

- The Early Vedic Period was a Bronze (chalcolithic) Age culture where as the later vedic period was an Iron Age culture.
- The transition of vedic society from semi-nomadic life to **settled agriculture** in the later vedic age lead to an increase in trade and competition for resources.
- Rice, barley, beans, sesame and wheat were cultivated.
- Rice is called **Vrihi** in the Vedic texts.
- Now the agricultural technology was developed. The farmers started plowing lands with the help of 6 to 24 bulls.
- Various kinds of lentils were also produced by the later Vedic people.
- Griha was the basic unit of agricultural production, with the **grahapati** emerging as the **defacto** owner of the land.
- Land was cultivated with the help of the **shudras** and the slaves.
- The Vaisya were the producing class and the Kshatriyas (rajanya) and the Brahmanas (priests) depended on them for their subsistence. With the growth of civilisation, the volume of trade and commerce had increased by leaps and bounds. Inland trade was carried on with the kiratas inhabiting the mountains.
- The coins which were in circulation were “Nishka”, “Satamana” and “Krishnala”. The unit value of goods was a gold bar called “nishka” weighing three hundred and twenty ratis, which was also the weight of a satamana.
- A ‘Krishnala’ weighed one rati, i.e. 1.8 grams.
- ‘Pani’ was a class of merchants who controlled the trade.

- Houses were made of wood. The **Taittiriya Aranyakas** refer about a special type of house known as 'Dhandhani' (treasure house). The **Atharvaveda** mentions about 'Patniam sadan' (women's apartment).
- '**Bipatha**' was a rough vehicle for transport goods

Social Life:

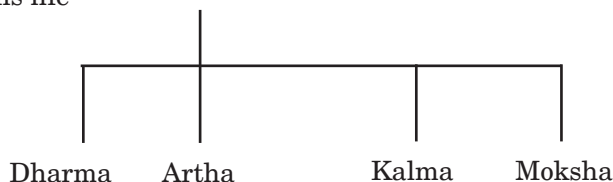
In later vedic period, the people dispersed in various parts of India. This affected social structures and made it more complex.

Patriarchal Family System

The eldest of male members of the family. Perceived as the head of family, called as 'grihapati'.

Concept of Purushartha

Every man was expected to follow four main duties in his life-



Concept of Varna

In the 10th mandala, in Purushsukta of Rig-veda clear-cut division of the society has been mentioned. According to this system various duties assigned to each varna like,

- Brahman** Teaching, learning, performance and hosting of sacrifice.
- Kshatriya** Learning, hosting sacrifice and protection of people and land.
- Vaishya** Trade and agriculture: the agriculturists, traders and artisans belonged to this varna.
- Shudra** Submission of service to upper three classes, this was the lowest of the varna-ladder and had no powers and no rights in the society.

The three (Brahmans, Kshatriya, Vaishya) in combination perceived as men of higher Varnas, i.e. traivarnikas.

Concept of Ashrama

In this system, a person's life divided into four parts and he was assigned some duties with respect to his age, like.

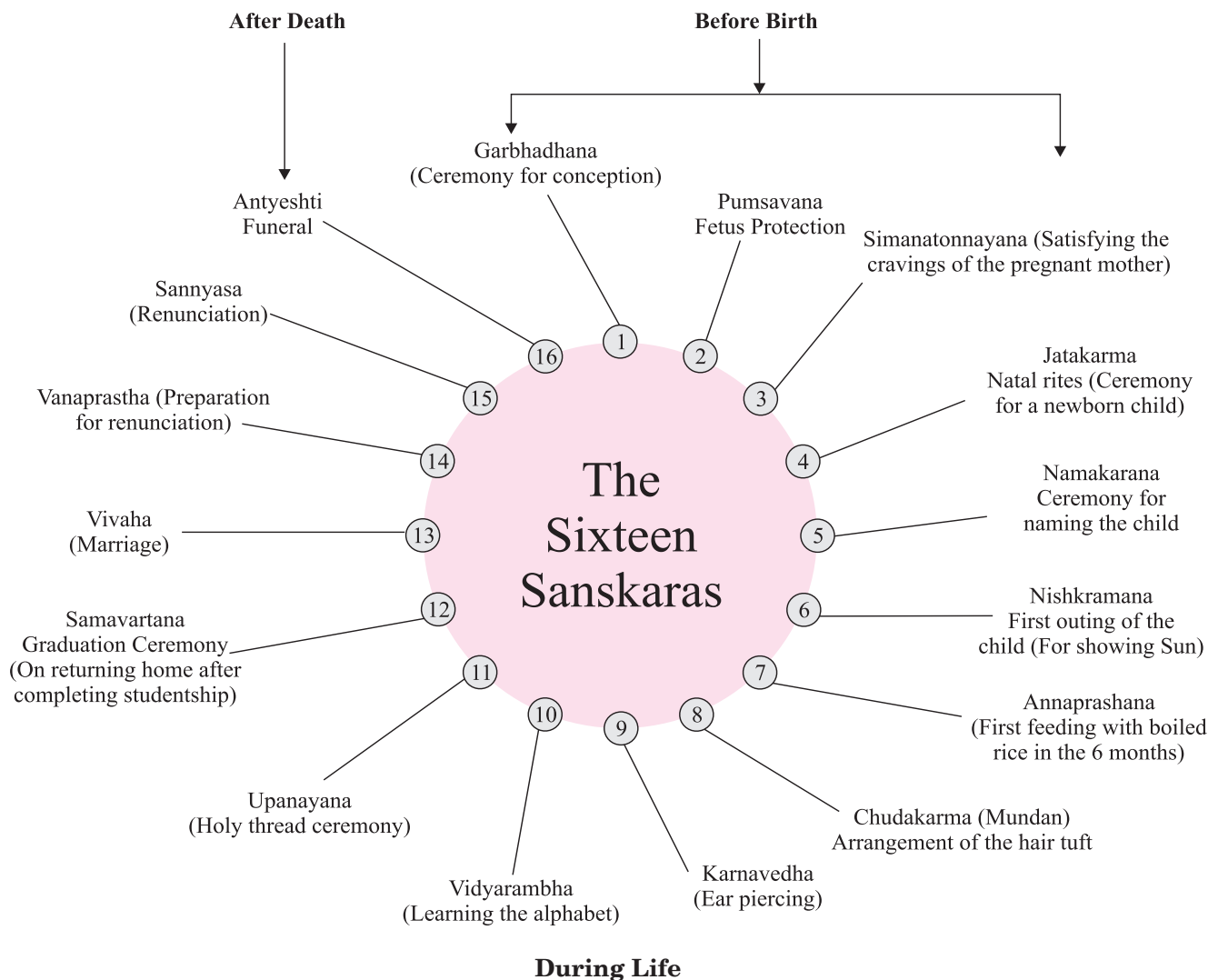
- Brahmacharya - ashrama (studentship)
- Grihastha - ashrama (house holds)

- Van-prastha- ashrama (partial retirement from household life)
- Sanaya-ashrama (complete retirement from social life)

The System of Marriage

- Marriage was considered as main duty of vedic people and hence it became a point of religious importance. In the **grihastasashrama** a person is expected by the canons to get married. It is perceived that through marriage and giving birth to children one could become free from the '**rina**' (lit. loan = responsibility) of his parents.
 - In this period, 'Inter-Varna' marriages were disliked, where as 'similar **gotra**/family marriages' were forbidden. There were two types of legalized structures of marriages:
 - Anuloma** marriage was used to perform between bridegroom from higher Varna and bride from lower Varna.
 - Pratiloma** marriage was used to perform between bridegroom from lower **varna** and bride from higher varna.
- There are eight types of marriages mentioned in the writings of smriti writers, These are of marriages.

- Brahma-vivaha** Father gives his daughters' hand to the know ledgeable and well behaved bridegroom with proper rites and rituals.
- Daiva-vivaha** Father gives the bride's hand to the priest as dakshina (fees).
- Prajaatya vivaha** Father greets bridegroom and appeals the couple to follow religious duties.
- Arsha-vivaha** Father gives the bride's hand to the bridegroom after receiving a pair of cattle from the groom.
- Gandharva-vivaha** Marriage through the consent of bridegroom and bride only, i.e., self choice or swayamvara.
- Asur- vivaha** Bridegroom gives money to the bride's father and purchases her for marriage.
- Rakshasa-vivaha** Forceful abduction of a girl and marrying her.
- Paishacha-vivaha** With force making the girl unconscious and violet her chastity.



The Position of women

This period onwards status of women was started deteriorating Rights which they had earlier were not enjoying in this period.

Husband received the status as a patiparmeshwar (God). women were denied to educate.

- Women were attending lectures of gurus rarely. In **Brhadaranyaka upanishad** tells of a learned lady Gargi Vacaknavi who attended the discussion of the sage **Yajnavalkya** mention that knowledge were only confined for male only.
- **Sati and Veil** system were become prevalent in this period. Hindu **Dharmashastra** were denied to offer prayers and sacrifices, practices of penances and undertake religious pilgrimages to women.
- **Manusmriti** laid down various restrictions regarding the traditional rights for women in his book manusmriti. **Upanayan** sanskar which was previously for both boys and girls are now for only for boys.

- According to the **Satapatha Brahmana** a wife was to eat only after the husband has finished eating.

Religious Scene

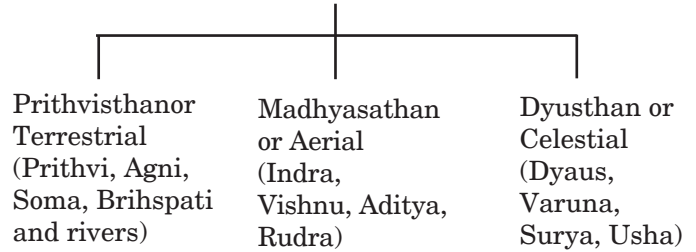
- The religion became very complex in the **Later Vedic** period.
- The Gods like Indra, Varuna and Surya became unpopular. Whereas there emerged new Gods like Vishnu, Rudra, Shiva.
- **Prajapati**, the lord of created beings, cost all the older deities into the shade.
- **Pushan**, became the God of the shudra who was the protector of cattle in the early vedic period.
- **Vishnu** occupied the place of **Varuna** as the most sublime among the celertials and his highest step became the goal of the sages.
- The sacrifices varied and codified with various types of rules and regulations, i.e. karmakanda. The right of performance of sacrifices was snatched off from **kulapati** and it was became the monopoly of the priest class.

Sacrifice Performed in the Later Vedic Period

- Asvamedha - horse sacrifice which was meant to establish king's supremacy over other kings
- Rajasuya - consecration ceremony which conferred supreme power of the kings
- Ratnahavimsi - part of Rajasuya ceremony
- Vajapeya - chariot race which was meant to re-establish a king's supremacy over his people

- The main tenets of **Hindusim** are the doctrines of karma, maya, transmigration, identification of individual soul with the universal soul and the mukti.

Triple Classification of Vedic Gods



Exercise - 1

1. In which type of marriage, payment of bride-price was a condition?
(a) Asura (b) Brahma
(c) Daiva (d) Gandharva
2. Which one of the following sites is not associated with Painted Grey Ware ?
(a) Gilaulikhera (b) Noh
(c) Tripuri (d) Satwali
3. The religion of early Vedic Aryans was primarily of
(a) Bhakti
(b) image worship and Yajnas
(c) worship of nature and Yajnas
(d) worship of nature and Bhakti
4. The people who migrated from the region of the Caspian sea were called
(a) Dravidians (b) Aryans
(c) Euro Asians (d) Africans
5. With regard to the position of woman during the Vedic age, which one of the following statements is not true?
(a) Women enjoyed an honourable position
(b) Women took part in religious deliberation during the early Vedic period
(c) The practice of 'sati' was unknown during the early Vedic period
(d) The birth of girl was looked down upon during the early vedic period
6. The ceremonies of rajasuya and vajpeya are mentioned in which text?
(a) Rig Veda (b) Sama Veda
(c) Yajur Veda (d) Atharva Veda
7. Which book of the later vedic age divides the country into five parts?
(a) Atharva veda (b) Aitareya Brahmana
(c) Satapatha Brahmana (d) Isa Upanishad
8. Who among the following artisan classes were entitled to wear the sacred thread in the vedic period?
(a) Chariot-makers (b) Goldsmiths
(c) Blacksmiths (d) Weavers
9. The concept of 'Gotra' become established in which period?
(a) Rig Vedic age (b) Later Vedic age
(c) Pre Mauryan Period (d) Mauryan period
10. Who is the most important God in Rigveda?
(a) Agni (b) Indra
(c) Varun (d) Vishnu
11. The river Chenab was known during the Vedic period by the name :
(a) Askini (b) Parushni
(c) Shutudri (d) Vitasta
12. Which one of the following assemblies was also called Narishta meaning a resolution that cannot be broken?
(a) Gana (b) Vidhata
(c) Sabha (d) Samiti
13. Which of the following is concerned with origin of Indian medicine?
(a) Rigveda (b) Samveda
(c) Yajurveda (d) Atharveda
14. How many times the word 'Jana' occur in the Rigveda?
(a) 75 times (b) 175 times
(c) 275 times (d) 375 times
15. Which of the following Samhitas of Yajurveda contains only hymns and no prose?
(a) Katha (b) Maitrayaviya
(c) Taittiriya (d) Vajasaneyi
16. The game of 'dice' was part of the ritual of :
(a) Agnistoma (b) Aswamedha
(c) Rajasuya (d) Vajapeya
17. The Gayatri Mantra is dedicated to :
(a) Indra (b) Aditi
(c) Gayatri (d) Savitri
18. The flood Legend in which a divine fish has been described as rescuing Manu occurs in detail in :
(a) Rigveda Samhita (b) Vajasaneyi Samhita
(c) Satapatha Brahmana (d) Aitareya Brahmana
19. To which Sakha does the publised Rigveda Samhita belong?
(a) Sawnaka (b) Asvalayan
(c) Sakala (d) Sankhayana
20. King Asvapati of the Upanishadic Age was the ruler of :
(a) Kekaya (b) Matsya
(c) Panchala (d) Sursena
21. Who among the following Vedic deities bears resemblance with Avestan God 'Ahurmazda' ?
(a) Indra (b) Varuna
(c) Rudra (d) Vishnu
22. Who among the following was a commentator of the Manusmriti ?
(a) Asahaya (b) Visvarupa
(c) Bhattacharya (d) Medhatithi
23. A story of Sunahsesha, in which his father Ajigarta is stated to have sold him to Harishchandra, occurs in :
(a) Aitareya Brahmana
(b) Gopatha Brahmana
(c) Svetasvatara Upanishad
(d) Brihadaranyaka Upanishad
24. Who wrote the first textbook on Jyotish?
(a) Panini (b) Patanjali
(c) Katyayan (d) Bhrgu
25. The words "Satyameva Jayate" in the state emblem of India have been adopted from which one of the following?
(a) Mundaka Upanishad (b) Katha Upanishad
(c) Mandukya Upanishad (d) Chhandogya Upanishad
26. The great law giver of ancient time was :
(a) Vatsyayana (b) Ashoka
(c) Manu (d) Panini
27. During the Rigvedic period, 'Niska' was an ornament of :
(a) Ear (b) Neck (c) Arm (d) Wrist
28. Sayana the famous commentator of the Vedic texts, was patronised by :
(a) Parmara rulers (b) Satvahana rulers
(c) Vijaynagar rulers (d) Vakataka rulers

29. The word Yava mentioned in Rigveda is used for which agricultural product?
(a) Barley (b) Gram (c) Rice (d) Wheat
30. Which of the following was the centre of Aryan activity in the later Vedic period?
(a) The Aryavarta
(b) From the Yamuna to the western border of Bengal
(c) The Punjab and Delhi region
(d) Uttarapatha
31. The Rigvedic hymns can be treated as being historically fairly authentic because
(a) They give a chronological account of the historical events
(b) The events described in them are corroborated by Avesthan Gathas.
(c) They are the earliest of the Vedic literature
(d) Their composition was contemporary with the period described
32. An inscription of 1400 B.C. which describes the Vedic Gods was found in Asia Minor at _____.
(a) Cilicia (b) Boghaz-Koi
(c) Hitti (d) Euphratide
33. Which of the following statements about the system of taxation and revenue administration in the Later Vedic period is not correct?
(a) Settled life and stable agriculture led to the production of surplus which could be collected by the king in the form of taxes
(b) The king received regular contributions from the people in the shape of bali and shulka
(c) One-sixth of the produce of the land was payable to the king
(d) An official called bhagadugha collected the royal share of the produce
34. Which of the following was not one of the reasons for the gradual weakening of the tribal assemblies in the Later Vedic Period?
(a) Increase in the royal power
(b) In large territorial states ordinary people could not travel long distances to attend their meetings
(c) The assemblies acquired an aristocratic character which took away most of their effectiveness
(d) They also surrendered some of their activities to the new officials called ratnins
35. Which of the following descriptions of the Later Vedic officials is not correct?
(a) Bhagadugha-Collector of taxes
(b) Kshttri-Chamberlain
(c) Akshavapa-Superintendent of gambling
(d) Adhikari-Suuperintendent of Police
36. Which of the following statements about the administrative system of the Early Vedic period is not correct?
(a) The king was assisted by a number of functionaries of whom the two most important were purohita and the senani
(b) Gramani was the head of the village only for civic purposes
(c) Forts and strongholds were under purapati
(d) To provide organization in society
37. The Rigvedic concept of Rita denotes the
(a) Cosmic order or law prevailing in nature
(b) Ethical and moral order
(c) Both (a) and (b) above
(d) Amalgamation of "All Gods" into "one"
38. The head of which of the following was supposed to be known as ganapati or jyeshtha?
(a) Family (b) Tribe
(c) Tribal republic (d) Sabha
39. Like the Vedic Aryans the custom of sacrificial fire was also followed by the ancient
(a) Romans (b) Greeks
(c) Iranians (d) All the above
40. The 'Wedding Hymn' describing the oldest marriage ritual is found in the
(a) Rigveda (b) Yajurveda
(c) Samveda (d) Grihyasutras
41. Which one among the following is not a characteristic of Rig-Vedic Aryans?
(a) They were acquainted with horses, chariots and the use of bronze
(b) They were acquainted with the use of iron
(c) They were acquainted with the cow, which formed the most important form of wealth
(d) They were acquainted with the use of copper and the modern ploughshare
42. Which one among the following is not true with regard to Rig Veda Samhita?
(a) There are about 300 non-Indo- European words in Rig Veda
(b) There is a reference to dasarajna (battle of ten kings) in the Rig Veda
(c) It is mentioned in the Rig Veda that the Bharata chief Sudas fought against a confederacy of ten tribes
(d) Purus sided with Bharata in the battle of ten kings

Exercise -2

Statement Based MCQ

1. Which of the following statements regarding the hymns of the Rig veda are correct ?
1. They refer to the Himavanta and the Nujavanta.
 2. They mention geographical terms like Aryavarta and Dakshinaty.
 3. Most rivers mentioned in them flow in areas west of the Yamuna and the Ganga.
 4. They mention the ruling families on the Kurus, Panchalas and the Ikshvakus.
- Select the correct answer from the codes given below:
- (a) 1 and 2
 - (b) 1 and 3
 - (c) 2, 3 and 4
 - (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

2. With reference to the early vedic age, consider the following statements:
1. In Rig Veda, there are 20 mandalas of which book I to X are the oldest and relate to early Vedic Age.
 2. The total numbers of hymns is 1028.
 3. Book VIII of Rigveda ascribed to Kanvas and Angirases.
 4. Samaveda, Yajurveda and Atharvaveda are composed during the early vedic age.
- Which of the above is/are correct
- (a) 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 4
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 2, 3 and 4
3. Regarding women in the Vedic period, which of the following are correct?
1. They were allowed to study
 2. They held good positions
 3. They did not practice Purdah system
 4. They attended Sabha and Samiti
- Which of the given above statements are correct?
- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 3 and 4
(c) 2 and 3 (d) All of these
4. The "Dharma" and "Rita" depict a central idea of ancient Vedic civilization of India. In this context, consider the following statements :
1. Dharma was a conception of obligations and of the discharge of one's duties to oneself and to others.
 2. Rita was the fundamental moral law governing the functioning of the universe and all it contained.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Matching Based MCQ

5.

List-I (Rivers)	List-II (Vedic Names)
A. Satluj	1. Vipasha
B. Vyas	2. Sutudari
C. Ravi	3. Asikini
D. Chenab	4. Parushni

Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	1	4	3
(b)	4	3	2	1
(c)	1	4	3	2
(d)	1	2	3	4

6.

List-I (Samhita)	List-II (Upanisad)
A. Rigveda	1. Chhandogya
B. Yajurveda	2. Mundaka
C. Samaveda	3. Katha
D. Atharvaveda	4. Kaushitaki

Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	1	4	3
(b)	4	3	1	2
(c)	1	2	3	4
(d)	3	4	2	1

7.

List-I (Rigvedic name)	List-II (Modern name)
A. Gomati	1. Gomati
B. Kurmu	2. Kurram
C. Suvastu	3. Swati
D. Drishavari	4. Ghaghar

Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	4	3	1
(b)	1	2	3	4
(c)	4	3	2	1
(d)	1	4	3	2

8. Which of the following characteristic(s) describes the nature of religion according to the Rig Veda?
1. Rig Vedic religion can be described a naturalistic polytheism.
 2. There are striking similarities between the Rig Vedic religion and the ideas in the Iranian Avesta.
 3. Vedic sacrifices were conducted in the house of the priest who was called yajaman.
 4. Vedic sacrifices were of two kind – those conducted by the household and those that required rituals specialists.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

- (a) 3 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 1, 2, 3 and 4 (d) 1, 2 and 4 only

Hints and Explanations

EXERCISE-1

1. (a) In Asura marriage, bridegroom gave as much wealth as he could afford to the bride's relatives, not in accordance with the injunctions of the scriptures because it was like buying the bride, which was prohibited.
2. (d)
3. (c) The early Vedic Aryans indulged in Image Worship and Yajnas.
4. (b)
5. (d) The birth of girl was looked down upon during the early vedic period
6. (c) 7.(b) 8. (a) 9.(b)
10. (b) Indra was the most important divinity and was lord of war. 250 hymns have been devoted to only Indra in Rigveda, which is highest for any of the Gods. His other names are: Car-warrior (Rathस्था); A winner (Jitendra) and Soma Drinker (Somapa). Indra is mentioned as son of Dyaus. He killed a demon Vritra, so he is known as Vritrahan. He destroyed the forests so also known as Purandhar. He held the thunderbolt (Vajra) with which he destroyed the enemies.
11. (a) The river Chenab was known in the Vedic period as Chandrabhaga also Askini or Iskmati and as Acesines to the Ancient Greeks.
12. (c) The Sabha is called Narishta which meant a 'resolution of many' that cannot be broken. It performed the

executive functions. In the later Vedic period it lost its importance due to the rise of royal power.

13. (d) Atharvaveda concerned with the origin of Indian medicine. It also consists mainly of magical spells and charms.
14. (c) The term 'Jana' occurs 275 times in the Rigveda. But Janapada is not mentioned. The term Rajya occurs only once.
15. (d) The Samhita of Yajurveda that contains only hymns and no prose is Vayasaneyi.
16. (c) Dicing seems to have a special significance when connected with myths and rituals. Dicing involves uncertainty, chance, the vagaries of fortune. The dice game is representative of the challenges that a king must endure during his reign. The game of dice be a part of the rituals of Rajasuya Yagya.
17. (d) The Gayatri Mantra is a highly revered mantra, based on a Vedic Sanskrit verse from a hymn of the Rigveda. The Gayatri mantra is dedicated to Savitr, is hence called Savitri. It is considered to be among the holiest mantras of Hinduism.
18. (c) Hindu flood myth from the Satapatha Brahmana, the Matsya Avatar saves the pious and the first man, Manu, and advises him to build a giant boat.
19. (c)
20. (a) The Kekaya kingdom was situated on the bank of river Beas, east of Gandhar kingdom. King Aswapati ruled Kekaya when Janak was the king of Videha.
21. (a) Indra was the Vedic deities bears resemblance with Avestan god Ahurmazda. In Zoroastrianism as reflected in the Avesta, Ahura Mazda is identified with the beneficent spirit and directly opposed to the destructive one. He is all-wise, liberal, undecieving and the creator of everything good.
22. (d) Medhatithi was first Sanskrit scholar who did commentary on Manusmriti a Dharmashastra. The exact date of Medhatithi's writing is unclear, and he has been placed anywhere between about 820 and 1050 AD.
23. (a) The story of Sunahsesha in which his father Ajigarta is stated to have sold him to Harishchandra, occurs in Aitareya Brahmana.
24. (d) Maharishi Bhrigu was the first compiler of predictive astrology, Jyotisha. He is credited as the father of Hindu astrology and the first astrological treatise Bhrigu Samhita is attributed to his authorship. The Bhrigu Samhita is an astrological (Jyotish) classic attributed to Maharishi Bhrigu during the Vedic period.
25. (a) 'Satyameva Jayate' is a mantra from the ancient Indian scripture Mundaka Upanishad. Upon independence of India, it was adopted as the national motto of India.
26. (c) Manu-smriti (Laws of Manu), traditionally, the most authoritative of the books of the Hindu code (Dharmashastra) in India. It is attributed to the legendary first man and lawgiver, Manu. In its present form, it dates from the 1st century BCE.
27. (b) In Rigvedic period, Niska was a gold necklace in the beginning but later it was also used as a coin for giving as a reward to a poet.
28. (c)
29. (a) It is accepted that the word 'yava' in the oldest texts, including the Rigveda, applied to any type of grain that was grounded into flour. Yet, many Indologists treat the word as meaning specifically barley.
30. (d) 31. (c) 32. (b) 33. (c) 34. (a) 35. (c)
36. (b) 37. (a) 38. (c) 39. (c) 40. (c)
41. (b) Rig Vedic Aryans were not acquainted to the use of Iron.
42. (a) Rigveda Samhita is an ancient Indian sacred collection of vedic sanskrit hymns. It is among the worlds oldest religions texts. The question of non-Indo European world being included in the original text does not arise.

EXERCISE-2

1. (c)
2. (a) Sam, yajur and Atharveda are composed during later Vedic Age, Then are ten books or Mandals in the Rigveda.
3. (d) The Rigvedic society was a free society. The Aryans evidently preferred male child to female child. However, females were as free as their male counterparts. Education was equally open for boys and girls. Girls studied the Veda and fine arts. Women never observed Purdha in the Vedic period. They enjoyed freedom in selecting their mates. But divorce was not permissible to them. In the family, they enjoyed complete freedom and were treated as Ardhanginis.
4. (c) 5. (a)
6. (b) Some of the important Upanishads are: Aitareya, Kaushitaki (belong to Rigveda); Chhandogya, Kena (belong to the Samaveda); Katha, Svetasvatara, Brihadaranyaka, Isa (belong to the Yajurveda); Mundaka, Prasna and Mandukya (belong to the Atharvaveda). The correct matching pairs are – Rigveda and Kaushitaki, Yajurveda and Katha, Samaveda and Chhandogya, Atharvaveda and Mundaka.
7. (b) The correct pairs of Rigvedic names and modern names are:

Rig-Vedic Name	Modern Name
Sindhu	Indus
Vitase	Jhelum
Askini	Chenab
Purushni	Ravi
Vipas	Beas
Sutudari	Satluj
Gumal	Gomati
Krumu	Kurram
Drishdvati	Ghagghar
Suvastu	Swat

8. (c) Even though monotheism characterizes some of the hymns of Rig Veda, naturalistic polytheism and monism can be discerned in the religion of the hymns of Rig Veda. Like the rigvedic Aryans the ancient Iranians worshipped gods like Mitr, Vayu and Verutraghna. They also wore the sacred thread and worshipped fire etc. Initially sacrifices were simple, house hold duties performed by the oldest male member of the house yajmana who acted as priest and the oldest female member. yajmana patni(wife of the householder) who assisted in the act. The agnihotra was a simple domestic sacrifice to be performed daily by the head of a Dvija household in the morning and the evening. Other involved the participation of many different ritual specialists along with their assistants.



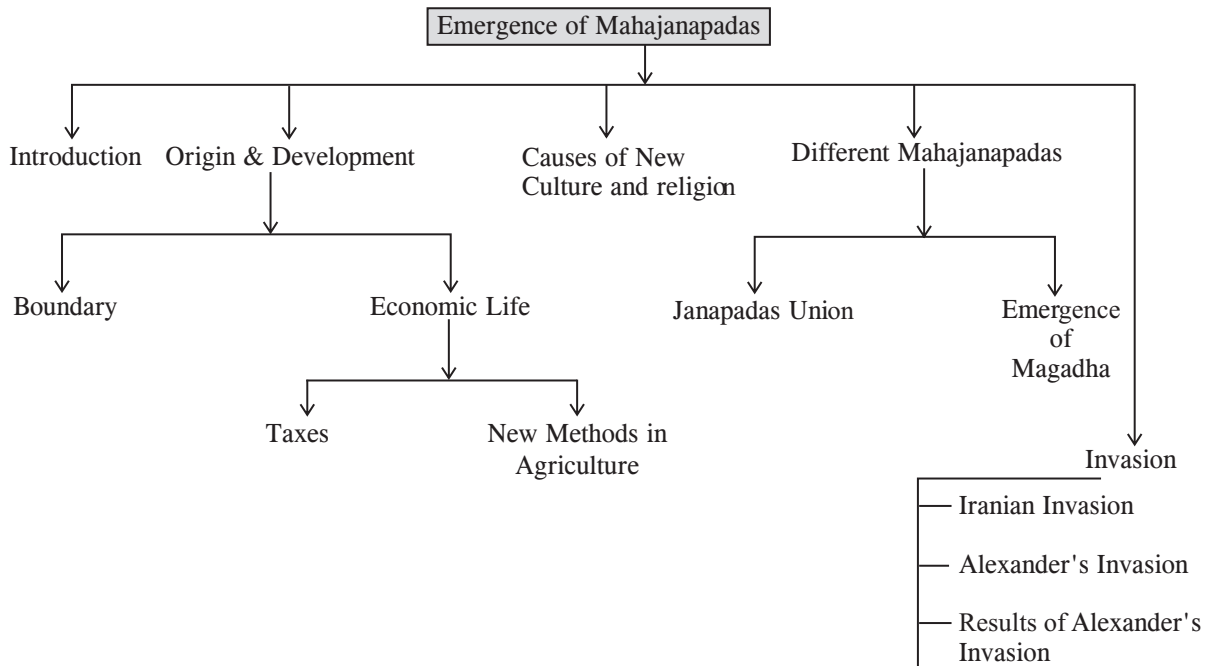
EMERGENCE OF MAHAJANAPADAS AND MAGADH

5

Chapter

Introduction

Janapada literally means the place where the people put their feet. However, these were permanent settlements of the agricultural communities of the later vedic period. The term *Mahajanapad* was used to describe a large area capable of bearing taxes and various imposition. Several Janapadas included in a Mahajanpada. There were several thousand villages in a Janapada. The Kautilyan Janapada comprised 3200 villages..



ORIGIN AND DEVELOPMENTS OF MAHAJANAPADAS

Boundary and Army

- Most of Mahajanapadas had a **capital city** and were fortified.
- It means the entire areas were surrounded by huge walls of wood, brick or stones.
- The **objectives** of building forts were to protect the people and the kingdom from the attacks of other kings.
- To show how rich and powerful they were by building large, tall and impressive walls around their cities
- To control the land and the people living inside the fortified area more easily.
- The rajas maintained armies to protect the people and the fort.
- The people lived in **huts**, and kept **cattle** as well as other animals.

- They used to grow a variety of crops like rice, wheat, barley, pulses, sugarcane, sesame and mustard.
- They knew making **earthen pots**, some were in grey and red colours.
- Some painted grey pots of **geometric pattern** are found.

In transition from tribe to monarchy they lost the essential democratic pattern of the tribe but retained the idea of government through an assembly representing the tribes. These states consisted of either a single tribe such as the Shakyas, Kolia, Mallas, etc. or a confederacy of tribes such as the Vrijis, Yadavas, Panchala, etc.

The people in the lower Ganges Valley and Delta were outside the Aryan boundary were considered as **mlecchas**. There was a strong consciousness of the purity of the Aryans called **Aryavarta**. Each janapada tried to dominate and subjugate other janapadas to become Mahajanapads.

Economic Life

Taxes of Mahajanapada

The rulers needed **more resources** for building **huge forts** and maintaining **big armies**. So, they started collecting regular

taxes, instead of depending on occasional gifts brought by people which was in the case of the raja of janapadas. These taxes were collected from :

- Farmers** on their **crop** production,
- Crafts** persons in the form of labour,
- Herders** in the form of animals and **animal** produce,
- Traders** on goods that were brought and sold,
- Hunters** and gatherers on forest produce.

New Methods in Agriculture

There were two changes adopted in the practice of agriculture, that were:

- They used **iron ploughshare** at the place of wooden ploughshare. Its motive was to turn over the heavy clayey soil better to produce more grain.
- People started developing **nursery of paddy** instead of scattering seed on the ground for final cropping. In this nursery plants were sprouted, saplings were grown and then planted in the fields to increase production.

CAUSES OF RISE OF NEW CULTURE AND RELIGIONS

- The changes in economic and social events led in co-existent of religious thought.
- The creation of awakened groups of traders, industrialists and labour resulted in putting a challenge to the supremacy of the Brahmanas.
- The creation of sub-castes also did the same.
- Several of these groups were rich as well which gave them an advantageous position in the society. It led to religious awakening in the society which **caused the formation of several religious sects**.
- There is no doubt that the **rise of Jainism and Buddhism** during this period was a result of the **changed economic and social circumstances** also.
- We also find that both of these religious sects got support from the **neo-rich trading and industrial classes** which were eager to get a better social status so far denied to them.
- The same way, both Jainism and Buddhism drew large converts from new sub-castes who were interested in getting equal status for all castes thereby getting the facility of having better social status for themselves.

DIFFERENT MAHAJANAPADAS

There were about sixteen Mahajanapadas (about 2500 years ago) according to **Anguttara Nikaya** in the sixth century B.C. namely:

Magadha (including the present districts of Patna, Gaya and parts of Shahabad) with its capital at **Girivraja** or **Rajgriha**. (ii) **Anga** (including the present districts of Monghyr and Bhagalpur in Bihar) with its capital at **Champa**. (iii) **Vajji** (a confederacy of eight republican clans. To the north of the river Ganga in Bihar) with its capital, **Vaisali**. (iv) **Malla** (also a republican confederacy including the present districts of **Deoria, Basti, Gorakhpur** and **Siddharthnagar** in eastern Uttar Pradesh) with two capitals at **Kusinagar** and **Pawa**. (v) **Kasi** with its capital at **Varanasi**. (vi) **Kosala** (including the present district of **Faizabad, Gonda, Baharaich**, etc.) with its capital at **Shravasti**. (vii) **Vatsa** (including the present districts **Allahabad, Mirzapur** etc.), with Its capital at **Kausambi**. (viii) **Chedi**, (including the present Bundelkhand area) with its capital at **Shuktimati**. (ix) **Kuru** (including the present Haryana and Delhi area to the West of river Yamuna) with its capital at **Indraprastha** (modern Delhi). (x) **Panchala**

(including the area of western Uttar Pradesh upto the east of river Yamuna upto the Kosala Janapada) with its capital at **Ahichhatra**. (xi) **Surasena**, (covering Brij Mandal) with its capital at **Mathura**. (xii) **Matsya** (covering the area of Alwar, Bharatpur and Jaipur in Rajasthan). (xiii) **Avanti** (modern Malwa) with its capital at **Ujjain** and Mahishmati. (xiv) **Asmaka** (between the rivers Narmada and Godavari with its capital at **Potana**. (xv) **Gandhara** (area covering the western part of Pakistan and eastern Afghanistan) with its capitals at **Taxila** and Pushkalavati, and (xvi) **Kamboja** (identified with modern district of Hazara districts of Pakistan) with its capital at **Rajpur**.

S. No.	Mahajanapadas	Present areas	Capitals
1.	Gandhara	Western Pakistan & Afghanistan	Taxila
2.	Kamboja	Pakistan	Rajpur
3.	Asmaka	Between Narmada & Godavari	Potana

4.	Vatsa	Allahabad	Kaushambi
5.	Avanti	Malwa	Ujjain
6.	Surasena	Brij Mandal	Mathura
7.	Chedi	Bundel khand	Shuktimati
8.	Malla	Deoria, Basti	Kushinara, Pawa
9.	Kurus	Haryana, Delhi	Hastinapur/ Indraprastha (Delhi)
10.	Matsya	Alwar, Jaipur	Virat Nagari
11.	Vajjis (Vrijji)	Bihar	Vaishali
12.	Anga	Monghyr	Champa
13.	Kashi		Banaras (Varanasi)
14.	Kosala	Faizabad Gonda	Shravasti
15.	Magadha	Patna, Gaya	Girivraja/ Rajgriha
16.	Panchala	Uttar Pradesh	Ahichhatra (W. Panchala) Kampilya (S. Panchala)

Important Janapadas Union (Republic)

Republican Manajanapada was ruled by a group of representatives elected by the common people. The Mahajanapadas of Vrijji, Mall, Kuru, Panchal and Kamboj were republican states and so were either smaller states like Lichhavi, Shakya, Kolya, Bhagga, and Moriya. All the administrative decisions of the states were taken by the *Parisha*. The republics were basically of two types:

- The republics comprising a **single tribe** like those of the Sakyas, the Kolias and the Mallas.
- The republics comprising a number of tribes or the republics of **confederacy** like the Vrijjis.

Emergence of Magadha

The first important king of Magadha was **Bimbisara** (542 B.C. – 493 B.C.) who belonged to the *Haryanka dynasty*. He

strengthened his position by marriage alliances. He took three wives. His first wife was the daughter of the king Kosala and the sister of Prasenajit. His second wife Chellana was a Lichhavi Princess from Vaishali, and his third wife was the daughter of the chief of the Madra clan of Punjab.

- Marriage relations with the different princely families gave enormous diplomatic prestige and paved the way for the expansion of Magadha westward and northward.
- The earliest capital of Magadha was at *Rajgir*, which was called *Girivraja* at that time. It was surrounded by **five hills**, the openings in which were closed by stone walls on all sides. This made Rajgir invincible.
- He was succeeded by his son *Ajatasatru* (492–460 B.C.)
- Ajatasatru killed his father and seized the throne for himself. Throughout his *reign*, he pursued an aggressive policy of expansion.
- Ajatasatru was succeeded by *Udayin* (460 – 444 B.C.). His reign was important because he **built the fort** upon the confluence of the Ganga and Son at Patna. This was done because Patna lay in the centre of the Magadhan kingdom.
- Udayin was succeeded by the dynasty of *Sisunagas*, who temporarily shifted the capital to *Vaishali*. Their greatest achievement was the destruction of the power of Avanti with its capital at Ujjain. This brought to an end the 100 years old rivalry between Magadha and Avanti.

Causes for the Rise of Magadha

- Advantageous **geographical location** either at Rajgir or Pataliputra situated at strategic locations.
- Advantageous **natural resources** such as **iron** enable Magadhan rulers to equip with **effective weapons**.
- The **alluvial soil** of Gangetic plains and sufficient rainfall was very conducive for **agriculture produces**.
- Rise of town and **use of metallic money** boosted trade and commerce.
- The princes could use **tools** and accumulate **wealth to pay and maintain their army**.
- Use of **elephants** on a large scale **in wars**.
- Liberal** (Unorthodox) **character** of Magadhan society.
- Contribution of several enterprising and ambitious rulers.

VARIOUS INVASIONS

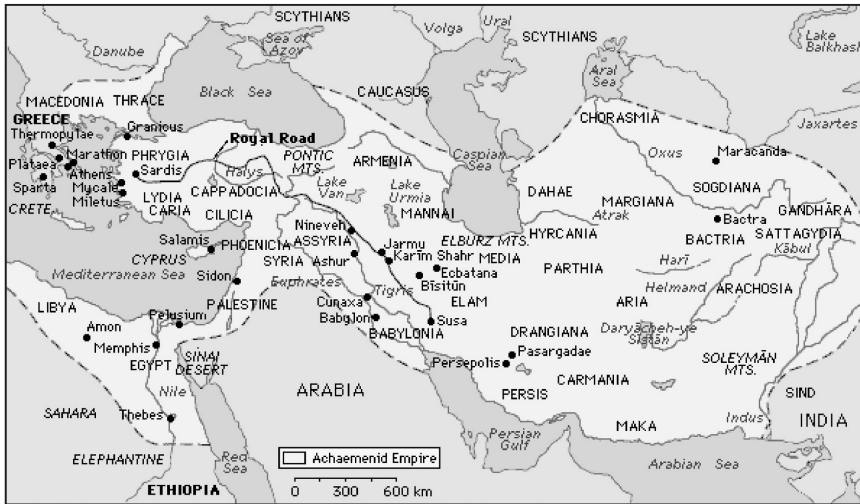
Iranian Invasion

The *Achaemenid rulers of Iran*, who spreaded their kingdom at the same time as the Magadhan princes, took advantage of the political disunity on the north-west frontier. The Iranian ruler, *Darius* penetrated into north-west India in 516 B.C. and annexed Punjab, west of the Indus, and Sindh. It gave a momentum to Indo-Iranian trade and commerce. The Iranian scribes brought into India a form of writing which came to be known as the *Kharoshi script*. It was written from right to left *like the Arabic*. Iranian coins are also found in the north-west region which points to the existence of trade with Iran. Iranian effect on the Maurya sculpture is clearly noticeable. The monuments of Ashoka's time, especially the bell shaped capitals owed something to the Iranian models.

Iranian influence may also be witnessed in the preamble of Ashoka's edicts as well as in certain words used in them.

Points to Remember

- In 516 B.C. *Darius* sent a naval expedition to explore the valley of the river Indus.
- He marked the province as *20th Straphy*, which was considered to be the richest and the most populous province of the Persian Empire.
- Its annual tribute amounted to 360 Euboic talents of gold-dust.
- The Kharoshi script was used on the north-western frontier since then until about 4th century A.D.



Alexander's Invasion

In the fourth century B.C., the Greeks and the Iranians fought for the supremacy of the world. **Alexander**, the king of **Macedonia Grece** conquered not only Asia Minor and Iraq but also Iran. From Iran, he moved on to India, obviously **attracted by its great wealth**.

Alexander defeated Indian rulers one after another. Among the rulers of these territories, two were well-known **Ambhi**, the prince of Taxila, and **Porus** whose kingdom lay between the Jhelum and the Chenab.

After the victory of Iran, Alexander reached to Kabul, from where he marched to India through the *Khyber Pass*.

Ambhi, the ruler of Taxila, readily submitted to the invader, augmented his army and replenish his treasure.

When he reached the Jhelum, Alexander met the first and the **strongest resistance** from **Porus**. Although Alexander defeated Porus, he was impressed by the bravery and courage of the Indian prince. So, he restored his kingdom to him and made him his ally.

Then, he advanced as far as the *Beas river*. He wanted to move still further eastward but his army refused to accompany him.

Alexander remained in India for 19 months (326–325 B.C.), which were full of fighting. He had barely any time to organize his conquests. Still, he made some arrangements. Most conquered states were restored to their rulers who submitted to his authority.

But his own territorial possessions were divided into three parts, which were placed under three Greek governors.

One of the most remarkable aspects of Alexander's foreign policy was his encouragement of **inter-racial marriages**.

He dreamt of **uniting the east and the west** by the natural bonds of marriage, and ruling over it.

Results of Alexander's Invasion

- Alexander's campaign opened up and reinforces a number of trade routes between north-western India, via Afghanistan and Iran to Asia Minor and to the ports along the eastern Mediterranean.
- The date of Alexander's campaign noted clearly in the chronicles left by the historians has helped establish the

chronological order of subsequent events in India. It also opened a new door for Greek art and architecture.

- Thus, Alexander paved the way for the rise of a united empire under the Mauryas.

Summary of Alexander's Invasion

- Alexander marched to India through the **Khyber Pass** in **326 B.C.**
- **Ambi**, the ruler of Taxila, submitted to Alexander.
- He was bravely checked by the local chieftains despite the fact that they had no chance of success.
- He was resisted first strongest by Porus at Jhelum.
- His advance was checked on the bank of the Beas because of the mutiny of his soldiers.
- In 325 B.C., he began his homeward journey.
- In 324 B.C., he reached Susa in Persia and died the next year.
- The Greek invasion of India opened the trade route between north-west India and Western Asia.

Chronology of Foreign Invasions

- 518–486 B.C.: King Darius or Darus invaded India.
- 326 B.C.: Alexander invaded India.
- 190 B.C.: India-Greeks or Bactrians invaded India.
- 90 B.C.: Sakas invaded India.
- A.D. 1st Century: Pahlavas invaded India.
- A.D. 45: Kushanas or Yue-chis invaded India.

Points to Remember

- Increased in prosperity and growth of towns.
- Increased in prosperity was due to foreign trade.
- **One trade route** was from Kosambi → Gangetic plain → Punjab → Taxila to Iran, Central Asia, Europe.
- **Another trade route** was from Rajagriha → Kosambi → Ujjain → Port of Baroach through sea-route to western countries.
- **Another route** from Gangetic plain to northern plains to Burma.
- Towns became centres of trade and industries.
- Indian rulers **minted coins** of different metals.
- Intellectual groups were created in towns which led the formation of several sub-castes.
- Sanskrit became the language of intellectuals and purohits.
- Regional languages were also formed like Prakrit, Pali, Magadhi, etc.

Exercise -1

- Which one of the following Janapadas was republican state in sixth century BC?
(a) Kosala (b) Anga
(c) Mayadha (d) Vajji
- By whom, the first republic of the world was established in Vaishali?
(a) Maurya (b) Nand
(c) Licchavi (d) Gupta
- The list of sixteen Mahajanapadas is available in
(a) Mahabharata
(b) Chhandogya Upanishad
(c) Samyukta Nikaya
(d) Anguttara Nikaya
- In sixth century BC, Suksimati was the capital of
(a) Panchala (b) Kuru
(c) Chedi (d) Avanti
- Name of the Mahajanapada, which was a confederacy of eight republican clans?
(a) Vatsa (b) Magadha
(c) Vajji (d) Malla
- In the Mahayana Buddhism, the Bodhisatva Avalokitesvara was also known as:
(a) Vajrapani (b) Manjusri
(c) Padmapani (d) Maitreya
- The kingdom which was most powerful among the Shodasa Mahajanapadas ?
(a) Anga (b) Magadha
(c) Kosala (d) Vajji
- The capital of Magadha was shifted from Rajgriha to
(a) Patliputra (b) Ujjaini
(c) Varanasi (d) Kannauj
- The dynasties which ruled Magadha were
(a) Haryanka (b) Saisunagas
(c) Nandas (d) All of above
- Where did the 16 Janapadas were mentioned?
(a) Buddhist Scripts (b) Brahmanas
(c) Aranyakas (d) Jaina Scriptures
- Which one of the following statements about ancient Indian Mahajanapadas is correct?
(a) All Mahajanapadas were oligarchies where power was exercised by a group of people
(b) All Mahajanapadas were located in Eastern India
(c) No army was maintained by the Mahajanapadas
(d) Buddhist and Jaina texts list sixteen Mahajanapadas
- What was the period of Chandra Gupta Maurya?
(a) 314-287 BC (b) 310-299 BC
(c) 320-289 BC (d) 324-300 BC
- Chandra Gupta Maurya defeated Nandas with the help of?
(a) Chanakya (b) Aswaghosa
(c) Harisena (d) Jayasimha
- Chandra Gupta Maurya was the follower of?
(a) Buddhism (b) Hinduism
(c) Aynika (d) Jainism

Exercise -2

Statement Based MCQ

- Arrange the following Mahajanapadas moving from west to east in the correct order:
1. Avanti 2. Magadha
3. Matsya 4. Kosala
Codes:
(a) 1 2 3 4 (b) 1 3 4 2
(c) 1 3 2 4 (d) 1 4 3 2
- Arrange the following Magadha dynasties in the chronological order:
1. Nandas 2. Sungas
3. Mauryas 4. Haryanks
Codes:
(a) 2, 1, 4, 3 (b) 3, 2, 1, 4
(c) 1, 3, 4, 2 (d) 4, 1, 3, 2
- Consider the following statements:
1. The list of sixteen Mahajanapadas is available in Anguttara Nikaya.
2. Asmaka Mahajanapada was situated on the bank of Godavari.
Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
- With reference to Mahajanapada as consider the statements:
1. Anga and Magadha were located in the wheat growing area of the Gangetic Valley
2. In agricultural output, rice exceeded wheat leading to a greater density of population in the rice growing area.
Which of the above is / are not correct ?
(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
- Which of the following caused by success of Magadh ?
1. Magadha enjoyed a advantageous geographical position in the iron age as most of the deposits were located there.
2. The rulers of this state had very good weapon.
3. The capitals of Magadha were situated at strategic positions.
4. No other power at that time had the courage to attack it
(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 2
(c) 2 and 4 (d) 1 and 4

Matching Based MCQ

6. **List-I (King)** **List-II (Kingdom)**
- | | |
|---------------|------------|
| A. Pradyota | 1. Magadha |
| B. Udayana | 2. Vatsa |
| C. Prasenjit | 3. Avanti |
| D. Ajatshatru | 4. Kosala |

Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	3	1	4
(b)	3	2	4	1
(c)	4	1	3	2
(d)	1	4	2	3

7. **List-I (Mahajanpada)** **List-II (Capital)**
- | | |
|-----------|---------------|
| A. Matsya | 1. Potana |
| B. Asmaka | 2. Virat |
| C. Anga | 3. Champa |
| D. Chedi | 4. Shuktimati |

Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	2	1	3	4
(c)	4	3	2	1
(d)	3	4	2	1

Hints and Explanations

EXERCISE-1

- (d) Vajji Janapada was republican state in sixth century BC. Its capital was Vaishali. The Vajji republic was ruled by a confederation of eight clans (Atthakula) of whom the Vrijis, the Lichchavis, the Jnatikass and the Videhas were the most important.
- (c) Licchavis established the first republic of the world in Vajji Mahajanapada of ancient India. They were the most famous clan amongst the ruling confederate clans of the Vajji. Vaishali was the capital of the Lichchavis,
- (d) The ancient Buddhist text Anguttara Nikaya gives the list of sixteen Mahajanapadas includes the Gandhara and the Kamboja as the only two salient Mahajanapadas in the Uttarapatha. Another Buddhist text Digha Nikaya mentions only twelve Mahajanapadas.
- (c) Chedi kingdom was one among the many kingdoms ruled during early periods by Paurava kings in the central and western India. Suktimati was the capital of Chedi.
- (c)
- (c) Avalokitesvara is a Bodhisattva who embodies the compassion of all Buddhas. He is one of the more widely revered bodhisattvas in mainstream Mahayana Buddhism. In Sanskrit, Avalokitesvara is also referred to as *Padmapâni* ("Holder of the Lotus") or *Lokeśvara* ("Lord of the World").
- (b) 8.(a) 9. (d) 10. (d)
- (d) According to Anguttara Nikaya (Buddhist text) and Bhagavati sutra (Jain text) there were 16 mahajanapadas in ancient India.
- (d) 13 (a) 14 (d)

EXERCISE-2

- (b) Mahajanapadas west to east are Avanti, Matsya, Kosala and Magadha. There were many states of the

Aryans in North India, around the 6th century BC. These states were called the 'Mahajanapadas'. There were sixteen of such Mahajanapadas: Kasi, Kosala, Anga, Magadha, Vajji, Malla, Chedi, Vatsa, Kuru, Panchala, Machcha, Surasena, Assaka, Avanti, Gandhara and Kamboja. Literally Mahajanapadas means 'Great Kingdoms'.

- (d) In chronological order, Magadha dynasties are Haryanks, Nandas, Mauryas and Sungas. Haryanka dynasty founded the Magadha empire in 600 BC, whose capital was Rajagriha, later Pataliputra, near the present day Patna. This dynasty lasted until 424 BC, when it was overthrown by the Shishunaga dynasty.
- (c) The list of sixteen Mahajanapadas is available in Anguttara Nikaya. Asmaka Mahajanapada was situated on the bank of river Godavari. The Anguttara Nikaya, the fourth division of the Sutta Pitaka, consists of several thousand suttas arranged in eleven books (nipatas) according to numerical content. An excellent modern print translation of the complete Anguttara Nikaya is Bhikkhu Bodhi's The Numerical Discourses of the Buddha:

- (a)
- (a)
- (b) Correctly matched pairs are:

Pradyot — Avanti
Udayana — Vatsa
Prasenjit — Kosala
Ajatshatru — Magadha

- (b) Correctly matched pairs are:

Matsya — Virat
Asmaka — Potana
Anga — Champa
Chedi — Suktimati

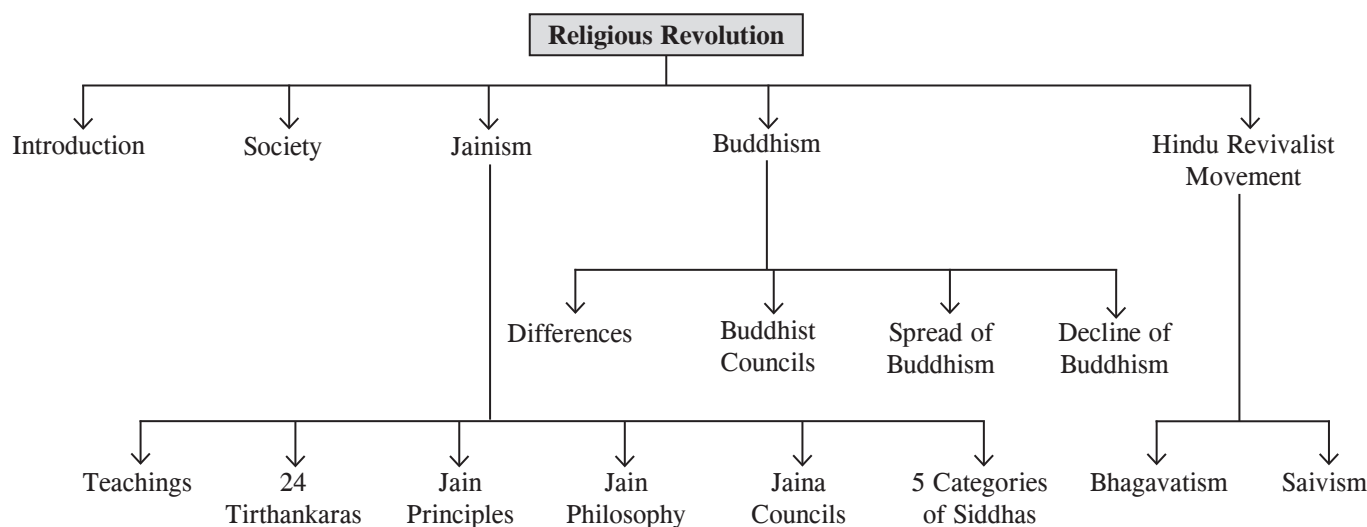


RELIGIOUS REVOLUTION

6 Chapter

Introduction

A number of religious sects came into existence in the middle Gangetic basin in the sixth century B.C. There were around 62 religious sects at that period. Out of these, Jainism and Buddhism were the most important, and they emerged as the most potent religious reform movements.



SOCIETY

The society was clearly divided into four Varnas: brahmins, kshatriyas, vaisyas and shudras, in the Vedic period. Each Varna was allowed well-defined jobs, although it was emphasized that Varna was based on birth and two higher varnas were given some privileges.

Clearly the Varna seems to have created tension in the society. The Kshatriyas, who acted as rulers, reacted against the domination of priestly class called brahmins, who enjoyed various privileges, was one of the causes of the origin of new religions. Vrdhamana Mahavira, who founded Jainism and Gautama Buddha, who founded Buddhism, belonged to the Kshatriya clan, and both disputed the authority of the Brahmins. The trade of money-lending was established in the Vedic age. The practice of interest on loans was also legal but the

trade was generally looked down upon by the brahmins. The vaisyas who practiced this trade wanted to raise their social position in the eyes of religion.

The vaisyas gave their support to both Mahavira and Gautama Buddha. The merchants, called the setthis, offered precious gifts to Gautama Buddha and his disciples.

The Vedic practice of killing cattles in sacrificial rituals was inimical to the emerging agricultural economy. Besides, the Sanskrit language was the language of a chosen few while the common masses spoke Prakrit. The elaborate Vedic rituals were heavily felt even by the rich. The interior position of women also facilitated the growth of new religions which had actually started off the reform of the Hinduism.

JAINISM

Vardhmana Mahavira is associated with Jainism. The Jains believe that Mahavira was the last of the 24 tirthankaras, or great teachers. The first was *Rishabhadev*. Their teachings constitute the core of the religion of Jainism.

Mahavira was born at *Kundagrama (near Vaishali)*, in Bihar. His father was the head of the Jnatraka clan and his mother was a Lichchavi princess.

At the age of 30, Mahavira left his home. For the next 12 years, he wandered from place to place in search of knowledge. Then one day, while meditating, he realized the truth. Through this knowledge, he conquered both misery and happiness. He came to be known as Jina the great conqueror. His followers came to be known as Jains.

Mahavira travelled from place to place preaching his message. He visited the court of Bimbisara and Ajatashatru.

Jainism in the Past

- The name of Jaina Tirthankra Rishabha is found in the Rig Veda.
- The Vishnu Purana and the Bhagavat Purana describe Rishaba as an incarnation of Narayana.
- The male nude torso discovered from the Indus Valley culture has something to do with the tirthankaras.
- There were twenty-four tirthankaras, all Kshatriyas and belonging to the royal family. Parsavnath was the 23rd tirthankara.

Teachings

Jainism was based on five doctrines: (i) *Ahinsa, non-violence*, (ii) *do not speak a lie*, (iii) *do not steal*, (iv) *do not acquire property* and (v) *observe continence (Brahmacharya)*. It is said that only the fifth doctrine was added by Mahavir, the other four being taken over by him from previous teachers.

Jainism recognized the existence of the Gods but regarded them lower than the jina. It did not condemn the Varna system. According to Mahavira, a person is born in a high or in a lower Varna in consequence of the sins or the virtues acquired by him in the previous birth. In his opinion, through pure and meritorious life, members of the lower castes can attain liberation. Full knowledge, action and liberation are considered to be the three gems or ratnas of Jainism.

24 Tirthankaras

Name	Symbol
1. Rishabha	Bull
2. Ajitnath	Elephant
3. Sambhavanath	Horse
4. Abhinandam Swamy	Monkey
5. Sumathinath	Curlew
6. Padamprabhu	Red Lotus
7. Suparaswanath	Swastik
8. Chandrajit Prabhu	Moon

9. Suivdhinath	Crocodile
10. Shitalnath	Srivatsa
11. Shreyansnath	Rhinoceros
12. Vasupujya	Buffalo
13. Vimalnath	Bear
14. Ananthnath	Falcon
15. Dharamnath	Vajra
16. Shantinath	Deer
17. Kuntunath	He-Goat
18. Aranath	Fish
19. Mallinath	Water Pot
20. Munisuvrata	Tortoise
21. Naminath	Blue Lotus
22. Neminath	Conch Shell
23. Parswanath	Serpent
24. Mahavir	Lion

According to Jainism, the tirthankaras descended on earth from time to time to guide the masses.

The Principles of Jainism as Preached by Mahavira

Rejected the authority of the Vedas and the Vedic rituals.

- **Svetambaras and Digambaras** : Although Parsva, a predecessor of Mahavira, had asked his followers to cover the upper and lower portions of their body. Mahavira asked them to discard clothes completely. On account of this, in later times Jainism was divided into two sect: svetambaras or those who put on white dress, and digambaras or those who keep themselves naked.
- **Sacred Literature** : According to svetambaras, the original doctrine taught by Mahavira was contained in 14 old texts called "*Purvas*", which was passed orally and was compiled later.
- The sacred literature of the Svetambaras is written in a form of *Prakrit* called Arghamagadhi and may be classified as follows:
 - (i) The twelve Angas (ii) The twelve Upangas
 - (iii) The ten Prakirnakas (iv) The six Chhedasutras
 - (v) The four Mulasutras
 This literature is not accepted by Digambaras.

Jaina Philosophy

- **Syadvada** : All our judgements are necessarily relative, conditional and limited. According to Syadvada (the theory of may be) seven modes of predication (saptabhangi) are possible. Absolute affirmation and absolute negation both are wrong. All judgements are conditional.
- **Anekantavada** : The Jaina metaphysics is a realistic and relativistic pluralism. It is called Anekantavada or the doctrine of the 'manyness of reality'. *Matter (Pudgala)* and *Spirit (Jiva)* are regarded as separate and independent realities.

Important Terms

Ajnanevada: Ajnanevada refers to the Jain doctrine agnosticism or scepticism. In the Jain text, there is mention of 67 kinds of Ajnanevada.

Anuvratas: Anuvratas refer to first five vows in Jainism. These are more moderate version of Mahavrate. These vows include abstinence from gross violence, gross falsehood, gross stealing, contentment with one's own wife and limitation of one's possessions.

Avasarpini: In Jainism time is divided into infinite equal time cycles or 'Kalchakras'. Every time cycle is further divided into two equal halves. The first half is the progressive cycle or ascending order, called 'Utsarpini' whereas the second half is the regressive cycle or descending order, called 'Avasarpini'.

Samavasarana: The term samavasarana refers to a place where all have a common opportunity of acquiring the wisdom. The theme of Samavasarana has been popular in Jain art.

Samayasara: Samayasara is a famous Jain text written by Acharya Kundakunda. In this text, Acharya describes about 'Ratnatraya' which includes Samyak Darshan, Samyak Gyan, Samyak Charitra.

Samachari: It refers to a part of Kalpsutra. Which deals with Jain monks.

Jaina Councils

By the end of fourth century B.C., there was a serious famine in the Ganges valley leading to a great exodus of many Jain monks to the Deccan and South India (Sravana Belgola) along with Bhadrabahu and Chandragupta Maurya. They returned to the Gangetic valley after 12 years. The leader of the group, which stayed back at Magadha, was Sthulabahu. The changes that took place in the code of conduct of the followers of Sthulabahu led to the division of the Jainas into Digambaras (sky-clad or naked) and Svetambaras (white-clad).

- **First Council** was held at *Pataliputra* by Sthulabahu in the beginning of the third century BC and resulted in the compilation of 12 Angas to replace the lost 14 Purvas.
- **Second Council** was held at *Valabhi* in the 5th century AD under the leadership of Devaradhi Kshamasramana and resulted in final compilation of 12 Angas and 12 Upangas.

Ratnatraya (Three Gems of Jainism)

Right faith (Samyak Vishwas) referring to Lord Mahavira right knowledge (Samyak Gyan) knowledge of doctrines of Jainism Right conduct (Samyak Karma) fulfilment of 5 rows of Jainism.

Five Categories of Siddhas

- *Tirthankara*, who has attained salvation.
- *Arhat*, who is about to attain Nirvana.
- *Acharya*, the head of the ascetic group.
- *Upadhyaya*, teacher or saint, and
- *Sadhu*, an ordinary ascetic

Spread of Jainism : In order to propagate the teachings of Jainism, Mahavira organized an order of his followers which admitted both men and women. Since Jainism did not very

clearly mark itself out from the Brahmanical religion, it failed to attract the masses. Despite this, Jainism gradually spread into south and west India. According to a late tradition, the spread of Jainism in Karnataka is attributed to Chandragupta Maurya (322– 298 B.C.). The emperor became a Jain, gave up his throne and spent the last years of his life in Karnataka as a Jain monk. But this tradition is not conditioned by any other sources.

Jainism spread to Kalinga in Orissa in the fourth century B.C. It enjoyed the patronage of the Kalinga king Kharavela who had defeated the princes of Andhra and Magadha. In the second and first centuries B.C. it also seems to have reached the southern districts of Tamil Nadu. In later centuries, Jainism penetrated Malwa, Gujarat and Rajasthan, and even now these areas have good number of Jainas, mainly engaged in trade and commerce. In the south, royal dynasties like the Gangas, Kadambas, Chalukyas and Rashtrakutas supported Jainism. In Gujarat, patronage came from wealthy merchants. The concrete expression of Jainism's religious favour is seen all over the country in the works of art and architecture. The 57-foot high statue of *Gomateshvara at Sravana Belgola in Mysore*, erected in 983 or 984 A.D. is a marvel of its kind. The temples at Mount Abu and those at Palithana in Gujarat and Moodabidri and Karkala in the south make a rich contribution to the Indian heritage.

Decline : Several factors attributed to the declining popularity of Jainism. In India, it had to compete with both Hinduism and Buddhism. Absence of popular religious preachers after the death of Mahavira, its division into two important sects, absence of protection by later rulers and the revival of Hinduism all contributed to the decline of this religion. Besides, it also was unable to spread to any considerable extent beyond the limits of India and never reached the popularity of Buddhism. The followers of Jainism also abstracted from an active policy of conversion. It, thus, practically escaped unnoticed during the Brahmanical revival. Yet, it continues to retain its hold on a small body of follower's upto the present day.

Impact of Jainism : Jainism made the first serious attempt to reduce the evils of the Varna order and the ritualistic Vedic religion. The early Jain Sanskrit language mainly patronized by the Brahmanas. They adopted Prakrit language of the common people to preach their doctrines. Jainism contributed much to lexicography, poetry, mathematics, astronomy, astrology and political thought. The Jainas composed the earliest important works in *Apabhramsa* (common language of the masses) and its first grammar. The Jain literature contains epics, Puranas, novels and drama. A large portion of the Jain writing is still in the form of manuscripts, which have not been published and which are found in the Jain shrines of Gujarat and Rajasthan. Last but not the least; they contributed to the growth of regional languages such as Tamil, Telugu, Gujarati, Hindi, Marathi, Rajasthani and Kannada, in which they wrote extensively.

Jain architecture is remarkable. The *Hathi gumpas* of Kharavela and Khandagiri and Udaigiri caves of Orissa contain early Jain reliefs. In the Gupta period, big statues of Bahubali (called Gomateshwara) at Sravana Belgola and Karkala in Karnataka were erected. Also Jain temples of Ranakpur (near Jodhpur) and *Dilwara* temples in Mount Abu are examples of excellent architecture.

BUDDHISM

Buddhism is named after Gautam Buddha. His real name was Siddhartha. He was born at Lumbini. His father was the chief of the Shakya clan. Siddhartha had a comfortable life as a prince, yet, he was not happy.

Siddhartha left home to seek knowledge and the true meaning of life. For six years, he wandered from place to place. He learnt to meditate. He sat beneath a pipal tree in Gaya and began to meditate. After many days of intense meditation, he discovered enlightenment. He understood why the world is full of suffering and what should be done to overcome it. He thus, became the 'Buddha', the enlightened or the Awakened or the Wise one. The pipal tree, under which he attained enlightenment, came to be known as the tree of wisdom or 'Bodhi Vriksha'.

From Gaya, the Buddha went to Sarnath. He gave his first sermon at the Deer Park in Sarnath. It is known as the *Dharmachakra Pravartana* (setting in motion the wheel of dharma). The Buddha spend the rest of his life travelling from one place to another, meeting people and preaching his message of love and peace. He taught in a language which the common people could understand.

The Concept of Nirvana

The concept of 'Nirvana' was originally explained by Lord Buddha. The word 'Nirvana' literally means to 'blow out' and refers to extinguishing of fires of greed, hatred and delusion.

The term 'Nirvana' has been explained as extinction of three fires- namely, passion or 'raga', aversion or 'dwesha' and ignorance 'moha'. According to Buddhist philosophy, when these fires are extinguished, one gets freedom from the cycle of birth and death and thus 'Nirvana' is attained by the individual.

Jatakas: The stories of different births of Buddha are called Jatakas. It is a collection of over 500 poems briefly outlining folk tales and stories, attributed to Buddhaghosa.

Differences in Buddhism

Like Jainism, Buddhism also faced ideological differences. It was divided into three sects:

Hinayana

- (i) The followers of Hinyana believed in the original teachings of Buddha.
- (ii) They sought individual salvation through self-disciplined meditation.
- (iii) They did not believe in idol-worship (iv) Hinayana, like Jainism, is a religion without God, **Karma** taking the place of God.
- (v) Nirvana is regarded as the annihilation of all.
- (vi) The oldest school of Hinayana Buddhism is the Sthaviravada (Theravada in Pali) or the 'doctrine of the Elders'.
- (vii) Gradually, Sarvastivada or Vaibhasika branch of another school called Sautantrika, which was more critical in outlook.

Mahayana

- (i) The followers of Mahayana believed in the heavenliness of Budha and sought the salvation of all through the grace and help of Buddha and Bodhisattavas.
- (ii) Believes in idol-worship.
- (iii) Believes that Nirvana is not a negative cessation of misery but a positive state of bliss.
- (iv) Mahanaya had two chief philosophical schools: the Madhyamika and the Yogachara.

Vajrayana

- (i) The followers of vajrayana believed that salvation could be best attained by achieving the magical power, which they called Vajra.
- (ii) The chief divinities of this new sect were the Taras.
- (iii) It became popular in Eastern India, particularly Bengal and Bihar. It was a form of Buddhism, which appeared in eastern India in the 8th century and was finally established in Tibet in 11th century, as a result of mission sent from the great Vajranaya monastery of Vikramshila.

Buddhist Councils

According to Pali literature four councils were held to draw up the canonical texts and the creed in their pure form.

The First Council was held at *Rajgir* immediately after the Parinirvana of the Buddha. It was presided over by Molakassapa. At this council, Vinaya Pitaka and Sutra Pitaka were compiled.

The Second Council was held at *Vaishali* in 383 B.C. In it Vinaya Pitaka was revised and the daily activities of the monks were settled.

The Third Council was held in *Patliputra* in 250 B.C. during the reign of Ashoka. Moggliputta Tissa presided over it. At this council Abhidhamma Pitaka were collected.

The Fourth Council was held under *Kanishka*. The place of assembly was Kashmir. The president of this council was Vasumitra where Ashvaghosha acted as vice president of this council. The proceedings of this council were confirmed to the composition of commentaries.

Spread of Buddhism

The spread of Buddhism was due to the missionarie's activities of Emperor Ashoka. He sent missionaries to many place in central Asia to popularize Buddhism. During the reign of king Kanishka also many Indian missionaries went to Central Asia. They introduced Mahayan's Buddhism in this region. According to Mahayana, Buddha was considered a form of God on earth and his images were worshipped. The worship of Bodhi Satvas, Buddhist Saints, also became popular from Central Asia and China. Buddhism spread to Korea and Japan. The *Silk Route* also helped greatly in the spread of Buddhism to Central Asia and China. Pligrims and missionaries from India travelled to China and Central Asia through this route.

The famous Buddhist monk, Kumaraja went to China and stayed there for some time to spread Buddhism. Buddhist pilgrims from China also come to India by this Silk Route. Other countries such as Java, Sumatra, Vietnam, Thailand and Cambodia were also influenced by Buddhism. Today, Buddhism is practised in Central and South-east Asia.

Decline of Buddhism

Buddhism became extinct in India by the end of 12 century. Gradually, the Buddhist monks were cut off from the mainstream of life; they gave up Pali, the language of the people, and took to Sanskrit, the language of intellectuals. The Hinduism was internally reformed and stressing upon love and devotion, promised non-violence against cattle and raise in women's position in the society. From the first century A.D. they practised idol worship on a large scale and received numerous offerings from devotees. Some of the monasteries such as Nalanda collected revenue from as many as 200 villages. By the seventh century A.D., the Buddhist monasteries had come to be dominated by ease-loving people and became centres of corrupt practices which Gautama Buddha had strictly prohibited. The new form of Buddhism was known as Vajrayana. Entry of women into Buddhist-Sanghas and the

attacks of Huna king in the 6th century A.D. and the Turkish invaders in the 12th century A.D. brought rapid extinction of Buddhism.

Despite its extinction as an organized religion, Buddhism left its mark on the history of India. The objective of the Buddhist teachings was to secure the salvation of the individual or Nirvana. Buddhism made an important impact on society by keeping its doors open to women and sudras. Their conversions to Buddhism freed them from such mark of inferiority.

Buddhism strengthens the cattle of the country. The earliest Buddhist text *Sutra pitaka* declares the cattle to be giver of *food, beauty and happiness (annada, vannada and sukhada)*, and thus defended for their protection. Buddhism created and developed a new awareness in the field of intellect and culture. Buddhism left its mark on the art of ancient India. *The first human statues worshipped in India were probably those of the Buddha*. The faithful devotees described the various events in the life of the Buddha in stone.

For the residence of the monks, rooms were hewn carved out of the rocks, and thus, began the cave architecture in the Barabar hills in Gaya and in western India around Nasik. Under the impetus of Roman trade, Buddhist art flourished in the Krishna delta, and under that of Central Asian contacts, it thrived in Mathura and Gandhara.

HINDU REVIVALIST MOVEMENT

In face of attacks from Jainism and Buddhism, the Hindu religion sought to revive its lost glory.

(a) Bhagavatism or Vaishnavism

This sect was propagated by *Vasudeva*. The faith in the Puranas, the Ramayana, the Mahabharata, the Bhagwat Gita, theory of incarnations of God, attainment of Salvation or Nirvana by bhakti, idol-worship, chanting of prayers, etc. were popularized by him.

Teachings: In Bhagavatism, *Vishnu*, is considered as the supreme God. He is the creator of the universe, reigns in Vaikunthas and rests in the primeval ocean on the thousand-headed snake, 'Sesanaaga.' The colour of his skin is dark blue and he has four arms. His wife is Lakshmi who is the Goddess of wealth and prosperity. He rides the great eagle, Garuda.

Brahma who creates the world is born in the lotus-flower which grows from the navel of Vishnu in his sleep. The same way, all other Gods have been created and are dependent on Vishnu. Therefore, Vishnu is the Param-Brahma, the Paramatma, Narayana or Hari and therefore, worship and bhakti of Vishnu is the most essential religious duty of an individual.

Literature: *Bhagwad Gita* was the most popular religious book of Bhagavatism which is generally believed to be a work of the first or second century B.C.

The Gita delivers the most harmonious blend of three paths of salvation or Nirvana, viz. though *Gyana* (knowledge), *Karma* (action) and *Bhakti* (devotion) and declares, "All roads to Moksha (salvation) lead but unto me." Gyana is

the realization by an individual that every soul is a part of the Paramatma (Universal Soul), every person has a soul, soul never dies, nobody can touch or kill a soul, soul has neither friends, enemies nor relations and soul neither feels pleasure nor pain. If an individual does not realize this, then he or she is ignorant and cannot attain salvation. According to the Gita, *Agyana* (ignorance) is more a spiritual blindness than an intellectual weakness which can be removed by Karma-yoga. But the Gyana marg which directs an individual to the meditation of the absolute is a difficult process. Therefore, the Gita suggests Karma-marg as an easier alternative. An individual should be Karma-Yoging to attain Nirvana.

Spread of Bhagvatism: The religious ideas and practices which grew up during this time had matured by the age of the Guptas and found their permanent place in Hinduism. Of course, religious scholars and preachers like *Kumaril Bhatt* who preached *Dualism* and *Shankaracharya* who preached *Monism* tried to revive the Karma (action) and Gyana (knowledge) marg respectively to attain Nirvana but their efforts brought little results.

(b) Saivism

The other popular sect of Hinduisim is *Saivism*. The origin of *Siva* can be traced to the concept of Rudra in the Rigveda. Probably, he found his place among Aryan Gods because of the influence of the Dravidians, who had a similar God among them called *Pasupati*. In the Yajurveda, he is referred to as *Sambhu* or *Shankar*. In the Athravaveda, he is regarded as the Supreme God while in the Svetasvatara

Upanishad, his spouse Uma or Parvati, is provided a similar position. Thus, Siva rose into prominence with the passage of time. However, the rise of Saivism, with a philosophy and organization of its own, cannot be traced back earlier than about the beginning of the Christian era. The sect, probably, was started by a person called *Lakulin or Nakulin* near about the beginning of the 2nd century A.D. Afterwards, Saivism was divided into four important schools, viz. Pasupata, Saiva, Kapalika and Kalamukha. However, Shiva is worshipped most in the form of the *Linga (Phallus)* because of the influence of another sect of Saivism called Lingyat. Saivism is now a part of Hinduism and the worship of Siva is most popular among the Hindus.

Points to Remember

- Jainism and Buddhism emerged as the most prominent religious reforms movements.
 - Jainism is based on five doctrines.
 - (i) Ahimsa (ii) Do not speak a lie (iii) Do not steal (iv) Do not acquire property and (v) Observe continence.
 - Jain philosophy includes-
 - ‘Syadvada’: All our judgement is necessarily relative, conditional and limited.
 - ‘Anekantavada’: Matter (Pudgala) and spirit (Jiva) are regarded as separate and independent realities.
 - Buddhism is named after Gautam Buddha. Whose real name was Siddhartha.
- Buddhism has three sects Hinayana Mahayana and Vajrayana.
 - Emperor Ashok played an important role in spread of Buddhism. He sent missionaries to many places in central Asia.
 - Hindu revivalist movement played an important role in reducing popularity of Jainism and Buddhism.
 - Bhagvatism or vaishnavism sect was propagated by Vasuadeva. “Vishnu” is considered surname God is Bhagvatism and Bhagwat Gita is considered most popular book.
 - Saivism considers siva as its supreme God. This sect was started by Lakalir or Nakulir in 2nd century AD.
 - Jainism and Buddhism emerged as the most prominent religious reform movements.
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Exercise -1

1. The Bodhisatva Doctrine is associated with
 - (a) Mahayana Buddhism
 - (b) Hinayana Buddhism
 - (c) Vajrayana Buddhism
 - (d) Theravada Buddhism View
2. Ashoka carved out rock-cut caves at Barabar and Nagarjun hills in Bihar for one of the following:
 - (a) Hinayana (b) Digambara
 - (c) Mahayana (d) Ajivika
3. Who was the founder of Ajeevika sect?
 - (a) Makkali Gosala (b) Mahavira
 - (c) Vasudeva Krishna (d) Suddhodana
4. Who among the following was King of Magadha, at the time of Mahaparinirvana of Gautam Buddha?
 - (a) Bimbisara (b) Udayi
 - (c) Ajatshatru (d) Chandragupta Maurya
5. The main difference between Jainas and Hindus in treating the ascetics is:
 - (a) To Hindus ascetic were escapists be listed to
 - (b) Jains respect them while Hindus worship them
 - (c) Hindus treat ascetics as Godmen whereas Jains don't
 - (d) An acsetic is outside the society to Hindus, while Jaina ascetic kept a relationship with the society.
6. The merchants were attracted to a sect like Buddhism because:
 - (a) Brahmanical rituals were becoming expensive for them.
 - (b) They found it suitable for their vocation.
 - (c) They felt that the new materialistic conditions were corrupting society.
 - (d) They were not granted a social status that was in resonance with economic prosperity.
7. Which of the features given below was not an aspect of Buddhism?
 - (a) Divine intervention was necessary in the process of obtaining salvation.
 - (b) It challenged the superiority of the Brahmanas.
 - (c) It denied the predominance assigned to vedic texts
 - (d) It was practical and simple
8. Which one of the following characteristics of Buddhism distinguishes it from Jainism?
 - (a) Belief in efficacy of action
 - (b) Non acceptance of the authority of the Vedas
 - (c) Attitude of non-injury towards all beings
 - (d) Rejection of both extreme pleasure and self-mortification
9. What were the 'Four Great Signs' that according to Buddhist tradition led Gautama to renounce the world?
 - (a) Love, compassion, non-injury, purity
 - (b) Old age, diseased person, dead body, an ascetic
 - (c) That the world is full of suffering, desire and carve for existence, renunciation of desire, cycle of births and re-birth
 - (d) None of the above.
10. The points of similarity between Buddhism and Hinduism is
 - (a) The missionary spirit
 - (b) The pantheon of Gods in Hinduism
 - (c) Acceptance of the laws of Karma and the Hindu theories of re-birth
 - (d) None of the above.
11. The mercantile community was most attracted to Jainism because:
 - (a) It could follow the religion without any hindrance to its economic activities
 - (b) The Vedic rituals and sacrifices were hindrances to its vocation
 - (c) The peace and non-violence of Jainism was conducive to the development of trade and commerce
 - (d) The doctrine of Kama of Jainism greatly impressed the merchants and traders
12. On the basis of which of the following traditional records have the dates of Lord Buddha's birth and death been fixed?
 - (a) Chinese tradition—Cantonese records
 - (b) Simhalese tradion—Mahavamsa and Dipavamsa
 - (c) Indian Buddhist texts—Ashokavadan and Divyavadan
 - (d) Tibetan tradition of historian Taranath
13. What was the nature of difference between Bhadrabahu and his followers, which led to the split of Jainism into two sects, namely Digambaras and Svetambaras?
 - (a) Interpretation of certain philosophical canons
 - (b) Compilation of the teachings of Mahavira
 - (c) Whether or not the monks should wear clothes
 - (d) Idol worship
14. From the point of view of places of Buddhist pilgrimage/interest, which of the following is the latest archaeological discovery?
 - (a) Discovery of the Buddha's tooth relic at Bharhut in M.P.
 - (b) Discovery of a Pillar indicating the actual birth place of the Buddha, at Lumbini
 - (c) Discovery and identification of Kapilavastu with Piprahawa, a village in Basti district of Uttar Pradesh
 - (d) Sanghol—a Kushana Buddhist site
15. The Doctrine of Karma in Buddhism means:
 - (a) predestination
 - (b) the justification for social and economic inequalities in life
 - (c) the deeds of a person determine the state of his life
 - (d) doing one's duty without bothering about the result
16. The Buddha did not talk of spiritual aspects such as God, soul, life after death, etc. because:
 - (a) He was only concerned with the ethical aspects of life
 - (b) He wanted to resolve the practical problems of life
 - (c) He considered such speculations unnecessary
 - (d) He did not intend to establish a formal religion

17. What was the occasion of the Second Buddhist Council?
 - (a) To prepare a complete and authentic collection of the teachings of Lord Buddha
 - (b) To settle the controversy arising from the adoption of certain practices by the Vajjian monks of Vaishali
 - (c) to establish the purity of the canon which had been imperiled by the rise of different sects
 - (d) To put an end to the dissensions in the Church (Sangha)
18. Which of the following works, included in Vaipulyasutras (nine canonical books of Mahayanists), is a typical Mahayana work containing all the characteristic features of that school?
 - (a) Saddharmapundarika
 - (b) Lalitavistara
 - (c) Lankavatara
 - (d) Suvarnaprabhasa
19. The admission of which of the following to the Sangha, at the instance of Ananda (the personal attendant of the Master), marked the beginning of an order of nuns in India?
 - (a) Yashodhara, the wife of the Buddha
 - (b) Gautami, the widowed stepmother of the Buddha
 - (c) Sujata, the merchant's daughter who offered a bowl of milk to the Buddha after he had decided to give up austerities
 - (d) Ghositaramma monastery at Piprahwa
20. Which of the following writers was the founder of Buddhist logic and has been called the Father of Medieval Nyaya?
 - (a) Dharmakirti
 - (b) Dignaga
 - (c) Budhhapalita
 - (d) Bhavaviveka
21. Nagarjuna is known as the Einstein of India because:
 - (a) Like Einstein he had a rare insight into the nature of the universe
 - (b) He was one of the greatest physicists of all time
 - (c) He propounded the theory of shunyavada similar to Einstein's theory of relativity
 - (d) He was a great dialectician
22. Which of the following was not one of the reasons for the popularity of Buddhism in China?
 - (a) There were no rival religions at the time of introduction of Buddhism in China
 - (b) The writing of such people as Mou-tseu created confidence in the minds of the educated Chinese
 - (c) The life of purity followed by the immigrant Indian Buddhists and their Chinese Disciples attracted the Chinese to Buddhism
 - (d) The patronage of the reigning dynasties in China (e.g. Wei dynasty) helped the cause of Buddhism
23. The so-called universities of Nalanda, Vikramshila, etc. were actually:
 - (a) Buddhist monasteries
 - (b) Apex bodies of Buddhist monasteries
 - (c) Learning centres of Buddhist monks
 - (d) Secular centres of education and learning
24. Zen Buddhism, introduced in the twelfth century A.D., found its adherents mainly among the warriors and influenced Japanese culture considerably. The key to enlightenment, according to Zen Buddhism, is:
 - (a) Recollection
 - (b) Virtuous life
 - (c) Meditation
 - (d) Piety
25. What is the greatest debt owed by the Buddhist world to Sri Lanka?
 - (a) The preservation of Buddha's relics and sacred Bodhi tree
 - (b) The reservation of the Pali canon in its entirety
 - (c) The development of Buddhism through Sinhalese commentaries of Buddhist texts
 - (d) The propagation of Buddhism in South-East Asian countries
26. The Buddhist Law of Doctrine of Karma meant:
 - (a) A man reaps what he sows
 - (b) Every individual is the maker of his own destiny
 - (c) Prayers to a God or Gods alone cannot change the destiny of man
 - (d) All of the above
27. Which of the following Buddhist Philosopher is said to have visited Nepal in the fourth century A.D. in order to propagate his own doctrine?
 - (a) Acharya Atisha
 - (b) Acharya Kamalashila
 - (c) Acharya Shatarakshita
 - (d) Acharya Vasubandhu
28. Which of the following statements correctly describe the difference between a Chaitya and a Stupa?
 - (a) Chaitya is a religious term, while Stupa is an architectural term for a mound containing a relic of the Buddha and later on of leading Buddhist Saints
 - (b) Chaitya is a place of prayers/worship while Stupa is a funeral monument
 - (c) Chaitya were constructed by the monasteries while Stupas were constructed by the kings and the rich merchants
 - (d) Chaityas represent Mahayanism and Stupas Hinayanism
29. What was the purpose of the Chaityas during the early phase of Buddhism?
 - (a) They served the purpose of temples
 - (b) They were meditation halls
 - (c) They were used for religious assemblies and prayers
 - (d) They were used for holding social functions
30. Which of the following was not one of the points of religious difference between Buddhism and Jainism?
 - (a) Compared to Jainism, Buddhism was moderate in its stress on the doctrine of ahimsa
 - (b) Whereas Jainism believed in rigorous asceticism, Buddhism considered rigid penance to be useless
 - (c) Unlike Buddhism, Jainism did not altogether dispense with the worship of the old deities or the services of the Brahmins
 - (d) While Buddhism acknowledges a permanent entity or an immortal soul, Jainism does not
31. Some hold the view that Buddhism was merely a phase of Hinduism. Which of the following was not one of the concepts and practices borrowed by Buddhism from Hinduism/Brahmanism?
 - (a) The idea of monastic order
 - (b) The emphasis on purity of body and right conduct
 - (c) The concept of Nirvana
 - (d) Belief in Samsara and Karma

32. Which of the following places can be regarded as the largest monastic establishment in Western India (containing 130 caves)?
 (a) Karle (b) Ajanta
 (c) Junnair (d) Kanheri
33. Which of the following was not a similarity between Buddhism and Jainism?
 (a) Both were agnostic and rejected the Vedic thoughts
 (b) Both had equal faith in Ahinsa
 (c) Both accepted followers without any casts distinction
 (d) Both believed in the Law of Doctrine of Karma
34. The most important event on the death centenary (parinivvana) of the Buddha was the:
 (a) Despatch of the Buddhist mission to Sri Lanka
 (b) Calling of the second Buddhist Council
 (c) Compilation of the teachings of the Buddha
 (d) Division of Buddhism into Mahayana and Hinayana sects
35. Which of the following was not one of the reasons for the rapid spread of Jainism amongst the trading community?
 (a) The trading community could observe the vow of non-injury without any difficulty
 (b) The strict limitation of private property was interpreted to mean landed property and not the wealth earned from trade and commerce
 (c) The Jain temples received generous donations from rich merchants
 (d) The encouragement of frugality in Jainism coincided with a similar sentiment in commercial activity
36. Which of the following was not one of the reasons for the gradual decline of Jainism?
 (a) The assimilative power of Hinduism
 (b) The destruction of their temples by the foreign invaders and others
 (c) The extremism of its ethical code and religious discipline
 (d) The influence and popularity of Shaiva and Vaishnava saints in the South
37. Where did the Mahasamghika school arise ?
 (a) Bodhagaya (b) Rajagriha
 (c) Sravasti (d) Vaishali
38. The earliest epigraphic evidence mentioning the birth place of Sakyamuni Buddha is obtained from
 (a) Sarnath (b) Sravasti
 (c) Kausambi (d) Rummindei
39. Which one among the following Tirthankaras was according to the Svetambar tradition, a lady?
 (a) Sumatinatha (b) Shantinatha
 (c) Mallinatha (d) Arishtanemi
40. The Jain Tirthankara Mahavira has been mentioned in the early Buddhist literature as
 (a) Nigantha Nataputta (b) Vardhamana
 (c) Vesaliya (d) Videhaputta
41. Who amongst the following is known as the Light of Asia?
 (a) Jesus Christ
 (b) Lord Buddha
 (c) Prophet Mohammad
 (d) Zarathustra
42. Which one of the following is not included in the eight-fold path of Buddhism?
 (a) Right speech (b) Right contemplation
 (c) Right desire (d) Right conduct
43. Which one of the following is not a part of early Jain literature?
 (a) Therigatha (b) Acarangasutra
 (c) Suttrakritanga (d) Brihatkalpasutra
44. The concept of Anuvrata was advocated by
 (a) Mahayana Buddhism
 (b) Himayana Buddhism
 (c) Jainism
 (d) The Lokayata School
45. Who of the following was a contemporary of Gautama Buddha?
 (a) Bhadrabahu (b) Kalashok
 (c) Parsvanath (d) Vardhaman Mahavir
46. Svetambara Agama was finally edited at the Jain council of
 (a) Vaishali (b) Vallabhi
 (c) Pawa (d) Vidarbha
47. Anekantavada is a core theory and philosophy of which one of the following?
 (a) Buddhism (b) Jainism
 (c) Sikhism (d) Vaishnavism
48. Milinda Panho is in the form of a dialogue between the king Menander and Buddhist Monk
 (a) Nagasena (b) Nagarjuna
 (c) Nagabhata (d) Kumarilbhatta
49. Who is believed by the Jainas to be the first Tirthankar?
 (a) Rishabhadeva (b) Mahavira
 (c) Neminath (d) Parshvanath
50. Who was the founder of Mahayan sect of Buddhism?
 (a) Buddhadeva (b) Ghoshak
 (c) Dharmtrata (d) Asanga
51. Who founded the Lingayat Movement?
 (a) Basava (b) Lakulisha
 (c) Matsyendranath (d) Kulshekhar
52. Syadvad is a doctrine of
 (a) Buddhism (b) Jainism
 (c) Shaivism (d) Vaishnavism
53. Who became the chief of Jain Sangh after the death of Mahavira?
 (a) Indrabhuti (b) Jambu
 (c) Sthulbhadra (d) Sudharma
54. Mother of Gautam Buddha belonged to which dynasty?
 (a) Shakya dynasty (b) Maya dynasty
 (c) Lichchavi dynasty (d) Koliyan dynasty
55. Buddha is depicted on the coins of
 (a) Wima Kadphises (b) Kanishka
 (c) Nahapana (d) Budhgupta
56. Some Buddhist rock-cut caves are called Chaityas, while the others are called Viharas. What is the difference between the two?
 (a) Vihara is a place of worship, while Chaitya is the dwelling place of the monks
 (b) Chaitya is a place of worship, while Vihara is the dwelling place of the monks

- (c) Chaitya is the stupa at the far end of the cave, while Vihara is the hall axial to it
 (d) There is no material difference between the two
57. Which one of the following describes best the concept of Nirvana in Buddhism?
 (a) The extinction of the flame of desire
 (b) The complete annihilation of self
 (c) A state of bliss and rest
 (d) A mental stage beyond all comprehension.
58. The Buddha delivered his first sermon, known as 'Turning of the wheel of law' at
 (a) Sanchi (b) Sarnath
 (c) Sravasti (d) Bodh Gaya
59. In Buddhism, what does Patimokkha stand for?
 (a) A description of Mahayana Buddhism
 (b) A description of Hinayana Buddhism
 (c) The rules of the Sangha
 (d) The questions of king Menander
60. The Jainas believe that Jainism is the outcome of the teachings of 24 tirthankaras. In the light of this statement, which one among the following is correct of Vardhamana Mahavira?
 (a) He was the first tirthankara and the founder of Jainism
 (b) He was the 23rd tirthankara, the first 22 tirthankaras being considered legendary
 (c) He was the last and 24th tirthankara, who was not considered as the founder of the new faith but as a reformer of the existing religious sect
 (d) He was not one of the 24 tirthankaras
61. The Fourth Buddhist Council was held in Kashmir under the leadership of
 (a) Bindusara (b) Ashoka
 (c) Kunal (d) Kanishka
62. Gautam Buddha delivered his first sermon at which one of the following places?
 (a) Kushinagar (b) Sarnath
 (c) Bodh Gaya (d) Lumbini
63. Where did Buddha attain Parinirvana ?
 (a) Bodh Gaya (b) Kushinagara
 (c) Rajgriha (d) Vaisali
64. Where did Gautam Buddha give his first sermon?
 (a) Gaya (b) Rajgriha
 (c) Sarnath (d) Sanchi
65. Who of the following is a contemporary of Gautama Buddha?
 (a) Ashvaghosa (b) Nagarjuna
 (c) Parsvanath (d) Vardhamana Mahavira
66. Who among the following was a contemporary of Gautam Buddha?
 (a) Nagarjuna (b) Kanishka
 (c) Kautila (d) Mahavir

Exercise -2

Statement Based MCQ

- Consider the statements :
 - Vinaya texts deal with the monastic discipline.
 - The Visuddhimagga is a part of colonial text.
 - Mahayana texts deal with prajna or wisdom.
 - Sutras in transmigration advocate the doctrine of twelve links of pratiya - samutpada.
 Which of the above is / are correct ?
 - 1, 3 and 4
 - 1 and 2
 - 1 and 3
 - 1, 2 and 4
- With reference to the ancient India, which of the following was / were common to both Buddhism and Jainism?
 - Avoidance to extremities of penance and enjoyment
 - Indifference to the authority of the Vedas
 - Denial of efficacy of rituals
 Select the correct answers :
 - 1 only
 - 2 and 3
 - Both 1 and 2
 - 1, 2 and 3
- Which of the following were common to both Buddhism and Jainism?
 - Avoidance of extremities of penance and enjoyment.
 - Indifference to the authority of the vedas.
 - Denial of efficiency of rituals
 - Non - injury to animal life.
 Which of the above is / are correct ?
 - 1, 2, 3 and 4
 - 2, 3 and 4
 - 1, 3 and 4
 - 1 and 2
- With reference to Jainism which one of the following statements is correct?
 - Jainism enjoyed the patronage of the kalinga king Kharavela in the 1st century BC.
 - In the initial stage of Jainism, the Jainas worshipped images unlike Buddhist.
 - 1 only
 - 2 only
 - Both 1 and 2
 - Neither 1 nor 2
- The importance of Nagarjunakonda stupa is because of its beautiful panels which illustrate episodes from the life of the Buddha. Which of the following is not the characteristic of the scenes depicted?
 - Gods praying to the Boddhisathva to take birth on earth.
 - Buddha's entry into the womb in the form of a white elephant.
 - Birth of the Buddha under a flowering teak tree etc.
 - Unique representation of the forest animals in a manner which looks as if the entire animal world turned out to worship the Buddha
 Which of the above is/are correct?
 - 1 and 3
 - 2 and 4
 - 4 only
 - None
- What were the impacts of Buddhism in Indian culture?
 - The religious indifference between women and shudras were removed by Buddhism.
 - Sanskrit developed as a literary language.
 - In Sanchi, Bharhut, Bodhgaya, Amravati art and paintings were flourished.
 - It popularized idol worship.
 - Concept of residential universities became popular.
 Which of the above is/are correct?
 - 1 and 4
 - 2 and 3
 - All of above
 - None
- Why did Buddhism start declining in India in the early medieval times?
 - Buddha was by that time considered as one of the incarnations of Vishnu and this became a part of Vaishnavism.
 - The invading tribes from Central Asia till the time of last Gupta king adopted Hinduism and persecuted Buddhists.
 - The kings of Gupta dynasty were strongly opposed to Buddhism.
 Which of the above is/are correct?
 - 1 only
 - 1 and 3
 - 2 and 3
 - 1, 2 and 3
- Which of the following kings of ancient India were patrons of Jainism?
 - Srenika Bimbisara
 - Chandragupta Maurya
 - Kharavela**Codes:**
 - 1, 2 and 3
 - 1 and 2
 - 2 and 3
 - 1 and 3
- Which one of the following hills is/are sacred to the Jainas?
 - Satrunjauyagiri
 - Urjayantogiri
 - Arbudagiri
 - Chandragiri**Codes:**
 - 1 and 3
 - 1, 2, 3, and 4
 - 1 only
 - 2 and 4
- Which two of the four kings listed below were on friendly term equally with Vardhamana Mahavir and Gautama Buddha?
 - Bibisara of Magadha
 - Ajatasatru of Magadha
 - Prasenjit of Kosala
 - Pradyota of Avanti
 - 1 and 3
 - 3 and 4
 - 1 and 4
 - 2 and 3
- Which of the following is/are true regarding Buddhism?
 - It did not reject Varna and Jati.
 - It challenged the highest social ranking of Brahmanas.
 - It regarded certain jobs as low.
 Choose the correct code.
 - 1 and 2
 - 3 and 2
 - 1, 2 and 3
 - None of these

12. Which of the following are characteristic ascribed to Buddhism? Choose the correct answer given below:
1. Theory of Prakrit and Purusha
 2. Rejection of the authority of the Vedas
 3. Emphasis on the role of the individual
 4. Beliefs in the categories of Jiva and Ajiva
- (a) 3 and 4 (b) 1 and 2
(c) 1, 3 and 4 (d) 1 and 3
13. Which of the following are true of Jainism?
1. It has affinity with the Sankhya system of philosophy.
 2. It completely rejected the concept of the soul.
 3. It has affinity with the Vedanta system of philosophy.
 4. According to it the world consists of two eternal categories, viz., conscious Jiva and unconscious (Ajiva).
- Choose the correct answer from the codes given below.
- (a) 2 and 3 (b) 1 and 3
(c) 3 and 4 (d) 2 and 4
14. Which of the following statements is/are applicable to Jain doctrine?
1. The surest way of annihilating Karma is to practice penance.
 2. Every object, even the smallest particle has a soul.
 3. Karma is the bane of the soul and must be ended.
- Select the correct answer using the codes given below.
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3
15. Which of the following Kingdoms were associated with the life of the Buddha?
1. Avanti
 2. Gandhara
 3. Kosala
 4. Magadha
- Select the correct answer using the code given below.
- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2 and 4.
(c) 3 and 4 only (d) 1, 3 and 4
16. With reference to Buddhist history, tradition and culture in India, consider the following pairs :
- | <i>Famous shrine</i> | <i>Location</i> |
|--------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 1. Tabo monastery and temple complex | : Spiti Valley |
| 2. Lhotsava Lhakhang temple, Nako | : Zaskar Valley |
| 3. Alchi temple complex | : Ladakh |
- Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3
17. Consider the following Bhakti Saints:
1. Dadu Dayal
 2. Guru Nanak
 3. Tyagaraja
- Who among the above was/were preaching when the Lodi dynasty fell and Babur took over?
- (a) 1 and 3 (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 (d) 1 and 2
18. Consider the following statements regarding Greek's influence of Indian Culture.
1. The Indo-Greek king, mahendra was converted to Buddhism by Buddhist monk and philosopher, nagasena.
 2. Indian astrology was influenced by Greek ideas with the term Horastra used for astrology in Sanskrit.
 3. Greeks introduced into Indian astronomy the methods of calculating eclipses, the notion of methods of calculating eclipses, the notion of parallax and methods of calculating it.
 4. Greeks introduced the use of curtain in Indian theatre.
- Which of the above is/are correct ?
- (a) 1, 3 and 4 (b) 2, 3 and 4
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) All of above
19. Consider the following statements
1. The Buddhists in Deccan excavated rock-cut Chaityas and the Vaishnavas, Shaivas and Jainas imitated these in later centuries.
 2. The Vaishnavas, Shaivas and Jainas excavated temples at sites far distant from rock-cut Chaityas.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
20. Consider the following statements
1. The Jains believed that Mahavira had twenty-three predecessors.
 2. Parshvanatha was twenty-third Tirthankara.
 3. Rishava was immediate successor of Mahavira.
- Which of the statements given above is/are correct?
- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) Only 2 (d) Only 3
- Directions (Q. 21): The following questions consist of two statements, Statement I and Statement II. You are to examine these two statements carefully and select the answers to these questions using the codes given below Codes
- (a) Both the statements are true and Statement II is the correct explanation of Statement I
(b) Both the statements are true, but Statement II is not the correct explanation of Statement I
(c) Statement I is true, but Statement II is false
(d) Statement I is false, but Statement II is true
21. **Statement I:** Mahavira initially joined a group of ascetics called Nirgranthas.
Statement II: The sect was founded 200 years earlier by Parsva.
22. Which of the following was/were not related to Buddha's life?
1. Kanthaka
 2. Alara Kalama
 3. Channa
 4. Goshala Maskariputra
- Select the correct answer using the codes given below
- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 4
(c) 1 and 2 (d) 3 and 4
23. The national motto of India, 'Satyameva Jayate' inscribed below the Emblem of India is taken from
- (a) Katha Upanishad
(b) Chandogya Upanishad
(c) Aitareya Upanishad
(d) Mundaka Upanishad

Matching Based MCQ

24. **List I** **List II**
 A. Second Sangam 1. Abhidhamma Pitak
 B. Third Sangam 2. Tolkappiyam
 C. First Buddhist council 3. Tripitika
 D. Third Buddhist council 4. Silakhadikaram
 (a) A - 2; B - 3; C - 1; D - 4
 (b) A - 2; B - 4; C - 3; D - 1
 (c) A - 4; B - 2; C - 3; D - 1
 (d) A - 4; B - 2; C - 1; D - 3
25. **List-I** **List-II**
(Characters) **(Related objects)**
 A. Vishnu 1. Katyotsarga Posture
 B. Gautama Buddha 2. Flask and rosary
 C. Jina 3. Dharmachakra
 D. Bodhisattva 4. Garudadhvaja
 Maiteya
Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	2	4	1
(b)	3	2	1	4
(c)	2	3	4	1
(d)	2	3	1	4
26. **List-I** **List-II**
(Vedangas) **(Their subject)**
 A. Nirukta 1. Metres
 B. Shiksha 2. Etymology
 C. Kalpa 3. Astrology
 D. Chhadas 4. Phonetic
 5. Ritual
Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	4	5	1	3
(b)	4	1	2	3
(c)	3	5	1	4
(d)	3	1	2	4
27. **List-I** **List-II**
 A. Rahul 1. Buddhas's father
 B. Alara Kalam 2. Buddha's cousin
 C. Suddhodhana 3. Buddha's son
 D. Devdatta 4. The sage who taught meditation to Buddha
 E. Siddhartha 5. Buddha's original name

	A	B	C	D	E
(a)	1	4	5	3	2
(b)	3	4	1	2	5
(c)	4	3	5	2	1
(d)	2	1	5	4	3
28. **List-I** **List-II**
 A. Birth 1. Stupa
 B. First Sermon 2. Lotus and bull
 C. Nirvana 3. Dharmachakra
 D. Parinirvana 4. Bodhi tree
Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	2	3	4	1
(c)	4	1	2	3
(d)	1	2	4	3

29. **List-I** **List-II**
 A. Ajit Kesh Kamblin 1. Fatalism
 B. Sanjay Vethalipulta 2. Atomist
 C. Pakudh Kachayan 3. Materialism
 D. Puran Kashyap 4. Materialism-Syncicism
Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	4	1	2
(b)	1	2	3	4
(c)	2	1	3	4
(d)	1	2	3	4
30. **List-I** **List-II**
(Tirthankara) **(Birth place)**
 A. Rishabhanatha 1. Kashi
 B. Sambhavanatha 2. Kausambi
 C. Padmanabha 3. Saravasti
 D. Parashvanath 4. Ayodhya
Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	2	3	4	1
(c)	3	4	1	2
(d)	4	3	2	1
31. **List-I** **List-II**
(Jain Tirthankara) **(Birth place)**
 A. Ajitnath 1. Kashi
 B. Vimalnath 2. Hastinapur
 C. Shantinath 3. Kampilya
 D. Parshavanath 4. Ayodhya
Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	3	4
(b)	2	3	4	1
(c)	3	4	1	2
(d)	4	3	2	1
32. **List-I** **List-II**
(Jain Tirthankars) **(Cognizance)**
 A. Santi Natha 1. Antelope
 B. Malli Natha 2. Lion
 C. Parswa Natha 3. Serpent
 D. Mahavira 4. Water jar
Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	2	4	3
(b)	4	1	3	2
(c)	2	3	1	4
(d)	1	4	3	2
33. Match the five major Mauryan provinces with their capitals:
 A. Uttarapatha I. Ujjain
 (Northern Province)
 B. Avantiratha II. Suvarnagiri
 (Western Province)
 C. Dakshinapatha III. Tosali
 (Southern Province)
 D. Prachya IV. Pataliputra
 (Eastern Province)
 E. Central Province V. Taxila

	A	B	C	D	E
(a)	V	I	II	III	IV
(b)	I	II	I	III	V
(c)	II	III	I	IV	V
(d)	III	II	I	IV	V

Hints and Explanations

EXERCISE-1

1. (d) 2.(d) 3. (a) 4. (c) 5. (d)
6. (d) 7.(a) 8. (d) 9. (b) 10. (c)
11. (c) 12. (a)
13. (c) There was a further split around the sixth century A.D. on the point of idol worship.
14. (d) 15. (c) 16. (d) 17. (b) 18. (a)
19. (b)
20. (b) All the four authors were logicians. The latter two at responses (c) and (d) founded two schools of logical thinking, namely, Prasangika and Svatantra school, respectively.
21. (c) Nagarjuna was the founder of Madhyamika school which teaches that the whole world is a mere illusion (Shunvavada).
22. (a) Indigenous religions like Confucianism and Taoism were there. Buddhism was, however, a much richer religion than Confucianism and it possessed a much more profound philosophy than Taoism.
23. (a) 24. (c) 25. (d) 26. (d) 27. (d)
28. (a) 29. (c)
30. (d) The fact is just the reverse of it.
31. (a) 32. (c) 33. (b) 34. (b) 35. (c)
36. (c) It was not the cause of its decline, but the cause of its limited following/appeal.
37. (d) Mahasanghika is the name of an early Buddhist school in India, during the Second Buddhist council held at Vaishali. The Mahasanghika school represents the first major schism ever recorded in Buddhism.
38. (d) Rummindei Pillar Inscription says that The Beloved of the Gods, the king Piyadassi, when he had been consecrated twenty years, came in person find referenced the place where Buddha Sakyamuni was born. He caused a stone enclosure to be made and a stone pillar to be erected. As the Lord was born here in the village of Lumbini, he has exempted it from tax, and fixed its contribution [i.e. of grain] at one-eighth.
39. (c) Svetambaras maintain that the 19th Tirthankara, Mallinath, was a woman. They also believe that women are able to obtain Moksha.
40. (a) In the Buddhist Pali Canon, Mahavira is referred as Nigantha Nataputta. Nigantha Nataputta refers to. A Nirgrantha refers to Jains. A person who has attained Kevalya can be a Nirgrantha.
41. (b) Gautam Buddha, who was prince Siddhartha of Kapilavastu in India/Asia before his enlightenment, is called "The Light of Asia".
42. (c) The eightfold Path in Buddhism, an early formulation of the path to enlightenment. The idea of the Eight fold Path appears from the first sermon of the Buddha, which delivered after his enlightenment. Right desire is not included in the Eight fold path of Buddhism.
43. (a) Therigatha is not a part of early Jains literature. The Therigatha is a Buddhist scripture, a collection of short poems supposedly recited by early members of the Buddhist Sangha in India around 600 BC.
44. (c) In Jainism, Ahinsa is the standard by which all actions are judged. For a householder observing the small vows (anuvrata), the practice of ahinsa requires that he not kill any animal life.
45. (d)
46. (b) Vallabhi has been a famous Jain centre. It was here in 453 or 466 AD, the Vallabhi council of the Jains produced in writing the religious canon under the head of the shraman Devardhigani. Svetambara Agama was finally edited at the Jain council of Vallabhi.
47. (b) Anekantavada is one of the most important and fundamental doctrines of Jainism. It refers to the notion that truth and reality are perceived differently from diverse points of view, and that no single point of view is the complete truth.
48. (a) Milinda Panha is in the form of a dialogue between the Greek King Milinda (Minander I) and the Buddhist monk Nagasena.
49. (a)
50. (d) Asanga was born as the son of a Kshatriya father and Brahmin mother in Purusapura. Current scholars place him in the fourth century CE. He was perhaps originally a member of the Mahisasaka school or the Mulasarvastivada school but later converted to Mahayana.
51. (a) The Lingayat Community was founded by Basava in the 12th century AD. The Lingayats are Virashaivites. The philosophy of the Lingayatas was influenced by the teachings of both Shankaracharya and Ramanuja. This sect was characterised by an anti-Brahmanical spirit.
52. (b) Syadvad is a doctrine of Jainism. Syadvad is the philosophy of seeing an individual or an object from various points of view; trying to understand them and acquiring the right knowledge of those things.
53. (d) After the death of Mahavira, one of his disciple Sudharma Swami is said to have took over the leadership. He was the head of Jain community till 515 BCE.
54. (d) Maya was the mother of the Buddha and was from the Koliyan clan. Maya was born in Devadaha in ancient Nepal. She was married to King Suddhodana, who ruled in the kingdom of Kapilavastu.
55. (b) Kanishka's coins portray images of Indian, Greek, Iranian and even Sumero-Elamite divinities, demonstrating the religious syncretism in his beliefs. The Buddhist coins of Kanishka are comparatively rare. Several coins show Kanishka on the obverse and the Buddha standing on the reverse, in Hellenistic style.

56. (b) Chaityas refer to the halls enclosing the stupas. Chaityas were probably constructed to hold large numbers of devotees for prayer. Viharas on the other hand are constructions built in ancient India in order to provide resting places for the wandering Buddhist monks.
57. (c) The concept of Nirvana was originally explained by Lord Buddha (566-486 BC). The word 'Nirvana' comes from the root meaning 'to blow out' and refers to the extinguishing of the fires of greed, hatred, and delusion. When these emotional and psychological defilements are destroyed by wisdom, the mind becomes free, radiant, and joyful and he who has realized the Truth (Nirvana) is the happiest being in the world. He is free from all complexes and obsessions. He does not repent the past nor does he brood over the future. He lives fully in present. He appreciates and enjoys things in life in the purest sense without self projections. He is free from the thirst of becoming and the illusion of self. Buddhism explain Nirvana as a state of bliss or peace.
58. (b) Buddha delivered his first sermon at Sarnath. Sarnath is a city located in the north-east of Varanasi near the confluence of the Ganges and the Gomati rivers in Uttar Pradesh,
59. (c) Patimokkha stands for the rules of the Sangha. Buddha Dhamma and Sangha are the three Jewels of Buddhism.
60. (c) Mahavira was a teacher of the religion of Jainism. He lived in India. His followers believed that he was the 24th in a line of great teachers. These teachers were called tirthankaras.
61. (d) The Fourth Buddhist Council was held at Kundalvana, Kashmir in 72 AD under the patronage of Kushan king Kanishka and the president of this council was Vasumitra, with Ashvaghosa as his deputy. This council distinctly divided the Buddhism into 2 sects- Mahayan & Hinayan.
62. (b) After enlightened, Buddha journeyed to the Sarnath where he preached his first sermon to his five disciples.
63. (b) Buddha attained Parinirvana at Kushinagar in Uttar Pradesh.
64. (c)
65. (d) The twenty-fourth and last Tirthankara was Vardhamana Mahavira born in 540 BC. In 468 BC, he died at the age of 72. Gautam born about 566 BC and died at the age of 80 (about 487 BC).
66. (d) Both Gautam Buddha and Vardhaman Mahavir were contemporary to each other and founded their respective religions better known as Buddhism and Jainism in India.

EXERCISE-2

1. (a) The Vishuddhimagga is a part of non - colonial test.
2. (b)
3. (b) In Buddhism avoidance of extremities of Penance and enjoyment stressed on which Jainism stresses on penance and extremism.
4. (a) Jainism enjoyed the patronage of Kalinga king Kharavela. Jainas never worshiped images.
5. (c) 6. (c)
7. (a) Buddha was by that time considered as one of the incarnations of Vishnu and became part of Vaishnavism.
8. (c) 9. (a) 10. (c) 11. (a) 12. (a)
13. (d)
14. (d) The surest way of annihilating Karma is to practice penance. Karma is the bane of the soul and must be ended.
"Swadhyay Paramam Tap" According to Jain doctrines Penance washes away all the blemishes and purges the soul of all karmic matter.
Also, according to Jainism, Karma is the bane of the soul. Karma not only encompasses the causality of transmigration but it is also conceived as an extremely subtle matter which infiltrates the soul, obscuring its natural, transparent, pure qualities. Karma is thought of as a kind of pollution that taints the soul with various colors. Based on its karma, a soul undergoes transmigration and reincarnation in various states of existence like heavens or hells or as humans or animals.
15. (c) Buddha born in Lumbini, in Kosala kingdom. Buddha died in Kusinara, in Magadha kingdom. Avanti lay outside the area visited by Buddha, and was converted to his teaching by his disciple Mahakaccana. Gandhara is western part of Pakistan & Afghanistan and Buddha never went to Pakistan.
16. (c) Tabo monastery and temple complex is in Spiti Valley and Alchi temple complex is in Ladakh. Lhotsava Lhakhang, Nako is in Himachal Pradesh. Zaskar Valley is in Jammu and Kashmir.
17. (b) Guru Nanak Dev was born in 1469. Babur defeated Ibrahim Lodi in 1526. When Babur took over and established the Mughal dynasty, Nanak was travelling to different parts of India and preaching Sikhism. Babur once met Guru Nanak during one of his travel.
18. (d)
19. (a) A Chaitya is a Buddhist shrine including a stupa.
20. (a) Rishabh- 1st Tirthankara out of 24. Parshvanatha- 23rd tirthankara. Mahavira 24th tirthankara
21. (b) Mahavira was not the founder and author of Jain religion but simply a reformer. This sect of the Nigranthas was an important sect at the rise of Buddhism. This may be inferred from the fact

that they are frequently mentioned in the pitakas as opponents of Buddha and his disciples. This conclusion is further supported by another fact. Mankkhali Gosala, a contemporary of Buddha and Mahavira divided mankind into six classes, of these the third class contained the Nigranthas. Hence, statement II is not the correct explanation of statement I.

22. (b) Goshala Maskariputra was the founder of Ajivika Sect. He was the contemporary of Mahavir.
 23. (d) The words Satyameva Jayate came from Mundaka Upanishad, meaning 'Truth Alone Triumphs'.
 24. (b) 25. (c) 26. (a) 27. (b)
 28. (b) Symbol of 5 great events of Buddha's life

Event	Symbol
Buddha's birth	Lotus & bull
The great departure (Mahabhinishkramana)	Horse
Enlightment (Nirvana)	Bodhi tree
First sermon (Dhammachakraparivartan)	Wheel
Death (Parinirvana)	Stupa

29. (a) Early Buddhist texts speak of six foremost opponents of Lord Buddha who were:
 1. Ajit Kesh Kamblin—Believed in Materialism
 2. Maskari Gosal—Founder of Ajivaka sect
 3. Puran Kasyap—Atomist
 4. Pakudh Katayam—Believed in Fatalism
 5. Sanjay Vethaliputta—Believed in materialism synicism
 6. Niggantha Nathputta—He was Bhagvan Mahavir

30. (d) **List of 24 Tirthankars and their birth places**

Name	Birth place
1. Rishabha (Adinath)	Ayodhya
2. Ajitnath	Ayodhya
3. Sambhavanath	Sravasti
4. Abhinandannath	Ayodhya
5. Sumatinath	Ayodhya
6. Padmabrabha	Kausambhi
7. Suparshvanath	Kasi (Banaras)
8. Chandraprabha	Chandrapuri
9. Pushpadanta (Suvidhinatha)	Kakandi
10. Shiatnath	Bhadrikapuri
11. Shreyansanath	Simhapuri
12. Vasupujya	Champapuri
13. Vimalnath	Kampilya
14. Anantnath	Ayodhya
15. Dharmanath	Ratnapuri
16. Shantinath	Hastinapura
17. Kunthunath	Hastinapura
18. Aranath	Hastinapura
19. Malinath	Mithilapuri
20. Munisuvrata	Kusagranagara (Rajgrih)
21. Naminatha	Mithilapuri (Mathura)
22. Neminatha	Sauripura (Dwarka)
23. Parsvanatha	Kasi (Banaras)
24. Mahavira (Vardhamana)	Kundapura

31. (d) 32. (d) 33. (a)



THE MAURYAN EMPIRE

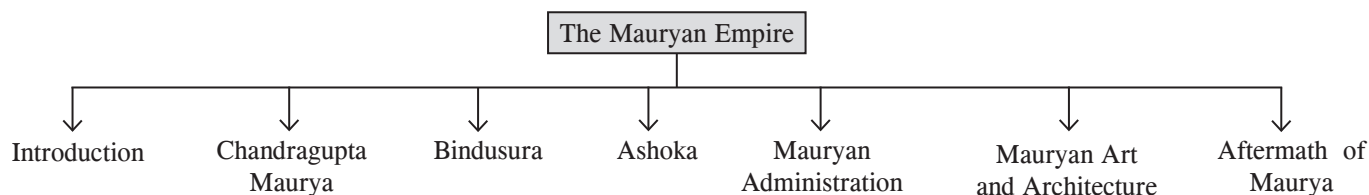
Chapter

Introduction

There are two important sources of Mauryan history. One is the '**Arthashastra**', written by Kautilya also known as Chanakya, the Prime Minister of Chandragupta Maurya, which describes how a good government should be organized. The other source is '**Indica**' written in Greek by Megasthenes, the ambassador of Seleucus Nicator at the court of Chandragupta. Megasthenes wrote not only about the capital city of Pataliputra but also about the Maurya Empire as a whole and about the society. The history of Ashoka's reign can be framed on the basis of his edicts.

Other source is the '**Mudrarakshasa**' written by Vishakhadatta in 5th century A.D. gives an interesting account of how Chandragupta with the help of Kautilya and a Paurava prince defeated the Nandas. Jain and Buddhist traditions also throw light on the history of the Mauryas. Jain scriptures refer to Chandragupta's death and the Buddhist work, '**Mahavamsa**', relates an account of the life and work of the king Ashoka. '**Malvikagnimitram**' written by Kalidasa throws enough light on the last years of the Mauryan rule and the ascendance of Pushyamitra Sunga.

Apart from the above sources, inscription of *Junagarh* and other inscriptions of Ashoka on rocks and pillars help us much in building the story of this age. The monuments belonging to the Mauryan period speak of the culture and civilization of this period. The stupas, viharas, and caves tell us about the development of art and architecture of this period. Let's see a glimpse of mauryan empire in the chart.



CHANDRAGUPTA MAURYA (322-297 B.C.)

Chandragupta Maurya was the founder of Mauryan dynasty. He took advantage of the growing weakness and unpopularity of the Nandas in the last days of their rule. With the help of Chanakya, he defeated the Nandas and established the rule of the Maurya dynasty.

Chandragupta erected a big empire which was not limited in Bihar but also extended to western and north-western India, and the Deccan. The Mauryas ruled over the whole of the subcontinent. In the north-west they penetrated over certain areas which were not included even in the British rule.

Chandragupta was a just king. He himself attended the court and gave justice. He appointed all the high officials of the states such as, the 'Sachivas' or 'Amatyas' 'Mantrins' or the High Ministers, the 'Purohita' or the High Priest, Spies,

'Adhayakshas', Who maintained correspondence with the Mantri parishad.

The administration of Patliputra was carried by six committees entrusted with sanitation care of foreigners, registration of birth and death, regulation of weights and measures and similar other functions. Chandragupta's government was divided into two parts, the **Central** and the **Provincial Governments**. The empire was divided into a number of provinces which were subdivided into districts. But the exact number of provinces are not known.

According to the Jaina literature, in his last days **Chandragupta converted into Jainism** and giving up his throne in favour of his son Bindusara and became a monk.

BINDUSARA (297–273 B.C.)

Chandragupta was succeeded by his son Bindusara. He defeated the rulers of 16 kingdoms and added their lands to his empire. Under him, the Mauryan Empire spread across the whole of Indian subcontinent. Except for Kalinga (Orissa) and a few kingdoms in the south.

ASHOKA (273–232 B.C.)

Ashoka was the most famous Mauryan king and one of the greatest rulers. The British historian *H.G Wells* had this to say about Ashoka—Amidst the tens of thousands names of monarchs that crowd the columns of history... the name of Ashoka shines and shines almost alone, like a star.

Ashoka governed his kingdom well. His numerous rock and pillar edict, spread over a large part of India, give a lot of information about this great ruler.

Kalinga War (261 B.C.): When Ashoka became the king, Kalinga was the only kingdom which was not under Mauryan control. Kalinga was important as it controlled the land and sea routes to south India and south-east Asia. Ashoka attacked Kalinga and conquered it after a fierce battle.

The war with Kalinga was a turning point in the life of Ashoka. The death, destruction and suffering that he saw in the war made him very sad. He realized the futility of fighting a war and vowed not to fight any more wars. He devoted the rest of his life to serve his people.

Like his predecessors, Ashoka assumed the title of **Priyadarshi** (pleasing to look at) and **Devanampriya** (beloved of Gods). In the Sarnath inscription, he adopted the third title, i.e. **Dharmshoka**.

Ashoka's Rock Edicts

- Major rock edicts (a set of 14 inscriptions) found at following 8 places: Dhauli, Givnav, Jauguda, Kalsi, Mansehra, Shahbazgarhi, Sopara and Yenagrdi.
- Minor rock edicts found at 13 places: Bairat, Brahmagiri, Gavimath, Gajarra, Jatinga-Rameshwar, Maski, Palkigunda, Meadagiri, Rupanath, Sasaram, Siddhapur, Suvarnagiri and Verragudi.

Contents of Rock Edicts

- 1st **Major Rock Edict-** Prohibition of animal sacrifice.
- 2nd **Major Rock Edict-** Related to measures of social welfare.
- 3rd **Major Rock Edict-** Respecting one's parents.
- 4th **Major Rock Edict-** Impact of Dhamma, Non-violence towards animals.
- 5th **Major Rock Edict-** Appointment of Dhamma Mahamantras to spread Dhamma.
- 6th **Major Rock Edict-** Welfare measures of efficient administration.
- 7th **Major Rock Edict-** Peace, balance of mind and faith, tolerance.
- 8th **Major Rock Edict-** Details of Bodhi tree, Dhammasutras.
- 9th **Major Rock Edict-** Ceremony of Dhamma.
- 10th **Major Rock Edict-** Ashoka's desire to Popularise Dhamma.
- 11th **Major Rock Edict-** Appraisal of Dhamma, Religious tolerance.
- 12th **Major Rock Edict-** Promoting religion of different faith.
- 13th **Major Rock Edict-** Kalinga's destruction, mention of Greek rulers.
- 14th **Major Rock Edict-** Nature of all other rock edicts.

Ashoka's Dhamma

Dhamma is the Prakrit word form of the Sanskrit term 'Dharma' which means religious duty. Ashoka gave up the policy of conquest through war (dig-vijaya) and began to follow a policy of conquest through dharma (dharma-vijaya). Ashoka's Dhamma was related to norms of social behaviour and activities. Its norms are mentioned in Ashoka's edicts. Due to this policy, his name shines with unique brilliance.

Ashoka's Contemporaries

Anitochus II Theos	–	Syria
Ptolemy II Philadelphus	–	Egypt
Magas	–	Cyme
Antigonos Gonatas	–	Macedonia
Alexander	–	Epirus

Post Ashoka period

According to Buddhist texts, Ashoka ruled for twenty-seven years. The subsequent history of the Mauryas under his successors is very inadequately known. This is because a state of disintegration seemed to have set in immediately after Ashoka's death. The post-Ashokan period is a dark chapter in Indian history and no first-rate source-material is available on the period. Pillar Edict VII mentions Tivara as a son of Ashoka. Three other sons—Junala, Jaluka and Mahendra are known to literature. It appears on the evidence of the Vayu Purana that Junala ruled for eight years, but the extent of his dominions is not indicated therein. Moreover, Jain and Buddhist writers tell us that Samprati, the son of Junal, who was incapable of ruling because of blindness, immediately succeeded Ashoka to the throne of Patliputra.

The tenth and the last of the Mauryas was **Brihadratha** who, according to the testimony of **Banabhatta**, was murdered by his general **Pushyamitra** and who ascended the throne in 187 B.C. The empire founded by him is known as **Sunga Dynasty**. With Brihadratha's death (185 B.C.) this historic rule of the Mauryas came to an end within less than half a century of Ashoka's death and 137 years since its foundation by Chandragupta Maurya.

Decline of Mauryan Empire

- (i) Harprasad Shastri holds that Brahmanical reaction was responsible for the downfall of the Mauryan empire.
- (ii) D.D. Koshambi says that heavy economic pressure was the chief cause for the downfall of the Mauryan empire.
- (iii) Ghosal says that propagation of Buddhism during Ashoka's period disturbed brahmanical social and religious order, which weakened the state.
- (iv) Romila Thapar says that nature of organisation or administration and the faulty conception of state ultimately caused the downfall of the empire.

MAURYAN ADMINISTRATION

The Mauryan administration can be divided into four divisions—central, provincial, district and village. The administration of the city of Pataliputra was separate.

Central

The king was the supreme authority. He took all important decisions concerning the empire. He was assisted by a council of ministers. They acted as the king's advisors.

Provincial

The empire was divided into many provinces each headed by a prince. He ruled the province as the representative of the king and was assisted by many officers.

District

Provinces were further divided into districts. The '**Pradishikas**' was the head of the district. He was assisted by the '**Yuktas**' and the '**Rajukas**'. He measured the land, collected tax and maintained law and order.

Village

A number of villages made up a district. Villagers assisted government official in making the village boundaries, maintaining land records and collecting taxes. Each village had a headman who was chosen by the villagers themselves.

Mauryan Mantriparishad

Mantrin	- Chief Minister
Purohita	- High Priest
Senapati	- Commander-in-charge
Yuvaraj	- Crowned Prince
Samaharta	- Collector of Revenue
Yukta	- Subordinate Officer-in-charge of Revenue of the king
Prashasti	- Head of Prisons
Sannidata	- Head of Treasury
Nayaka	- Head of City Security
Paur	- City Police
Byabharika	- Chief Judge
Karmantika	- Head of Industries and Factories
Dandapala	- Head of Police
Durgapala	- Head of Royal Fort
Annapala	- Head of the Food Grains Department
Rajjukas	- Officers responsible for land measurement and fixing its boundary.
Pradesika	- Head of District Administration

Judicial Administration

Justice was provided by the king, Pradeshika and Rajukas; at lowest level was the village headman. There were two types of courts:

- The **civil courts** redressing cases of marriage, contracts etc. were called '**Dharmasthas**',
- Kantakasodhana**: the criminal courts which tried criminal cases and tax evasion.

Army

Mauryas owned a big army. According to Plinny, Chandragupta maintained 6,00,000 foot soldiers, 30, 000 cavalry and 900 elephants. According to Meghasthenese, the army was administered by six committees consisting of five members each, taken from a board of 30 officers.

Espionage

It was important part of the Maurya administration; and was of two types—**Santha** and **Sanchar**, the former worked by remaining stationed at a public place and the latter by moving from place to place. The spies were the ears and eyes of the king. They were also called '**Cudhapurshas**'.

Revenue Administration

There were various sources of state revenues: cities (durga), rural areas (rashtra), mines (khan), road and traffic (vanikpatha), pastures (Vraja), Plantations (setu) and forests (vana).

Import Duties

Prabeshya or import duties were fixed at 20 per cent of the cost price. *Panyadhyaksha* and *Pattanadhyaksha* was respectively responsible to verify every import to the state. They were also responsible for the export of each article from the state and collected the revenue known as nishkramya.

Sales Tax: Taxes were imposed on every article before it was sold or purchased by Sulkadhyaksha. 9.5 per cent on items sold on the basis of calculation, 5 per cent on the items sold on the basis of measurement, and 6.5 per cent on the goods sold on the basis of weight.

Besides these, there were many other taxes collected by the state such as taxes on artisans and artist, taxes on animal slaughter-houses, taxes on manufacturing houses, taxes on gambling houses, on prostitutes, on the income of temples and on the additional incomes of the wage earners.

Social, Religious and Economic, Conditions Under The Mauryas

Kautilya's Arthashastra and Megasthenes' Indica give a detailed view about the society and social condition of the people. Varna or the caste-system and stages of religious discipline took a definite shape, which corresponds to Hindu caste-system. Slavery was an established institution. **Women** were placed in high esteem. Yet, **prostitution** was in established institution. Festivals and merry gatherings were common. The people led simple and peaceful life and were inspired by the sense of morality and idealism.

The Jainism and Buddhism were the main religions. In addition, several minor religions including Ajivikas were also in existence. The Mauryan rulers took much pain to spread education and to set up literary standard of their subjects as well. The universities of Taxila and Banaras earned world fame for teaching Brahmanical and Buddhist literature.

Economic Conditions under the Mauryas

It was mainly based on agriculture as cultivators formed a majority of population, though trade was also important.

Agriculture

- Some lands were owned by state called Sita Lands which were either cultivated by labourers or leased out to cultivators.

- Private Land owners required to pay taxes in the form of **bali, bhaga, shulka, kara**, etc.

Trade

- State was also big traders.
- It also collected tolls through officials.
- Trade was also internal and to foreign countries.
- It exported spices, pearls, diamonds, cotton textiles, ivory works to Greece and Rome.
- It imported horses, gold, glass, linen, etc. from other countries.
- Balance of trade was very much in favour of India.

MAURYAN ART AND ARCHITECTURE

The period of Mauryas contributed significantly in the field of arts including architecture, sculpture, engineering, polishing, etc. The palace of Chandragupta was made of wood. Ashoka during his long reign further improved the wooden walls and buildings of the capital and added many attractive edifices, which could be traced from the site at Kumrahar. Ashoka constructed as good as 84,000 stupas. These buildings were solid and dome, made of rock or bricks. The art of sculpture or rock cutting also reached its zenith during Ashoka's time. Seven rock-cut sanctuaries lying about 25 miles north of Gaya, Bihar, four on the Barabar hills and three on the Nagarjuna hills belong to the time of Ashoka and his successors. The caves are fine example of Mauryan art. The caves were used for religious ceremonies and also as assembly halls.

- The Mauryans introduced stone masonry on large scale.
- Fragments of stone pillars and stumps indicating the existence of an 80 pillared hall have been discovered at Kumrahar on outskirts of Patna.
- The pillars represent the masterpiece of Mauryan sculpture. Each pillar is made of single piece of sandstone, only their capitals which are beautiful pieces of sculpture in the form of lion or bulls are joined with pillar on the top.
- **Single lion** capital at Rampurva at **Lauriya** Nandangarh.
- **Single bull** capital at Rupurva.
- **Four lion** capital at Sarnath and Sanchi.
- A carved elephant at Dhauri and engraved elephant at Kalsi.
- The Mauryan artisans also started the practice of hewing out caves from rocks for monks to live in. The earliest example is Barabar caves in Gaya.

- Stupas were built throughout the empire to enshrine the relics of Buddha. Of these, the most famous are at Sanchi and Barhut.

Categories of Ashoka's Inscription

- **Bhabru-** Conversion to Buddhism.
- **Barabar Hills** – Enjoins toleration.
- **Tarai Pillars** – Respect to Buddhism.
- **14 Rock Edicts** – Administration and ethics. Minor Rock Edict IV declares Dhammaghosh and not the Bherighosh to be ideal of human beings.
- **Minor Rock Edicts** – Personal history of Ashoka and summary of Dhamma.
- **7 Pillar Rock Edicts** – Appendix to Rock Edicts.

Another remarkable feature was the art of polishing monuments, pillars, caves made of hard rocks, etc. Art of engineering equally flourished. Civil Engineering was in highly advanced state and, therefore, so many spectacular buildings, stupas, pillars could be constructed with perfection and efficiency. Also the art of jewellery attained a remarkable progress.

The **punched marked silver coins** of the Mauryas which carry the symbols of the **peacock**, and the hill and crescent were also a part of Court Art.

The other type of arts included the folk tradition of arts represented by figures of Yaksha and Yakshinis found from Besnagar, Daudganj, etc. The abundance of beautiful pottery called **Northern Black Polished Ware (NBPW)** and terracotta figurines were another item of popular art.

AFTERMATH OF MAURYAS

The period which started in about 200 B.C. did not have any large empire like that of the Mauryas. In eastern India, central India and the Deccan, the Mauryas were succeeded by a number of native rulers such as the Sungas, the Kanvas and the Satavahanas. In north-western India they were succeeded by a number of ruling dynasties from Central Asia.

Sunga Dynasty (185 – 71 B.C.)

The Sunga dynasty was founded by *Pushyamitra* who ruled for 36 years and his reign ended in 149 or 148 B.C. Pushyamitra was succeeded by his son, Agnimitra who was the governor of Vidisha during his father's reign. He ruled for eight years. Agnimitra was succeeded by Jyeshtha. The next important king of this dynasty was *Vasumitra*, who was the son of Agnimitra. Another important king of this dynasty was *Bhagabhadra*. The ninth important king of this dynasty was Bhagvata who ruled for 32 years. The last king of this dynasty was *Devabhuti* or *Devabhumi*. He was put to death by his minister or amaty called Vasudeva Kanva. Thus, the kingdom of Magadha passed from the Sungas to Kanvas.

The Sunga dynasty occupies a very important place in the history of India. Their greatest achievement was the safeguarding of India from the invasion of Hunas. The Sunga Kings greatly encouraged the Brahman religion and literature.

Hunas

Hunas were one of the fierce tribes from Central Asia. They have been periodically invading India since the Sunga period. They were resisted by the rulers until the second half of the 5th century A.D. But the weakness of Gupta empire provided them with a chance and by A.D. 485 they were able to occupy eastern Malwa and a good portion of central India.

Kanva Dynasty (72 B.C. – 27 B.C.)

The rule of the Kanvas lasted for about 45 years. Four kings ruled during this period. Vasudeva ruled for a period of nine years and Bhumimitra for 14 years. Narayana held the reigns of administration for almost 12 years— *Shusarma* was the last of the Kanvas. During the Kanva dynasty, the Brahmanical reaction persisted.

Cheta (Chetis) Dynasty Of Kalinga

The history of Kalinga is not known with any degree of certainty till the first century B.C. The veil of obscurity is lifted by the far famed but damaged *Hatigumpha* (in the Udaygiri hill near Bhubaneswar) inscription. It records the exploits of Kharavela belonging to the Cheta or Cheti line of kings, founded by Maha Meghavahana. According to the testimony of the inscription of Kharavela, aged 24, ascended the throne of Kalinga probably in 25 B.C. after having served apprenticeship as Yuvaraja for eight years. The inscription which accounts for the 13 years of Kharavela's rule, describes in detail the digvijaya of the Kalinga prince.

Age of Satvahanas (235 B.C. – 100 B.C.)

The most important of the native successors of the Mauryas in the Deccan and in central India were the Satavahanas. The Satvahanas also known as Andhras ruled the Deccan for 300 years. *Pratisthana* was their capital. Some powerful rulers were *Sri Sata-karni*, *Vasisthaputra Palimahi*, *Yajunasri Sata-Karni* and *Gautmiputra Sri Sata-karni*. The most powerful among them all was satavahanas. He fought against the other kingdoms and expanded his empire.

The Satavahanas established a powerful empire. Continuous military conflicts, especially against the Shakas, however, gradually weakened them. Eventually, the empire broke up into many smaller kingdoms.

The Satavahana kingdom had three grades of feudatories. The highest grade was formed by the king who was called raja who had the right to strike coins. The second grade was formed by the mahabhoja and the third grade by the senapati. It seems that these feudatories and landed beneficiaries enjoyed some authority in their respective localities.

Increasing craft and commerce in this period brought many merchants and artisans to the forefront. Both artisans and merchants made generous donations to the Buddhist cause. They set up small memorial tablets. Among the artisans, the ganghikas or the perfumers are repeatedly mentioned as donor. At a later stage the term gandhika became so general as to denote all kinds of shopkeepers.

Many temples and monasteries were cut out of the solid rock in the north-western Deccan or Maharashtra with great skill and patience. The two common structures were the temple which was called **chaitya vihara**. The chaitya was a large hall with a number of columns, and the vihara consisted of a central hall entered by a doorway from a verandah in front.

Invasions from The Central Asia

The Indo-Greek (190 B.C.)

The first invaders were the Greeks, who are called the Indo-Greeks or **Bactrian Greeks**. In the Beginning of the second century B.C., the Indo-Greeks occupied a large part of north-western India, much larger than that conquered by Alexander. Two Greek dynasties ruled north-western India on parallel lines at one and the same time. The most famous Indo-Greek ruler was *Menander* (165- 145 B.C.) with his capital of **Sakala** in Punjab. We know this, from the famous treatise '*Milinda Panha*' written by Nagasena.

The Indo-Greeks were the first rulers in India to issue coins which can be definitely attributed to the kings. The earlier

punch marked coins were though in gold definitely attributed to the kings. The earlier coins were not easy to be assigned with any dynasty. **The Indo-Greeks were the first to issue gold coins in India**, which increased in number under the Kushans. The Greek rule is also memorable on account of the introduction of Hellenistic features in the north-west frontier of India, giving rise to the Gandhara art.

The Sakas (90 B.C. – 1st A.D.)

The most famous Saka ruler in India was Rudradaman-I (A.D. 130-150). *Rudradaman* was a great lover of Sanskrit. Although a foreigner settled in India, he issued the first-ever long inscription in chaste Sanskrit.

The Parthians (19-45 A.D.)

The Saka kingdom in north-western India was followed by that of the Parthians, and in many ancient Indian Sanskrit texts the two peoples are together mentioned as Saka-Pahlavas.

In fact, they ruled over this country on parallel lines for some time. The most famous Parthian king was *Gondopernes*.

The Kushanas (45 A.D. – 73 A.D.)

The Parthians were succeeded by the Kushans. The Kushans established a powerful empire in north India. They defeated the Indo-Greeks, the Pahlavas and the Shakas and established themselves in the region around Takshashila and Peshawar. Later, they occupied Kashmir, Punjab and parts of present day Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh.

The greatest of the Kushana rulers was *Kanishka*. He established a vast empire which included parts of central Asia. *Purashapura* (modern Peshawar) was the capital of his empire. Mathura was another important city in his empire.

There were two successive dynasties of the Kushans. The first dynasty was founded by a house of chiefs who were called *Kadphises* and who ruled for 28 years from about A.D. 50. It had two kings. The First was **Kadphises I**, who issued coins in the south of the Hindukush.

The house of Kadphises was bigger by that of Kanishka. Its kingdom extended the Kushan power over upper India and the lower Indus basin. The early Kushan kings issued numerous gold coins with higher gold content than is found in the Gupta coins.

Impact of Central Asian Contacts

The impact of Saka-Kushana period can be witnessed in various fields such as pottery, trade and technology, polity, religion, art, science and technology, literature and learning. Buddhist missionaries followed the merchants and due to this, the communication and trade with China improved.

The foreign rulers established relationship between Central Asia and India. The Central Asian conquerors implemented their rule on various petty native princes. This led to the development of a feudatory organization. The Sakas and the Kushans strengthened the idea of the divine origin of kingship. Gradually, the Greeks, the Sakas, the Parthians and the Kushans lost their own identity and became completely Indianized. Some of the foreign rulers were converted to Vaishnavism and a few other adopted Buddhism. There were also some changes in Indian religions, i.e. Buddhism which developed a new form called the Mahayana and Hinayana, Kanishka, an important Kushan ruler became a Buddhist convert and held the fourth Buddhist Council.

Indian craftsmen came into contact with the Greeks and the Romans, which gave rise to a new art called *Gandhara School of Art*. The *Mathura Schools of Art* flourished in the early centuries of the Christian era, and its products made of red sandstone are found even outside Mathura. In the south, *Amravati Art* became famous.

The foreign rulers patronized and cultivated Sanskrit literature. *Asvaghosha* wrote the '*Buddhacharita*', a biography of Buddha and composed '*Saundarananda*' in Sanskrit kavya form. The progress of 'Mahayana' Buddhism led to the composition of several 'avadanas'. Some of the important books of this genre were the '*Mahavastu*' and the '*Divyavadana*'.

These foreigners introduced turban, tunic, trousers and heavy long coat, along with cap, helmets and boots used by the warriors. Indian astronomy and astrology were more flourished due to the contact with the Greeks. Indian astrology in Sanskrit derived the term '*horasastra*' from the Greek term '*horoscope*'. We also find that the Kushan copper coins in India were imitation of the Roman coins. Working on glass during this period was especially influenced by foreign ideas and practices.

Art and Architecture

The art and architecture were closely associated with religion.

Temple

As the society was predominantly Buddhist, the building of temples was least done. However, we find many important temples of the period, such as at Jhandial, Taxila, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, and Andhra Pradesh. The *Sankarshan temple* at *Nagari*, *Apsita temple* at *Nagarjunakonda* and the *Besnagar temple* are worth mentioning.

Rock Cut Architecture : According to British historian V.A. Smith—"The art of polishing hard stone was carried out with such perfection that it is said to have become a lost art beyond modern powers."

Udayagiri caves are the most famous Jain cave temples situated in the hills of Khandagiri and Udaygiri and built by Kharavela, the Jain ruler of Kalinga. Out of 17 caves, the four most important Udaygiri caves are **Rani Gumph**, **Hathi Gumph**, **Bag Gumph** and **Machipuri Gumph**. The most important and distinct features of the Kalinga Rock cut architecture is the complete absence of Chaityas or a shrine cell with a stupa in the centre.

Stupas

Stupas were normally built to enshrine the sacred relics of the Buddha or Bodhisattvas. The railings and gateway of Sanchi stupa was later enlarged by Sunga rulers. Other important stupas of the period are Bodh Gaya, Taxila, Amravati, Nagarjunakonda, etc.

Schools of Art

Kishana (Mathura) School of Art

From the beginning of the Christian era, Mathura became an important centre of artistic activity. The five centuries of indigenous art traditions were preserved and improved upon by the Mathura sculptors. Artist at Mathura used a purely indigenous style. They used spotted red sandstone. Apart from Buddhism, the artists also made statues of Hindu and Jain deities. The images produced at Mathura became models for succeeding generations of artists.

Gandhara School of Art

Besides Mathura arts, an important art was associated with

Gandhara in the north-west. After the Greek invasion and during the period of the Kushanas, many artists from west Asia migrated to north-west India. This distinctive style which grew in the region of Gandhara is known as the **Gandhara School of Art**. Since Mahayana, Buddhism encouraged image worship, artists created sculptures adopting themes from Buddha's life and the Jataka stories. The school produced several pieces of fine sculpture in which this distinct style is clearly visible.

Evidence of Gandhara art has been found in **Taxila** and in ancient cities of Afghanistan.

Amravati School of Art

Apart from these arts there was the Amravati school of Buddhist art which flourished in western Andhra Pradesh under the patronages of Satavahana rulers.

Crafts, Trade and Towns In The Post-Maurya Age

In ancient India, the age of the Sakas, Kushans, Satavahans (200 B.C.-A.D. 200) and the first Tamil states was the most flourishing period in the history of crafts and commerce. Technological knowledge about the work of iron had made great progress. Cloth-making, silk-weaving and the making of arms and luxury articles also made progress.

The development in the field of crafts and commerce and the increasing use of money promoted the prosperity of numerous towns during this period. The important towns in north India such as Vaishali, Pataliputra, Varanasi, Kaushambi, Shravasti, Hastinapur, Mathura, Indraprastha are all mentioned in literary texts. Tagar (Ter), Paithan, Dhanyakataka, Amravati, Nagarjunakonda, Broach, Sopara, Arikamedu, Kaveripattanam were prosperous towns in the Satvahana period in western and south India.

Points to remember

- "Arthashastra" written by Kautilya and "Indica" by Megasthenes are two important sources of Mauryan history.
- Mauryan dynasty was founded by Chandra Gupta Maurya, who with the help of Chanakya defeated Nandas and established Mauryan empire.
- Mauryan empire was a vast empire which was extended to western and north-western India, and Deccan.
- Bindusara (293-273 BC) and Ashoka (273-232 BC) are among famous Mauryan Kings.
- Mauryan empire weakened gradually after Ashoka and came to an end within less than half a century after Ashoka death.
- Mauryan administration was divided into four divisions: central, provincial, district and village.
- Mauryan administration included king, Pradeshika and Rajukas.
- Mauryan owned a big army which consisted 6,00,000 foot soldiers, 30,000 cavalry and 700 elephants.
- Espionage was an important part of Mauryan administration and was of two types - Santha and Sanchar.
- Other important rulers after the Mauryas were - the Sungas (185-71 BC), the Hunas, the Kanvas, the Chetas, the Satvahanas.
- Many invaders from central Asia also ruled India - the Indo-Greek (190 BC), the Saka, (90 BC - 1st AD). The Parthians (19-45 AD), the Kushanas (45 B.C. - 73 AD)
- There has been a considerable impact of central Asian contact in various fields e.g. - pottery, trade, technology, polity, art, religion, painting, architecture, etc.

Exercise -1

1. Kumara Gupta I was succeeded by
 - (a) Chandra gupta II (b) Budha gupta
 - (c) Samundra gupta (d) Skanda gupta
2. For the first time in Indian History, the description of the State Administration was found for which among the following periods?
 - (a) Gupta Period (b) Maurya Period
 - (c) Shunga Period (d) Saatvahana Period
3. What was the function of Samaharta in Mauryan Administration?
 - (a) To Collect Revenue
 - (b) To Work as a Judge
 - (c) Leadership of Army
 - (d) Delivering Justice
4. Which among the following was the first investigated pillar of Ashoka?
 - (a) Delhi Meerut Pillar (b) Barabar cave
 - (c) Dhauli (d) Sarnath
5. Pushyamitra Shunga, who was originally a Senapati of the Mauryan empire and assassinated the last Mauryan Emperor Brihadrath in 185 BC was a _____.
 - (a) Brahman (b) Kshatriya
 - (c) Vaishya (d) Shudra
6. There is only one edict, in which Ashoka refers himself as King of Magadha (Laja Magadhe.) Identify the edict from the following:
 - (a) Minor Rock Edict of Maski
 - (b) The Queens Edict
 - (c) Bhabhru Edict
 - (d) Dhauli Pillar Inscription
7. At which among the following places, Chandragupta Maurya spent his last days ?
 - (a) Nalanda (b) Ujjain
 - (c) Shravana Belgola (d) Kashi
8. Ceylon became a stronghold of which among the following branches of Buddhism?
 - (a) Mahayan (b) Hinayan
 - (c) Mahendra (d) Theravada
9. Ashvaghosha, who has written the marvelous work "Buddhacharita" was a court poet of which among the following kings?
 - (a) Ashoka (b) Kanishka
 - (c) Samudragupta (d) Ajatshatru
10. Who among the following kings was a contemporary of both Mahavira and Buddha ?
 - (a) Ajatshatru (b) Nandivardhana
 - (c) Bimbisara (d) Ashoka
11. The followers of which of the following sects worshipped the Ashoka Tree as God and carried in their hands a bunch of peacock feathers?
 - (a) Shakta (b) Pashupata
 - (c) Ajivika (d) Digambar Jain
12. Which of the following is known as the Turning of the Wheel of Law (Dharma- Chakrapravartana)?
 - (a) The first sermon preached by the Buddha at the Deer Park at Sarnath
 - (b) The practice of setting the wheel in motion everyday in the morning in the sanghas
 - (c) The extinction of karma leading to the achievement of nirvana
 - (d) The continuous existence of human beings like the wheel of causes and effects
13. The reign of the Kushana monarch Kanishka was a turning point in the history of Buddhism, because:
 - (a) It witnessed the rise of Mahayanism
 - (b) Buddhism was introduced in China and Central Asia in his time
 - (c) Both (a) and (b)
 - (d) The images of Buddha and Bodhisattvas began to be carved out during this period
14. Which of the following is not one of the common points of significance of both Rajagriha and Vaishali?
 - (a) Both places are associated with the miracles preformed by the Buddha
 - (b) At both places one of the Buddhist councils was held
 - (c) At both places a stupa was built with the mortal remains of the Buddha enshrined in them
 - (d) Both places were important centres of Buddhist art
15. The majority of the Buddhist vases in India are found in Western Maharashtra because:
 - (a) The Sahyadri mountain in western Maharashtra with its hard trap was best suited for rock-cut architecture
 - (b) There was a long-standing tradition in this region of royal patronage to rock-cut architecture
 - (c) The caves in this region provided a safe sanctuary away from foreign invaders
 - (d) Many of the royal dynasties of Western India were patrons of Buddhism
16. The Allahabad Pillar inscription is associated with which one of the following?
 - (a) Mahapadma Nanda (b) Chandragupta Maurya
 - (c) Ashoka (d) Samudragupta
17. Which one of the following is the correct chronological order of the given rulers of ancient India?
 - (a) Ashoka—Kanishka—Milinda
 - (b) Milinda—Ashoka—Kanishka
 - (c) Ashoka—Milinda—Kanishka
 - (d) Milinda—Kanishka—Ashoka
18. Which of the following languages was used in Ashoka's Edicts?
 - (a) Vasudeva (b) Pali
 - (c) Brahmi (d) Sanskrit
19. After the Kalinga war, Ashoka :
 - (a) restored all the kingdoms he had conquered
 - (b) abandoned the policy of physical conquests in favour of cultural conquests.
 - (c) renounced his kingdom and became a sadhu
 - (d) followed the policy of physical occupation more rigorously

20. Which of the following metals were mostly used for minting coins during the Mauryan period?
 - (a) Bronze and gold
 - (b) Gold and lead
 - (c) Silver and copper
 - (d) Lead and silver
21. Ring wells are identified for the first time in?
 - (a) Later Vedic age
 - (b) Pre-mauryan age
 - (c) Mauryan period
 - (d) Post-Mauryan
22. Which of the following books serves as a source for the Mauryan period?
 - (a) Historica
 - (b) Indica
 - (c) Suttapitaka
 - (d) Jain Purvas
23. The governor under Chandragupta Maurya who constructed the Sudarshana Lake is?
 - (a) Parnadatta
 - (b) Tusaspa
 - (c) Pushagupta
 - (d) Chakrapalita
24. Who patronized the third Buddhist council held at Pataliputra?
 - (a) Kanishka
 - (b) Ashoka
 - (c) Kalasoka
 - (d) Ajatashatru
25. The most informative source about Mauryan administration is?
 - (a) Indica
 - (b) Arthashastra
 - (c) Ashokan Inscriptions
 - (d) Buddhist Chronicles
26. The Mauryan state had monopoly over which of the following sectors?
 - (a) Mining and Metallurgy
 - (b) Coins and currency
 - (c) Armaments and ship building
 - (d) All the above
27. Which of the following dynasties had a role in the construction and maintenance of the Sanchi Stupa?
 - (a) Mauryas
 - (b) Sungas
 - (c) Kanvas
 - (d) Satavahanas
28. Which of the following pairs is correctly matched?
 - (a) Jatakas - Mauryan chronology and genealogy
 - (b) Puranas - Ashoka's efforts to spread Buddhism to Sri Lanka
 - (c) Dipavamsa - Socio-economic conditions of the Mauryan period
 - (d) Digha nikaya - Influence of Buddhist ideas on Mauryan polity
29. The lowest order in the social scale of Mauryan society was not a slave but the outcaste. Which of the following statements about the outcastes is not correct?
 - (a) Their caste names referred directly to their profession or work
 - (b) They accepted the position of social ostracism
 - (c) They lived together with their families outside the towns
 - (d) They were not allowed to perform any rituals
30. Which of the following was not a state monopoly during the Mauryan period?
 - (a) Mines and forests
 - (b) Pearl and fisheries
 - (c) Ferries and bridges
 - (d) Slaughter houses and gambling houses
31. Which of the following public health measures was not punishable under the Mauryan public health laws?
 - (a) Throwing dirt, mud or dead bodies on public thoroughfares
 - (b) Polluting the water tanks or sources of water
 - (c) Taking the dead bodies for cremation or burial along paths not meant for the purpose
 - (d) Treating patients and selling herbs and drugs without securing registration
32. Who of the following officers were charged with superintendence of women?
 - (a) Dhamma-mahamattas
 - (b) Ithihakha-mahamattas
 - (c) Anta-mahamattas
 - (d) Antahpur-adhyakshas
33. One of the following Mauryan provinces, which had a foreign (Yavana-Greek) Governor, was:
 - (a) Southern province — Suvarnagiri
 - (b) Eastern province — Tosali
 - (c) Western province — Ujjain
 - (d) Saurashtra — Junagarh
34. Which of the following statements about the officers designated as mahamattas in Mauryan administration is correct?
 - (a) These officers were charged with the responsibility of propagating Buddhism
 - (b) They were appointed as viceroys of various provinces
 - (c) The term was used for any senior official irrespective of the duties assigned to him
 - (d) It is a Prakrit expression for the Sanskrit word amatya
35. Four major provinces of the Mauryan empire were the Northern, Eastern, Western and Southern provinces, each under the vice-royalty of a prince or a member of the royal family. Which of the following provincial capitals of the Mauryan empire was the capital of the Northern province?
 - (a) Suvarnagiri
 - (b) Tosali
 - (c) Ujjain
 - (d) Taxila
36. From which of the following months did the Mauryan fiscal year use to begin?
 - (a) Phalgun (March)
 - (b) Asadha (July)
 - (c) Jyestha (June)
 - (d) Pausa-Magha (January-February)
37. Which of the following was not one of the checks on the powers of the Mauryan kings?
 - (a) Customs of the land
 - (b) Guilds
 - (c) Brahmins
 - (d) Mantri-parishad
38. Which of the following would be the most accurate description of the Mauryan monarchy under Ashoka?
 - (a) Enlightened despotism
 - (b) Centralised autocracy
 - (c) Paternal despotism
 - (d) Guided democracy
39. Which of the following statements about the Mauryan kings is not correct?
 - (a) They had extensive powers encompassing administrative, judicial, and legislative functions
 - (b) They laid claim to divinity
 - (c) Appointments to the most important offices were made by the ruler himself
 - (d) The kings often laid down codes of regulation for the guidance of their officers and the people

40. Pushyamitra Sunga, who killed the last Mauryan ruler Brihadratha and founded the Sunga dynasty, was a:
 - (a) Prime Minister of the Mauryas
 - (b) General of the Mauryas
 - (c) Both (a) and (b) above
 - (d) Feudatory ruler
41. The officer of the Central Government, who was in-charge of collection of revenue, was:
 - (a) Adhyaksha or Superintendent of Departments
 - (b) Sannidhata or High Treasurer
 - (c) Samaharta or Collector General
 - (d) Karmika or Clerk
42. Which of the following statements about the Mauryan Council of Ministers (mantri-parishad) is not correct?
 - (a) The members of the council were personally selected by the king
 - (b) The number of members of the council was fixed and it consisted of three councillors and a Chief Minister
 - (c) It was specially consulted in times of emergency
 - (d) It may have acted as a political check on the king
43. Who of the following was not one of the later Mauryas who succeeded Ashoka?
 - (a) Dasharatha
 - (b) Samprati
 - (c) Shalishuka
 - (d) Shubhagasena
44. Which of the following was not one of Hellenic kings to whom diplomatic missions were sent by Ashoka?
 - (a) Xerxes of Macedonia
 - (b) Antiochus II Theos of Syria
 - (c) Ptolemy II Philadelphos of Egypt
 - (d) Antigonus Gonatas of Macedonia
45. The most striking example of the architectural closeness between Achaemenid Iran and Mauryan India was:
 - (a) The stone elephant at Dhauri
 - (b) The lion-capital at Sarnath
 - (c) The royal palace at Pataliputra
 - (d) Terracotta objects found at various Mauryan sites
46. Towards health care, the most important measures taken by Ashoka was/were:
 - (a) He opened dispensaries for the treatment of both human beings and animals
 - (b) He got the herbs and plants, needed for medical purposes, cultivated
 - (c) Both (a) and (b) above
 - (d) He made arrangements for safe drinking water in the whole of his empire
47. Which of the following was not one of the reasons for gradual weakening of the Mauryan finances?
 - (a) Need for vast revenues to maintain a huge but inactive army
 - (b) Need for finances to maintain a very large bureaucracy
 - (c) Unfavourable balance of trade with foreign countries
 - (d) The strain on the exchequer of Ashoka's charitable public works
48. Who of the following was the last of the Mauryas, assassinated by his commander-in-chief, Pushyamitra, the founder of the Shunga dynasty?
 - (a) Samprati
 - (b) Devavarman
 - (c) Shatadhanvan
 - (d) Brihadratha
49. Which of the following supposed causes of decline and disintegration of the Mauryan Empire is the least likely?
 - (a) Succession of weak kings after Ashoka and the partition of the empire after Ashoka
 - (b) Military inactivity on account of Ashoka's pacifist policies
 - (c) Brahmanical revolt against the pro-Buddhist policy of Ashoka
 - (d) Absence of national consciousness and representative institutions
50. Who of the following dedicated the caves in Nagarjuni Hills to the Ajivikas?
 - (a) Kunala
 - (b) Dasharatha
 - (c) Samprati
 - (d) Indrapalit
51. How long did the entire Mauryan dynasty last according to the Puranas?
 - (a) 218 years
 - (b) 137 years
 - (c) 85 years
 - (d) 182 years
52. Which of the following was a measure adopted by the later Mauryas to meet the needs of a depleted treasury?
 - (a) Increase in taxes
 - (b) Imposition of new taxes
 - (c) debasement of currency
 - (d) Increase of exports
53. According to which of the following sources is Ashoka said to have built the city of Srinagar?
 - (a) Buddhist tradition
 - (b) Jain tradition
 - (c) Tibetan tradition
 - (d) Kalhana's Rajatarangini
54. Which of the following states of India did not form part of the Mauryan empire?
 - (a) Kerala
 - (b) Tamil Nadu
 - (c) Both (a) and (b) above
 - (d) Kashmir
55. Which of the following was not one of the reasons why the conquest of Kalinga was of strategic and economic importance to the Mauryan empire?
 - (a) It stood in the way of the southern routes from the Ganges valley
 - (b) It was also a powerful maritime state and, therefore a convenient source of income
 - (c) Its rich and fertile land could contribute to the economic prosperity of the empire
 - (d) It provided congruity to the Mauryan territories of Andhra and Bengal
56. According to which of the following sources, did Ashoka in his old age abdicate the throne in favour of his grandson Samprati?
 - (a) Ashokavadana
 - (b) Divyavadana
 - (c) Mahavamsa
 - (d) Gargi-Samhita
57. Which of the following is not one of the sources for determining the geographical extent of the Mauryan empire during the reign of Ashoka?
 - (a) The distribution of his rock and pillar edicts
 - (b) The contents of his inscriptions
 - (c) The literary and religious traditions
 - (d) Numismatic evidence

58. The Mauryan king who issued the Nagarjuni Hill Cave Inscriptions and assumed the royal title of Devanampriya was:
 - (a) Ashoka
 - (b) Dasharatha
 - (c) Bindusara
 - (d) Brihadratha
59. Which of the following was the contribution of the Mauryas to the Tamil culture?
 - (a) Brahmi script
 - (b) Art of engraving stone inscriptions
 - (c) Prakrit language
 - (d) The art of stone-cutting and sculpture
60. On what basis is it held that on the east the province of Vanga (part of modern Bengal) formed part of the Mauryan empire?
 - (a) Discovery of Ashokan edicts in this part of Bengal
 - (b) Tamralipti, the principal port of the area, was one of the most important maritime centres during the Mauryan period
 - (c) Megasthenes' Indica mentions Chandragupta's conquest of the region
 - (d) Buddhist traditions associate Ashoka with propagation of Buddhism in Bengal
61. Which of the following statements about the Mauryan relations with Sri Lanka is not correct?
 - (a) The coming of Mahendra and Sanghmitra to Sri Lanka was the First official contact between the two countries
 - (b) The king of Sri Lanka, Tissa, adopted the title of Devanampirya and appears to have modelled himself on Ashoka
 - (c) There were frequent exchanges of gifts and envoys
 - (d) Tisas, the Sinhalese king, accepted Buddhism and appears to have made it the state religion
62. Rock Edict XIII (also known as Separate Rock Edict, because it is not found elsewhere) is regarded as one of the most important documents of Ashokan history, because:
 - (a) It expresses his regret and remorse at the suffering caused by the Kalinga War
 - (b) It expresses a new idea of conquest that of dhamma-vijaya instead of victory by war and violence
 - (c) It is the longest of the fourteen major Rock Edicts and is recorded in a tone of recapitulation
 - (d) All the above
63. In which of the following Major Rock Edicts does Ashoka introduce the institution of dhamma-mahamatta for the first time?
 - (a) Rock Edict II
 - (b) Rock Edict III
 - (c) Rock Edict IV
 - (d) Rock Edict V
64. Which edict of Ashoka contains the famous pronouncement: "at all times, whether I am eating, or I am in the women's apartments, or in my inner apartments, or at the cattleshed, or in my carriage, or in my gardens—wherever I may be—my mahamatta should keep me in touch with public business"?
 - (a) Rock Edict II
 - (b) Rock Edict IV
 - (c) Rock Edict VI
 - (d) Rock Edict VIII
65. What was the subject of Rock Edict I issued by Ashoka?
 - (a) Prohibition of animal sacrifice and festive meetings (samaja)
 - (b) Measures of social welfare undertaken for the benefit of the people
 - (c) Liberality to Brahmins and Sramanas
 - (d) Visit to Bodh-Gaya
66. Which of the following was not the result of the Kalinga War?
 - (a) The number of casualties of combatants and non-combatants is stated to have been around four lakhs
 - (b) The cruel consequences of war revolutionized the personality and public policies of Ashoka
 - (c) He wages no wars after the Kalinga War
 - (d) The strength of the Mauryan army was curtailed
67. Which of the following statements about the conversion of Ashoka to Buddhism is generally believed to be correct?
 - (a) It took place as a dramatic event soon after the Kalinga War
 - (b) Ashoka was never converted to Buddhism; he only borrowed some of its ideas to propound his doctrine of dhamma
 - (c) His conversion to Buddhism was a gradual process
 - (d) He became a convert to Buddhism under the influence of Upagupta
68. One of the strongest arguments in support of the view that Ashoka's dhamma was not a religious policy but a secular concept is the:
 - (a) Appointment of dhamma-mahamattas
 - (b) Emphasis laid by him on respect for the elders
 - (c) Stress laid on the importance of the family
 - (d) Stress on the maintenance of concord with all sects
69. The dhamma mahamattas (dharma mahamatras) appointed by Ashoka were entrusted with the job of:
 - (a) Checking the abuses in the administration of justice
 - (b) The moral uplift of the people through propagation of dhamma
 - (c) Management of the welfare activities of the state
 - (d) All the above
70. Which of the following was not one of the reasons for the failure of dhamma?
 - (a) Ashoka's excessive enthusiasm produced a reaction against it
 - (b) It failed to provide a solution to the problems which it set out to solve
 - (c) It was too vague a solution, because the problems lay at the very roots of the system
 - (d) It was too idealistic a concept, which could not break the social and sectarian barriers
71. Ashoka himself considered his policy of dhamma as:
 - (a) The essence of original Buddhism as preached by the Buddha
 - (b) A way of life which was both practical and convenient as well as highly moral
 - (c) The ideal of virtuous life based on moral teachings of various thinkers
 - (d) The essence of all religions or the common religion of mankind

72. In social matters Ashoka's most revolutionary concept was:
- Proper behavior to slaves, servants, elders etc.
 - His opposition to wasteful social rituals and ceremonies at marriages, births, journeys etc.
 - His opposition to social entertainments, such as the samajas
 - All the above
73. To promote communal harmony Ashoka asked the people:
- To attend to the essential elements of their religions rather than the non-essential ones
 - Not to glorify their own sect and be little another's sect
 - To maintain concord (samvaya) with all creeds
 - All the above
74. The edicts of Ashoka which reveal his inner sorrow on account of war and violence are:
- Dhauili and Jaugada
 - Shahbazgarhi and Sopara
 - Maski and Bhabra
 - Mansehra and Girnar
75. Which of the following was not one of the contributions of Ashoka to India polity and culture?
- Political and cultural unification of the country
 - Religious toleration and promotion of communal harmony
 - A non-aggressive foreign policy based on equality between the big and small states
 - Reform in criminal justice and revolutionary changes in the social system
76. In spite of his conversion to Buddhism and the concept of dhamma-vijaya, Ashoka was not a total pacifist. Which of the following does not confirm this view?
- He felt sorry for the suffering caused by Kalinga War, but did not give up the conquered territory
 - After the conquest of Kalinga, Ashoka consolidated his southern conquests
 - In dealing with the troublesome forest tribes he clearly recognized the possibility of the use of force
 - He did not abolish capital punishment and granted only a brief reprieve to the condemned prisoners
77. Which of the following edicts/inscriptions does not belong to the category directed to the sangha?
- Kandahar Inscription
 - Bhabra Edict
 - Schism Edict
 - Nigalisagar Inscription
78. Which of the following is not one of the broad categories into which the edicts issued by Ashoka can be divided?
- Public pronouncements meant for his subjects
 - Personal epistles directed to the Sangha
 - Pronouncement explaining the philosophy of Buddhism and its relevance in day-to-day life
 - Edicts issued for the propagation of dhamma
79. Which of the following steps was not taken by Ashoka to promote and patronise Buddhism?
- He erected a commemorative pillar at the place where the Buddha was said to have been born
 - Lumbini was made free of religious cess and revenue was reduced to only one-eighth share (of the produce)
 - He got thousands of dissenter monks expelled from the Ashokarama monastery
 - He took a great deal of personal interest in the welfare of the monks and the nuns
80. The family member of Ashoka mentioned in his edicts, is:
- His second wife Karuvaki
 - His son Tivara
 - His wife Asandhamitra
 - His daughter Sanghamitra
81. The major contribution of the Third Buddhist Council convened by Ashoka was:
- It purged the Buddhist sangha of its dissenters
 - At this conference kathavatthu was compiled by its President Moggaliputta Tissa
 - It decided to dispatch Buddhist missions to various parts of India and foreign countries
 - All the above
82. In which of the following edicts did Ashoka order that "whosoever monk or nun breaks up the Sangha, after being clothed in white garments, shall take up abode in a place other than a monastery"?
- Sarnath Edict
 - Kausambi Edict
 - Sanchi Edict
 - The Queen's Edict
83. Which of the following administrative measures was not undertaken by Ashoka?
- The monarch started the practice of royal tours and instituted quinquennial circuits of officers
 - He issued a code of conduct to his officials
 - He tried to save people from miscarriage of justice
 - Release of the convicts on the mercy petition moved by his ministers
84. What is the most significant difference in the message of the pillar Edicts as compared to the Rock Edicts?
- The main stress in the Pillar Edicts is on social welfare measure
 - There is a hint of fanaticism about dhamma and of megalomania in the Pillar Edicts
 - The Pillar Edicts are mainly devoted to the moral aspects of dhamma and Ashoka's attachment to Buddhism
 - Rock Edicts are addressed to common people and Pillar Edicts to the Buddhist order
85. In which of the following respect do the Ashokan epigraphs not help us to draw historical inferences?
- In delineating the boundary of the Mauryan empire
 - In inferring Ashoka's relations with his border countries
 - In inferring the impact of Kalinga War on the non-combatants
 - In deriving conclusions regarding his relations with the members of his family

86. Which of the following contains the pronouncement: "All men are my children"?
- Rock Edict V
 - Pillar Edict VI
 - Separate Rock Edict I
 - Separate Rock Edict II
87. In which of the following edicts/inscriptions does Ashoka express his faith in the Buddhist creed?
- Schism Edict
 - Bhabru Edict
 - Kandahar Inscription
 - Rummindei Inscription
88. Information in respect of which of the following cannot be obtained from the edicts and inscriptions of Ashoka?
- The sectarian and communal conflict of the period
 - Working of the inner mind of Ashoka
 - Administrative reforms introduced by Ashoka
 - The social, religious and economic life of the people of his time
89. The head of a district (Ahara), the principal coordinator of the revenue and the officer incharge of general and military functions in his jurisdiction during Mauryan empire was known as
- Krori
 - Rajuka
 - Foujdar
 - Chirastadar
90. Which one among the following statements about Ashokan edicts is correct?
- The Pillar edicts were located in all parts of the empire
 - The edicts give details of his personal concerns but are silent on events of the empire
 - The subject of inscribed matter on Rock edicts differs completely with that of the Pillar edicts
 - The Greek or Aramaic edicts are versions or translations of the texts used in other edicts
91. Ashokan inscriptions of Mansehra and Shahbazgadhi are written in
- Prakrit language, Kharoshthi script
 - Prakrit language, Brahmi script
 - Prakrit-Aramaic language, Brahmi script
 - Aramaic language, Kharoshthi script
92. The Dhamma propagated by Ashoka was
- the tenets of Buddhism
 - a mixture of the philosophies of Ajivikas and Charvakas
 - a system of morals consistent with the tenets of most of the sects of the time
 - the religious policy of the state
93. The first Indian ruler to be shown in images as wearing a dress akin to trousers is
- Chandragupta
 - Ashoka
 - Kanishka
 - Samudragupta
94. Which among the following materials were used for minting coins during the rule of the Mauryas?
- Gold and Silver
 - Silver and Copper
 - Copper and Bronze
 - Gold and Copper
95. The highly polished monolithic Ashokan Pillars were carved out of single pieces of a buff-coloured sandstone, usually mined from the quarries of
- Chunar near Mirzapur
 - Lauriya in Nandangarh
 - Sarnath near Varanasi
 - Udayagiri near Bhubaneswar
96. The only inscribed stone portrait of Emperor Ashoka has been found at
- Sanchi
 - Amaravati
 - Kanaganahalli
 - Ajanta
97. Which one of the following dynasties was associated with Gandhara School of Art ?
- Chalukyas
 - Guptas
 - Kushanas
 - Mauryas
98. Which one of the following chronological orders of the given dynasties of India is correct ?
- Maurya-Nanda-Kanva-Sunga
 - Nanda-Maurya-Sunga-Kanva
 - Nanda-Maurya-Kanva-Sunga
 - Maurya-Nanda-Sunga-Kanva
99. Who of the following was a contemporary of Alexander, the Great?
- Bimbisara
 - Chandragupta Maurya
 - Ashoka
 - Pushyamitra Sunga
100. Which one of the following is the correct chronological order of the given rulers of ancient India?
- Ashoka—Kanishka—Milinda
 - Milinda—Ashoka—Kanishka
 - Ashoka—Milinda—Kanishka
 - Milinda—Kanishka—Ashoka
101. Which one of the following statements about Chandragupta II is not correct ?
- Kalidas and Amarsingh were famous scholars in his court
 - He expanded his empire both through matrimonial alliances and conquests
 - He married a Naga princess, named Kubera Naga
 - He married his daughter Prabhawati to an Ahom prince
102. Which one among the following statements is not correct?
- Gandhara School of Arts owed its origin to the Indo-Greek rulers but the real patrons of the school were the Kushans, especially Kanishka
 - Rich carving, elaborate ornamentations and complex symbolism were not the main features of the Gandhara sculpture
 - The Graeco-Roman architectural impact modified the structure of the Buddhist Stupas
 - The artists of the Amravati School of Arts mainly used white marble

Exercise -2

Statement Based MCQ

- Consider the following statements regarding Ashoka's Dhamma is not correct ?
 - Major Rock Edict XIII is of paramount importance in understanding the Ashokan policy of Dhamma.
 - The Policy of Dhamma was an attempt at founding a new religion.
 - Major Rock Edict III relates to social welfare measures like medical centres for animals as well as men, road construction and planting of medicinal herbs.
 - Pillar Edict I states that through the king's care and love of Dhamma it had grown and that it was the king's principle to administer affairs.

(a) 1 and 4 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 2 and 4 (d) None of these
- Consider the following statements
 - The last Mauryan ruler, Brihadratha was assassinated by his commander-in-chief Pushyamitra Sunga.
 - The last Sunga king, Devabhuti was assassinated by his Brahman minister Vasudeva Kanva who usurped the throne.

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
- Which of the following statements is not true with reference to the production of commercial goods in the post Mauryan period?
 - Considerable technological advancement was reached in the production of commercial goods.
 - Production and distribution of commercial goods was organised effectively through guilds.
 - The producers worked under rigid state control.
 - The guilds used hired labour for production

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) 2 and 3 (d) 3 and 4
- The Kushana kings assumed title of Devaputra Kushana. Kanishka's predecessors also were assuming titles like Sarvaloka Isvara Mahisvara. This shows that Kushana Kings-
 - assumed high sounding titles implying power and fame.
 - assumed divine Kingship

Which of the above statements are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
- Which one is the correct chronological order in which the given rulers ruled over Magadha?
 - Brihadratha - Bimbisara - Sisunaga - Bindusara
 - Sisunaga - Bindusara - Brihadratha - Bimbisara
 - Brihadratha - Bindusara - Sisunaga - Bimbisara
 - Sisunaga - Bimbisara - Brihadratha - Bindusara

(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 3 only
(c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) 4 only
- What were the impacts of Kautilya's Arthashastra in Mauryan empire ?
 - The Arthashastra provided the state management of large scale trade and industry and exercise of effective control over every occupation.
 - It laid emphasis on education and moral training to the future king.
 - The Arthashastra maintained the state council to formulate the policy of the state

Which of the above statements is/are correct.

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) 3 only (d) All of them
- Consider the following with reference to the disintegration and decline of the Mauryan Empire:
 - Brahmanical revolt
 - King Ashoka's pacifist policies
 - Invasions from outside
 - Weakness of Ashoka's successors

Which of the above reasons led to the disintegration and decline of the Mauryan Empire?

(a) 1, 2 and 4 (b) 2 and 4
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4
- Arrange the following dynasties in chronological order in terms of their arrival in India
 - Sakas
 - Indo-Greeks
 - Parthians
 - Kushanas

Choose the correct answer from the codes given below :

(a) 1, 2, 3 and 4 (b) 1, 3, 4 and 2
(c) 2, 1, 3 and 4 (d) 2, 3, 1 and 4
- Who among the following performed Asvamedha sacrifice?
 - Pushyamitra sunga
 - Samudragupta
 - Pravarsena I
 - Pulakesin I

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Codes:

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4
- With reference to the history of Indian rock-cut architecture, consider the following statements:
 - The caves at Badami are the oldest surviving rock-cut caves in India.

2. The Barabar rock-cut caves were originally made for Ajivikas by Emperor Chandragupta Maurya.
3. At Ellora, caves were made for different faiths.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Directions (Qs. 11): The following questions consist of two statements, **Statement I** and **Statement II**. You are to examine these two statements carefully and select the answers to these questions using the codes given below Codes

- (a) Both the statements are true and Statement II is the correct explanation of Statement I
(b) Both the statements are true, but Statement II is not the correct explanation of Statement I
(c) Statement I is true, but Statement II is false
(d) Statement I is false, but Statement II is true
11. **Statement I:** There was great exodus of Jaina monks under the leadership of Bhadrabahu to the Deccan following severe famine in the Ganga valley towards the end of Chandragupta's reign.

Statement II: Chandragupta Maurya joined the Jaina

Matching Based MCQ

12. **List-I** **List-II**
- (A) Shunga dynasty (1) Narayan, Susharma Vasudev
(B) Kanva dynasty (2) Siemukh, Shatkarni, Krishna
(C) Satvahan dynasty (3) Kaniskha
(D) Shaka dynasty (4) Pushyamitra, Sujesthasak
- (a) A - 3, B - 4, C - 1, D - 2
(b) A - 2, B - 4, C - 3, D - 1
(c) A - 4, B - 1, C - 2, D - 3
(d) A - 1, B - 3, C - 4, D - 2

13. **List-I** **List-II**
- (Ashoka's contemporary rulers) (Countries where they ruled)
- A. Antiyoka 1. Cyrena
B. Autkina 2. Egypt
C. Maka 3. Macedonia
D. Turmaya 4. Syria

Codes:

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 1 | 4 | 2 | 3 |
| (b) | 2 | 1 | 3 | 4 |
| (c) | 3 | 2 | 4 | 1 |
| (d) | 4 | 3 | 1 | 2 |

14. **List-I** **List-II**
- A. Uttarapatha 1. Suvarnagiri
B. Dakshinapatha 2. Takshashila
C. Prashi 3. Tosali
D. Kalinga 4. Patliputra

Select the correct answer from the codes given below :

Codes:

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| (b) | 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| (c) | 3 | 4 | 2 | 1 |
| (d) | 4 | 3 | 1 | 2 |

15. **List-I** **List-II**
- A. Chandragupta Maurya 1. Amitrochates
B. Bindusar 2. Sandrocotts
C. Ashok 3. Devanampriya
D. Dasharatha 4. Buddha shakya

Codes:

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |
| (b) | 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| (c) | 3 | 4 | 2 | 1 |
| (d) | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |

16. **List-I** **List-II**
- A. Indo-Greek 1. Rudradaman
B. Shaka 2. Minandar
C. Parthiyau 3. Vim Kadfises
D. Kushan 4. Gondofarnis

Codes:

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 3 | 4 | 1 | 2 |
| (b) | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| (c) | 2 | 1 | 4 | 3 |
| (d) | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 |

17. **List-I** **List-II**
- A. Shunga 1. Prawarsen-I
B. Kanva 2. Kharvela
C. Chedi 3. Vasudeva
D. Vakataka 4. Bhagbhadra

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Codes:

- | | A | B | C | D |
|-----|---|---|---|---|
| (a) | 1 | 3 | 4 | 2 |
| (b) | 2 | 3 | 4 | 1 |
| (c) | 4 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| (d) | 3 | 4 | 2 | 1 |

Hints and Explanations

EXERCISE-1

1. (d) 2. (b) 3. (a) 4. (a) 5. (a)
6. (a) 7. (a) 8. (b) 9. (b) 10. (c)
11. (c) 12. (a) 13. (c) 14. (d) 15. (a)
16. (d) It was written by Samudragupta's court poet Harisena.
17. (c)
18. (d) 19. (b) 20. (c) 21. (c) 22. (b)
23. (c) 24. (b) 25. (b) 26. (d) 27. (c)
28. (d) 29. (d) 30. (d) 31. (d) 32. (b)
33. (d) 34. (c) 35. (d) 36. (b) 37. (c)
38. (c) 39. (b) 40. (b) 41. (c) 42. (b)
43. (d) 44. (a) 45. (c) 46. (c) 47. (c)
48. (d) 49. (d) 50. (b) 51. (b) 52. (d)
53. (d) 54. (c) 55. (c) 56. (b) 57. (d)
58. (a) 59. (a) 60. (b) 61. (a) 62. (d)
63. (d) 64. (c) 65. (a) 66. (d) 67. (c)
68. (a) 69. (d) 70. (d) 71. (b) 72. (b)
73. (c) 74. (a) 75. (d) 76. (b) 77. (a)
78. (c) 79. (d) 80. (a) 81. (d) 82. (d)
83. (d) 84. (b) 85. (d) 86. (c) 87. (d)
88. (a)
89. (b) In District administration each district was administered by 3 officers viz. Pradeshika, Rajuka, & Yukta. Pradeshika was senior and Rajuka was subordinate. Yukta was subordinate to both of them. The district administration was under the charge of Rajukas, whose position and functions are similar to modern collectors. He was assisted by Yuktas or subordinate officials. The rajjuka was responsible for surveying and assessing the land, fixing its rent and record keeping besides judicial functions.
90. (b) The edicts focus on social and moral precepts rather than religious practices or the philosophical dimension of Buddhism. Major themes are Ashoka's conversion to Buddhism, the description of his efforts to spread Buddhism, his moral and religious precepts, and his social and animal welfare programs.
91. (d) Mansehra and Shahbazgadhi inscriptions of ashoka are written in Aramaic language, Kharoshthi script. Shahbaz Garhi is an historic site located in Mardan District in the North West Frontier Province of Pakistan. Mansehra is located in Mansehra District, Khyber-Pakhtunkhwa province of Pakistan.
92. (a) The word Dhamma is the Prakrit version of the Sanskrit word Dharma. Ashoka's Dhamma is a philosophical entity that emphasizes on the high ideals in order to lead a successful life. He wanted everyone to live peacefully and co-exist in a harmonious environment.

93. (c) Kanishka was the first Indian ruler who has been shown in images as wearing a dress akin to trousers.
94. (b) During the rule of Maurya Dynasty Silver and Copper were used for minting coins.
95. (a) The highly polished monolithic Ashoka pillar usually with small black spots were quarried from the Chunar near Mirzapur.
96. (c) Ashoka's only inscribed stone portrait was found at Kanaganahalli, near Bhima river In Gulbarg district, Karnataka.
97. (c) Gandhara sculpture art is associated to Kushanas and it was developed during the period of Kanishka. This style is also called as Greek Buddh style. Its main centre is Bamian Swats Afghanistan.
98. (b) Ruling period of given dynasties is as follows :
Nanda (344 BC-323 BC); Maurya (323 BC-184 BC); Sunga (184 BC- 75 BC) and Kanva (75 BC-30BC)
99. (b) Chandra Gupta Maurya was the founder of Maurya dynasty. Megosthenes, the Greek ambaseddor lived in her court.
100. (c)
101. (b) Chandragupta Maurya-II expanded his kingdom/ empire through matrimonial relationship and conquests.
102. (c)

EXERCISE-2

1. (b)
 2. (c) Pushyamitra founded the Sunga dynasty by killing the last Mauryan ruler Brihadrath and the last Sunga ruler Devabhuti was killed by his minister Vasudeva Kanva.
 3. (a) 4.(b) 5. (b) 6. (d) 7. (d)
 8. (c)
 9. (d) Pusyamitra Sunga is said to have performed the Ashvamedha rite after he toppled Mauryan rule in 185 BC. A historically documented performance of the Ashvamedha is during the reign of Samudragupta I (died 380), the father of Chandragupta II. Special coins were minted to commemorate the Ashvamedha and the king took on the title of Maharajadhiraja after successful completion of the sacrifice.
- Vakataka Dynasty 3rd (Century -5th Century AD) was founded by Vindhyaashakti. Pravarasena I was the real founder of Vakataka empire. He performed four Asvamedha Yajnas.
- Pulakesin I was a monarch from the Chalukya dynasty in the western Deccan region. Pulakesin performed sacrifices like Asvamedha, Hiranyagarbha, Agnistoma, Vajapeya, Bahusuvarna

and Paundarika. These details are provided by his Badami Cliff inscription dated Saka 565 (543 CE).

10. (b) The Barabar rock cut caves are the oldest rock cut caves. They were originally made for the Ajivikas during the Mauryan period (322-185 BCE). The Ellora caves were built between 5th century and 10th century. There were 34 caves out of which 12 were Buddhist caves, 17 were Hindu caves and 5 were Jain caves. The proximity of the caves clearly demonstrates the religious harmony prevalent at that period of time.
11. (a) The important occasion of Chandragupta Maurya's reign was the forecast of a twelve years famine. At that time Acharya Bhadrabahu was the head of the Jain church. According to the Jain text Rajvaliya Katha, the king saw sixteen dreams. He requested Bhadrabahu to interpret the dreams. The latter explained all the dreams and according to the last one, he predicted a famine of twelve years. Chandragupta, who was a follower of Bhadrabahu, gave up his throne. He finally ended his life following the Jain fashion.
12. (c)
13. (d) The correct match list is :

Rulers	Country
Antiyoka	Syria
Antikini	Macedonia
Maka	Cyrena
Turmaya	Egypt

In his thirteenth inscription Ashoka mentions five Greek contemporary kings-Antiyoka (Syria 261-246 B. C.) Turamaya (Egypt, upto 247 B.C.), Kairina Kamar (300-250 B.C.) Alike Sundara (Apiran, 272-258 B.C.), Autkina (Macedonia 278—339 B.C.).

Historians find that all these rulers were thus before 258 B. C. The ruler of Apiran died in 258 B. C. but it finds mention in Ashoka's inscription.

14. (b) The Mauryan empire was divided into provinces and the provinces divided into districts. Provinces during the Mauryan age with their capital were: Uttarapatha-Taxila; Dakshinapatha-Suvarnagiri; Prachya-Pataliputra; Kalinga-Tosali; Avantiratha-Ujjain. Ashoka appointed a representative in each province. The representatives were chosen for their ability and not on the basis of birth or high connections. They enjoyed considerable freedom in the administration of their provinces.
15. (b) In foreign Greek and Latin accounts, Chandragupta is known as Sandrocottos and Androcottus. He became well known in the Hellenistic world for conquering Alexander the Great's easternmost satrapies, and for defeating the most powerful of Alexander's successors, Seleucus I Nicator, in battle.

Bindusara Maurya (c. 320 BC – 272 BC) was emperor of the Maurya Empire from 298 BC – 272 BC. During his reign, the empire expanded southwards. The Greeks called him Amitrochates or Allitrochades – the Greek transliteration for the Sanskrit word 'Amitraghata' (Slayer of enemies).

In the third century B.C.E., King Ashoka of the Maurya dynasty supported and protected Buddhism and erected stupas and stone pillars at sites associated with Shakyamuni Buddha.

Dasaratha is known to have dedicated three caves in the Nagarjuni Hills to the Ajivikas. Three inscriptions at the cave refer to him as 'Devanampiya Dasaratha'

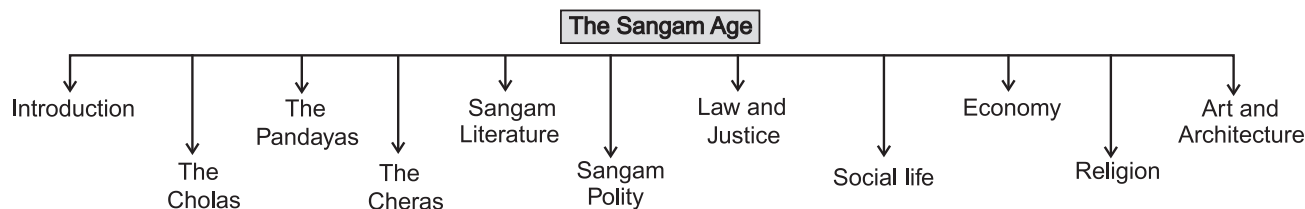
16. (c) 17. (d)



Introduction

Sanskrit word ‘Sangha’ means a group of persons or an association. The Tamil Sangam was an academy of poets and bards, who flourished in three different periods and in different places under the patronage of the Pandyan kings. The Sangam literature speaks highly of three south Indian Kingdoms—Chola, Pandya and Chera. The earliest reference that we find about this era is preserved in three forms: Ashokan inscriptions, Sangam literature and Megasthenese accounts.

The three important kingdoms of the Cholas, the Pandyas and the Cheras, combinedly was known as **Tamilakam**. The Aryan influence did not penetrate to this distant region till the fourth century B.C., but our knowledge of ‘the country and its people belonging to the pre-Christian era is meager and indirect. The ancient literature of Tamils, known as the **Sangam literature**, is very massive, but it hardly fulfils the demands of history and chronology.



THE CHOLAS

The kingdom of the Cholas with its capital at **Kaveripattanam** was started from Kavery delta to the adjoining region of modern Tanjore and Trichinopoly. One of their early kings, **Karikala** (A.D. 190), who figures very prominently in ancient literature, is credited with victories over the rulers of the neighbouring Pandya and Chera kingdoms and is believed to have even extended his authority over **Ceylon**. Towards the beginning of the fourth century A.D., the power of the Cholas began to decline mainly because of the rise of Pallavas on one hand and the continuous wars waged by the Pandyas and the Cheras on the other.

THE PANDAYAS

The kingdom of the Pandyas with its capital at **Madurai** extended to the modern districts of Madura, Ramnad, Tinnevely and the southern parts of Travancore. References to the Pandyas occur in ancient literary works like the **Mahabharata** and the **Jatakas** as well as in Indica of Megasthenes. According to Ashokan edicts, the Pandyas were independent people living

beyond the southern border of the Maurya empire. A Pandya king is also known to have sent an embassy to the court of the Roman emperor **Augustus** and Trojan.

The Three Southern Kingdoms

Kingdoms	Capital	Emblems	Famous port
Cholas	Uraiyur, late Puhar	Tiger	Puhar (Kaveripattanam)
Cheras	Vanji or Karur	Bow	Muzris, Tondi, Bandar
Pandayas	Madurai	Carp	Korkai, Saliyur

THE CHERAS

The earliest reference to the Chera (Keralaputra) kingdom can be traced in the Ashokan inscriptions. It comprised the modern districts of Malabar, Cochin and Northern Travancore. Its capital was **Vanji**, which is identified by some with a site of Periyar River, by others with Karur or Karuvur located in the western most Taluq of the Trichinopoly district.

The people of Chera Kingdoms were a sea-faring people who, established close commercial relationship with Egypt and the Roman Empire. Tondi, Musiri, Kaveripathanam and Korkai were among the well-known trade centres of Peninsular India.

SANGAM LITERATURE

Sangam was an association or assembly of Tamil poets held probably under chiefly or royal patronage. But we do not know the number of Sangams or the period for which they were held. The Sangam literature was compiled in circa A.D. 300-600. But parts of this literature look back to at least the second century A.D. The Sangam literature can roughly be divided into two groups, **narrative** and **didactic**. The narrative texts are considered works of **heroic poetry** in which heroes are glorified and perpetual wars and cattle raids frequently mentioned. The didactic texts cover the early centuries of the Christian era and prescribe a code of conduct not only for the king and his court but also for various social groups and occupations. All this could have been possible only after the fourth century A.D. when Brahmanas appeared in good numbers under the Pallavas.

Sangam literature consists of the earliest Tamil works (such as **Tolkappiyam**), the **Ettutogai** (Eight Anthologies) the **Pattuppattu** (Ten Idylls), the **Padanenkilkanakku** (Eighteen Minor works) and the three epics.

Earliest Tamil Works were the **Agattiyam** (a work on grammar of letters and life) by Rishi Agastya, Pannirupadalam (a grammatical work on puram literature) by 12 disciples of Agastya the Kakkipadiniyam (a work on prosody) and Tolkappiyam (a treatise on grammar and poetry). It is divided into three sections each consisting of nine sub chapters and has a total of 1,612 sutras by Talkappiya (.)

The three **epics** were **Silappadikaram**, **Mianimekalai** and **Sivaga Sidamanai**.

The last epic shows the dominance of Sanskrit style over the indigenous style of the previous epics.

Apart from Sangam texts we have a text called **Tolkappiyam**, written by *Tolkappiar* which deals with grammar and poetics. It is the only work which has survived from the second Sangam. Another important Tamil text deals with philosophy and wise maxims; this text is called **Tirukkural**. Addition to this we have the twin Tamil epics of **Silappadikaram** and **Mainmekalai**. The first deals with a love story in which a dignitary called Kovalan prefers a courtesan called Madhavi of Kaveripattanam to his noble wedded wife Kannagi. The author apparently seems to be a Jaina and tries to locate the scenes of the story in all the kingdoms of the Tamil country. The other epic Manimekalai deals with the adventures of the daughter born of the union of Kovalan and Madhavi though this epic is of more religious than literary interest. Though the epics cannot be dated so early, they throw light on the social and economic life of the Tamils upto about the sixth century A.D.

Sangam Terms

Enadi	–	Captain of army
Vallalas	–	Rich peasants
Arasar	–	Ruling class
Orrar	–	Spies
Avai	–	Small village assembly
Irai/Karai	–	Land tax
Ulgu/sungam	–	Tolls and custom duties
Nagar	–	Temple
Perundaram	–	Higher officials
Sirutaram	–	Lower officials
Avanam	–	Market place
Panar	–	Birds
Vedars	–	Hunters
Marakkhdi	–	Warrior class
Kuravar	–	Hill tribes
Varalis	–	Dancing girls
Lamaram	–	Missile
Kalavu	–	Sacred marriage
Umanar	–	Salt maker
Korravai	–	Goddess of victory
Kadurai	–	Diety of forest
Eripatti	–	Tank

SANGAM POLITY

The Tamils during the Sangam period were ruled by powerful kings. The kings were regarded as **Vendar** while the local chieftains were called **Mannar**.

The form of government was hereditary monarchy. The eldest son usually succeeded the father.

The crowned king held impressive courts to which the subjects were allowed. There was conspicuous absence of Privy Council or a Council Chamber. **The king was regarded as God**. The theory of divine right of kingship was accepted. But he was always assisted and guided by wise men whether a minister, or a poet or a purohitar. These wise men were divided into two categories—**Aimperukulu** consisting of Purohita, the army chief, the ambassador, the spies and the ministers; and **Enperayam** consisting of accountants, executive officials, treasury officials, palace guards, and the leading men among his subjects. Wars occurred on the pretext of cattle-lifting.

Aimperukku Officials

Purohitar	–	Priest
Senapatiyar	–	Army Chief
Amaichhar	–	Minister
Dutar	–	Ambassador
Orrar	–	Spy
Enadi	–	Captain of the army
Umanchatha	–	Collector of merchandise from different regions
Makamattor	–	Members of a guild
Veellalar	–	Rich peasants

Enperayam Officials

Karanattiyalavar	–	Accountant
Karumakarar	–	Executive officials
Kanasassurram	–	Treasury Officials
Kdaikappalar	–	Palace guards

Nagaramandar	– Leading men among the king's subjects
Padaittalaivar	– Chiefs of the infantry
Yanai Virar	– Chiefs of elephantry
Ivuli	– Chiefs of cavalry

LAW AND JUSTICE

Sangam literature does not describe any posts of Judge disputes were settled by learned men of high character, and the judgement was based on integrity and impartiality. The Cholas have gained great respect because of this. The king was the supreme magistrate. The town court was called '*Avai*' and the village court was known as '*Manrams*' which might have been pachayats, were distributed across *Mandalam* (kingdom) in *Nadu* (districts) and *Ur* (town).

SOCIAL LIFE

The Sangam society was based on binary fission, i.e.

1. Vyarntoc (high born people),
2. Ilipirappalar (low born people)

However, Tholkappian mentions, about four categories of castes–

- | | |
|--------------------------|------------------------|
| (i) Andanar (Brahmanas) | (ii) Arasar (kings) |
| (iii) Vaisiyar (Traders) | (iv) Velalar (Farmers) |

Moreover, these were communities, called parciyas experienced untouchability among higher classes.

Position of Women

Women took part in various fields like–

- They contributed in literature, evidence is from their poetry.
- Women were allowed to choose their life-partners, i.e. *love-marriage* was permitted.
- *Widows* lived a miserable life and *sati* system was practiced in higher classes of society.
- The kings and nobles patronised dancers for their entertainment.

ECONOMY

The Sangam economy was most prosperous. The common people were included agriculturists or cow-herders, hunters and fisherman. Indigenous industries such as textile, weapon making, ship-building, carpentry, metal smelting, etc. There were also a large number of merchants who indulged in comprehensive trade with foreign countries particularly with Rome. Roman coins of **Augustus Caesar's** period have been found in a large number in South India.

But, South Indians did not have a system of coinage and they bartered their goods. Examples of honey and roots exchanged for fish-oil and of sugarcane and cornflakes for venison and toddy find its mention.

Economic Groups of people

Group	Work
(i) Kuravar	– Practicing shifting agriculture
(ii) Idaiyar	– rearing and keeping cattles
(iii) Vetar	– hunting and gathering foods
(iv) Ulavar	– ploughing land for crops
(v) Kallar	– plundering i.e., cattle lifting
(vi) Panar	– wandering bards
(vii) Paratavar	– fishing
(viii) Umnar	– salt-manufacturing

RELIGION

Sangam religion is based on the synthesis of the non-Aryan Tamils and the Aryan vedic deities. The people of Sangam Tamil generally worshiped stones, water, stars and planets. The Sangam religious worship is classified into three categories–

- (i) Worship of indigenous Gods,
- (ii) Worship of exotic Hindu Gods
- (iii) Worship or faith in the exotic non-Hindu rituals.

The people worshipped *Murugan*, *Tirumal*, *Balram* and *Indra* in the temple known as Nagar, Koil, Kottam, Purai or Devalayam. The worship of Vedic deities was also not uncommon. The Vedic practice of Yagna (Velvi) Sraddha and Panda were practised by the Sangam people. Varna-system took roots even in the South. The influence of Buddhism, Jainism and Ajivikas was paramount.

ART AND ARCHITECTURE

The temples of South India had a distinct Dravidian style which is different from the Nagara style of the North Indian temples. The Kailash Temple at Ellora, Hoysala temple at Belur and Halebid, Chennakesava temple at Belur, the Hoysaleswara temple at Halebid, Ratha and **Shore** temple at **Mahabalipuram**, Brihadeshwara temple at Tanjavur, Vithala temple at Hampi, and Meenakshi Temple at Madurai are fine examples of architecture.

Points to Remember

- The Sangam literature speaks highly of three South Indian Kingdoms – Chola, Pandaya and Chera.
- The kingdom of Chola started from Kavery delta to adjoining areas of modern Tanjore and **Trichinopoly Kaveripattanam** was its capital.
- **Karikala** (AD 190) was an important Chola ruler who extended his authority over Ceylon.
- The Pandayas were independent people living beyond the southern border of Mauryan empire.
- The **Kingdom of Pandayas** was extended to modern districts of Madura, Ramnad, Tinnevely and parts of Travancore. **Madurai** was its capital.
- The **Chera kingdom** comprised modern districts of Malabar, Cochin and northern Travancore. Its capital was Vanji. This kingdom had a close commercial relationship with Egypt and Roman empire.
- Sangam literature was compiled in AD 300-600.
- Sangam literature can be divided into two groups – narrative and didactic.
- The Tamils during the Sangam period were ruled by powerful kings. The form of government was hereditary monarchy.
- Sangam literature does not describe any post of Judge. The king was the supreme magistrate.
- The Sangam economy was prosperous. The common people were engaged in agriculture, cow-herding, hunting, fishing, textiles, weapon making etc.
- The Sangam people worshipped Murugan, Tirumal, and Balram. The worship of Vedic deities was also not uncommon.

Exercise -1

1. Consider the following passage and identify the three tribal principalities referred to therein using the code given below. In the early history of the far South in India, three tribal principalities are mentioned in Ashokan inscriptions of the third century BC and in Kharavela inscription of the third century BC and in Kharavela inscription of the first century BC.
 - (a) Vakatakas, Cholas and Satvahanas
 - (b) Cholas, Pandyas and Cheras
 - (c) Ikshvakus, Vakatakas and Pandyas
 - (d) Pallavas, Cholas and Pandyas
2. Which of the following statement about the institution of kingship during this period is not correct?
 - (a) The form of government was hereditary monarchy
 - (b) The king, whose conquering expedition (march of Digvijaya) was led by a mysterious wheel of gold and gem, was called Chakravartin
 - (c) The crown prince was called Komahan
 - (d) In the Sangam literature we come across numerous instances of women rulers
3. The last anthology or group of Sangam literature, known as 'Ten Idylls', is :
 - (a) Tolkappiyam
 - (b) Kural
 - (c) Manimekalai
 - (d) Pattupattu
4. The word 'Sangam' is associated in Tamil history with:
 - (a) The literature produced during the reign of the great Pallava dynasty of Kanchi
 - (b) The poems written in praise of the Pandyan kings of the early Christian era
 - (c) The court poetry of Chola kings who were famous for patronizing artists
 - (d) A college or assembly (literary academy) of Tamil scholars held under the royal patronage of Pandyan kings at Madurai.
5. Which of the following was not one of the ideas of Sanskrit literature incorporated into Sangam literature?
 - (a) Worship of Indra as the principal deity
 - (b) Arundhati as the ideal of chastity
 - (c) The concept of three-fold debt (trinatra) of man
 - (d) Uttar-Kuru (northern country) as a land of perpetual enjoyment
6. Which of the following dynasties were constantly at war with the Cheras during the later Sangam Age?
 - (a) Chola
 - (b) Pandya
 - (c) Ikshvaku
 - (d) Pallava
7. Which of the following does not testify to the impact of Aryan culture on the Sangam Age?
 - (a) Incorporation of Sanskrit ideas into Sangam literature
 - (b) The anxiety to connect the local dynasties with the events of Mahabharata
 - (c) The worship of the forest tree and animal deities
 - (d) The concept of marriage as a sacrament attended with rituals
8. To which of the following dynasties did Karikala, the famous king of this period, belong?
 - (a) Chera
 - (b) Chola
 - (c) Pandya
 - (d) Pallava
9. Which of the following was not one of the royal dynasties of the Tamil country during the Sangam Age?
 - (a) Pandya
 - (b) Pallava
 - (c) Chera
 - (d) Chola
10. The Greco-Roman merchants visiting South India during the Sangam Age were referred to in the Tamil literature as:
 - (a) Yavanas
 - (b) Pahalvas
 - (c) Yauvanas
 - (d) Ayyavanas
11. Which of the following products of the Sangam Age is considered to be the greatest monument of ancient Tamil literature?
 - (a) Tolkappiyam
 - (b) Padienenkilkanakku
 - (c) Ettutogai
 - (d) Pattupattu
12. The basis, on which the chronology or period of the Sangam literature is fixed between the first to third century A.D., is:
 - (a) King Gajabahu I of Sri Lanka was contemporary of the Chera monarch Senaguttuvan
 - (b) Striking similarity between the Sangam poems and the Greco-Roman accounts on trade
 - (c) Both (a) and (b)
 - (d) Reference to the Chola-Chera-Pandya' kingdoms in Ashokan edicts
13. The centre of Sangam literature and the patrons of Sangam poets were:
 - (a) The Cheras of Vanji
 - (b) The Cholas of Uraiyur
 - (c) The Pandyas of Madurai
 - (d) All of the above
14. The current Tamil designation of the ministers during the Sangam Age was:
 - (a) Amaichchan or Amaichchar
 - (b) Mantri
 - (c) Amatya
 - (d) Surram
15. The term 'Variyam' during the Sangam Age signified the:
 - (a) Revenue-free villages granted to Brahmanas
 - (b) Unit of revenue yielding territory
 - (c) Officer-in-charge collecting the land revenue
 - (d) Managing committee of the village assemblies
16. The spies during the Sangam Age were known as:
 - (a) Spasas
 - (b) Dutas
 - (c) Orrars
 - (d) Sanjayans
17. Which of the following works provides a beautiful account of Madurai during the Sangam Age?
 - (a) Manimekalai
 - (b) Silappadikaram
 - (c) Kural or Tirukural
 - (d) Pattupattu
18. Small village Assemblies during the Sangam Age were known as:
 - (a) Manaram
 - (b) Ambalam
 - (c) Avai
 - (d) Podiyil
19. Which of the following was not one of the conventional checks on a king's power?
 - (a) Customs
 - (b) Maxims of the wise
 - (c) Occasional intercessions of the ministers
 - (d) Dictates of the priests
20. The provinces during the Sangam Age were known as Mandalams and Mandalams were further subdivided into:
 - (a) Nadu
 - (b) Kurram
 - (c) Kottam
 - (d) Ur

21. During the Sangam Age, war was usually declared or provoked by:
 - (a) Cutting the tutelary tree of the enemy
 - (b) Lifting the cattle of the enemy
 - (c) Besieging the enemy's fort
 - (d) Crushing the crops of the enemy's territory under the feet of elephants
22. Which of the following statements about the manaram, the Sabha of this period, is not correct?
 - (a) It was the common meeting place in the village
 - (b) It was the highest court of justice
 - (c) It also served the purpose of a political gathering
 - (d) It was a general assembly dealing with all affairs
23. Which of the following statements about the army of the king is not correct?
 - (a) The army traditionally had four arms, namely, chariots drawn by oxen, elephants, cavalry and infantry
 - (b) The captains of the army were invested with the title of Enadi
 - (c) The soldiers wounded in battle were well attended
 - (d) Death on the battlefield was considered to lead to heaven
24. During the Sangam Age a tutelary tree called Kadimaram or Kavalmararam was planted by the rulers at a central place in the town and they took great care to protect the tree because:
 - (a) It was believed that the tree had power to protect the town
 - (b) The destruction of the tree was symbolic of the defeat of the ruler
 - (c) Both (a) and (b)
 - (d) The tree was symbolic dynastic growth
25. Which of the following is not one of the sources from which evidence of Indo-Roman trade during the Sangam Age is derived?
 - (a) Sangam literature
 - (b) The Roman coins of silver and gold found on the South Indian coast
 - (c) Discovery of a Roman hoard at Arikamedu, near Pondicherry
 - (d) The accounts of Chinese and Roman travellers
26. Which of the following was the most important factor responsible for the extensive growth of foreign trade?
 - (a) Surplus production of several commodities which were in great demand in foreign markets
 - (b) Tamils had a great reputation as seafarers
 - (c) There was a direct trade route between Tamil land and Arabia, Egypt and Rome
 - (d) Because the Yavanas (i.e. the Romans, The Greeks and The Egyptians) had colonized certain parts of South India
27. Writing about the volume of Indo-Roman trade, who bitterly remarked "not a year passed without the (Roman) Empire paying out 100 million sesterces (nearly one and a half-crore rupees) to India, to the Chera land and Arabia"?
 - (a) Ptolemy
 - (b) Pliny
 - (c) Author of Periplus
 - (d) Caldwell
28. A good contemporary account of the trade between the Tamil States of the Sangam Age and Greece and Rome has been given in :
 - (a) Das Wurfelspiel in alten Indien
 - (b) The Sangam work Pattinapalai
 - (c) Periplus of the Erythrean Sea
 - (d) Ptolemy's Geography
29. The chief centre or meeting point of the Indo-Roman trade was:
 - (a) Arikamedu
 - (b) Alexandria
 - (c) Madurai
 - (d) Muziris
30. The richest and biggest land-owning class during the Sangam Age were:
 - (a) Brahmanas
 - (b) Velas
 - (c) Nayaks
 - (d) Ulavar
31. Which of the following statements regarding the collections of revenue is not correct?
 - (a) The leading members of the cowherds community paid revenue in the form of milk and milk products
 - (b) Orrar was incharge of the Revenue Department
 - (c) Ayakkarar was the revenue accountant who collected trade and transit duties
 - (d) The royal seal was fixed on the packet of imported and exported goods after realizing the custom duties
32. Karikala, the Chola king, made a grand anicut on the Kaveri, the water of which nowadays drawn off through a new channel called Vennar. Which of the following regions of Tamil Nadu does it irrigate?
 - (a) West Madurai
 - (b) South Arcot
 - (c) South Thanjavur
 - (d) Chingleput
33. Which of the following was not one of the better known agricultural products of the Sangam Age?
 - (a) Wheat
 - (b) Rice
 - (c) Sugar-cane
 - (d) Turmeric
34. It is said that in Chola territory, watered by Kaveri, the space in which an elephant could lie down produced enough to feed seven persons. What does this statement imply?
 - (a) The elephants were rated very highly among the domesticated animals
 - (b) The lands were very fertile with enough irrigation facilities
 - (c) The economy was mainly agricultural
 - (d) There was a large agricultural surplus
35. Which of the following was not one of the methods of disposal of the dead practiced in the Sangam Age?
 - (a) Cremation
 - (b) Simple burial
 - (c) Urn burial
 - (d) Giving watery grave to the dead
36. Which of the following was a great customs port with an artificial harbour?
 - (a) Musiri or Muziris
 - (b) Tondi
 - (c) Puhar (Kaveripumpattinam)
 - (d) Uraiyur
37. Which of the following non-Aryan social beliefs has been continuing in Tamil Nadu since the Sangam Age?
 - (a) Children wearing an ornament on which the five weapons of Tirumala are punched
 - (b) Wearing of Tali by bride or married woman
 - (c) Shaving the head of the widows
 - (d) Offering a ball of cooked rice to the departed soul
38. Which of the following was great centre of cotton trade?
 - (a) Uraiyur
 - (b) Korkai
 - (c) Tondi
 - (d) Musiri or Muziris
39. The Chera king who is said to have gone to North India to get a Himalayan stone to make the image of Goddess Kannagi was:
 - (a) Imayavaramban
 - (b) Senaguttuvan
 - (c) Kuttuvancheral
 - (d) Nedumcheral Adan

40. Which of the following institutions did not exist during the Sangam Age?
 (a) Slavery (b) Sati
 (c) Ritualistic marriage (d) Courtesans
41. After the death of which one of the following Roman kings was the trade conducted more by barter than by coins on account of the financial difficulties of the Roman Empire?
 (a) Augustus (b) Claudius
 (c) Pius (d) Nero
42. Which of the following was not one of the important articles of export?
 (a) Spice and perfumes (b) Jewels
 (c) Fine textiles (d) Sugar
43. Which of the following was not one of the reasons why India had a favourable balance of trade with the West?
 (a) Great demand for Indian luxury goods
 (b) Import of gold by India in return for her exports
 (c) Imports of coins by India
 (d) Better business sense of Indian traders
44. A Tamil king who is said to have sent the earliest embassy to Augustus at Athens about 20 BC was a _____ king:
 (a) Pandyan (b) Chola
 (c) Chera (d) Pallava
45. Which of the following was the main article of import?
 (a) Gold and silver (b) Pottery and glassware
 (c) Wine and slave girls (d) Horses
46. Which of the following was the wonderful discovery made by Hippalus in A.D. 45, leading to increasing of trade with Rome?
 (a) Fitting of sails to the ships
 (b) Propelling of ship with mechanical aid
 (c) The existence of the monsoon winds, blowing across the Indian Ocean
 (d) A shorter route for Rome to the eastern coast of India
47. The sea borne trade between India and Rome received great impetus during the first-second century A.D. on account of the discovery of:
 (a) Direct sea-route between India and Italy
 (b) Monsoon winds blowing regularly across the Indian Ocean
 (c) Large gold mines in the Roman Empire
 (d) New navigational techniques
48. Which of the following was not one of the popular deities of the Sangam Age?
 (a) Indra and Murugan (b) Siva and Vishnu
 (c) Krishna and Balaram (d) Ganesha
49. Monuments (Herostones) for the dead soldiers bearing their names, which were erected and worshiped during the Sangam Age, were known as:
 (a) Nadukul (b) Virakkal
 (c) Both (a) and (b) (d) Mahavirakkal
50. One of the religious beliefs of the Sangam people, which was primitive in nature, was:
 (a) Worship of totemic symbols
 (b) Ancestor worship
 (c) Worship of stars and planets
 (d) Worship of the Gods and Goddess of the hill-side
51. Which of the following statements about the social structure of the Sangam Age is not correct?
 (a) The difference in the status and economic conditions was well accepted and rarely challenged by the people
 (b) Sangam literature mentions three regular varnas, namely, Brahmins, Kshatriyas and Vaisyas
 (c) There were four castes, namely, Tudiyan, Panan, Paraiyan and Kadamban
 (d) People were organized in professional social groups living apart from one-another
52. At Puhar or Kaveripumpattinam a great festival, described vividly by the Sangam Epic, was held in honour of Lord:
 (a) Venkateswara (b) Murugan
 (c) Indra (d) Svamimalai
53. Which of the following was not one of the popular beliefs and customs prevalent during the Sangam Age?
 (a) There was much faith in omens and astrology
 (b) A woman with dishevelled hair was a bad omen
 (c) Rites were performed to avert the mischief of demons
 (d) Eclipses were believed to be the result of Rahu and Ketu eating up the sun and the moon
54. The most favourite God of the Tamils during the Sangam Age was:
 (a) Indra (b) Murugan
 (c) Tirumal (d) Varuna
55. Which of the following statements about the position of women in the Sangam Age is not correct?
 (a) Higher class women officiated as priests
 (b) Women were employed as guards to attend on the king in the military camps
 (c) The women performing sati used to earn fame
 (d) Women do not seem to have owned property
56. A righteous government to the Sangam Tamils meant one which:
 (a) Promoted agriculture and trade
 (b) Maintained social solidarity
 (c) Provided correct, quick and straight justice
 (d) Pursued social and ethical values
57. Which of the following Sangam works tries to expound the excellence of Buddhism?
 (a) Manimekalai (b) Silappadikaram
 (c) Kurla (d) Tokappiyam
58. The increased commercial intercourse between India and Rome led to the writing of large number of books by the western authors on India and on Indian _____.
 (a) Economy (b) Social life
 (c) Geography (d) All of the above
59. The Ramaka Sidhanta and Paulisa Siddhanta, freely alluded to by the great Indian astronomer Varahmihira, indicate:
 (a) Roman influence on Indian astronomy
 (b) Knowledge of Roman geography
 (c) Adoption of western astronomical terms by the Indian astronomers
 (d) Close interaction between Roman and Indian astronomers
60. In which of the following respects did the Romans not profoundly influenced Indian life and culture?
 (a) Coinage (b) Art
 (c) Astronomy (d) Fashions
61. The Goddess Kannagi, whose many temples were erected during the Sangam Age, was the Goddess of:
 (a) Wisdom (b) Learning
 (c) Chastity (d) Prowess
62. Sangam literature formed a very important source for the reconstruction of the history of South India. It was written in
 (a) Tamil (b) Kannada
 (c) Telugu (d) Malayalam

Exercise -2

Statement Based MCQ

- Consider the following statements
 - The three literary academics of Sangam literature were at Madurai
 - The akam genre of Tamil poetics dealt with the praise of kings.
 - The poems of the Puran genre had their own tinai and turais.
 - Each akam poem had to follow the nation of turai which had its own deity, biological organisms, subsistence pattern, musical instruments and songs.

Which of these statements is/are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 3 and 4
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 2 and 4

- Consider the following statements
 - Naval expeditions of Rajaraja I occupied parts of Burma, Malaya and Sumatra.
 - Rajendra I conquered Ceylon.
 - The Cholas held northern Ceylon until they were expelled by Vijayabahu I.
 - The Cholas fell in the 13th century when their territory was shared by the Hoysalas and Pandyas.

Which of the above statements is/ are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 3 and 4
(c) 2, 3 and 4 (d) 4 only

- Consider the following statements about the temples built by cholas -
 - The earliest chola temple dating from 10th century is the one at Dadapuram in South Arcot.
 - The huge chola temples of Tanjore and Gangaikonda - Cholaipuram are marked by their lofty towers.
 - The later chola temples have mighty gopurans or gateways

Which of the above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) None

- Arrange the following into sequential order and select the correct answer using the codes given below.
 - Rajaraja Chola I
 - Aditya Chola
 - Rajendra Chola
 - Parantaka Chola I

Codes:

- (a) 1, 2, 3, 4 (b) 2, 4, 1, 3
(c) 1, 2, 4, 3 (d) 2, 1, 3, 4

- Given below are the two statements one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other labelled as Reason (R) :

Assertion (A) : Advanced farming during the Sangam Age remained absolutely confined to small pockets of wet-land in the valleys of Kaveri, Vaigai, Tamraparni and periyar without any remarkable progress till the 7th-8th centuries.

Reason (R) : Setting fire to standing crops and destruction of settlements (ceri) was common during the Sangam Age : In the context of the above two statements which one of the following is correct?

- (a) Both A and R are true but R is the correct explanation of A
(b) both A and R are true but R is not a correct explanation of A
(c) A is false but R is true
(d) A is true but R is false

Matching Based MCQ

- Match List 'A' with 'B' and choose the correct answer from the options given below:

- | A | B |
|------------------------|-------------|
| (1) Bull flag | (a) Shivan |
| (2) Peacock flag | (b) Murugan |
| (3) Garuda flag | (c) Tirumal |
| (4) The mace | (d) Kurram |
| (a) 1-a, 2-c, 3-b, 4-d | |
| (b) 1-d, 2-b, 3-c, 4-a | |
| (c) 1-a, 2-b, 3-c, 4-d | |
| (d) 1-d, 2-c, 3-b, 4-a | |

- Match List 'I' with 'II' and select the correct answer from the options given below the lists:

- | A | B |
|--------------------|--------------------------|
| (A) Pon-vanikan | (1) Textile merchant |
| (B) Aruvai-vanikan | (2) Toddy merchant |
| (C) Kolu-vanikan | (3) Salt merchant |
| (D) Uppu-vanikan | (4) Gold merchant |
| (E) Panita-vanikan | (5) Ploughshare merchant |

Codes :

- | A | B | C | D | E |
|-------|---|---|---|---|
| (a) 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| (b) 4 | 5 | 3 | 2 | 1 |
| (c) 4 | 1 | 2 | 3 | 5 |
| (d) 4 | 1 | 5 | 3 | 2 |

Hints and Explanations

EXERCISE-1

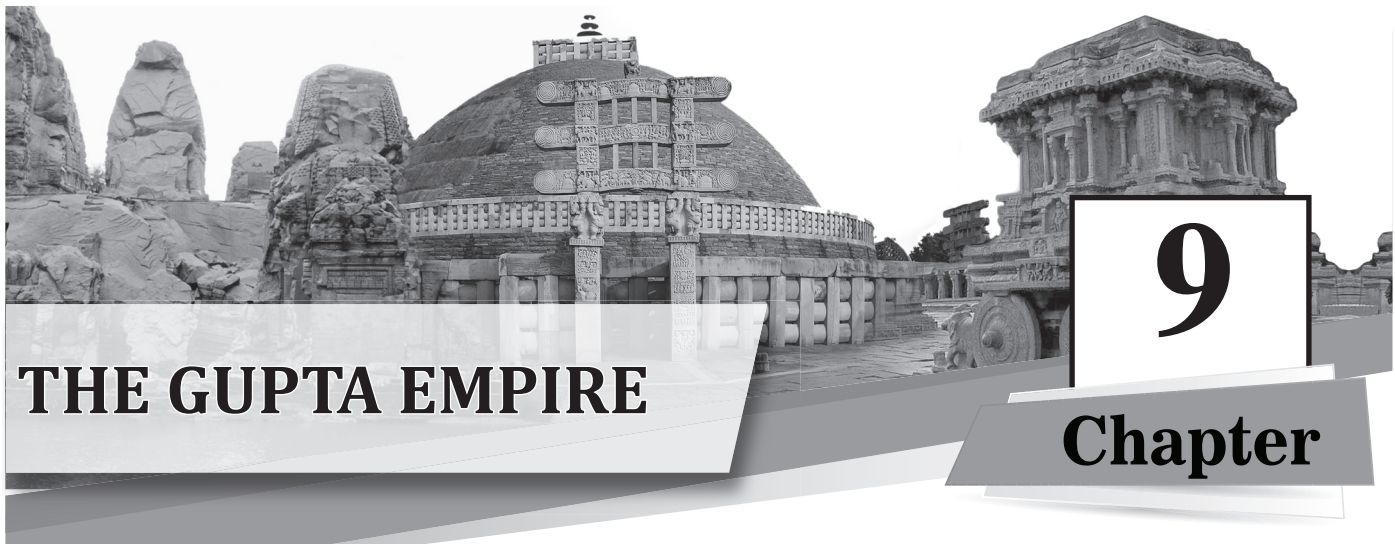
1. (b) The Edicts of Ashoka (Ashokan inscription) are a collection of 33 inscriptions on the Pillars of Ashoka, as boulders and cave walls, made by the Emperor Ashoka of the Maurayan dynasty during his reign 269 BC to 231 BC. These inscriptions are dispersed throughout the areas of modern day Bangladesh, India, Nepal and Pakistan. In the Ashoka inscriptions there were three south Indian states cholas, Pandayas and cheras was in existence.

2. (d) 3. (d) 4. (d) 5. (a) 6. (b)
 7. (c) 8. (b) 9. (b) 10. (a) 11. (c)
 12. (c) 13. (c) 14. (a) 15. (b) 16. (c)
 17. (a) 18. (c) 19. (d) 20. (c) 21. (b)
 22. (c) 23. (c) 24. (c) 25. (d) 26. (a)
 27. (b) 28. (c) 29. (b) 30. (b) 31. (b)
 32. (c) 33. (a) 34. (b) 35. (d) 36. (c)

37. (b) 38. (a) 39. (b) 40. (a) 41. (d)
 42. (d) 43. (d) 44. (a) 45. (a) 46. (c)
 47. (b) 48. (d) 49. (c) 50. (a) 51. (b)
 52. (c) 53. (d) 54. (b) 55. (a) 56. (c)
 57. (a) 58. (c) 59. (a) 60. (d) 61. (c)
 62. (a) The poems belonging to the Sangam literature were composed by Tamil poets.

EXERCISE-2

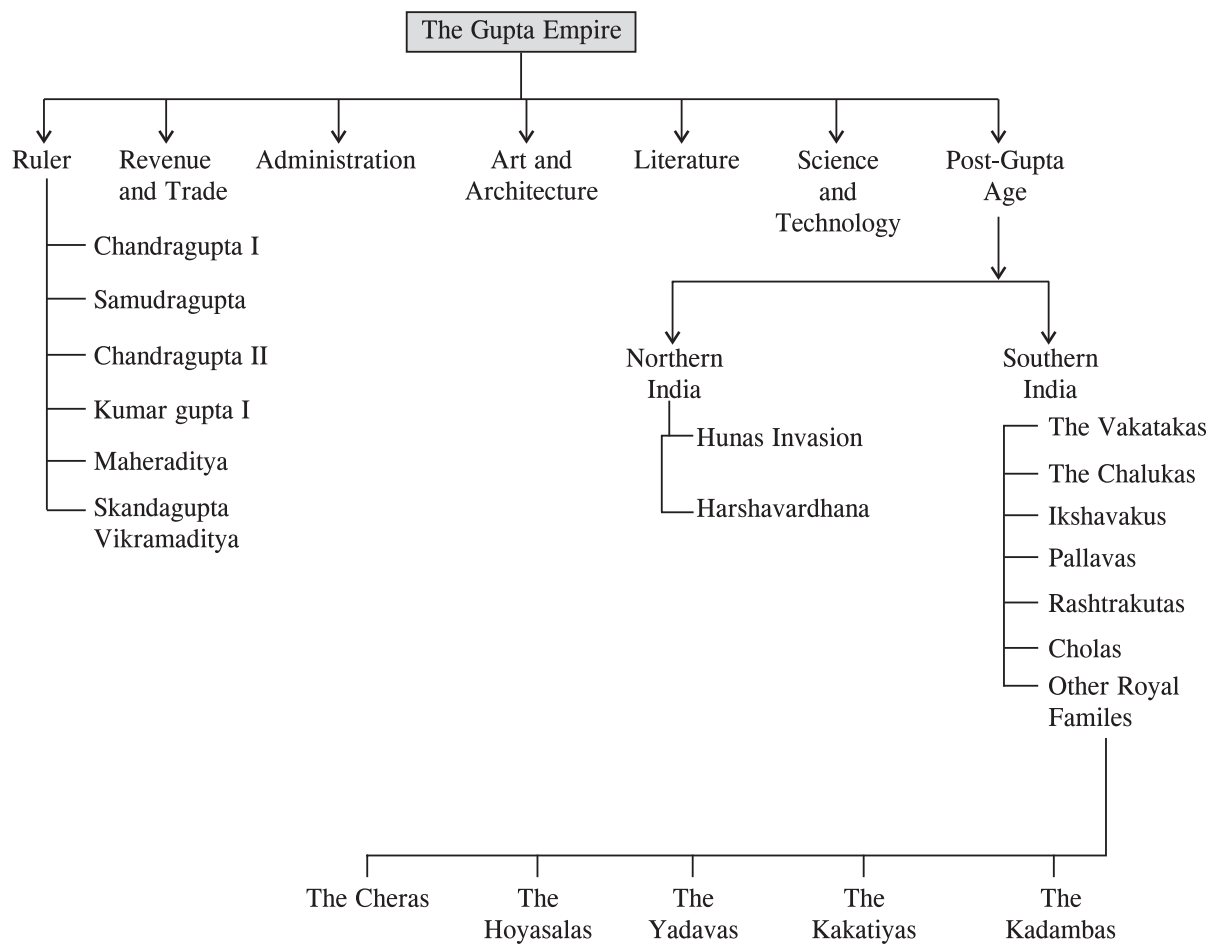
1. (c) The Aham and Puran are called post sangam works because they are compiled later than Sangam period
 2. (c) 3. (a)
 4. (b) Chola kingdom rose in 9th century. It was Vijaypal who established it. Other rulers were Aditya-I, Parantaka Chola-I, Rajaraja Chola-I and Rajendra Chola.
 5. (a) 6. (c) 7. (d)



Introduction

By the end of third century A.D. the powerful empires established by the Kushanas in the north and Satvahanas in the Deccan had come to end. It was against this background that the Guptas emerged to dominate the history of India for the next four centuries.

Information about the Gupta period is available from both archaeological and literary sources. The most important archaeological source is in the Allahabad Pillar inscription. Temples, Paintings and Coins are some other archaeological sources. The main literary sources include the works of *Kalidasa* and these accounts of *Fa-Hien* and *It-sing*.



RULERS OF GUPTA EMPIRE

Chandragupta I (A.D. 320-335)

Chandragupta I, grand son of Sri Gupta and son of Ghototkacha was the most powerful ruler of the line. He increased power and prestige of the empire to a great extent by matrimonial alliance and conquests. He married *Kumaradevi*, the Lichhavi princess. His empire extended from Magadh, modern Bihar, Oudh, Prayag (Allahabad), Tirhent, in addition to Magatha he adopted the title if *Maharajadhiraj*.

Samudragutpa (A.D. 335-375)

Samudragupta, son of Chandragupta I ascended the throne in A.D. 335. He was the greatest ruler of Gupta dynasty. An inscription engraved on a pillar at Allahabad popularly called *Allahabad Pillar* inscription or the *Prayag Prashasti* is the main source of information on his reign. The *Prashasti* was composed by Samudragupta's court poet *Harisena* which gives a detailed account of the conquests of Samudragupta. This account contains a long list of states king and tribes which were conquered and brought under various degrees of subjugations. Harisena also described Samudragupta as the '*Hero of a Hundred Battles*'.

Chandragupta II (380-414 A.D.)

Samudragupta was succeeded by his son Chandragupta. He was also known as Vikramaditya. Chandragupta married his daughter Prabhavati with a Vakataka prince who belonged to the Brahmana caste and ruled in central India. The prince died and was succeeded by his young son, So, *Prabhavati* became the ritual ruler. Chandragupta exercised indirect control over the Vakataka Kingdom in central India. This offered a great advantage to him. With his great influence in this area, Chandragupta II conquered western Malwa and Gujarat, which had been under the rule of the Saka Kshatrapas for about four centuries by that time. The conquest gave Chandragupta the eastern sea coast, famous for trade and commerce. This contributed to the prosperity of Malwa, and its chief city Ujjain. *Ujjain* seems to have been made the second capital by *Chandragupta II*.

Kumaragupta I Maheraditya (415-455 A.D.)

Kumaragupta, son of Chandragupta I ascended the throne in 415. Nothing is known about his political career, but numismatic and epigraphic evidence indicate that the strength, unity, and prestige of the empire remained unshaken in his reign. Towards the end of his reign, the Gupta power was seriously menaced by the hostility of the Pushyamitra, a tribe of uncertain identity.

Skandagupta Vikramaditya (455-467 A.D.)

Skandagupta, the last powerful king of the Gupta dynasty came to the throne when the war with Pushyamitra was still going on. His victory saved the Gupta empire; but it was invaded by the *Hunas*. He succeeded in defeating the *Hunas* and in maintaining the integrity of his ancestral empire. Success in repelling the *Hunas* seems to have been celebrated by the assumption of the title *Vikramaditya*. The decline of the empire began soon after his death. The *Hunas* later became the rulers of Punjab and Kashmir.

Decline of the Gupta Empire

Though their rule lasted till the middle of the sixth century A.D. the imperial glory had ended a century earlier.

The reasons were:

- (i) invasion by the *Hunas*,
- (ii) rise in feudalism,
- (iii) weak successors,
- (iv) financial difficulties,
- (v) decline of foreign trade, and
- (vi) absence of large professional army to maintain vast empire.

REVENUE AND TRADE

From the inscriptions of the Gupta period we come to know that taxes were levied at that time were of eighteen types. Land revenue and so called *Bhaga* were the chief source of income. It is known from the inscription of Pallavas and Vakatakas that taxes were enforced on buffalo milk, curd and also on fruits and flowers. The forests, meadows and salt mines, added to the income of the state.

During this period, the ship-building industry was at peak. *Tamralipti*, a port in Bengal, was an important trade centre and from there trade was carried on with the eastern countries like China, Ceylon, Java and Sumatra. In Andhra, there were many ports on the banks of the rivers, Godavari and Krishna; *Tondai* was a famous port of Chola state. Kalyana, Chol, Broach and Cambay were the important ports of the South.

GUPTA ADMINISTRATION

Opposite to the Mauryas, the Gupta kings adopted pompous title such as parameshavara, maharajadhiraja and paramabhattaraka which signify that they ruled over kings in their empire. Kingship was hereditary, but royal power was limited by absence of a firm practice of primogeniture. The throne did not always go to the eldest son.

The Gupta bureaucracy was not as efficient as that of the Mauryas. The most important officers in the Gupta empire were the *kumaramatyas*. The Guptas organized a system of provincial and local administration. The empire was divided into divisions (*bhuktis*) and each *bhukti* was placed under the charge of an *uparika*. The *bhuktis* were divided into districts

(*vishayas*), which were placed under the charge of *vishyapati*. In eastern India, the *vishyas* were divided into *vithis*, which again were divided into villages. The village headman became more important in Gupta times.

Land taxes increased while those on trade and commerce decreased; land tax was between 1/4 to 1/6 of the produce.

Visthi (Forced labour) prevailed. Religious functionaries were granted land called *Agrahara*.

Important Officials at the Central Level

- | | |
|-------------------------|---|
| (i) Mahabaladhikrita | – Commander-in-Chief |
| (ii) Mahadanayak | – Chief justice |
| (iii) Mahapratihar | – An official to maintain the royal palace. |
| (iv) Mahasandhivigrahak | – An official for post-war conciliation |
- Or Sandhivigrahak

- | | |
|-------------------------------|--|
| (v) Dandapashika | – Head of the police department |
| (vi) Bhandagaradhikreta | – Head of the royal treasury |
| (vii) Mahapaksha-Patalik | – Head of the account department |
| (viii) Vinaysthitisansathapak | – Head of the education department |
| (ix) Sarvadhyaksha | – Inspector for the all central departments |
| (x) Mahashwapati | – Controller of cavalry. |
| (xi) Mahamahipilapati | – Controller and executor of elephantry. |
| (xii) Vinayapura | – Official to present different guests at king's court |
| (xiii) Yuktapurusha | – Office to keep account of war booty |
| (xiv) Khadyatpakika | – Inspector of royal kitchen |
| (xv) Ranabhandagarika | – Officer-in-charge of army stores |
| (xvi) Mahanarpati | – Head of foot soldiers (infantry) |

ART AND ARCHITECTURE

The Gupta period witnessed exceptional growth in the field of architecture, sculpture, painting and terra cotta. That is why the period is also known as the '*Golden Age of Ancient India*'. In architectural types it gave entrance to a new age which is particularly noticed in the architectural style of the temples. In fact, it initiated a creative and formative period for the foundation of a typical Indian temple architecture.

Apart from temple architecture rock-cut architecture also reached their zenith. The most remarkable of these are to be found in Ajanta, Ellora, Aurangabad (Hyderabad) and Bagh (Central India). Bragnabucak rock-cut shrines although lesser in number than those of the Buddhist, were not rare either. Reference may be made in this connection to the Udaygiri series of shrines near Bhilsa in Bhopal state. The shrines are both rock-cut Brahmanical shrines and are also to be found at Badami in the Bijapur district. Jaina caves are to be found at Badami as also at *Aihole*.

The art of painting, including *terra-cotta* and clay modelling, considered a secular character during this period and became more popular than stone sculpture. The best specimens of painting of the period are to be found on the walls of the *Ajanta caves*, *Bagh cave in Gwalior*, *Settannavasal temple at Puddukkottai* and at *Badami*. Incidents of life of Buddha were the main theme of the Gupta painters. The Painting '*Dying Princess*' in one Ajanta cave has earned the admiration of Burgess, Fergusson, Griffiths and many others. The Gupta art of painting has been praised by art critics for its brilliance of colour, richness of expression and delicacy of execution.

The artists of the Gupta age were also superb in casting metals and making of copper statues. The iron pillar at Delhi made at time of Samudragupta is a marvel of metallurgical skill of the Gupta period artists.

LITERATURE

During the period of Gupta dynasty, Sanskrit literature greatly flourished. It would not be unfair to say that there was never such a literary outburst in India especially in the sphere of Sanskrit language.

Prose and poetry both were written during this period. The Allahabad Pillar Inscription shows that Harisena was a poet of great eminence. The manner in which, he has described the achievement of Samudragupta by Chandragupta signifies he was a poet of great calibre.

Important Literary works during the Gupta period

- | | |
|------------------------------------|---------------|
| Raghuwansa, Ritusamhara, Meghaduta | – Kalidasa |
| Ravanabodha | – Batsabhathi |
| Kavyadarshana and Dasakumarcharita | – Dandin |
| Kiratarjuniyam | – Bharavi |
| Nitishataka | – Bhartahari |

Dramas

- | | |
|---|----------------|
| Vikramovarshiya, Malvikagnimitra and Abhijnanasakuntalam | – Kalidasa |
| Mrichchakatika | – Sudaraka |
| Swapnavasavadatta, Charudatta and Pratignayaugandharayana | – Bhasa |
| Mudrarakshasa and Devichandraguptam | – Visakhadatta |

Eulogy

- | | |
|----------------|------------|
| Pryag-Prasasti | – Harisena |
|----------------|------------|

Philosophy

- | | |
|--|-------------------------|
| Sankhyakarika (base on Sankhya philosophy) | – Ishwar Krishna |
| Padartha Dharma sangraha (based on Vaisheshika Philosophy) | – Acharya Prashastipada |
| Vyasa Bhasya (based on Yoga philosophy) | – Acharya Vyasa |
| Nyaya Bhasya (on Nyaya philosophy) | – Vatsyayana |

Religious Works

The two great epics, the Ramayana and the Mahabharata, were given final shape during the period.

Grammar

Amarakosha	– Amarsimha
Chandrvyakarana	– Chandragomin
Kavyadarsha	– Dandin

Narrative Story

Panchatantra and Hitopadesha	– Vishnu Sharma
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Smritis

Vaynavalkyasmriti, Parasharsmriti, Brihaspatismriti, Naradasmriti and Katyayanasmriti

Mathematics and Astronomy

Aryabhattacharya, Dashajitikasutra and	– Aryabhata
Aryashtashata	– Varahmihira
Brhatsamhita and Panchasidhantika	– Brahmagupta
Brahmasidhanata	

Miscellaneous Works

Nitisastra	– Kamandaka
Kamsutra	– Vatsayana
Kavyalankara	– Bhamah

Poetry, verse and drama of a very high class were composed and written in this age. The name of Kalidasa shines like a glittering star in the period. It is very difficult to say which of his work is the best but *Shakuntalam* is the most popular of his plays. Before the *Shakuntalam*, Kalidasa had already composed two plays, the *Malavikagnimitra* and the *Vikramorvasiya*. His two Mahakavyas, *Raghuvamsa* and *Kamarasambhava* and the lyrical poem *Meghaduta* are universally regarded as *gems of Sanskrit poetry*.

Philosophical literature was also written during this period. The Hindus, Buddhists and Jains all wrote on the principles of their respective religions. A commentary was written on Sankhya philosophy and also on Mimamsa Sutra. In this period Vatsayana wrote a commentary on the philosophy of law, although his views were contradicted, later on, by Dingnaga Chandra, a great intellect, wrote a book called '*Dashpadarthasthra*'.

SCIENCE AND TECHNOLOGY

Mathematics

In the field of mathematics, we come across during this period a work called *Aryabhattacharya* written by *Aryabhata*, who belonged to Pataliputra. It seems that this mathematician was well versed in various kinds of calculations. A Gupta inscription of Allahabad suggests that the decimal system was known in India at the beginning of the fifth century A.D. In the field of astronomy a book called *Romaka Sidhanta* was compiled. It was influenced by Greek ideas, as can be inferred from its name.

Aryabhata was the first to use the *decimal system*. He formulated the rule for finding out the area of triangle which led to the origin of *trigonometry* and calculated the value of **pie** (π). He laid the foundation of algebra in his *aryabhattacharya*. The most famous work of this time was *Suryasidhanta*. Brahmagupta in 7th century A.D. began to apply algebra to astronomical problems. The three major contributions in the field of mathematics are the notational system, the decimal system and the use of zero.

Metallurgy

The Gupta craftsmen distinguished themselves by their work in iron and bronze. We know of several bronze images of the Buddha, which began to be produced on a considerable scale because of the knowledge of advanced metal technology. In the case of iron objects the best example is the iron pillar

found at Mehrauli in Delhi. Manufactured in the fourth century A.D. believed to be erected by *Kumaragupta*, the pillar has not gathered any rust in the subsequent 15 centuries, which is a great tribute to the technological skill of the craftsmen. It was impossible to produce such a pillar in any iron foundry in the west until about a century ago. It is a pity that the later craftsmen could not develop this knowledge further.

Astronomy

In the field of astronomy, this period also witnessed excellent work. *Aryabhata* and *Varahmihir* were prominent astronomers. The former found out the causes of lunar and solar eclipses; calculated the circumference of earth; was first to reveal that the sun is stationary and the earth revolved round the sun. *Varahmihir*'s well known works are *Brihatsamhita* and *Panch Sidhantika*. Brahmagupta wrote the *Brahma Sphutic Siddhanta* in verse and laid the foundation of the law of gravitation.

Medicine

Sushruta and *Charaka* were the two great physicians of this period. The *Sushruta Samhita* describes the methods of operating cataracts, stone diseases and various other ailments. *Charaka* is considered to be the father of Indian Medicine. *Vrihad Vagabhatta*, a well-known physician, guided by the work of *Charaka*, wrote *Astanghriday*.

THE POST GUPTA AGE

Northern India

By the end of fifth century the vast Gupta empire broke up into several independent states. It was due to the repeated invasions of the Hunas, the nomadic tribesman of central Asia and internal disruption of provincial governments, who established independent-states in different parts of the northern part of India. With the decline of the imperial Gupta, Magadha

and its capital Pataliputra, which since the sixth century B.C. had been the centre of political activity in North India, lost their importance when Harsha united his ancestral kingdom of Thaneswar with the Maukhari kingdom of Kannauj and shifted his capital to Kannauj. From now (A.D. 606) onwards till the Turkish conquests at the close of the twelfth century, Kannauj remained the centre of political activity in North India.

Hunas Invasion (A.D. 454)

There was a barbarous race which came to India from Central Asia. Hunas invaded India for the first time during the reign of Kumaragupta but their further progress was checked by the Gupta king who inflicted a crushing defeat upon them in about 460 A.D. After fourteen years of this invasion, Hunas defeated Firoz, king of Persia, and became the masters of Persia. This success boosted their power and by the end of fifth century A.D., they ruled over a vast empire. From this time onwards the invasions of Hunas over India became more frequent.

Harshavardhana (A.D. 606-647)

The break-up of the Gupta Empire was followed by a period of disorder. Small kingdoms fought against one-another. Finally, Harshavardhana conquered these kingdoms and established a powerful empire.

Source Materials

We come to know about Harsha and the developments during his reign from two main sources. One is *Harshacharita*, the biography of the king written in Sanskrit by his court poet *Banabhatta*. The book lists military and cultural achievements of Harsha. The other is the account of *Hiuen Tsang*, who visited India during Harsha's reign. He spent eight years in the court of Harsha. He has written in detail about the developments during these years. Besides these sources, inscriptions and coins of this period also tell us about Harsha.

Kannauj - As Capital

Harshavardhan shifted his capital from *Thanesvar* to *Kannauj* which was situated on the bank of Ganga. He converted it into a magnificent, wealthy and well-fortified city, nearly four miles long and a mile broad, furnished with numerous lofty buildings, and adorned with many tanks and gardens.

Generally, he is regarded as the last powerful Hindu emperor of India, but he was neither a staunch Hindu nor the ruler of the whole country. His authority was limited to the north India except Kashmir. Rajasthan, Punjab, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar and Orissa were under his direct control, but his sphere of influence spread over a much wider area. Mostly, the feudatories seem to have accepted his suzerainty.

Administration Under Harsha

Harsha ruled his kingdom on the same lines as the Guptas did, except that his administration had become more feudal and decentralised. It is stated that Harsha had soldiers numbering over one lakh and 60,000 cavalry and 9,000 elephants. Harsha could mobilize that support of all his feudatories at the time of war. Evidently every feudatory contributed his quota of foot soldiers and horse, and thus made the army vast in numbers.

Land grants continued to be made to priests for special services rendered to the state. In addition, Harsha is credited with the grant of land to the officers by charters. These grants allowed more concessions to priests and officers than those by the earlier grants. Thus, the feudal practice of rewarding and paying officers with grants of land on a large scale seems to have begun under Harsha.

Harsha-A Patron of Arts

Harsha was a patron of arts and learning. He himself was a good writer. He wrote three plays in Sanskrit-*Ratnavali*, *Priyadarshika* and *Nagananda*. Scholars like Banabhatta, Subandhu and Dandian lived in his court. In his early years, Harsha was a worshipper of Shiva but later he became a Buddhist. He was tolerant of other religions. He organized a grand assembly at Kannauj. He also gave money to the University of Nalanda. This university prospered and became a famous centre of learning. Hiuen Tsang spent many years studying Buddhist text at this Nalanda University.

Harsha ruled for about forty-one years till his death in A.D. 647. His death facilitated the growth of petty territories to become states. He also does not seem to have left any heir to the throne of Kannauj which was usurped after his death by his minister.

Southern India

The period during A.D. 300 to A.D. 750 witnesses the second historical phase in the regions south of the Vindhayas. By the beginning of the seventh century, the Pallavas of Kanchi, the Chalukyas of Badami and the Pandyas of Madurai appeared to be the three major states.

The Vakatakas (A.D. 225-510)

The Satvahanas were succeeded by the Vakatakas, a local power in northern Maharashtra and Vidarbha (Berar). The Vakatakas, who were Brahmanas themselves, are known from a large number of copper-plate and grants issued to the Brahmanas. They were great champions of the Brahmanical religion and performed several Vedic sacrifices. Their political history is of more importance to north India than to south India. Culturally, the Vakataka kingdom became a channel for transmitting brahmanical ideas and social institutions to the south.

The founder of this dynasty was *Vidya Shakti* but his son Pravarsena could be its real founder in western and central India. Chandragupta II realised the importance of this empire and formed alliance through marriage of his daughter into Vakataka family.

In 5th century A.D., Vakatakas extended their power in Malwa. Harisena was the last important monarch controlling all the central Deccan.

The Vakatakas contributed towards the arts and architecture. Several caves of Ajanta are credited to the royal patronage of the Vakatakas.

They were uprooted by the growing power of Chalukyas of Badami, Pallavas of Kanchipuram and Pandyas of Madurai. The Vakatakas had been in power for about two centuries.

The Chalukyas (543-753 A.D.)

(a) Chalukyas of Badami

The most notable of the early medieval dynasties of the Deccan was that of the Chalukyas. *Jayasimha* was the first Chalukyan king. But Pulakeshin I is generally attributed to be the first Chalukyan king. He was succeeded by Maharaja Kirtivarman in 566 A.D. Pulakeshin II was the most prominent ruler of the dynasty who ruled from A.D. 608 and was a contemporary of Harshavardhan.

His fame was far extended even upto Persia, with whom he exchanged embassies. He was defeated and killed by the Pallava ruler Narsimvarman. 32 years later in 674, one of Pulakeshin's son avenged his father's death and captured Kanchi.

(b) Eastern Chalukyas of Vengi

Pulkeshin II's brother, *Kubja Vishnu Vardhan* established a new dynasty with its capital at the ancient city of Vengi. But soon its power was declined and in about 10th century they allied the Cholas but the Chola king did not maintain the alliance and annexed the kingdom in A.D. 1076

(c) Western Chalukyas of Kalyani

The kingdom founded by Taila II in 973, after defeating Amoghavarsha IV, the last Rashtrakuta ruler. He extended his kingdom upto southern part of Pormera kingdom of Malwa. Vikramaditya II Tribhuvanmall (1076-1126) was the greatest ruler of this dynasty and he was regarded as the hero of Bilhana's *Vikramankadevacharita*. He is the founder of the Vikarm Samvat Era. Jagadekamall II, was the last ruler after whose death his Kalachuri minister Vijjala usurped his throne.

Art and Architecture

Art made great progress under their patronage. The temple architecture was a blend of Dravida and Nagara styles. They built about 70 temples at Aihole which is rightly regarded as the 'cradle of Indian temple architecture'. Other famous temples include the Virupaksha temple at Pattadakal, the Vishnu temple of Badami, the Shiva temple of Maguti and the Kasi Vishvesvara temple of Lakhundi. They gave patronage to Hinduism and Jainism. Their empire came to an end by A.D. 753 when their feudatory Rastrakutas defeated Kirtivarman.

Ikshavakus

On the decline of the Satvahana power in the eastern part of the peninsula there arose the Ikshavakus in the *Krishna Guntur* region. They seem to have been a local tribe who adopted the dignified name of the Ikshavakus in order to show the antiquity of their lineage. They are mostly recalled for monuments like *Nagarjunakonda* and *Dharanikota*. They were overthrown by the Pallavas.

Pallavas (600-757 A.D.)

During the 6th century to late 8th century, the Pallavas were the dominant power in the Deccan, who were the indigenous subordinates of the Satavahanas. They marched to Andhra and then to Kanchi where they established the mighty Pallava Empire. Pallavas were religious tolerant and supported Buddhism, Jainism and the Brahminical faith and were patrons of music, paintings and literature. Their greatest monuments are at Mahabalipuram. The clash between the Pallavas and the Chalukyas continued for many centuries. The last Pallava ruler Aparajitavarma was defeated by the Cholas.

Struggle Between The Pallavas and the Chalukyas

The main cause of the struggle between Pallavas and Chalukyas was the supremacy. The Pandyas, who were in control of Madurai and Tinnevely district of Tamil Nadu, joined this conflict as a poor third. Although both the Pallavas and the

Chalukyas supported Brahmanism, performed Vedic sacrifices and made grants to the Brahmanas, the two quarreled with each-other for prestige and territorial resources. Both tried to establish supremacy over the land lying between the Krishna and the Tungabhadra.

The first important event in this long struggle took place in the reign of *Pulakeshin-II* (609-642), the most prominent Chalukya king. He overthrew the Kadamba capital at *Banavasi* and compelled the Ganges of Mysore to accept his suzerainty. He also defeated Harsha's army on the Narmada and checked his march towards the Deccan. In his conflict with the Pallavas, he almost reached the Pallava capital, but the Pallavas purchased peace by ceding their northern-provinces to Pulakeshin II.

Pulakeshin's second invasion of the Pallava territory ended in failure. The Pallava king *Narasimhavarman* (A.D. 630-668) occupied the Chalukya capital at *Vatapi* in about A.D. 642, when Pulakeshin II was probably killed in fight against the Pallavas. Narsimhavarman adopted the title of Vatapikonda or the conqueror of Vatapi. He is also said to have defeated the Cholas, the Cheras, the Pandyas and the Kalabhras.

By the end of the seventh century, the conflict was subsided but it was again resumed in the first half of the eighth century A.D. The Chalukya king *Vikramaditya II* (A.D. 733-745) is said to have overrun Kanchi three times. In 740 A.D., he completely overthrew the Pallavas. His victory ended the Pallava supremacy in the far south although the ruling house continued for more than a century afterwards. However, the Chalukyas could not enjoy the fruits of their victory over the Pallavas for long for their own hegemony was brought to an end in A.D. 757 by the Rashtrakutas.

Rashtrakutas (A.D. 753-973)

The term Rashtrakutas means officers-in-charge of territorial divisions called rashtr. The Rashtrakutas originally belonged to *Lattalura*, modern Latur of Maharashtra. They were of Kannada origin and Kannada was their mother tongue.

The founder of the Rashtrakuta was *Dantidurga*. He was contemporary of Chalukya king Pulkeshin II. Dantidurga was succeeded by his uncle Krishnaraja (768-772). He defeated the territories that were still under the Chalukyas and thereby completed conquest of the Chalukya territories. Chalukyaraj Vishnuvardhana IV of Vengi and the Ganga king of Mysore were overthrown by the Rashtrakuta King Krishnaraja. *Krishnaraja* built the *Kailash temple of Ellora* which was superb example of the Rashtrakuta art and architecture. Krishnaraja's eventful period came to an end within a very short time and he was succeeded by his son Govindraj who ruled for sometime as Govinda II. His worthlessness as a ruler and his lack of interest in administration led to his deposition by his brother Dhruva who ascended the throne himself. Dhruva was succeeded by Govinda III, his son and with almost equal vigour as of his father.

The Rashtrakutas kept on the best of terms with the Arabas of Sindh and enriched their subjects by encouraging commerce. They encouraged Hinduism, and Digambara Jainism. Their capital was at Manyakheta.

Literature was encouraged. The king Amoghavarsha I himself authored a part of *Kavirajamarga*, the earliest known Kannada poem.

The powerful king of the Rashtrakuta dynasty was *Amoghavarsha* who succeeded in defeating the East-Chalukya kings. It was Amoghavarsha who had successfully checked the progress of the Gurjara King Bhoja I towards South India. He set up a new capital at Malkhed or Manyakheta and during his reign Broach became the best port of his kingdom.

Amoghavarsha ruled for 63 years and he was succeeded by his son Krishna II who in his turn was succeeded by Indra III. Indra III was a powerful king. He defeated and deposed Mahipala. The Rastrkuta King Amoghavarsha II, Govinda IV and Amoghavarsha III were weak and worthless kings. The last powerful and efficient king of the Rastrakutas was Krishna III.

Cholas

The founder of the Chola dynasty was *Vijayala*, a feudatory of the Pallavas. His dynasty rose to high eminence and lasted for more than two centuries. Vijayala rose to power near *Uraiyyar*, the capital of the Cholas of the Sangam Age. An inscription at Tiruchirapalli district records a gift of land in accordance with the orders of the Parakesari Vijayala Chladeva. The titles of Parakesari and Rajakesari were alternately assumed by the Chola sovereigns from the time of Vijayala.

The ascendancy of *Rajraja* gave Cholas, the supreme power in India, Rajraja was the most famous and important among the Cholas. He very efficiently and successfully carried on the administration of his country from A.D. 985 to 1014 A successful conqueror, he had defeated the Cheras and the Pandyas. He had annexed Mysore and Travancore and had defeated the Chalukyas of Vengi. The inscriptions reveal that he had conquered the Simhaldip. His conquests established his authority in the Deccan.

Rajraja was succeeded by his son, *Rajendra*. He was also a brave warrior and a successful ruler. He ruled from A.D. 1015-1035. After his death, his son, *Rajadhiraja*, became the ruler. He was the last among the Cholas. In 1052, he was killed while fighting with the Chalukyas.

Chola Administration

The most striking feature of the administrative system of the Cholas was their autonomous village and town administration. there was no significant difference between the central and provincial administration of the Cholas and that of any other dynasty of early medieval India. But, the administration of Cholas was more centralized than that of the Rashtrakutas or the Chalukyas.

Central Administration: The emperor or king was at the apex of the administration. He had an *udankuttam*, immediate attendants, a group of ministers representing all the chief departments of administration to advise him on the disposal of business, besides a chancery (*olai*). Worship at deceased rulers, and construction of temples as tributes to dead kings was a special feature of the Chola period.

There was an elaborate and complicated administrative machinery or bureaucracy for the Cholas, comprising officials of various grades. The officials tended to form a separate class in society, organized in two ranks, an *upper perundanam* and a *lower sirudanam*. Higher officers were known by the title of *adigarigal*, while officers of all ranks were usually referred to

by the general titles of *Karumigal* and *Panimakkal*. They were usually remunerated by assignments of land (*jivitas*) suited to their position. Titles of honour and shares in booty taken in war formed other rewards of public service.

Provincial Administration: The empire was divided into principalities (under vassal chiefs) and mandalams (provinces under viceroys who were mostly royal princes) with further division of the provinces into Valanadus (divisions), Nadus (districts) and Kurrams (villages).

Achievement of Cholas: The Chola empire during Rajaraja I included Tamil Nadu, Goorg, Srilanka and many islands including Laskswadeep and Maldives.

Rajendra Chola assumed the title of Gangaikonda, after consolidating his territories right upto river Ganga.

Chola art and Literature: The Cholas greatly encouraged sculpture, architercute and painting. The Cholas established new cities and constructed many palatial buildings. They beautifully erected temples served as the conference houses for the assemblies. The Shiva temple of *Rajrajeshwar* at Tanjore is a perfect example of Chola art which is 197 feet high and has thirteen storeys. The Brihadesvara temple at Thanjore is the finest specimen of Chola architecture.

Literature and culture too witnessed a great progress under the Cholas. Culture had reached the height of glory and peak of power. Sanskrit and Tamil languages developed to a great extent. The Chola kings greatly encouraged the scholarly and the literary minds.

Arab Influence

On the west coast, the initiative in the trade with the west was gradually passing into the hands of the Arabs. Indian Traders were becoming suppliers of goods rather than carriers and communication with the West became indirect, via the Arabs, and limited to trade alone. Maritime trade with South East Asia continued. There were now three major kingdoms. Kambuja (Cambodia), Champa (Annam) and Shrivijaya (the southern Malay Peninsula and Sumatra), with whom cultural contact increased. Pallava architectural styles and the Tamil script were extensively used amongst the local royalty.

Other Royal Families of the Deccan

The Cheras

In ancient time *Kerala* was known as *Cheras*. The kingdom extended to the districts of Malabar, Travancore, Cochin, etc. The Cheras had trade relations with Rome in the first century A.D. the description of the Cheras of early times is found in the edicts of Ashoka, in which they have been called by the name of Kerala Putras. Enough historical material about the history of Kerala is not available. Some of the important rulers of this dynasty were *Perunar*, *Adan II*, and *Senaguttavam*, etc. who in their reigns fought many battles with other dynasties of the Deccan like the Cholas, the Pandyas, and the Hoyasalas, etc. They remained dominant till the 13th century A.D.

The Hoyasalas

The kingdom of Hoyasalas situated between the kingdom of the Chalukyas on the North-West and that of the Cholas on

south-east. They ruled over modern Mysore and Madras. Their capital was *Dwarasamudra*. The credit of bringing this dynasty into eminence goes to *Vishnu Vardhan*. He improved political position of his kingdom by his victories. With the help of his commander-in-chief, Ganga Raja, he defeated the Cheras, the Cholas and the Pandyas. He defeated the Gurjaras at Talkad. The *Chennakesava* temple built by Vishnuvardhan at Belur in A.D. 1117 and the *Hoyasaleswar* temple built in A.D. 1150 at Halesbid are examples of Hoyasala architecture. The kingdom of the Hoyasalas made all the progress under *Vir Balla II*. He defeated the Chalukyas and the Yadavas too. The last king of this dynasty was *Vir Balla III*, who was defeated by *Malik Kafur*, the chief general of *Alauddin Khilji* in 1311. He deposed him from the throne and this, dynasty came to its end.

The Yadavas

The Yadavas were, at first, under the supremacy of the Chalukyas, became independent and began to gain power. They ruled over the region that extended from *Nasik* to *Devagiri*. Thus, Khandesh territory was under their sway. These people acknowledged being chandravansi (Moon race). Their great rulers were Bhillama; Simhana Ramachandra, etc. *Bhillama* was the first important king of this dynasty. He reigned from 1187 to 1191. He conquered the Hoyasalas and made *Devagiri* his capital. The most prominent king of this dynasty was *Simhana* who defeated several dynasties, such as, the Hoyasalas, the Andhras, etc. He also defeated Arjun Varman, the ruler of Malwa. In addition to this, he invaded Gujarat several times and tried to defeat it. The last king of this dynasty was Ramachandra who ruled the whole of the region upto the river Narmada.

The Kakatiyas

The Kakatiyas were under the control of the Chalukya dynasty and after the downfall of Chalukyan they asserted their independent in the territories of *Telingana* and *Warrangal*, where they founded their own kingdom. Some of the powerful and important kings of this dynasty were *Prolaraja*, *Ganpati Pratap Rudra Deo*, etc. Prolaraja defeated the Chalukyas and fought many other battles. After him *Ganpati* was another important king of this dynasty. He defeated the Cholas, the

Yadavas and several other rulers of various families. He reaped the full advantage of the disorder and disturbance in the political condition of those regions and extended his rule in all the four corners of his kingdom. The fact is that he was the most important king of the *Kakatiya* dynasty. In his reign, the Kakatiya rule was at the height of its power and progress. After his reign, the decline and decay of this dynasty started and finally in the reign of Pratapa Rudra Deo, Malik Kafur invaded their kingdom in A.D 1309.

The Kadambas

This dynasty was established by *Brahman Mayurasarma* in north Karnataka with his capital at *Banavasi* after defeating Satvahana. *Mayurasaraman* was a champion of Vedic sacrifices and is believed to have performed 18 Ashvamedha sacrifices. The kingdom was annexed to the Chalukya kingdom by Pulkesin II.

Points to Remember

- Information about the Gupta empire are available from Allahabad pillar inscription, temples, paintings and coins.
- Prominent rulers of Gupta empire Chandragupta I (320-335 AD), Samudragupta (335-375 AD), Chandragupta II (380-414 AD), Kumaragupta I, Maharaditya (415-455 AD), Skandagupta Vikramaditya (455-467 AD).
- In Gupta period, eighteen types of taxes were levied. Land tax was between 1/4 to 1/6 of the produce.
- Gupta period witnessed exceptional growth in field of architecture, sculpture, painting and terracotta. This period is also known as "*Golden Age of Ancient India*".
- In Gupta period, Sanskrit literature greatly flourished. Kalidasa was prominent poet from this period. Philosophical literature was also written during this period.
- This period marks notable advancement in field of Mathematics, Metallurgy, Astronomy and medicine. Aryabhata, Varahmihir are prominent names in this period.

Exercise -1

- Which among the following dynasties is known to have given the largest grant of villages to the temples and Brahmins?
 - Pratihara
 - Gupta
 - Pala
 - Saatvahana
- The finest specimens of Buddhist paintings are found in the caves at Bagh and Ajanta. How do the Buddhist paintings at Bagh differ from those found at Ajanta?
 - They are mostly depictions of Jataka stories
 - They contain representations of scenes from the Buddha's life from conception to the attainment of Nirvana
 - They are basically secular in character, and significantly reflect contemporary life
 - The style of the paintings reveals great delicacy and depth of feeling
- The silver coins issued by the Guptas were called:
 - Rupaka
 - Karshapana
 - Dinara
 - Pana
- Which one of the following ports handled the North Indian trade during the Gupta period?
 - Tamralipti
 - Broach
 - Kalyan
 - Cambay
- There are only two known examples of cave paintings of the Gupta period in ancient India. One of these is paintings of Ajanta caves. Where is the other surviving example of Gupta paintings?
 - Bagh caves
 - Ellora caves
 - Lomas Rishi cave
 - Nasik caves
- During the period of which of the following was 'Panchtantra' written?
 - Nandas
 - Mauryas
 - Guptas
 - Sungas
- The decimal numeral system, including the concept of zero was invented in India during which one of the following dynasty?
 - Saka
 - Gupta
 - Pala
 - Chola
- Which Gupta ruler repaired the Sudarshana lake constructed by Chandragupta Maurya?
 - Kumaragupta I
 - Samudragupta
 - Bhangupta
 - Sakandagupta
- Sarnath inscription highlights the achievements of which Kushana ruler?
 - Kajula Kadphises
 - Huvushka
 - Kanishka
 - Kadphises II
- Which book is considered as the Gupta equivalent of Kautilya's Arthashastra?
 - Nitisara
 - Amarakosa
 - Mudrarakshasa
 - Malavikagnimitra
- Which Gupta emperor's inscription at Eran dated 510 AD gives the first inscriptional evidence of Sati?
 - Kumaragupta
 - Skandagupta
 - Narasimhagupta
 - Bhanugupta
- Who among the Gupta emperors in his Bhitari and Junagarh inscriptions claimed victory over the Hunas?
 - Kumaragupta
 - Skandagupta
 - Bhanugupta
 - Narasimhagupta
- Which of the following Gupta emperors is represented on his coins as playing the flute or Veena?
 - Chandragupta I
 - Chandragupta II
 - Samudragupta
 - Skandagupta
- Which Gupta emperor is said to have founded Nalanda University?
 - Skandagupta
 - Buddhagupta
 - Purugupta
 - Kumaragupta I
- The Gupta ruler who finally defeated the Shakas of Ujjain is?
 - Samudragupta
 - Chandragupta I
 - Kumaragupta I
 - Skandagupta
- During whose reign did the Hunas start posing a threat to the Gupta empire?
 - Kumaragupta I
 - Skandagupta
 - Bhanugupta
 - Vishnugupta
- Pick out the incorrect statement?
 - In ancient India, Guptas issued the largest number of gold coins.
 - After the conquest of Gujarat, Guptas issued a good number of silver coins.
 - Guptas issued more copper coins than the Kushanas.
 - Guptas had good trade contacts with Eastern Roman (Byzantine) empire.
- Alvars who were Vaishnavite saints were popular in which part of India?
 - South India
 - Kashmir
 - Bengal
 - Gujarat
- Which of the Republican states in the Post-Mauryan period patronised Shaivism?
 - Audumburas
 - Kunindas
 - Yaudehyas
 - All the above
- Who is considered to be the greatest Pallava ruler?
 - Simhavishnu
 - Narasimhavarman I
 - Paramesvarvarman I
 - Nandivarman II
- Which of the Pallava rulers founded the city of Mahabalipuram?
 - Mahendavarman I
 - Narasimhavarman I
 - Nandivarman II
 - Nripatunga
- Which Chalukyan ruler is said to have received an embassy from the Persian king Khosrau II?
 - Pulkesin II
 - Vikramaditya I
 - Vinayaditya
 - Vijayaditya

23. The royal seal of the Guptas bore the emblem of
 - (a) Nandi (b) Garuda
 - (c) Lion (d) Tiger
24. Which among the following was not the cause of continuous war between Cholas and Chalukyas of Kalyan?
 - (a) The economic factors
 - (b) Rivalry between the Chalukyas of Kalyan and Chalukyas of Vengi
 - (c) The geo-political factors
 - (d) Rivalry to capture south India's foreign trade with China and South-eastern Asia.
25. Which one of the following is not related to the feudal formation in the Gupta and post-Gupta times.
 - (a) Emergence of landed intermediaries.
 - (b) Growth of a class of subject peasantry.
 - (c) Localised village economy developed with little scope for functioning of the market system.
 - (d) Emergence of strong centralised political authority.
26. Who among the following Gupta kings ascended the throne in the year 56 of Gupta era?
 - (a) Samudragupta (b) Chandragupta II
 - (c) Kumargupta (d) Skandgupta
27. The guild organization described in the Mandore inscription of Kumaragupta was known as
 - (a) Tantuvaya (b) Dantakara
 - (c) Kulika (d) Tailika
28. Who among the following was the ruler of Kanchi during the time of Samudragupta?
 - (a) Hastivarman (b) Mantaraya
 - (c) Nilaraja (d) Vishnugopa
29. Which inscription of the Gupta period gives details regarding the sale of land?
 - (a) Junagarh inscription
 - (b) Bhitari pillar inscription
 - (c) Begram copper plate
 - (d) Damodarpur copper plate
30. In the Gupta inscription who has been called "Lichchhavi Dauhitra"?
 - (a) Chandragupta I (b) Samudragupta
 - (c) Chandragupta II (d) Skandgupta
31. The officer responsible for the safe custody of land records during the Gupta period was known as
 - (a) Dhruvadhikarana (b) Karanika
 - (c) Samaharta (d) Shaulkika
32. Who among the following was the mother of Prabhavati Gupta?
 - (a) Kumaradevi (b) Kuberanaga
 - (c) Dhruvadevi (d) None of these
33. The travel account of Fa-hien is known as
 - (a) Si-yu-ki (b) Yen-tu
 - (c) Fo-kwo-ki (d) Fa-chien
34. Who has complimented Samudragupta as the 'Indian Napoleon'?
 - (a) Radhakumud Mukherji
 - (b) V.A. Smith
 - (c) R.N. Dandekar
 - (d) R.C. Majumdar
35. The word Vishti means
 - (a) Forced labour (b) Irrigation tax
 - (c) Rights of slaves (d) Property of women
36. Expansion of agricultural land took place on the largest scale in which period?
 - (a) Pre-Mauryan age (b) Mauryan age
 - (c) Post-Mauryan age (d) Gupta age
37. Which of the following literary works did not belong to the Gupta period?
 - (a) Amarakosa
 - (b) Abhigyanashakuntalam
 - (c) Charaka Samhita
 - (d) Mrichhakatikam
38. Who was the court poet of Samudragupta?
 - (a) Nagarjuna (b) Aryabhata
 - (c) Virasena (d) Harisena
39. Who was the author of Mandasore inscription?
 - (a) Veersena (b) Harisena
 - (c) Vatsabhatta (d) Banabhatta
40. Who of the following Gupta kings granted permission to Meghverma, the ruler of Sri Lanka to build a Buddhist temple at Gaya?
 - (a) Chandragupta I (b) Chandragupta II
 - (c) Samudragupta (d) Skandgupta
41. In the Gupta administration, who was Purpala?
 - (a) Administrator of village
 - (b) Administrator of town
 - (c) Administrator of capital
 - (d) Administrator of conquered territories
42. In which century, did the famous Chinese pilgrim Fa-hien visit India?
 - (a) 4th century AD (b) 5th century AD
 - (c) 6th century AD (d) 7th century AD
43. The six district school of Indian philosophy Sankhya, Yoga, Nyaya, Vaishasika, Mimansa, Vedanta became fully articulated during the
 - (a) Vedic period (b) Maurya period
 - (c) Buddha period (d) Gupta period
44. Who was the author of famous Ayurvedic text Ashtanghriday?
 - (a) Vagbhatta (b) Charaka
 - (c) Dhanvantari (d) Nagarjuna
45. Who was the author of Amarkosha?
 - (a) Chandragomina (b) Amarsingh
 - (c) Amar Kanta (d) Kalidasa
46. During which period, the great epics of Ramayan and Mahabharat were given the final form?
 - (a) Nanda period (b) Maurya period
 - (c) Post Maurya period (d) Gupta period
47. Who was Dhanavantri?
 - (a) A Chemist (b) A Physician
 - (c) A Philosopher (d) A Surgeon
48. How many students were studying in the Nalanda University as mentioned by Hiuen Tsang?
 - (a) 8,000 (b) 10,000
 - (c) 12,000 (d) 15,000

49. Who among the following had the title 'Amoghavarsha' ?
 (a) Munja Paramara
 (b) Rajendra Chola
 (c) Govinda Chandra Gahadavala
 (d) None of these
50. Who destroyed the Nalanda University in 1202 AD ?
 (a) Moizuddin Muhammad Ghori
 (b) Bakhtiyar Khilji
 (c) Mahmud of Ghazni
 (d) Qutbuddin Aibak
51. Which of the following temples was a well known centre of higher education?
 (a) Dasavatar Temple at Devogarh
 (b) Sasbahu Temple at Gwalior
 (c) Shore Temple at Mamallapuram
 (d) Trayipurusha Temple at Salotgi
52. The Jain text which describes that Chandragupta embraced Jainism towards the end of his life, is:
 (a) Ratnamalika (b) Jayadhavala
 (c) Parishisthaparvan (d) Dravya-samgraha
53. Which of the following is regarded to be a controversial part of the treaty of 303 (BC) between Chandragupta and Seleucus?
 (a) Seleucus surrendered his large territories to Chandragupta
 (b) Chandragupta made a gift of 500 elephants to Seleucus
 (c) Seleucus gave his daughter in marriage to Chandragupta
 (d) A Greek envoy (Megasthenes) was accredited to the Mauryan court at Pataliputra
54. The greatest royal patron of the University of Nalanda was/were:
 (a) King Harsha of Kannauj
 (b) King Balaputradeva of Sumatra
 (c) Pala kings Dharmapala and Devapala
 (d) The Gupta king Chandragupta II, Vikramaditya
55. Which of the following port handled North Indian trade during the Gupta period?
 (a) Sopara (b) Broach
 (c) Tamralipti (d) Cambay
56. Samudragupta ascended the throne in
 (a) 400 (b) 390
 (c) 380 (d) 330
57. The book Navanitakam of the Gupta period belongs to
 (a) Medicine (b) Astronomy
 (c) Administration (d) Agriculture
58. The Gupta ruler who repaired Sudarsana Lake for the second time
 (a) Skanda Gupta (b) Rama Gupta
 (c) Samudra Gupta (d) Vishnu Gupta
59. How many inscriptions are available for Guptas period?
 (a) 40 (b) 38
 (c) 42 (d) 48
60. Gupta kings ruled North India for a period of
 (a) 230 (b) 130
 (c) 330 (d) 430
61. Who was the author of Allahabad pillar inscription?
 (a) Aswaghosha (b) Harisena
 (c) Ravekeerthi (d) Veerasena
62. Nitisara was written by
 (a) Vishaka Datta (b) Kamandaka
 (c) Sudraka (d) Vajjika
63. Majority of the Gupta emperors patronised
 (a) Buddhism (b) Jainism
 (c) Vaishnavism (d) Shaivism
64. Ajanta Cave paintings belongs to the period of
 (a) Nandas (b) Mauryas
 (c) Guptas-Vakatakas (d) Haryanks
65. Kaumudi Mahotsava was written by
 (a) Vajjika (b) Sudraka
 (c) Kamandaka (d) Vishaka Dutta
66. Brihath Samhita was written by
 (a) Vatsyayana (b) Varahamihira
 (c) Shudraka (d) Aryabhatta
67. The Sultan Ganj Buddha Statue in Bronze belongs to
 (a) Guptas (b) Mauryas
 (c) Kanishka (d) Harsha
68. Harivamsa Purana was written by
 (a) Vishaka Datta (b) Kamandaka
 (c) Sudraka (d) Jinasena Suri
69. Who wrote 'Aryabhattiyam' Suryasiddhanta'?
 (a) Varahamihira (b) Aryabhatta
 (c) Brahma Gupta (d) Baskara
70. Who wrote 'Siddhanta Siromani'?
 (a) Bhaskaracharya (b) Varahamihira
 (c) Brahma Gupta (d) Aryabhatta
71. Kamasutra was written by
 (a) Vatsyayana (b) Vajjika
 (c) Kalhana (d) Vishakadatta I
72. Who wrote Khanda-Khadyaka?
 (a) Varahamihira (b) Baskara
 (c) Brahma Gupta (d) Aryabhatta
73. Who was the founder of Gupta dynasty?
 (a) SamudraGupta (b) ChandraGupta I
 (c) RamaGupta (d) Vikramaditya
74. What was the Period of rule of SamudraGupta?
 (a) 375-396 A. D. (b) 370-380 A. D.
 (c) 380-398 A. D. (d) 330-375 A. D.
75. The Gupta king who was good player of Veena?
 (a) Chandra Gupta (b) Vikramaditya
 (c) Samudra Gupta (d) Kumara Gupta
76. The Vengi king who was defeated by Samudra Gupta
 (a) Hastivarma (b) Danarnava
 (c) Vimaladitya (d) Gunaga Vijayaditya
77. The Gupta king who destroyed Sakas?
 (a) SamudraGupta (b) ChandraGupta I
 (c) KumaraGupta (d) ChandraGupta II
78. The gold coins during Gupta Period were called
 (a) Rupaka (b) Niska
 (c) Tanka (d) Pana

79. The Gupta king who has the title of 'Mahendraditya'?
(a) VishnuGupta (b) RamaGupta
(c) BudhaGupta (d) KumaraGupta
80. The court poet of SamudraGupta was
(a) Mahasena (b) Harisena
(c) Ravikeerthi (d) Veerasena
81. Who has the title of 'Kaviraja'?
(a) SamudraGupta (b) ChandraGupta II
(c) KumaraGupta (d) ChandraGupta I
82. Gupta Era was started in
(a) 330 A. D. (b) 340 A. D.
(c) 350 A. D. (d) 320 A. D.
83. Who was son of SamudraGupta?
(a) ChandraGupta II Vikramaditya
(b) KumaraGupta
(c) VishnuGupta
(d) Skanda Gupta
84. The Kosala king who was defeated by SamudraGupta
(a) Udayan (b) Mahendra
(c) Kalashoka (d) All the above
85. Which of the following was the inscription of Guptas about sati
(a) Junagarh Inscription
(b) Allahabad Inscription
(c) Bhitari Inscription
(d) Eran Inscription
86. The language patronised by Guptas was
(a) Sanskrit (b) Prakrit
(c) Arabic (d) Hindi
87. The officers of the village during the Guptas period were
(a) Uparika (b) Gramika and Bhojak
(c) Kotwal (d) Vishaypati
88. Who was son of Chandra Gupta II?
(a) BudhaGupta (b) VishnuGupta
(c) KumaraGupta (d) SkandaGupta
89. Who was the first Gupta ruler?
(a) SamudraGupta (b) SkandaGupta
(c) ChandraGupta I (d) SriGupta
90. Who started Gupta Era?
(a) ChandraGupta II (b) ChandraGupta I
(c) SkandaGupta (d) SamudraGupta
91. Who among the following was an expert musician?
(a) SamudraGupta (b) VishnuGupta
(c) SriGupta (d) ChandraGupta I
92. What was the Normal rate of interest on loans during the Guptas period
(a) 20% (b) 25%
(c) 10% (d) 15%
93. Who wrote 'Devi Chandra Guptam'?
(a) Sudraka (b) Visakha Datta
(c) Kamandaka (d) Vajjika
94. What was the language of Allahabad Parasasti?
(a) Parkrit (b) Hindi
(c) Sanskrit (d) Aramic
95. The religion patronised and propagated by Guptas
(a) Buddhism (b) Bhagavata
(c) Jainism (d) Hinduism
96. Who wrote 'Amarakosha'?
(a) Vatsyayana (b) Vishakha Dutta
(c) Amar Singh (d) Bhasa
97. The last ruler of Gupta dynasty was
(a) Budhagupta (b) Kumaragupta
(c) Vishnugupta (d) Srigupta
98. Which of the following inscription was found on iron pillar?
(a) Saranath (b) Mehrauli
(c) Babru (d) Sanchi
99. The poet who is called as Indian Shakespeare
(a) Rajasekhara (b) Bana
(c) Dhandi (d) Kalidas
100. The capital of Gupta Empire was
(a) Pataliputra (b) Kannauj
(c) Peshawar (d) Dhanyakatakam
101. Kalidas wrote (dramas)
(a) Vikramorvasiyam (b) Abhijnana Sakuntalam
(c) Malavikagnimitram (d) All the above
102. Which of the following is Kalidasa's work (poetical works)
(a) Meghasandesam (b) Kumara Sambhavam
(c) Raghuvamsam (d) All the above
103. The Pallava king who was defeated by Samudra Gupta?
(a) Simhavishnu (b) Vishnugopa
(c) Karikala (d) Simhavarma
104. Guptas period was a high water mark for
(a) Religion (b) Agriculture
(c) Administration (d) Sculpture
105. The ruler of provinces in Guptas period are called as
(a) Bhandagars (b) Kotwals
(c) Uparikas (d) Bhuktis
106. Fa-Hien's mission to India was to
(a) learn about the administrative system of the Gupta kings
(b) understand the social position of women during the Gupta period
(c) visit the Buddhist institutions and to collect copies of Buddhist manuscripts
(d) get full knowledge about the condition of peasants during the period of Gupta kings
107. Which one of the following inscriptions mentions Pulakesin II's military success against Harshavardhana?
(a) Allahabad Pillar inscription
(b) Aihole inscription
(c) Damodarpur Copperplate inscription
(d) Bilsad inscription
108. Which two of the following plays did Kalidasa wrote before writing Abhigyanashakuntalam?
1. Vikramorvasiyam
2. Malavikagnimitram
3. Swapnavasavadattam
4. Kadambari

Select the correct answer using the codes given below

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1 and 3
(c) 1 and 4 (d) 3 and 4
109. In the Gupta age, Varahamihira wrote the famous book, 'Brihat Samhita'. It was a treatise on
(a) astronomy
(b) statecraft
(c) ayurvedic system of medicine.
(d) economics
110. Among the precious stones, the most extensive foreign trade during the Gupta age was that of
(a) diamonds (b) ruby
(c) pearl (d) sapphire
111. The University of Nalanda was set-up by which Gupta ruler?
(a) Kumaragupta II (b) Kumaragupta I
(c) Chandragupta II (d) Samudragupta
112. Who among the following Chinese travellers visited the Kingdoms of Harshavardhana and Kumar Bhaskar Varma?
(a) I-Tsing (b) Fa-Hien
(c) Hiuen Tsang (d) Sun Shuyun
113. Which of the following rulers checked Harshavardhana's expedition in South India?
(a) Pulakesin I (b) Pulakesin II
(c) Vikramaditya I (d) Vikramaditya II
114. The king Pulakesin II belonged to which Dynasty ?
(a) Cholas (b) Cheras
(c) Chalukyas (d) Chedis
115. Which one of the following was the official language of Gupta period ?
(a) Pali (b) Magadhi
(c) Prakrit (d) Sanskrit
116. The notion of saptanga that was introduced in Arthashastra includes
(a) kings, territory, administration and treasury
(b) music, dance, ragas and wrestling
(c) ministers, civil servants, subalterns and those involved in espionage
(d) aristocrats, acharyas, traders and monks .
117. Which one among the following cities was the best producer of silk cloth under Gupta reign ?
(a) Pataliputra (b) Murshidabad
(c) Ghazipur (d) Varanasi
118. Which one among the following is not correct about the cave paintings at Ajanta ?
(a) Scenes have no dividing frame and blend into each other
(b) Scenes are both religious and secular in nature
(c) The influence of the Gandhara art is seen
(d) Scenes mostly depict tales from Jatakas

Exercise -2

Statement Based MCQ

1. The eulogies or “prashasti” among the following inscriptions : I. Aihole Inscription of Pulakesin II. II. Allahabad Pillar Inscription of Samudra Gupta. III. Junagarh Inscription of Rudradaman. IV. Hathigumpha Inscription of Kharavela.

(a) I, II and III are correct.
(b) I and II are only correct.
(c) II and III are only correct.
(d) I, III and IV are correct.

2. Which of the following statements are true with regard to Rajendra Chola I ?

1. He assumed the title of Gangaikondachola after his victory over the Gangetic valley.
2. He conquered the islands of Andaman and Nicobar.
3. He commemorated his victories by constructing temples.
4. He is regarded as the real founder of the Chola empire.

Which of the above statements are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 3 and 4
(c) 1, 2 and 4 (d) 1, 2 and 3

3. Which of the following is false statement regarding Gupta's administration?

1. The king did not impose any restrictions on the movement of his subjects.
2. The governors of the provinces were independent.
3. The lowest unit of administration was the village.
4. The Gupta kings had direct control over military.

Correct answer.

(a) 4 only (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 2 and 4

4. The Gupta period is considered as the ‘Golden Age of India’ which of the following statement is true regarding this-

1. The Gupta age was progressive in foreign trade.
2. There was peace and prosperity.
3. There was tremendous development in the field of science.

Which of the above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 3 (b) 2 and 4
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) All of above

5. Which of the following are true with regard to Pulakesin II?

1. His brother Kubja-Vishnuvardhana founded the kingdom of Chalukyas of Vengi.
2. The Aihole inscription in Sanskrit is a eulogy written for him by the poet Ravikirti.

Which of the above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

6. Which of the following are marked by the agrarian structure in the Post - Gupta period?

1. Large scale grants of land in different parts of India.
2. Undermining of communal rights over land
3. Subjection of peasants
(a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3

7. With reference to Chandragupta I, consider the following statement-

1. He married a Licchavi princess and ascended the throne in about 320 A.D.
2. Chandragupta I ruled over Saketa, Prayag and Magadha.

Which of the above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

8. Which of the following statements are true about Gupta coinage?

(1) The Guptas issued the largest number of gold coins in the Gupta period.
(2) Chandragupta I issued Kaumradevi type of coins
(3) Chandragupta II issued silver coins for the first time among the Gupta
(4) Samudragupta coins are known for their purity.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below :

(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2, 3 and 4
(c) 1, 2, 3 and 4 (d) 1 and 2

9. Arrange the following astronomers in their correct chronological order:

1. Aryabhatta 2. Brahmagupta
3. Lagadh 4. Varahamihira

Choose your answer from the codes given below:

Codes:

(a) 1 2 3 4 (b) 2 1 4 3
(c) 3 1 4 2 (d) 4 3 2 1

10. Which of the following are true about Samudragupta?

1. He is also known as ‘Kaviraja’
2. He is known as “Lichchhavi Dauhitra”
3. He built most extensive empire after Ashoka.

Which of the statement(s) given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 3 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 1 and 3

11. Which of the following is correctly matched?

1. Kshetra : Cultivated land
2. Khila : Waste land
3. Aprahta : Forest land
4. Vasti : Pasture land

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Codes:

(a) 1, 2 and 4 (b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 1, 2, 3 and 4 (d) 2, 3 and 4

12. Arrange the following Gupta emperors in the chronological order

1. Samudragupta 2. Chandragupta-I
3. Skandagupta 4. Chandragupta-II

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

Codes:

- (a) 1 2 3 4 (b) 2 1 4 3
(c) 4 3 1 2 (d) 3 2 1 4

13. Which of the following pair(s) are/is correctly matched?

1. Charasada — Pushkalavati
2. Sirkap — Takshila
3. Nagarjunakonda — Vijaypuri
4. Ter — Tamralipti

Choose the correct answer from the codes given below:

Codes:

- (a) 1, 2 and 4 (b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 2 and 4 (d) 2, 3 and 4

14. Consider the following historical places:

1. Ajanta Caves 2. Lepakshi Temple
3. Sanchi Stupa

Which of the above places is/are also known for mural paintings?

- (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 only
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) None

15. The themes of the murals of the Ajanta Caves are

1. Decorative designs which include a variety of animals, trees and flowers.
2. Portraits of various Buddhas and Bodhiysattvas.
3. Narrative scenes portraying Jataka stories.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1 and 2 only

Matching Based MCQ

16. **List-I** **List-II**
(A) Chandragupta Maurya (1) 232 - 185 BC.
(B) Bindusaur (2) 269 - 232 BC.
(C) Ashoka (3) 321 - 297 BC.
(D) Brahadrath (4) 297 - 272 BC.
(a) A - 3, B - 1, C - 2, D - 4
(b) A - 2, B - 3, C - 1, D - 4
(c) A - 3, B - 4, C - 2, D - 1
(d) A - 4, B - 2, C - 3, D - 1

17. **List-I** **List-II**
A. Vikramaditya II 1. 633 - 34 A.D.
B. Pulakesin II 2. 606 - 647 A.D.
C. Harshavardhana 3. 335 A.D.
D. Samudragupta 4. 733 - 744 A.D.
(a) A - 4 ; B - 1 ; C - 3 ; D - 2
(b) A - 2 ; B - 1 ; C - 4 ; D - 3
(c) A - 4 ; B - 1 ; C - 2 ; D - 3
(d) A - 3 ; B - 4 ; C - 1 ; D - 2

18. **Kings** **Queens**
1. Chandragupta-I Kumaradevi
2. Samudragupta Dattadevi
3. Chandragupta-II Dhruvadevi
4. Kumargupta-I Kuberanaga

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

Codes:

- (a) 1, 2 and 4 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1, 2 and 3 (d) 2 and 4

19. **List-I** **List-II**
(Dynasty) **(Capital)**
A Chalukya of Gujarat 1. Tripuri
B Kalachuris of Chedi 2. Anhilvad
C Parmaras of Malva 3. Ajmer
D Chahmans of Sakambhari 4. Dhara

Codes:

- A B C D
(a) 1 3 2 4
(b) 2 1 4 3
(c) 2 3 4 1
(d) 4 1 2 3

20. **List-I** **List-II**
(Dynasty) **(State)**
A. Kadamba 1. Odisha
B. Kharvela 2. Karnataka
C. Chalukya 3. Bengal
D. Pala 4. Gujarat

Codes:

- A B C D
(a) 1 2 4 3
(b) 1 2 3 4
(c) 2 1 3 4
(d) 2 1 4 3

21. With reference to the Indian history of art and culture, consider the following pairs :

- | | <i>Famous work of Sculpture</i> | <i>Site</i> |
|-----|--|--------------|
| 1. | A grand image of Buddha's Mahaparinirvana with numerous celestial musicians above and the sorrowful figures of his followers below | Ajanta |
| 2.. | A huge image of Varaha Avatar (boar incarnation) of Vishnu, as he rescues Goddess Earth from the deep and chaotic waters, sculpted on rock | Mount Abu |
| 3. | "Arjuna's Penance"/ "Descent of Ganga" sculpted on the surface of huge boulders | Mamallapuram |

Which of the pairs given above is/are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Hints and Explanations

EXERCISE-1

1. (b) 2. (c) 3. (a)
4. (a) Tamralipta or Tamralipti was the name of an ancient city on the Bay of Bengal corresponding with Tamluk in modern-day India. Tamralipta may have been one of the most important urban centres of trade and commerce of early historic India, trading along the Silk Road with China, by Uttarapatha, the northern high road, the main trade route into the Middle East and Europe; and by seafaring routes to Bali, Java and the Far East.
5. (a) A copper plate inscription of Maharaja Subandhu, recording his donation for the repair of the vihara was found at the site of Cave 2. Though, the date of the Bagh inscription is missing, the Badwani copper plate inscription is dated in the year (Gupta era) 167 (487).
6. (c) Panchtantra was composed by Vishnu Sharma in Gupta period. Gupta period is golden age of Indian history.
7. (b) In the Gupta period, a dynasty of ancient India, that rules around AD 240 to 550, the decimal numeral system, including the concept of zero was invented.
8. (d) 9. (c) 10. (a) 11. (d) 12. (b)
13. (c) 14. (d) 15. (b) 16. (a) 17. (c)
18. (a) 19. (d) 20. (b) 21. (b) 22. (a)
23. (b) 24. (d) 25. (d)
26. (b) Chandragupta II ascended the throne in the year 56 of Gupta era. In 319, Chandragupta created for himself the title King of Kings (Maharajadhiraja), and he extended his rule westward to Prayaga, in north-central India. Ten years into his rule, Chandragupta lay dying, and he told his son, Samudragupta, to rule the whole world. His son tried. Samudragupta's forty-five years of rule would be described as one vast military campaign. He waged war along the Ganges plain, overwhelming nine kings and incorporating their subjects and lands into the Gupta empire.
27. (a) The guild organization described in the Mandasore inscription of Kumargupta was known as Tantuvaya. This inscription informs us that he was a feudatory of the Gupta emperor Kumargupta I. It was during his reign, a temple dedicated to Surya was constructed by the guild of silk-weavers at Dashapura in the Malava Samvat 493 (436 CE). This temple was renovated in 473 CE by the same guild.
28. (d) Vishnugopa was the ruler of Kanchi during the time of Samudragupta. In the southern Pallava kingdom of Kanchipuram, he defeated king Vishnugopa, then restored him and other defeated southern kings to their thrones on payment of tribute. Several northern kings were uprooted, however, and their territories added to the Gupta empire. At the height of Samudragupta's power, he controlled nearly all of the valley of the Ganges (Ganga) river and received homage from rulers of parts of east Bengal, Assam, Nepal, the eastern part of the Punjab, and various tribes of Rajasthan.
29. (d) Damodarpur copper plate inscription of the Gupta period gives details regarding the sale of land. Damodarpur (in Dinajpur District) Copper Plate No.1 of Kumargupta I (443–444AD) is probably the most important for a knowledge of local administrative pattern and is the most popular source for historians. It refers to Visayapati Kumaramatyā Vetravarman, who was appointed by (Tanniyukta) the Uparika Ciratadatta, Governor of Pundravardhana Bhukti. Vetravarman being in-charge of Kotivarsa Visaya (dist.) administered the government of the locality in the Administrative Board in company of Dhrtipala, the Nagaraśresthi, Bandhumitra, the Sarthavaha, Dhrtimitra – the Prathamakulika and Śambapala – the Prathama Kayastha. They were seen to come together and consult on the sales of land.
30. (b) In the Gupta inscription, Samudragupta has been called 'Lichchhavi Dauhitra'. There is also evidence of relationship between the early Guptas and the Lichchhavis. Chandragupta I married the Lichchhavi princess Kumaradevi, for which reason their son Samudragupta has been called Lichchhavi – duhitra. It is further indicated by some gold coins which, on the obverse, bear their figures and names and, on the reverse, the name of the Lichchhavis.
31. (b) The officer responsible for the safe custody of land records during the Gupta period was known as Karanika. This is the Dhruvadhī-Karanika (otherwise called Dhruvasthanadhikaranika) the officer in-charge of the Dhruvas, the last term being applied till recent times in Kathiawar and Cutch to denote persons who superintended the collection of land-revenue by the farmers on the king's behalf.
32. (b) Kuberanaga was the mother of Prabhavati Gupta. Chandragupta II married the Naga Princess Kuberanaga and gave his own daughter, Prabhavati, in marriage to Vakataka king, Rudra Sena II. The Vakataka alliance was master stroke of diplomacy as it secured the subordinate alliance of the Vakataka king who occupied a strategic geographical position. It is noteworthy that Rudra Sena died young and his widow reigned until her sons came of age.
33. (c) The travel account of Fa-hien is known as Fo-kwo-ki. Fa-hien or Faxian (AD 399 – 413): Fa-hien was the first Chinese monk to travel to India in search of great Buddhist scriptures. At the age of

- sixty-five, he travelled, mostly on foot, from Central China taking the southern route through Shenshen, Dunhuang, Khotan, and then over the Himalayas, to Gandhara and Peshawar.
34. (b) VA Smith complimented Samudragupta as the Indian Napoleon. Samudragupta embarked upon a policy of conquest. In fact, Digvijay became the ultimate call of his life. For his military achievements, he has been aptly complemented by the historian VA Smith as the Indian Napoleon. He has described Samudragupta as the Hero of Hundred Battles.
 35. (a) The word Vishti means Forced labour. While the Kshatriyas acquired their share of the social surplus through the force of arms in the form of taxes (Kar, Shulka, Bali, etc.), forced labour (Vishti, Balutam, etc.), tithes and other privileges. The Brahmin clergy enforced its claim to the social surplus through a moral deterrent which was based on strength of the tribal morality of distribution.
 36. (d) Expansion of agricultural land took place on the largest scale in Gupta age. The degeneration of the Vaisya's (the third, or trader caste), which had begun earlier, intensified during this period. Because of advanced agricultural techniques and developments in handicrafts, the condition of the Sudra's (the fourth, or menial caste) improved and there was no great difference between a poor Vaisya and a prosperous Sudra.
 37. (d) Mrichhakatikam literary works did not belong to the Gupta period. Of all the Sanskrit dramas, Mrichhakatika remains one of the most widely celebrated and oft-performed in the West, in part because its plot structure more closely resembles that of Western classics than other Hindu plays. The work played a significant role in generating interest in Indian theatre among European audiences following several successful nineteenth century translations and stage productions.
 38. (d) Harisena was the court poet of Samudragupta. Samudragupta was brilliant commander and a great conqueror is proved by Harisena's description of his conquests. He mentions that Samudragupta exterminated nine north Indian states, Subdued eighteen Atavika kingdoms near Bajalpur and Chhota Nagpur, and in his blitz-like campaign humbled the pride of twelve South Indian Kings, Nine border tribes, and five frontier states of Smatata, Devaka, Karupa, Nepal and Krtripur.
 39. (a) Veersena was the author of Mandasore inscription. There is an inscription about Bandhuverma at Mandasore. The silk workers had constructed a Sun temple here which was repaired by Bandhuverma in Samvat 493. This indicates that he was present there till 436 CE. The Risthal stone slab inscription discovered in 1983 has brought to light another Aulikara dynasty, which comprised the following kings in the order of succession: Drumavardhana, Jayavardhana, Ajitavardhana, Vibhishanavardhana, Rajyavardhana and Prakashadharma.
 40. (c) Samudragupta granted permission to Meghverma the ruler of Sri Lanka to build a Buddhist temple in Gaya. Kittisirimegha of Sri Lanka, a contemporary of Samudragupta, erected with the permission of Samudragupta, a Sangharama near the Mahabodhi Vihara, chiefly for the use of the Singhalese monks who went to worship the Bodhi tree.
 41. (d) In the Gupta administration, purpala was the administrator of conquered territories. The person was mostly from the authority who reign in that region itself but sometime the faithful of king also takes the control of these territories.
 42. (b) In 5th century AD, the famous Chinese pilgrim Fa-hien visit India. Travelling through central Asia and northwest India, Fa-hien reached northern India and then visited the holy Buddhist sites located in the Ganges valley: Kapilavastu, the birthplace of Buddha; Bodhgaya, the site of Buddha's enlightenment; Sarnath, where Buddha preached his first sermon, and Kushinagara, the place of Buddha's nirvana.
 43. (d) The six district school of Indian philosophy Sankhya, Yoga, Nyaya, Vaishasika, Mimansa, Vedanta became fully articulated during the Gupta period.
 44. (a) Vagbhatta was the author of a famous Ayurvedic text Ashtanghrdaya. The science of chemistry, due to its Vedic antiquity might have been first recognized in India, as a separate discipline. Alchemy and the science of medicine gave rise to the study of chemistry in India. The ancient masters as mentioned in connection with chemistry are: Patanjali, Bhavya Dattadeva, Vyadi, Svachchanda, Damodara, Vasudeva, Charaka, Sushruta, Harita and Vagbhata. Ancient Sanskrit documents about the advanced chemical science find the expression in activities like distillation of perfumes and fragrant ointments. It is also found in activities like manufacturing of dyes and chemical preparation of pigments and colours and polishing of mirrors.
 45. (b) Amarsingh was the author of Amarkosha. Amara seems to have been a Buddhist, and most of his work was destroyed, with the exception of what is the celebrated Amara-Kosha (Treasury of Amara), a vocabulary of Sanskrit roots, in three books, and hence sometimes called Trikantha or the "Tripartite". It is also known as "Namalinganushasana". It contains 10,000 words, and is arranged, like other works of its class, in metre, to aid the memory. The first chapter of the Kosha was printed at Rome in Tamil character in 1798.
 46. (d) During the Gupta period, the great epics of Ramayan and Mahabharat were given the final form. Traditionally, the authorship of the Mahabharata is attributed to Vyasa. There have been many attempts

- to unravel its historical growth and compositional layers. The oldest preserved parts of the text are thought to be not much older than around 400 BCE, though the origins of the epic probably fall between the 8th and 9th centuries BCE.
47. (b) Dhanavantri was a physician. Dhanvantari is depicted as Vishnu with four hands, holding medical herbs in one hand and a pot containing rejuvenating nectar called amrita in another. He is often shown with a leech in his hand rather than the scriptures. The Puranas state that Dhanavantari emerged from the 'Ocean of Milk' and appeared with the pot of nectar during the story of the Samudra or Sagar Manthan whilst the ocean was being churned by the Devas and Asuras, using the Mandara mountain and the serpent Vasuki.
48. (b) As mentioned by Hiuen Tsang, 10,000 students were studying in the Nalanda University. Founded in the 5th Century AD, Nalanda University is known as the ancient seat of learning. 2,000 teachers and 10,000 students from all over the Buddhist world lived and studied at Nalanda, the first Residential International University of the World. A walk in the ruins of the university, takes you to an era, that saw India leading in imparting knowledge, to the world – the era when India was a coveted place for studies. The University flourished during the 5th and 12th century.
49. (d) None of the above had the title 'Amoghavarsha'. The Arab traveller Sulaiman described Amoghavarsha as one of the four great kings of the world. Sulaiman also wrote that Amoghavarsha respected Muslims and that he allowed the construction of mosques in his cities. Because of his religious temperament, his interest in the arts and literature and his peace-loving nature, historian Panchamukhi has compared him to the emperor Ashoka and given him the honorific title "Ashoka of the South"
50. (b) Bakhtiyar Khilji destroyed the Nalanda University in 1202 AD. The prince of perverts – Muhammad Bakhtiyar Khalji – is a blot on the human race. And yet the town of Bakhtiyarpur in Bihar, close to the site of his cruel depredations, bears his name. Bakhtiyar Khalji holds a pride of place because, unlike the other Muslim marauders, he was not content with destroying the areas he traversed.
51. (d) Trayipurusha temple at Salotgi was a well known centre of higher education. Shri Narayan, minister to the Rastrakulta king of South India, constructed a temple in Salotgi (Bijapur) which in the twelfth century became a centre for Vedic education. Many buildings were built there for students to stay in. A description of this says that five hundred acres of land were donated (Epigraphia India) for classrooms, lodging and boarding.
52. (c) 53. (c) 54. (b) 55. (c) 56. (d)
57. (a) 58. (a) 59. (c) 60. (c) 61. (b)
62. (b) 63. (c) 64. (c) 65. (a) 66. (b)
67. (a) 68. (d) 69. (b) 70. (a) 71. (a)
72. (c) 73. (b) 74. (d) 75. (c) 76. (a)
77. (d) 78. (a) 79. (d) 80. (b) 81. (a)
82. (d) 83. (a) 84. (b) 85. (d) 86. (a)
87. (b) 88. (c) 89. (d) 90. (b) 91. (a)
92. (d) 93. (b) 94. (c) 95. (d) 96. (c)
97. (c) 98. (b) 99. (d) 100. (a) 101. (d)
102. (d) 103. (b) 104. (d) 105. (c)
106. (c) Fa-hien was a Chinese monk who travelled India during the age of Chandra Gupta Vikramaditya. He travelled during C 399-414. Fa-hien wanted to go to India to search for the treatises of the Vinaya Pitaka, the monastic rules of BUDDHISM. Travelling through Central Asia and Northwest India, Fa-hien reached northern India and then visited the holy Buddhist sites located in the Ganges valley: Kapilavastu, the birthplace of Buddha; Bodhgaya, the site of Buddha's enlightenment; Sarnath, where Buddha preached his first sermon, and Kushinagara, the place of Buddha's nirvana.
107. (b) Pulikeshn II (610-642 CE) is the most famous ruler of the Chalukya dynasty. The Aihole inscription describes how the mighty Harsha lost his harsha (joy) when he suffered the ignominy of defeat. Pulikeshi entered into a treaty with Harsha, with the Narmada River designated as the border between the Chalukya Empire and that of Harshavardhana.
108. (a)
109. (a) Varahamihira was an Indian astronomer, mathematician, and astrologer who lived in Ujjain. He wrote Brihat Samhita which covers astrology, planetary movements, eclipses, rainfall, clouds, architecture, growth of crops, manufacture of perfume, matrimony, domestic relations, gems, pearls, and rituals.
110. (d) Sapphire was the most precious stone in terms of foreign trade in Gupta period.
111. (b) University of Nalanda was set up by Gupta king Kumargupta I in 415 A.D.
112. (c) Hieun Tsang was a Chinese Buddhist monk who visited the kingdom of Harshvardhan and Kumar Bhaskar Varma.
113. (b) Chalukya ruler Pulkesin II checked Emperor Harshavardhan's expedition in South India. Pulkesin II had not let Harshavardhan come across Narmada according to its Ahole inscription.
114. (c) Pulkesin II was the greatest Chalukya king. He defeated Harsh on bank of Narmada.
115. (c) During Gupta period, Sanskrit was the official language.
116. (a) Kautilya wrote Arthashastra in which the notion of saptanga is mentioned including kings, territory, administration and treasury.
117. (b) The Gupta Empire was ruled by members of the Gupta dynasty from around 320 to 550 AD and covered most of North-central India, Gupta Empire (never included Pakistan); and what is now western India and Bangladesh. The time of the Gupta Empire is referred to as Golden Age

of India in science, mathematics, astronomy, religion and philosophy.

118. (a) The Ajanta Caves in Aurangabad district of Maharashtra, India are about 30 rock-cut Buddhist cave monuments which date from the 2nd century BCE to about 480 or 650 CE.

EXERCISE-2

1. (b) 2. (d) 3. (a) 4. (d)
5. (c) Pulakesin was the contemporary ruler of Harshavardhana and was the most famous Chalukya king. He ruled from 609 to 642 A.D.
6. (d) 7. (c) 8. (a)
9. (c) The correct chronological order is:
Lagadh, Aryabhatta, Varahamihira, Brahmagupta
The author of the treatise “Dzhetisha-Vedanga” (“Jyotisavedanga”), written between 450 and 350 BC. This work is a guide to determine the time for execution of the Vedic sacrificial. “Dzhetisha-Vedanga” preserved in the revised and corrected, which used Rigvediyya-Brahmins Aryabhata the Elder to distinguish him from a 10th-century Indian mathematician of the same name, he flourished in Kusumapura—near Pataliputra (Patna), then the capital of the Gupta dynasty. Varahamihira, also called Varahamira or simply Varaha, was one of the most celebrated scientists in South Asian history, having made substantial contributions to virtually all branches of the arts and sciences. Brahmagupta was the foremost Indian mathematician of his time. He made advances in astronomy and most importantly in number systems including algorithms for square roots and the solution of quadratic equations.
10. (c) Samudragupta is also known as ‘Kaviraja-Lichchhavi Dauhitra’. ‘Samudragupta was man of many sided genius, who put to shame the preceptor of the Lord Gods and Tumburu and Narada and others by his sharp and polished intellect and Chorla-skill and musical accomplishment. The Allahabad inscription, composed by the court poet Harisena in praise of Samudragupta’s spectacular victories, lists the names of kings and countries defeated by the Gupta ruler. During Samudragupta’s reign, the Gupta empire became one of the largest in the East. Its fluence spread and close ties were established with many other stages. This assessment made by the court poet of old has considerable influence on many modern scholars who tend to idealise Samudragupta and described him as did Vincent A. Smith as (as the Indian Napoleon) an outstanding individual possessed of remarkable qualities.
11. (b) The correct matched pairs are:
Kshetra — Cultivated land
Khila — Waste land
Aparahata — Forest land
These are the types of land available in the country at

that time. Despite these, there is one more class called Charagah land, which is used as a Pasture land.

12. (b) The correct chronological order is:
Chandragupta-I, Samudragupta, Chandragupta-II, Skandagupta
Ghatotkacha (C. 280–319) CE, had a son named Chandragupta. In a breakthrough deal, Chandragupta was married to Kumaradevi, a Lichchhavi—the main power in Magadha. With a dowry of the kingdom of Magadha (capital Pataliputra) and an alliance with the Lichchhavis, Chandragupta set about expanding his power, conquering much of Magadha, Prayaga and Saketa. Samudragupta was not only a warrior but also a great patron of art and literature. The important scholars present in his court were Harishena, Vasubandhu and Asanga. Chandragupta II, the Sun of Power (Vikramaditya), ruled until 413. He married his daughter Prabhavatigupta to Rudrasena II, the Vakataka king of Deccan, and gained a valuable ally. Skandagupta is generally considered the last of the great rulers. He defeated the Pushyamitra threat, but then was faced with invading Hephthalites or “White Huns”, known in India as Indo-Hephthalites or Hunas, from the northwest. He repulsed a Hunan attack C. 455. But the expense of the wars drained the empire’s resources and contributed to its decline. Skandagupta died in 467 and was succeeded by his son Narasimhagupta Baladitya.
13. (b) The correctly matched pairs are:
Charasadda — Pushkalavati
Sirkap — Takshila
Nagarjunakonda — Vijayapuri
Pushkalavati (modern-day Charasadda) is an ancient site situated in Peshawar valley in the Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province (formerly NWFP) of Pakistan. It is located on the banks of Swat river, near its junction with Kabul river. Sirkap is the name of an archaeological site on the bank opposite to the city of Takshila, Punjab, Pakistan. The city of Sirkap was built by the Greco-Bactrian king Demetrius after he invaded India around 180 BCE. A city flourished around 1,800 years ago at Nagarjunakonda, the Hill of Nagarjuna. A great religious and educational centre of Brahmanism and Buddhism, one of the names it had then was Vijayapuri, after king Vijaya Satakarni of the Satavahana dynasty. Thereafter a capital of the Ikshvaku dynasty (225 – 325 CE), it fell into terminal decline after the demise of the last Ikshvaku king. A teacher, S Venkataramayya, discovered the ruins of the ancient city in 1926.
14. (b) Ajanta Caves have mural paintings in caves 1, 2, 16 and 17. Some of the paintings were commissioned by Harisena of Vakataka dynasty. The theme of the paintings was Jataka tales. Lepakshi Temple is renowned for being one of the best repositories of mural paintings of the Vijaynagar kings. Sanchi

Stupa has many beautiful sculptures but not mural paintings.

15. (a) Ajanta caves are 29 rock cut cave monuments which date from 2nd century B.C. They have Buddhist religious art and depict Jataka tales. In 1819, John Smith a British army officer rediscovered the cave while on a hunting expedition. Paintings cover every surface except the floor.

16. (c) 17. (c)

18. (c) The correctly matched pairs are:

Chandragupta-I Kumaradevi
Samudragupta Dattadevi
Chandragupta-II Dhruvadevi

In a breakthrough deal, Chandragupta was married to Kumaradevi, a Lichchhavi princess the main power in Magadha. With a dowry of the kingdom of Magadha (capital Pataliputra) and an alliance with the Lichchhavis. Samudragupta's chief queen was named Dattadevi; and he seems to have had a number of sons by her and others; for we are told that he specially chose one of them, the later Chandragupta II, to succeed him. This seems to indicate that this prince was not the eldest son. Unfortunately, we have no details. Dhruvadevi was a queen of the Gupta dynasty. She reigned as the wife of Chandragupta II (380–415 AD) and mother of Kumaragupta (415–455 AD). Previously she had been married to Chandragupta's brother Ramagupta. She was a great patron of poets and gave shelter to many scholars in the Gupta court. Famed for her beauty and intellect, she was first married to the weak and cowardly son of Samudragupta, Ramagupta. Sometime later the mighty Shaka demanded of the Guptas that they hand over Dhruvadevi as a condition for peace.

19. (b) The correct match list is:

Dynasty	Capital
Chalukya of Gujarat	Anhilvad
Kalachuris of Chedi	Tripuri
Parmaras of Malwa	Dhara
Chahmans of Sakambhari	Ajmer

The Chalukya dynasty was an Indian royal dynasty that ruled large parts of southern and central India between the 6th and the 12th centuries. During this period, they ruled as three related yet individual dynasties. The Kalachuris, also known as the Haihayas, were an ancient people known from the Epics and Puranas from 249 or 250 AD. Several branches of the Kalachuris were settled in different parts of northern India. In the later half of sixth century AD, they ruled over a powerful kingdom comprising Gujarat,

northern Maharashtra, and later then some parts of Malwa. The Paramara. Their ancient capital was Chandrawati, situated 4 miles away from Abu station. This Vansha evolves out from the Agni Kunda of Yagya on the Abu mountain."ParajanMarithiParmar" means "Vansha which defeats the enemy" hence it is called Parmar. In 973–1192, Chahmans of Sakambhari (Ajmer – Rajasthan)

20. (d) The correct match list of dynasty and states is:

Dynasty	State
Kadamba	Karnataka
Kharvela	Odisha
Chalukya	Gujarat
Pala	Bengal

The Kadamba dynasty (345 – 525 CE) was a primeval majestic dynasty of Karnataka that ruled from Vijayanti or Banavasi in present day Uttara Kannada district. The decline of the Satavahana power in the Deccan was followed by the rule of many lesser dynasties like the Chutus, the Abhiras and the Ikshvakus. During the third century AD the Karnataka area, however, emerged out of this political confusion in the following century. Kharavela (193 BCE – after 170 BCE) was the third and greatest emperor of the Mahameghavahana dynasty of Kalinga (present-day Odisha). The main source of information about Kharavela is his famous seventeen line rock-cut Hatigumpha inscription in a cave in the Udayagiri hills near Bhubaneswar, Odisha. The Chalukya dynasty was a powerful Indian royal dynasty that ruled large parts of southern and central India between the 6th and the 12th century CE. Pala dynasty, ruling dynasty in Bihar and Bengal, India, from the 8th to the 12th centuries. Its founder, Gopala, was a local chieftain who rose to power in the mid-8th century during a period of anarchy.

21. (c) 1 is correctly matched because Parinirvana of the Buddha in Cave 17 of Ajanta, with numerous celestial musicians above and the sorrowful figures of his followers below, is one of the grandest and yet most delicately expressive scenes ever made in stone. 2 is wrong because huge image of Varaha Avatar of Vishnu, as he rescues Goddess Earth from the deep and chaotic waters, sculpted on rock is found in Mamallapuram. 3 is right because Arjuna's Penance "Descent of Ganga" sculpted on the surface of huge boulders is found in Mamallapuram.



Introduction

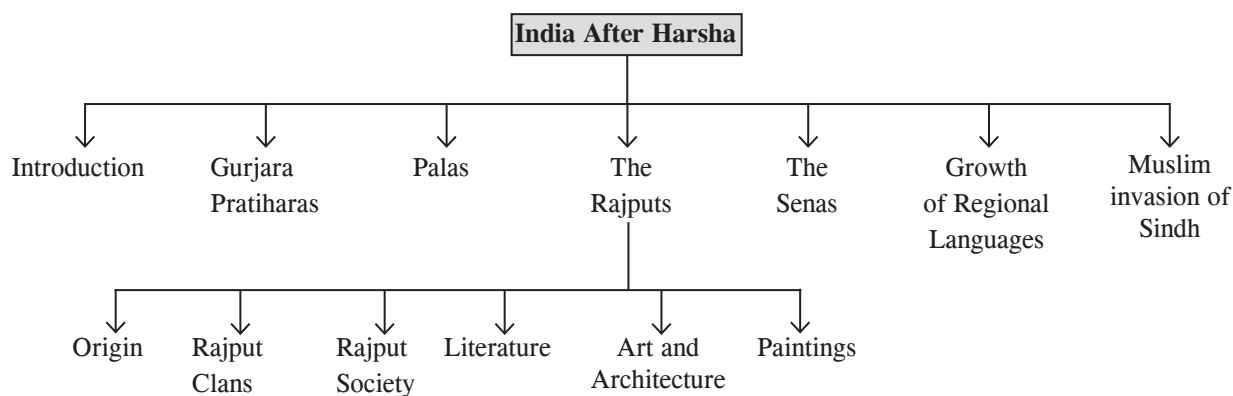
After the death of Harshavardhan, the unity fabricated by him in the north India, disintegrated. There opened several centres of power and resulted in the emergence of the multi-state system or as **Prof. Ishwari Prasad** says, “*India was nations within the nation.*”

But soon, the political disturbance and chaos gave chance to the Arabs to invade India (712 A.D.). The series of foreign invasions ruined India and at the same time forced the small petty feudatories to become strong and face the situation.

Thus, the period is marked with important developments such as:

- (i) Rise of important kingdoms in eastern, central, southern and northern India. However, these acted as a bridge between different regions because the cultural traditions of these kingdoms remained stable even though they often fought among themselves.
- (ii) There remained continuity in the field of economy, social structure, ideas and beliefs. This was perhaps because the changes in these areas took place more gradually than the changes in political spheres. The close interaction among various regions resulted in the formation of definite forms of some common cultural trends which can be seen in the literature, education, art and architecture of the period.

In the northern part of India and Deccan, three dynasties came into existence. These were Gurjara-Pratiharas, Palas and Rashtrakutas.



INDIA AFTER HARSHA

Gurjara-Pratiharas

The Gurjara-Pratiharas were the early Rajputs who started their rule from Gujarat and south western Rajasthan. Later they ruled from Kannauj. *Nagabhata* I was the first great ruler of the dynasty. He defeated the Muslim forces of Arab. *Bhoja* I (A.D. 836-885) was another prominent ruler of this dynasty. He succeeded in restoring the territories of the kingdom which

was lost for a short time to the Palas of Bengal. He was a devotee of Vishnu and adopted the title of *Adivarahi*, which has been incorporated as legend on some of his coins. During the reign of *Mahendrapala* I, son and successor of *Bhoja* I, the Pratihara emperor extended almost from the Himalayas in the north to the Vindhya in the south and from Bengal in the east to Gujarat in the west.

The Pratiharas ruled over north India for more than three hundred years. The *Arab* travelers such as *Sulaiman* and *Al Masudi*, who visited India in the ninth and tenth centuries A.D., wrote about the power and prestige of the Pratihara rulers and the vastness of their empire.

The Pratiharas were patrons of arts, crafts, learning and literature. The great Sanskrit poet *Rajashekhara* adorned the court of *Mahendrapala I*. His famous work is *Kavyamimansa*. The Pratiharas embellished Kannauj with fine buildings and temples.

Palas

The founder of Palas dynasty was *Gopala I* who was elected as the king by the people. He was able to consolidate his kingdom and established a powerful empire of Pala dynasty.

Dharmapala and *Devapala* were the most powerful rulers of this dynasty. They extended and consolidated the Pala Empire. The Palas ruled over Bihar, Bengal and parts of Orissa and Assam with many ups and downs in their fortune for over four centuries.

The Pala rulers were great supporter of learning and religions. *Dharmapala* founded the famous Buddhist monastery at *Vikramshila*, which became second only to Nalanda in fame as a centre for higher learning. During Palas' reign, the fame of *Nalanda University* spread all over the world.

During Devapala's reign the king of Suvarnadvipa (South East Asia) Balaputradeva built a monastery in Nalanda and requested Devapala to endow the income of five villages for the maintenance of the monastery.

Tripartite Struggle

The most important event of post-Harsha-period was tripartite conflict among the *Gurjara-Pratiharas*, *Rashtrakutas* and *Palas* for the supremacy of the north. This conflict started during the reign of *Vatsaraja-Pratihara*. He ascended the throne in A.D. 778. In order to give practical shape to his imperialist designs, *Vatsaraja* with the help of his feudatory chiefs attacked *Dharmapala*, the Pala king of Bengal, and carried away his state umbrella.

While the conflict between *Batsaraja* and *Dharmapala* was going on to establish supremacy in the north, *Dhruva*, the *Rashtrakuta* king of south, launched an attack on *Vatsaraja* and inflicted a crushing defeat upon him. *Dhruva* next turned against *Dharmapala* and defeated him somewhere between the Ganges and the Yamuna. Thus, began the tripartite struggle between the Pratiharas, Palas and *Rashtrakutas* for the supremacy in northern India. The city of Kannauj, which was elevated to an important position by *Harshavardhana*, seems to have been the coveted prize won by each. Though *Vatsaraja* defeated *Dharmapala* and both suffered a defeat at the hands of *Dhruva*, the *Rashtrakuta* king, yet it so appears that the condition of *Vatsaraja* had worsened as *Dharmapala* continued enjoying his hold over Kannauj even after suffering a defeat from him, *Dharmapala* also convened an assembly at Kannauj which was attended by the rulers of various states.

Vatsaraja was succeeded by his son and successor, *Nagabhatta*, who too was ambitious and an imperialist. He made efforts to restore the lost prestige of his empire. His efforts were crowned with tremendous success. From the Gwalior plates, we learn that *Nagabhatta* defeated *Dharmapala* and advanced as far as Monghyr. *Nagabhatta's* victory over *Dharmapala*

proved temporary and short-lived. Once again the *Rashtrakuta* king, *Govinda III*, upset the schemes of the Pratihara king.

Nagabhatta was succeeded by *Ramabhadra*, who ruled for a very short period. He was a weak ruler and during his times, the country was frequently invaded. *Ramabhadra* was succeeded by his son, *Bhoja*. He was probably the greatest and most illustrious king of Pratihara dynasty. *Bhoja* restored the lost glory and prestige of Pratihara Empire. In order to regain the lost power, he had to wage war against the Palas. The Pala king at that time was *Devapala*. *Bhoja* led an expedition towards the south. The chief attraction in south was the tottering condition of *Rashtrakuta* dynasty. From *Rashtrakuta* inscriptions, we learn that here too *Raja Bhoja* suffered a defeat.

In spite of these resistances *Bhoja* did not lose heart. From an inscription we learn that he resolved to "conquer all the three worlds", and so he renewed his aggressive career. By that time *Devapala*, the powerful king of Pala dynasty had expired and his successors were weak and peace-loving. Moreover his contemporary *Rashtrakuta* king at this time was *Amoghavarsha*. *Amoghavarsha* came into conflict with the rulers of Pala dynasty in which he scored some success.

Bhoja also tried to take advantage of the weak position of the Pala kings and attacked Bengal. The Pala king *Narayana Pala* suffered a crushing defeat and *Bhoja* annexed the western parts of his empire. *Bhoja* also had to wage a protracted war against the *Rashtrakutas* who had already dealt a crushing defeat on him. *Bhoja* made Kannauj as the capital of Pratihara Empire.

Raja Bhoja was succeeded by *Mahendrapala*. He defeated Bengal, the home territory of his hereditary enemies, the Palas. He was succeeded by *Mahipala*. He invaded *Rashtrakutas*. Even during the reign of *Mahipala's* successors, the *Rashtrakuta* invasions continued. After *Devapala* the glory of Palas came to an end and *Devapala's* successors could not resist the *Rashtrakuta* and Pratihara invasions. The *Sena* dynasty succeeded the Palas in Bengal.

The Rajputs

The smaller states in northern India were ruled by people known as Rajputs. The period between A.D. 647 and A.D. 1192 i.e. 500 years is known as the Rajput period in the history of India. With the downfall of Pratihara Empire, a number of Rajput states came into existence in north India.

Origin

There are different theories regarding the origin of the Rajputs. One theory suggests that the Rajputs are descendants of the ancient Kshatriyas belonging to either Sun family (*Suryavansha*) or Moon family (*Chandravansha*). There is a theory of the foreign origin also. But there were four clans which claimed that they had not descended from either of these two families but from the fire family (*agni-kula*). These four clans were the most important in the history of this period. They were the Pratiharas (or *Pariharas*) not to be confused with the main Pratiharas- the *Chauhans*, *Solankis*, and *Pawars* (or *Paramars*). The four ("agni-kula") clan established their power in Western India and over parts of Central India and Rajasthan. The foreign origin of some of the Rajput clans is definitely proved by the epigraphic evidence. On the whole, the diversity of the cults and beliefs, manners and customs prevalent among the Rajputs seems to indicate diversity of origin.

Gahadvalsa, Parmars and Chauhans

The most powerful Rajputs were the Gahadvalas of Kannauj, the Paramaras of Malwa, and the Chauhans of Ajmer. There were other smaller dynasties in different parts of the country, like the **Kalachuris** in the area around modern Jabalpur, the **Chandellas** in Bundelkhand, the **Chalukyas** of Gujarat, and the **Tomars** of Delhi, etc. the **Gahadvalas** of Kannauj gradually squeezed the Palas out of Bihar, and made Banaras a second capital. Meanwhile, the Chauhans who had established themselves at Ajmer were gradually extending their empire towards Gujarat, as well as towards Delhi and the Punjab. On the periphery of what had been the three major kingdoms, there had arisen a number of small states. These were Nepal, Kamarupa (Asaam), Kashmir, and Utkala (Orissa). Many of the hill states of the Punjab came into being at this time, including Champaka (Chamba), Durgara (Jammu) and Kuluta (Kulu). The obsession with local affairs and infighting among the states made them weak.

The Four Agnikula Rajput Clans

- (i) **The Parihara** - also known as Pratihara based in southern Rajasthan.

- (ii) **The Chauhans** - helped Pratihara against Arabs, based in eastern Rajasthan.
- (iii) **The Solankis** - also called Chalukyas of Gujarat, based in Kathiawara.
- (iv) **The Pawars of Parmars** - established their control in Malwa with their capital at Dhar near Indore.

The four clans dominated early Rajput activities.

Rajput Society

The Feudal order was strongly established among the Rajputs. The Rajput rulers divided the Kingdoms among landed units called **Jairs** and distributed them among faithful nobles. The Rajputs were Hindus and were known as Kshatriyas, being a warrior class. They celebrated the major Hindu festivals and invoked Goddesses like Durga or Bhavani for strength and valour. Rajput women were respected in society but did not enjoy the same position as men.

Rajput Contribution to Literature

The period under the Rajputs also witnessed the blossoming of literature. Munja of the Paramar dynasty of Malwa was a great scholar and poet. Another king, King Bhoj was well-known for his wisdom and learning and assumed the title of Raviraja.

Important Literary Work

Subject area	Name of the author	Name of the work	Remarks
Poetry	1. Jaideva 2. Bharavi 3. Bharatrhari 4. Damodar Gupta 5. Magha	Gita Govinda Kiatarjuneya Ravana Vadha Kuttanimata Sishupala Vadha Shri Harsha	• Jaideva was the court poet of Lakshmanasena of Bengal.
Drama	1. Raja Sekhara 2. Bhavabhuti	Bal Ramayana Mahavir Charita	• Raja Sekhara was the court poet of Mahendrapal, the Pratihara ruler. • Bhavabhuti wrote in Prakrit Malati Madhav, Uttara Ramcharita
Historic Work	1. Vandra Narain 2. Kalhana 3. Jayaniak 4. Hemchandra	Veni Sanhara Rajtarangini Prithviraj Vijay Kumarpal Charita	• Veni Sanhar is full of heroic tales. • Rajatarangini narrates the history of Kashmir • Prithviraj Vijay and Kumarpal Charit are Great sources of contemporary history.
Biography	1. Bilhana 2. Chand Bardai 3. Ballala	Vikramadeva Charita Prithviraj Raso Bhoja Prabandhu	• It is the biography of a Chalukya King. • It deals with the exploits of Prithviraj Chauhan. • It shows light on the life of king Bhoja.
Stories	1. Somadeva	Kathasarita Sagar Hitopadesha	• Hitopadesha is a collection of short stories based on Panchtantra.
Medicine and Science	1. Baghbhatta 2. Chakrapani Dutta 3. Bhaskaracharya 4. Saridhari	Astanghriday Ayurveda Siddhanta Siromani Tarisati	
Grammar	1. Jayaditya 2. Bharatrhari	Kasikvitri Commentary on Panini's Mahabhasya.	

Rajput Art and Architecture

The palaces of Jaipur and Udaipur and the forts of Chittor, Mandu, Jodhpur and Gwalior are fine examples of Rajput architecture. *Dilwara* temples at *Mount Abu*, the *Vimala Vasahi* and the *Luna Vasahi* were built by Soalankis of Gujarat.

Rajput Paintings

The Rajput paintings are classified into the *Rajasthani School of Art* and the *Pahari School of Art*. The Rajasthani School flourished in Mewar, Bikaner, Jaipur, Jodhpur, Jaisalmer and Bundi and specialized in depicting scenes from Krishna lila, Mayika Veda and Ritu Charita. The Pahari School was patronized by the rulers of Himalayan states especially in the regions of Basoli, Mandi, Jammu, Kangra, Garhwal. Sansar Chand, the ruler of Kangra encourages this school of paintings dealing with Radha and Krishna, Baramasa (12 months) and Ragas (Melodies). The best examples of Paharei school are the Nal Damayanti and Goghara, the Govardhan Dharan and the seize of Lanka.

The Senas

After the downfall of the Palas, the Senas under *Samanta Sena* formed an empire in Bengal. *Vijay Sena*, his grandson can be attributed to be the real founder of the empire as he united the whole of Bengal under his rule and ruled for about 70 years. A Saivite, he also gave patronage to art. Deopara Prasesti was composed by Umapatidhar during his time. The Empire came into decline during the reign of Lakshmansena. The Sultanate ruler *Muhammed Bakhtiyar Khilji's* attack led to its quick decay.

Apart from these, there were Ahoms in Assam, in Orissa Kesaries and Gangas from Bhubaneswar and Kalinganagar respectively ruled.

Kashmir was ruled by three dynasties- the Karkota, Utpala and Loharas. Lalitaditya was the most famous ruler of Kashmir during this period.

These rulers were at regular fights with each other for supremacy which made them weak. The contact between these small kingdoms and outside world was very limited. Even contacts between these kingdoms were limited to war. So, they could neither defend themselves individually nor unite against the Muslim invasions.

Growth of Regional Languages

A remarkable feature of the period was the growth of regional languages. Prakrit, the language of the masses played an important role in the development of local languages, such as Hindi, Marathi, Gujarati, Bengali and Oriya.

Muslim Invasion of Sindh

In A.D. 712 *Al Hajjaj* led an expedition against Sindh's ruler *Dahir*, under his nephew and son-in-law, *Muhammad-bin-Qasim*. This expedition put Sindh under the Arabs for about 200 years.

The cause of this invasion was neither the wish for territorial expansion nor religious. The king of Ceylon had sent some gifts to the king of Turkey which were looted at Debal in Sindh by the pirates. The ruler of the Sindh, *Dahir* refused to compensate the loss by showing his ignorance to the incident. But this could not satisfy the ego of the provincial governor of *Basra*, *Al Hajjaj*, who immediately sent an army expedition in 637. But, he was unsuccessful. Another military expedition met with the same fate.

The Arabs assault paved the way for further wrath of the attacker into India. It was against this background that *Mahmud of Ghazni* invaded the country in A.D. 1000 for her wealth. He wanted to make Ghazni, a principality of Afghanistan, into a region wielding formidable power in the politics of Central Asia. In a short period of 25 years, he made 17 raids. He destroyed many temples, e.g. Somnath temples in Gujarat as they were depositories of vast quantities of wealth.

Second attack from north-west was made by *Muhammed Ghori* at the end of 12th century, for which India was not prepared.

His first invasion was against *Multan* in A.D. 1175, which was successful.

He attacked from *Gomal pass* in 1182, and conquered *Sindh*. In 1182, he conquered *Lahore* and soon after, an attack was commenced on the Rajput kingdoms controlling the Ganges plain. *Prithviraj Chauhan* led the Rajputs against Muhammed Ghori at the *first battle of Tarain* in 1191 and the Rajputs became victorious. At the second battle in 1192 at the same place, Prithviraj was defeated and the kingdom of Delhi fell to Muhammed Ghori. Before his assassination in 1206, Turks had conquered the Ganga-Yamuna doab and its neighbouring areas, and Bihar and Bengal were also overrun. He started a new era in Indian history.

Points to Remember

- Mahmud of Ghazni ascended the throne in A.D. 998
- He invaded India to plunder the big towns and rich temples.
- He annexed Punjab and Multan to his empire.
- The famous historian Alberuni came in and wrote the famous *Tahrik-Hind*.
- In 1175 A.D. another wave of attack came from Shahabuddin Muhammed Ghori.
- He belonged to the ruling family in Afghanistan.
- His aim of invasion of India was to lay the foundations of the Muslim Empire here.
- He was a contemporary of Prithviraj Chauhan, who had ascended the throne at the age of 14.
- Prithviraj Chauhan was defeated by Muhammed Ghori at the second battle of Tarain in A.D. 1192

Exercise -1

1. Which of the following is not true about Rajputs?
 - (a) Their rise was an important social phenomenon of the early medieval period.
 - (b) They comprised the ruling and warrior chiefs
 - (c) They were a landed aristocracy
 - (d) The medas were denied entry to their ranks
2. Gold coins attributed to Harsha depict on the reverse
 - (a) Avalokitesvara
 - (b) Tara
 - (c) Surya
 - (d) Shiva-Parvati
3. The famous commentator of Vedic literature, associated with the Paramaras was
 - (a) Apararka
 - (b) Kshirasvamin
 - (c) Soyana
 - (d) Uvata
4. Who among the following exposed evils of the contemporary society by his satirical writings?
 - (a) Vishakhadatta
 - (b) Banabhatta
 - (c) Kalhana
 - (d) Kshemendra
5. Who among the following was the patron of the Kota school of painting?
 - (a) Balawant Singh
 - (b) Govardhan Singh
 - (c) Savant Singh
 - (d) Umed Singh
6. Rajashekhar, the author of 'Karpurmanjari', was the teacher of
 - (a) Mahendrapala I
 - (b) Narsimhavarma II
 - (c) Bhoja Parmara
 - (d) Yuvarajadeva II
7. Who among the following has been criticized by Kalhana for confiscating the temple treasure?
 - (a) Avantivarman
 - (b) Didda
 - (c) Harsha
 - (d) Lalitaditya
8. Who among the following levied Turushka-danda?
 - (a) Gahadavalas
 - (b) Chandellas
 - (c) Chahamanas
 - (d) Shahis
9. Which of the following sources provides a vivid description of Sindh?
 - (a) Khazainul Futuh
 - (b) Tarikh-i-Firoz-Shahi
 - (c) Insha-i-mehru
 - (d) Chachnamah
10. Kumardevi, the Queen of Govindachandra Gahadavala, constructed Dharmachakra-jina-vihar at
 - (a) Bodhgaya
 - (b) Kusinagar
 - (c) Kanauj
 - (d) Sarnath
11. Harsha had assumed the title
 - (a) Parama-Bhagavata
 - (b) Parama-Mahesvara
 - (c) Parama-Saugata
 - (d) Parama-Adityabhah
12. The Chola rulers were generally
 - (a) Saivites
 - (b) Vaisnavites
 - (c) Worshipers of Mother-goddess
 - (d) Worshipers of Kartikeya
13. The Turkish brought with them musical instruments
 - (a) Rabab and Sarangi
 - (b) Sitar and Flute
 - (c) Veena and Tabla
 - (d) Tanpura and Mridang
14. Harsha's military expansion in the Deccan was checked by
 - (a) Mahendrarvarman
 - (b) Dantidurga
 - (c) Rajendra
 - (d) Pulakesin II
15. Who of the following adopted Garuda as dynasty emblem after the imperial Guptas?
 - (a) Rashtrakutas
 - (b) Western Chalukyas
 - (c) Shilaharas
 - (d) Chedis
16. The north Indian dynasties that confronted the Rashtrakutas were
 - (a) The Pratiharas and the Paramaras
 - (b) The Palas and the Chandelas
 - (c) The Pratiharas and the Palas
 - (d) The Chalukyas and the Chahamanas
17. The Vikramshila Mahavihara, the renowned educational centre of Pala period at
 - (a) Antichak
 - (b) Aphasad
 - (c) Basarh
 - (d) Chandimau
18. Which one of the following Chola rulers had persecuted Ramanuja and ousted him from his Kingdom?
 - (a) Kulothunga I
 - (b) Kulothunga II
 - (c) Adhirajendra
 - (d) Rajaraja I
19. Which one of the following was the primary assembly in the Chola village administration?
 - (a) Nadu
 - (b) Sabha
 - (c) Ur
 - (d) Mahasabha
20. A Chalukya inscription is dated in the year 556 of the Saka era. Its equivalent is to
 - (a) 478 AD
 - (b) 499 AD
 - (c) 613 AD
 - (d) 634 AD
21. Vikramshila Mahavihar was established by the ruler of
 - (a) Pushyabhuti dynasty
 - (b) Barman dynasty
 - (c) Sen dynasty
 - (d) Pala dynasty
22. In which court was a Chinese embassy sent by T'ang emperor?
 - (a) Rajaraja I
 - (b) Rajendra I
 - (c) Harshavardhana
 - (d) Prantaka I
23. Who founded the four Mathas in the four corners of India?
 - (a) Shankaracharya
 - (b) Ramanujacharya
 - (c) Bhaskaracharya
 - (d) Madhvacharya
24. The presiding deity of Bhojsala Temple is
 - (a) Goddess Durga
 - (b) Goddess Laxmi
 - (c) Goddess Saraswati
 - (d) Goddess Parvati
25. Rath Temples at Mahabalipuram were built in the reign of which Pallava ruler?
 - (a) Mahendravarman
 - (b) Narasinghvarman I
 - (c) Parameshwarvarman
 - (d) Nandivarman I
26. 'Ramayan am' the Tamil version of the great epic Ramayana was made by
 - (a) Kamban
 - (b) Avvaiyar
 - (c) Ilango Vadigal
 - (d) None of these
27. Which one of the following is not a work on architecture?
 - (a) Manasare
 - (b) Samarangana Sutradhara
 - (c) Mahavastu
 - (d) Mayamata
28. Sugandhadevi who issued coins with the figure of seated Lakshmi was a Queen of

- (a) Karnataka (b) Kashmir
(c) Orissa (d) Saurashtra
29. Who among the following believed in the theory of Bheda-bhed?
- (a) Vallabhacharya (b) Nimbarakacharya
(c) Madhvacharya (d) Ramanujacharya
30. What was the main objective of Sultan Mahmud's Indian conquests?
- (a) Propagation of Religion
(b) Extension of Empire
(c) Acquisition of Wealth
(d) None of these
31. In the context of cultural history of India, a pose in dance and dramatics called 'Tribhanga' has been a favourite of Indian artists from ancient times till today. Which one of the following statements best describes this pose?
- (a) One leg is bent and the body is slightly but oppositely curved at waist and neck
(b) Facial expressions, hand gestures and make-up are combined to symbolize certain epic or historic characters
(c) Movements of body, face and hands are used to express oneself or to tell a story
(d) A little smile, slightly curved waist and certain hand gestures are emphasized to express the feelings of love or eroticism.
32. Rajputas are mentioned as Agnikula Kshatriyas in
- (a) Prithviraj Raso
(b) Rajataragini
(c) Vikramaditya Charita
(d) Dasakumara Charita
33. Who wrote Prithviraj Raso?
- (a) Kalhana (b) Vishakadatta
(c) Rajasekara (d) Chandbaradai
34. Who was the Shahi ruler of Punjab defeated by Muhammad Ghazni?
- (a) Nagabhatta (b) Prithviraj
(c) Jayapala (d) Mahipala
35. Rajatarangini was written by
- (a) Devadatta (b) Kalhana
(c) Dhandi (d) Bharavi
36. The Rajput dynasty that ruled Kannauj was
- (a) Gurjara Pratihara (b) Chandelas
(c) Gahadvalas (d) a and c
37. What was the capital of Gurjara Pratihara?
- (a) Bhinmal (b) Rangapur
(c) Manda (d) Khajuraho
38. Who may be the founder of Pratihara dynasty?
- (a) Dharmapala (b) Gopala
(c) Bhoja (d) Pratihara
39. Who was the first prominent ruler of Pratihara dynasty?
- (a) Bhoja I (b) Nagabhatta
(c) Jayapala (d) Chandradeva
40. The Pratihara ruler who occupied Kannauj?
- (a) Jayachandra (b) Prithviraj
(c) Nagabhatta (d) Rajyapala
41. The Pala ruler who was defeated by the Pratihara ruler Nagabhatta?
- (a) Govindapala (b) Mahipala
(c) Dharmapala (d) Gopala
42. The prominent ruler of Pratihara dynasty Bhoja I ruled from
- (a) 840-890 A.D. (b) 850-860 A.D.
(c) 860-870 A.D. (d) 870-880 A.D.
43. Who was the last ruler of Pratihara dynasty?
- (a) Nagabhatta (b) Vijayalaya
(c) Simhavishnu (d) Rajyapala
44. Why did the Gurjara Pratihara dynasty decline?
- (a) invasions of Muhammad Bin Quasim
(b) invasions of Muhammad Ghori
(c) invasions of Muhammad Ghazini
(d) invasions of Hunas
45. Pratihara dynasty came to end in
- (a) 1001 A.D. (b) 1018 A.D.
(c) 1213 A.D. (d) 1214 A.D.
46. The Rajput Clan that ruled Bundelkhand was
- (a) Gahadvalas (b) Chandelas
(c) Pratihara (d) Paramaras
47. What was the capital of Chandelas?
- (a) Bhinmal (b) Kannauj
(c) Khajuraho (d) Ajmer
48. Who was the founder of Chandelas dynasty?
- (a) Jayasakti (b) Narasimha
(c) Chandradeva (d) Nagabhatta
49. Who was the most prominent ruler of the Chandelas dynasty?
- (a) Krishna (b) Bhoja
(c) Dhanga (d) Jayachandra
50. Who built the famous temples at Khajuraho?
- (a) Chandelas (b) Gahadvalas
(c) Palas (d) Senas
51. The Chandelas ruler who built famous temple at Khajuraho?
- (a) Dhanga (b) Chandradeva
(c) Jayadeva (d) Bhimadeva
52. The son of Dhanga who gave resistance to Muhammad Ghazni
- (a) Jayapala (b) Anandapala
(c) Rajyapala (d) Ganda
53. The Muslim ruler who conquered the kingdom of Bundelkhand in 1203 A.D?
- (a) Muhammad Ghazni
(b) Muhammad Bin Quasim
(c) Qutb-ud-din Aibak
(d) Iltutmish
54. Who was the founder of Paramara dynasty?
- (a) Siyaka (b) Krishna Raja
(c) Mahadeva (d) Nagabhatta
55. Who established independent Paramara dynasty?
- (a) Rajasekara (b) Vishaladeva
(c) Prithviraj (d) Siyaka II
56. Paramara dynasty ruled
- (a) Bundelkhand (b) Kannauj
(c) Malwa (d) Bengal
57. What was the capital of Paramaras?
- (a) Dhara (b) Kannauj
(c) Manda (d) Khajuraho
58. Who was the most important ruler of Paramara dynasty?
- (a) Dhanga (b) Bhoja
(c) Dhruva (d) Krishna
59. Kaviraja Malavachakravartin was the title of
- (a) Jayachandra (b) Chandradeva
(c) Vishaladeva (d) Bhoja
60. The Paramara ruler who established a university at Dhara?
- (a) Bhoja (b) Nagabhatta
(c) Simhavishnu (d) Mahadeva
61. The first Muslims invaded India were
- (a) Arabs (b) Turks
(c) Afghans (d) Persians

62. Who was the last Hindu king ruled North India?
 (a) Pulakesi (b) Kanishka
 (c) Chandradeva (d) Harsha
63. The first Muslim expedition on India took place in
 (a) 716 A.D. (b) 718 A.D.
 (c) 712 A.D. (d) 720 A.D.
64. Who was the Hindu king at the time of invasion of Muhammad-Bin Quasim on Sind?
 (a) Dahir (b) Hala
 (c) Krishna (d) Ananda Pala
65. Who established first Islamic empire in India?
 (a) Hizzaz
 (b) Muhammad-Bin-Quasim
 (c) Muhammad Ghazni
 (d) Muhammad Ghor
66. Muhammad Ghazni invaded India 17 times between
 (a) 900-950 A.D. (b) 950-1000 A.D.
 (c) 1000-1026 A.D. (d) 1025-1046 A.D.
67. Muhammad Ghazni plundered Somnath temple in Kathiawar in
 (a) 1020 A.D. (b) 1025 A.D.
 (c) 1030 A.D. (d) 1029 A.D.
68. The first Tarian war took place in
 (a) 1191 A.D. (b) 1193 A.D.
 (c) 1195 A.D. (d) 1197 A.D.
69. The second Tarian war took place in
 (a) 1193 A.D. (b) 1198 A.D.
 (c) 1199 A.D. (d) 1192 A.D.
70. The Rajput king who was defeated and killed in second Tairan war?
 (a) Nagabhatta (b) Prithviraj Chauhan
 (c) Rana Pratap (d) Jaya Chandra

Exercise -2

Statement Based MCQ

1. Consider the following statements—
1. The supremacy over Kannauj was a major source of struggle between Pratiharas, the Palas, the Rashtrakutas
 2. The theory that Rajputs were descendants of Agnikula was first put forward by colonel Todd.
 3. It is after Yanasakti that the chandella kingdom was called Tejabhukti.
 4. During the Arab rule over sindh in the 6th and 7th centuries A.D., Zimmis were those exempted from Jaziya payment.
- Which of the above is/are not correct?
 (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 1, 3 and 4
 (c) 1 and 3 (d) 2 and 4
2. Consider the following statements—
1. Nagabhata I was the first great ruler of Gurjara Pratihara dynasty.
 2. Bhoja I was another prominent ruler of this dynasty.
 3. Mahendrapala I was the son of Boja I
- which of the above is/are correct?
 (a) Only 1 (b) Only 1 and 2
 (c) Only 2 and 3 (d) 1, 2 and 3
3. Consider the following statements
1. Rajputas came into existence before the downfall of pratihara empire.
 2. The Rajput rulers divided the kingdoms among landed units called Jars.
 3. Rajput women enjoyed the same position as men.
- Which of the above is/are not correct?
 (a) Only 1 (b) Only 1 and 3
 (c) Only 2 (d) Only 2 and 3

Matching Based MCQ

- 4.
- | List-I
(Authors) | List-II
(Historical Kavyas) |
|-----------------------------------|--|
| A. Hemachandra | 1. Dvyasraya Kavya |
| B. Jayanka | 2. Navasahshan Charita |
| C. Padmagupta | 3. Prithviraja Vijaya |
| D. Sandhyakar Nandi | 4. Rama Charita |

Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	3	2	4
(b)	2	4	3	1
(c)	3	1	4	2
(d)	4	2	1	3

- 5.
- | List-I
Clans' Name | List-II
Clans |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| A. Parihara | 1. Kathiwarra |
| B. Chauhans | 2. Indore |
| C. Solankis | 3. Southern Rajasthan |
| D. Pawaras | 4. Eastern Rajasthan |

Codes:

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	4	1	2
(b)	3	4	2	1
(c)	4	3	1	2
(d)	4	2	1	3

Hints and Explanations

EXERCISE-1

1. (d)
2. (d) Gold coins attributed to Harsha depict on the reverse Shiva-Parvati. The Gupta period is considered the “Golden Age” of classical India. This was a time when great universities flourished in Nalanda and Takshashila, and great writers, such as the playwright Kalidasa, and great scientists, such as the mathematician and astronomer Aryabhatta, who is credited with the concept of zero among his many achievements, helped create an atmosphere of tremendous creative impulse.
3. (d) The famous commentator of Vedic literature, associated with the Parmaras was Uvata. The Parmar dynasty was an early medieval Indian royal house that ruled over the Malwa region in central India. This dynasty was founded by Upendra in c. 800; the most significant ruler was Bhoja I. The seat of the Parmar kingdom was Dhangraja, the present day Dhar city in Madhya Pradesh.
4. (a) Vishakhadatta exposed evils of the contemporary society by his satirical writings. There is no unanimity among the authorities on the date of *Mudrarakshasa*. However, majority of them are in favour of assigning the composition of this Sanskrit work to 4th–5th centuries AD. The Minister Signet’s Ring centres around the schemes of the wily Chankya to frustrate the plots of Raksasa, the minister of Dhanananda, the last ruler of the Nanda dynasty.
5. (d) Umed singh was the patron of the Kota School of Painting. The Kota school of painting is one of the finest examples of this technique. Kota paintings are known for their depiction of nature and hunting scenes. Painting comprises a very integral part of Rajasthani culture. Woven into these splendid visuals are images of everyday life of the olden times. The development of miniature paintings has been one of the most important contributions of Rajasthan to Indian art.
6. (a) Rajashekhara, the author of ‘*Karpurmanjri*’ was the teacher of Mahendrapala I. Rajashekhara was an eminent Sanskrit poet, dramatist and critic. He was court poet of the Gurjara Pratihara. He wrote *Kavyamimamsa* between 880 and 920 CE. The work is essentially a practical guide for poets that explains the elements and composition of a good poem. The fame of Rajashekhara rests firmly on his play *Karpuramanjari*, written in Sauraseni Prakrit.
7. (c) Harsha has been criticised by Kalhana for confiscating the temple. Harsha (r.1089-1111) started out as a capable and noble king. Then ran into financial trouble because of his spending habits, and became an evil person. For the gold, he started raiding temples and started destroying statues. Harsha never felt himself as a “Hindu” king per se as there was no people who felt themselves to be “Hindus” in those days.
8. (a) Gahadavalas levied Turushka-danda. Gahadavala dynasty rule of the district is proved by the discovery at Kudarkot of a copper plate grant dated in the reign of Chandradeva. Chandradeva founded the Gahadavala dynasty at Kanyakubja after defeating a chief named Gopala of Tuar clan. His jurisdiction extended over nearly all of what is modern Uttar Pradesh including this district.
9. (d) *Chachnamah* provides a vivid description of Sindh. The *Chachnamah* was written by Kazi Ismail. Kazi Ismail was appointed the first Kazi of Alor by Muhammad Kasim after the conquest of the Sindh. It was translated into Persian by Muhammad Ali bin Hamid bin Abu Bakr Kufi in 1216 CE from an earlier Arabic text. At one time, it was considered to be a romance until Mountstuart Elphinstone’s observations of its historical veracity. The original work in Arabic is believed to have been composed by the Sakifi family, the kinsmen of Muhammad bin Qasim.
10. (d) Kumaradevi, the queen of Govindachandra Gahadavala, constructed Dharmachakrajnavihar at Sarnath. Kumaradevi, the Buddhist queen of the great Gahadavala king Govindachandra of Kashi (CE 1114-1154). All the halls and apartments of the monks have disappeared. This monastery had two gateways towards the east, there being a distance of 88.45 m between the two. At the western most edge of the site, a distinct covered passage leads to a small medieval shrine.
11. (b) Harsha had assumed the title Parama-Maheshwara. An early copper plate grant of king Dantidurga (753) shows an image of god Shiva and the coins of his successor, king Krishna I (768), bear the legend Parama-Maheshwara (another name for Shiva). The kings’ titles such as Veeranarayana showed their Vaishnava leanings. Their flag had the sign of the Ganges and Yamuna rivers, perhaps copied from the Badami Chalukyas.
12. (a) The Chola rulers were generally Saivites. Among the existing specimens in museums around the world and in the temples of South India may be seen many fine figures of Shiva in various forms, such as Vishnu and

his consort Lakshmi, and the Saivaite saints. Though conforming generally to the iconographic conventions established by long tradition, the sculptors worked with great freedom in the 11th and the 12th centuries to achieve a classic grace and grandeur. The best example of this can be seen in the form of Nataraja the Divine Dancer.

13. (a) The Turkish brought with them musical instruments Rabab and Sarangi. During this time, the music of North India began to acquire and adapt to the presence of Persian language, music, and musical instruments, such as the Setar, from which the Sitar got its name; the Kemaneh and Santur, which became popular in Kashmir; and the Rabab [alternately known as Rebab and Rubab], which preceded the Sarod. New instruments were introduced, including the Tabla and Sitar.
14. (d) Harsha's military expansion in the Deccan was checked by Pulakesin II. When Pulakesin II pushed forth up to the Narmada, he came face to face with Harshavardhana of Kanauj who already had the title Uttarapatheshvara (Lord of the north). In a decisive battle fought on the banks of the river Narmada, Harsha lost a major part of his elephant force and had to retreat. The Aihole inscription describes how the mighty Harsha lost his *harsha* (joy) when he suffered the ignominy of defeat.
15. (a) Rashtrakutas adopted Garuda as dynastic emblem after the imperial Gupta. Silver coins of the Gupta kings Chandragupta II and his son Kumargupta I adopted the Western Satrap design (itself derived from the Indo-Greeks) with bust of the ruler and pseudo-Greek inscription on the obverse, and a royal eagle (Garuda, the dynastic symbol of the Guptas) replacing the Chaitya hill with star and crescent on the reverse.
16. (c) The North Indian dynasties that confronted the Rashtrakutas were the Pratiharas and the Palas. The Pratiharas are believed to be the clan of Rajputs. The greatest ruler of the Pratihara dynasty was Mihir Bhoja. He recovered Kanauj (Kanyakubja) by 836, and it remained the capital of the Pratiharas for almost a century. The Pratihara dynasty started well under the ruler Nagabhata-I. Though initially he had hiccups with the Rashtrakutas, he was able to leave behind a strong State comprising Malwa, parts of Rajputana and Gujarat
17. (a) The Vikramshila Mahavihara, the renowned educational centre of Pala period at Antichak. Vikramshila Mahavihara was one of the two most important centres of Buddhist learning in India during the Pala dynasty. Established by King Dharmapala (783 to 820 CE), it is located about 50 km east of Bhagalpur and about 13 km north-east of Kahalgaon railway station on Bhagalpur-Sahebganj section of eastern railway. The area is under the protected jurisdiction of Archaeological Survey of India (ASI).
18. (a) Kulothunga I Chola ruler had persecuted Ramanuja and ousted him from his kingdom. Ramanuja was the contemporary of Kulothunga II. It is Kulothunga II who banished Ramanuja from Tamil country and the latter had to seek refuge in Melkote, Karnataka. Hence even bringing Ramanuja into Athirajendra's death would cause more confusion. Till Kulothunga II, all the Chola kings and emperors supported all the religions equally although they were staunch Saivaites.
19. (c) Ur was the primary village assembly in the Chola village administration. Every village was a self-governing unit. A number of such villages constituted a Korram in different parts of the country. Taniyur was a large village big enough to be a Kurram by itself. A number of Kurrams constituted a Valanadu. Several Valanadus made up one Mandalam, a province. At the height of the Chola empire, there were eight or nine of these provinces including Sri Lanka. These divisions and names underwent constant changes throughout the Chola period.
20. (a) A Chalukya inscription is dated in the year 556 of the Saka era. It's equivalent to 478 AD. This undated inscription belongs to the reign of the Chalukya king Vijayaditya Satyasraya. It registers the grant of 20 mattars of red soil, a mattar of wet land and 2 mattars of garden land to Talereyar by Vikramaditya, the uncle of Banarja, when the latter was ruling Turamara-vishaya as the king's feudatory. It also states that Vikramaditya had the birudas Taruna-Vasantan and Samanta-kesari and that he was ruling Ayiradi. The inscription was written by Singutti.
21. (d) Vikramshila Mahavihar was established by the ruler of pala dynasty. Pala Dynasty was the ruling dynasty in Bihar and Bengal in India, from the 8th to the 12th century. Called the Palas because all their names ended in Pala, "protector". The Palas rescued Bengal from the Chaos into which it had fallen after the death of Shashanka, a rival of Harsha of Kanauj. The founder of the dynasty was Gopala.
22. (c) In Harshavardhana court, a Chinese embassy was sent by T'ang emperor. The T'ang dynasty was formed in 618 due to the failed exhibitions to Korea by the Sui, which had led to conflicts in the north of China. The T'ang's founder, Li Yuan was a rebel from an aristocratic family (traced from the Han) that was influential under the Northern Zhou. The T'ang took some time to become established, in part due to a rebellion in 617 that took several years to succeed with the help of the Turks.

23. (a) Sankaracharya founded the four Mathas in the four corners of India. Shankara was born at Kaladi in Kerala as a result of austerities and earnest prayers of his childless parents to Lord Shiva. Shankara's father Shivaguru and mother Aryambal were Namboodiri Brahmin couples who led a holy life performing Vedic rituals ordained for a householder. However, they were childless.
24. (c) The presiding deity of Bhojsala temple is goddess Saraswati. Bhojsala is one of the most significant monuments of Madhya Pradesh as a whole as it spots the land of Dhar. It is an ancient monument that had been dedicated to goddess Saraswati. This was the only temple in that was dedicated to this deity of the Hindu cult.
25. (b) Rath temples of Mahabalipuram were built in the reign of Narasinghvarman I. There are about nine monolithic temples at Mahabalipuram. They are the unique contribution of the Pallavas to Indian art. The monolithic temples are called locally as Ratha (chariot) as they resemble the processional chariots of a temple. The five Rathas, the best of all monolithic temples, are hewn out of a huge boulder.
26. (a) 'Ramayanam' the Tamil version of the great epic Ramayana was made by Kamban. Ramavataram, popularly referred to as Kamba Ramayanam, is a Tamil epic that was written by Kamban during the 12th century. Based on Valmiki's Ramayana in Sanskrit, the story describes the life of king Rama of Ayodhya. However, Ramavataram is different from the Sanskrit original in many aspects – both in spiritual concepts and in the specifics of the story line.
27. (c) Mahavastu is not a work on architecture. Mahavastu is more refined version of Vastu Shastra. Vastu Shastra being a very old subject didn't have a proper procedure to apply the beneficial wisdom in modern lifestyle. Due to lack of proper research and documentation of results, it has never been possible to give it a scientific working procedure.
28. (b) Sugandhadevi who issued coins with the figure of seated Lakshmi was a queen of Kashmir. The auspicious markings on Srimati Radharani's lotus feet include the signs of the conchshell, moon, elephant, barleycorn, rod for controlling elephants, chariot flag, small drum, svastika and fish.
29. (b) Nimbarakacharya believed in the theory of Bheda-abheda. Sri Chaitanya Mahaprabhu amalgamated the views of all the previous Acaryas in his thesis of Acintya-bhedabheda Tattva explicitly explained by Sri Baladeva Vidyabhusana in his Govinda Bhasya of the Vedanta-sutra.
30. (c) Acquisition of wealth was the main objective of Sultan Mahmud's Indian conquests. In 1001, Mahmud of Ghazni had first invaded India. Mahmud defeated, captured and later released Shahi ruler Jaya Pala who had moved his capital to Peshawar. Jaya Pala killed himself and was succeeded by his son Ananda Pala. In 1005, Mahmud of Ghazni invaded Bhatia (probably Bhera) and in 1006 he invaded Multan at which time Ananda Pala's army attacked him.
31. (a) The pose 'Tribhanga' is the favourite posture of Lord Krishna. We have often seen Lord Krishna standing in tribhanga posture before his cow 'Kamdhenu' or whenever he is playing his flute. He is often called Tribhanga Murari.
32. (a) 33. (d) 34. (c) 35. (b) 36. (d)
 37. (a) 38. (d) 39. (b) 40. (c) 41. (c)
 42. (a) 43. (d) 44. (c) 45. (b) 46. (b)
 47. (c) 48. (a) 49. (c) 50. (a) 51. (a)
 52. (d) 53. (c) 54. (b) 55. (d) 56. (c)
 57. (a) 58. (b) 59. (d) 60. (a) 61. (a)
 62. (d) 63. (c) 64. (a) 65. (d) 66. (c)
 67. (b) 68. (a) 69. (d) 70. (d)

EXERCISE-2

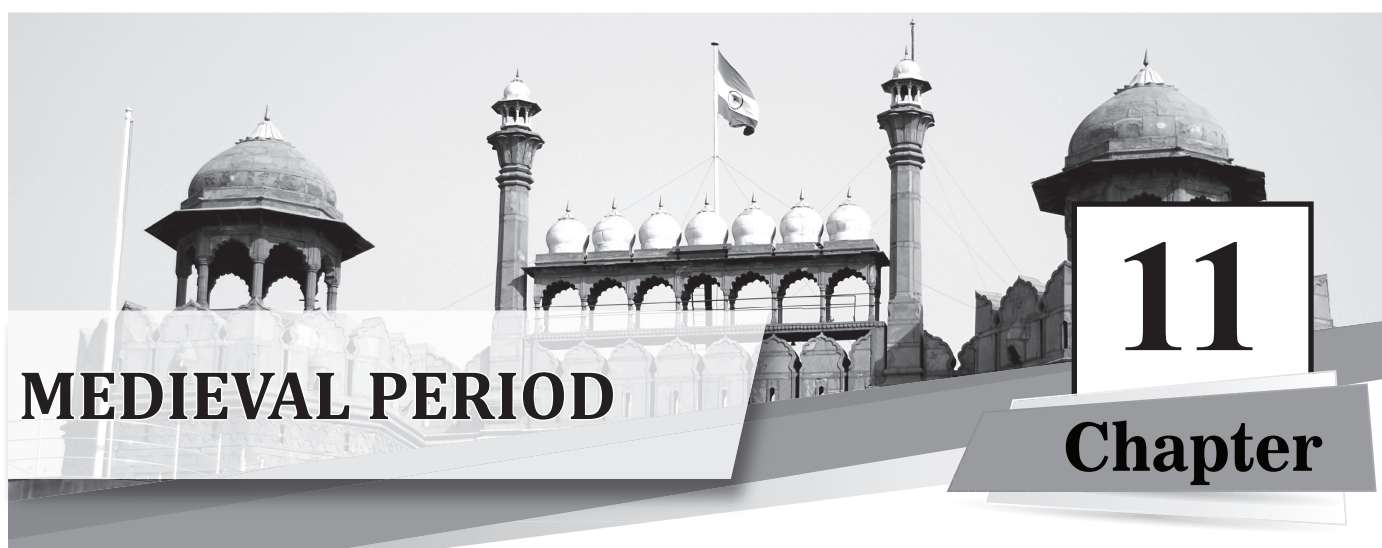
1. (d)
 2. (d) 3. (b)
 4. (a) The correct matchlist of authors and Kavyas is:

Authors	Kavyas
Hemachandra	Duyasraya Kavya
Jayanka	Prithviraja Vijaya
Padmagupta	Navasahshank
	Charita
Sandhyakara Nandi	Ramacharita

Samrat Hemachandra Vikramaditya (also known as Hemu Vikramaditya, Raja Vikrama-ditya or simply Hemu) (1501 – 5 November 1556) was a Hindu emperor of north India during the sixteenth century AD. The Prithviraj Vijay is a contemporary account of the 12th century Kingdom of Ajmer ruled by the Chauhan clan. In 1192, outlying portions of the kingdom fell to invading Turks, and the capital Ajmer later in 1195, but other parts under the Chauhan Rajaputras continued to resist the invaders for more than a century. The text helps to dispel many myths from that period, that have developed in later writings, for example the establishment of a Sufi shrine in Ajmer. He was the grandson of Pinaka Nandi and the son of Prajapati Nandi, the Sandhi-Vigraha (minister of peace and war) of the Pala emperor Ramapala. He wrote the epic poem Ramacharitam.

5. (a)

UNIT-II : MEDIEVAL HISTORY OF INDIA

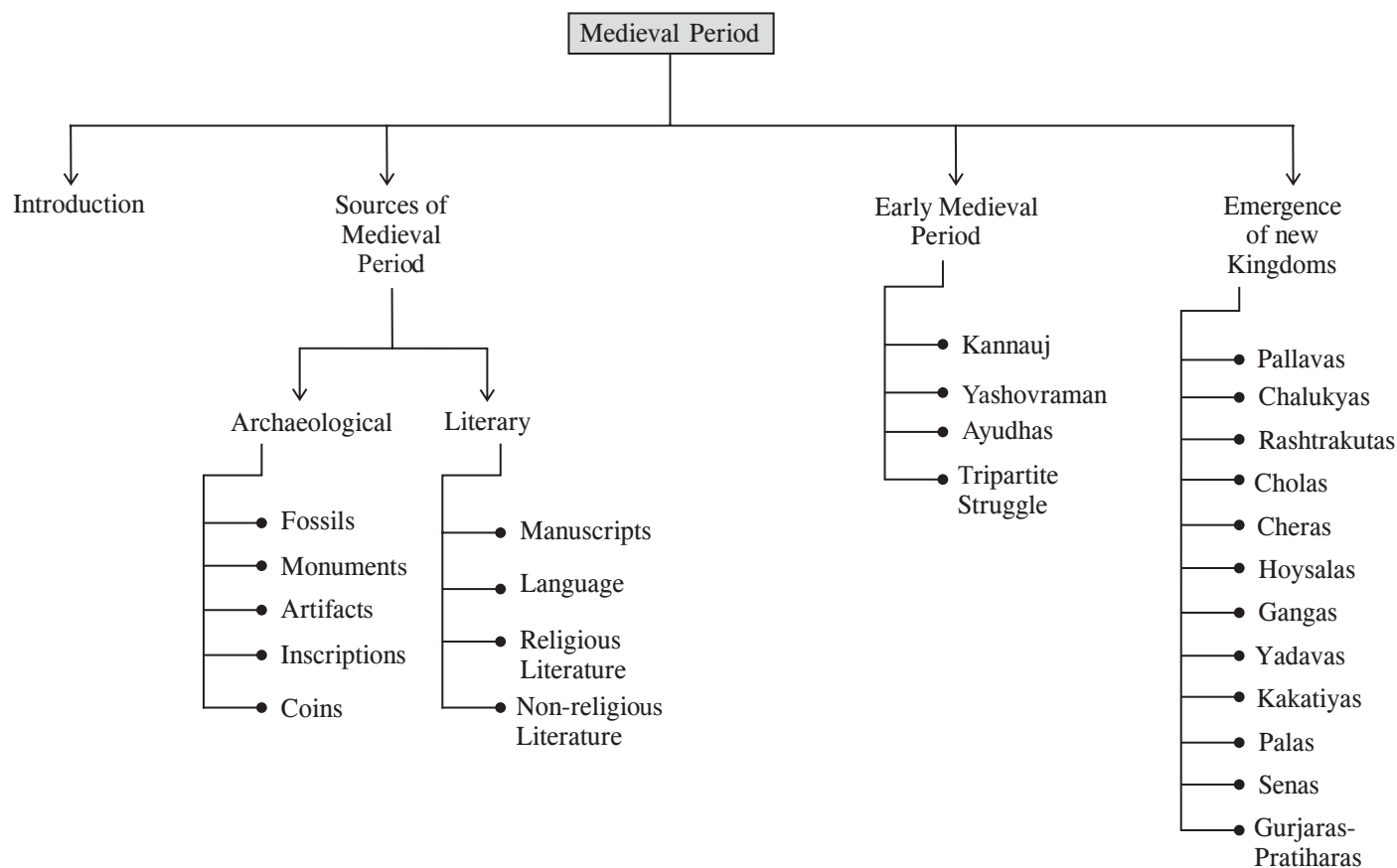


Introduction

During the medieval times in India, there have been developed important milestones in the field of religion, folk art and language. The medieval period of Indian history comprises a long period, spanning from 8th century, *i.e.* after the fall of the Gupta Empire to the 18th century, *i.e.* the beginning of colonial domination. Modern historians, divided the medieval period into *Early Medieval Period* and *Late Medieval Period*.

Early Medieval period refers to the phase of Indian history that stretches from the fall of the Gupta Empire to the beginning of the Sultanate period in the 13th century.

Late Medieval period comprises mainly that of the reigns of the Sultanate and the Mughal period.



SOURCES OF THE MEDIEVAL PERIOD

Historians depend on a variety of sources such as inscriptions, buildings, coins, and non-religious literature. The medieval period also has the first good example of written records of history which give us a better insight into the period.

Broadly we can divide the sources of history into two groups:

1. Archaeological
2. Literary

1. Archaeological Sources

- The archaeological sources are of immense value in the reconstruction of the socio - cultural and political history of medieval India.
- The archaeological sources include *fossil remains, artifacts, tools and implements, edicts and inscriptions, monuments, coins*.
- Archaeologists use them to reconstruct the past.

Let us briefly understand about each of the archaeological sources.

Fossil Remains

- Fossils are basically imprints of plants, animals or humans preserved in rocks.
- These have been buried for millions of years.
- These imprints are usually made from hard body parts such as bones or skulls, which leave a permanent mark on the rock.
- Fossils are the main source of information on the species that have become extinct, for example, dinosaurs.

Monuments

- Monuments are ancient buildings and structures such as temples, mosques, tombs, palaces and forts.
- They throw light on the social, religious and cultural life of the people of the age when they were built, rebuilt, repaired or altered.
- **Sanchi Stupa** in *Madhya Pradesh* is an important **Buddhist** monument. The stupa provides information of historical significance. It was originally built of bricks during Ashoka's time. It was expanded and remade of stones during the *Sunga Period*.
- An inscription on the southern gate was donated by *King Satakarni*. The northern gate and the panels depict stories from the Jatakas.

Artifacts

- Artifacts such as tools and implements, ornaments, and pottery have been found in various archaeological findings.
- They tell us about the kind of life people lived, their occupation and their social condition.

Inscriptions

- Inscriptions are the written records engraved on stones, pillars, clay or copper tablets, caves, and walls of the temples and monuments.
- They are reliable sources of information about the history of any period.

- They provide us names of the kings, the administration of the kingdom, some important events, the extent of the kingdom, etc.
- The *Ashoka inscriptions* and the *Allahabad pillar inscriptions* tell us a great deal about the reign of *Ashoka* and *Samudragupta*.

The inscriptions of the Mauryan king *Ashoka* are the earliest inscriptions in India.

Coins

- Coins belonging to this period are a valuable source for reconstructing dates of historical events.
- They also give us an idea of the economic conditions of that period.
- They help us to ascertain the territorial extent and reign of the rulers.
- They also provide valuable personal information about rulers, such as their religion. For example, *Samudragupta's* coins tell us that he was a good veena player.
- Monuments and paintings are also important archaeological sources of the period.

2. Literary Sources

- One of distinct features of the sources of the medieval period is that the number and variety of literary or textual records increased noticeably during this period.
- Literates and chroniclers wrote chronicles of rulers, petitions, judicial records, accounts and taxes.
- The teachings of saints and traders transaction were also recorded on these papers.
- The medieval chronicles were written by contemporary authors who were either court historians or freelancers.

There are three types of literary sources.

- (i) Manuscript
- (ii) Language
- (iii) Religious and non-religious literature.

Manuscripts

- The early literary records were handwritten. They are called manuscripts.
- Manuscripts were written on palm leaves, the bark of birch trees, and later on paper.
- Over the years, many of these manuscripts got destroyed, some of them are still preserved in temples, monasteries and archives.
- They throw light on the social and economic life, religious beliefs, practices and cultures of the past.

Language

- The language of ancient Indian literature depends on the region where it was written.
- Some of the languages included *Prakrit, Pali, Sanskrit or Tamil*.

- For example, the *Mahabharata* and the *Ramayana* were written in *Sanskrit* because they were authored in the northern part of India where Sanskrit happened to be the main language.
- On the other hand, *Silappadikaram* and *Manimekalai* were written in *Tamil* since they were written in Tamil speaking areas of south India.

Religious Literature

- The *Vedas* and the *Puranas* contain details of rituals, prayers and religious practices of the Ancient past.
- They are classified as sacred or religious literary sources.

Non-Religious Literature

- The historical accounts and biographies written by poets and foreign travellers form part of Non-religious or regular literature.
- They were written to record events, rules of the contemporary society and administrative regulations.
- *Kautilya's Arthashastra*, accounts of the foreign travellers such as India written by the Greek ambassador *Megasthenes* in the court of *Chandragupta Maurya*, and the writings of Chinese travellers *Fa-Hien* and *Hsuen - Tsang* are considered as secular literature.
- They describe the political, social and economic life of a certain period.

EARLY MEDIEVAL INDIA (AD 750-1200)

- Early medieval period is marked by the presence of a large number of regional and local powers in the absence of a paramount power in the country.
- This period has been characterized by certain historians as 'regional imperial kingdoms'.
- The essential points of early-medieval India may be highlighted as :
 1. Political Decentralization
 2. Emergence of landed Intermediaries
 3. Naturalisation of Economy
 4. Subjection of the Peasantry
 5. Proliferation of castes
 6. Formation of Regional cultural units
 7. Feudal Dimension of the Ideology and Culture.

Kannauj

In the post-Gupta period, **Kannauj** became the centre of political activities in North India. The political unity crumbled on Harsha's death and was followed by a period of anarchy and confusion in Northern India. A number of petty principalities and independent kingdoms rose on the ruins of the empire of Harsha.

Chachnama a work of rather late period, mentions four kings ruling at Kannauj during a period of seventy years following the death of Harsha. These four kings were *Rasil Rai*, *Sayar*, *Sahiras* and *Rai Harachander*.

Yashovarman

A famous monarch named Yashovarman defeated many kings, which included the king of the *Magadha*, *Vanga*, *Parasika*,

Shrikantha and *Harishchandra*. He is supposed to have founded the city named **Yashovarmapura**.

Yashovarman could not enjoy the rule of his vast empire, extending from north Bengal to N-W frontier province, for long. **Lalithaditya**, the king of Kashmir (about 750 AD) grew jealous of Yashovarman's power and attacked Kannauj (Gadhipura) and finally uprooted Yashovarman.

The **Rajatarangini** mentions that the poets *Vakpatiraja*, *Bhavabhuti* and others adorned the court of Yashovarman. **Malatimadhava**, **Mahaviracharita** and **Uttararamacharita**, three well-known Sanskrit plays were written by Bhavabhuti.

Ayudhas-Three rulers of Kannauj

After Yashovarman's dynasty, the last three rulers **Ama**, **Dunduka** and **Bhoja**. (belonging to the same lineage-Ayudhas) ruled for a very short period. During this period the struggle for Kannauj seems to have begun.

Vajrayudha was the first king who was defeated by **Jayapida Vinayaditya** of Kashmir. **Dhruva Rashtrakita** invaded the Doab and defeated the Kannauj king **Indrayudha**. Indrayudha was also defeated by Dharmapala of Bengal.

Kannauj and the Tripartite struggle

The tripartite struggle had started between *the Palas*, *the Pratiharas* and *the Rashtrakutas* for the control of Kannauj and North India.

The tripartite struggle continued for nearly a century and ended in favour of the Gurjara-Pratihara ruler **Nagabhata II** who founded the Gurjara-Pratihara kingdom at Kannauj.

EMERGENCE OF NEW KINGDOM [AD 700-1200]

During the period AD 700 - 1200, denoted as the early medieval period, a number of powerful regional kingdoms arose in north India, the Deccan and South India. All these kingdoms had the desire to build an empire and, therefore, continually fought with each other to gain control over their neighbouring territories.

The Palas were dominant in eastern India, whereas the Gurjara - Pratiharas dominated western India and the upper Gangetic

Valley. The third major kingdom was that of the Rashtrakutas who controlled the Deccan and also the territories in Northern and Southern India at different times. A number of Rajput kingdoms also emerged during this period and among them the *Chahamanas* or *Chauhans* were the most prominent. In the south, *the Cholas* surfaced as the most powerful kingdom and became known for a distinct administrative structure and agrarian expansion.

The Pallavas

During the period of Pallavas, the Pallavas and the Chalukyas had established powerful empires in South India. The Pallavas are mentioned in *Samudragupta's pillar*, where he is said to have defeated a Pallava king, *Vishnugopa*. The Pallavas were powerful between 330 and 550 AD. Their main area of dominance was *Kanchipuram*, their capital, up to the *Kaveri Delta*. After Vishnugopa's defeat by Samudragupta, the Pallavas became weaker and the *Cholas and the Kalabhras* repeatedly attacked the Pallava kingdom and robbed it of its wealth and territories. It was *Simhavishnu* son of *Simhavarma II*, who eventually crushed the dominance of the Kolabhras in AD 575 and re-established his kingdom. Although both the Pallava and Pandya kingdoms were enemies, the real struggle for political domination was between the *Pallavas and Chalukyas*. The Pallavas' history between 600 and 900 AD is full of accounts of wars between the Pallavas and the Chalukyas.

The Chalukyas

The incidence of grants to state officials varies from one region to another. The dynasty had two branches - *Vatapi* and *Kalyani*. The earlier rulers of this dynasty were *Jayasingha* and *Rameraja*. The Chalukyan kings were great patrons of art and letters. Most of the *Ajanta and Ellora paintings* were completed during this period. The famous scholars of their times include *Bilhana* a Sanskrit writer of works such as *Vikramaskadeva Charita* and the poem *Chaurapanchesika and Vijñanesvara* who wrote the *Mitaksara*.

The Chalukyas were largely influential in the area around *Raichur Doab* between *Krishna and Tungabhadra rivers*. Their capital was *Aihole* which was also an important trading centre. The famous ruler of this dynasty was *Pulakesin I*, who was the first independent ruler of Badami with *Vatapi in Bijapur* as its capital. He was succeeded by *Kirthivaraman I* and *Pulakesin II*. *Pulakesin II*, the grandson of Pulakesin I, was a contemporary of *Harshvardhana* and the most famous of the Chalukyan kings. He expanded his kingdom by annexing the entire Andhra Kingdom. His reign is remembered as the greatest period in the history of Karnataka. He defeated Harshavardhana on the banks of the river Narmada. *Ravikirti* was the court poet of Pulakesin II, who composed the *Aihole Inscription*.

This inscription gives a vivid account of the Chalukyan rule.

The Rashtrakutas

The term '*Rashtrakutas*' means designated officers - in charge of territorial divisions called '*Rashtra*'. They were feudatories under the *Chalukyas of Badami*. The founder of the Rashtrakuta kingdom was *Dantivarman or Dantidurga*, who after defeating the Chalukyas king *Kirti Varman* in the early eight century wrested from him the greater portion of the Deccan.

Dantivarman was succeeded in A.D. 750 by his uncle *Krishna I*, Who gave the final blow to the power of the Chalukyas of Badami, attacked the *Gangas of Mysore* and forced the *Chalukyas of Vengi* to acknowledge his supremacy. His son *Govinda II* was dethroned by his younger brother *Dhruva* in A.D. 779.

Their Cultural Contribution

- The ascendancy of the Rashtrakutas in the Deccan constitutes one of the most brilliant chapters in the history of the Deccan.
- They were tolerant in religious matters and patronised not only Shaivism and Vaishnavism, but Jainism as well.
- The Rashtrakutas were even tolerant of Islam. They permitted the Muslim merchants to settle, build their mosques and preach their religion in the Rashtrakutas.
- Their tolerant policies gave great impetus to trade and commerce.
- In the field of literature also their tolerant spirit is visible.
- They equally patronised Sanskrit, Prakrit, Apabhramsa, forerunner of many modern Indian languages, and Kannada.
- They patronised the arts liberally.
- The rock-cut cave temples at Ellora are the symbols of their religious toleration and are one of the splendours of Indian art.
- *The Kailash Temple*, built by the Rashtrakuta king Krishna I, is an unrivalled and stupendous piece of art. The ancient Indian rock - cut architecture reached its zenith under the Rashtrakutas.

The Cholas

The Cholas or Chodas, as rulers, are known to have existed from remote antiquity. According to II and XIII *Rock Edicts of Ashoka*, the earliest historical documents to refer to the Cholas, they were a friendly power in the south beyond the pale of Mauryan Suzerainty. The Chola dynasty ruled over *Tamil Nadu and parts of Karnataka*. *Tanjore* was its capital city. The Cholas disappeared only to resurface in 850AD when *Vijayalaya* captured Tanjore and made it his capital. However, during the rule of *Rajaraja I* and his son *Rajendra I* the Cholas entered their most glorious phase. They expanded the kingdom beyond south India to *Sri Lanka, Java and Sumatra*.

By his ability, prowess and military skill, *Rajaraja I* defeted the *Cheras* and seized *Madurai*. He invaded *Sri Lanka* and annexed its northern part which became a Chola Province under the name *Mummadi Cholaman Dalam*. *Rajaraja I* then overran the eastern Chalukyas who eventually accepted his authority *Rajaraja I* constructed the beautiful *Shiva temple* at *Thanjavur*, called *Rajarajesvara temple*. An account of *Rajaraja I's* exploits is engraved on the walls of the temple.

His son *Rajendra I*, by his military valour and administrative talents, raised the Chola empire to a pinnacle of glory. He annexed the whole of *Sri Lanka* and reasserted the Chola supremacy over *Kerala* and the *Pandhyan* country. His army marched triumphantly up to river *Ganga* and the dominions of the *Pala king, Mahipala*.

He adopted the title of *Gangaikonda* and founded a new capital called *Gangaikonda Cholahpuram* in *Tiruchirapalli* district. The Chola monarch's achievements were not limited to land only. He had a powerful naval fleet which gained successes across the *Bay of Bengal*. It is said that he also sent expeditions to *Java and Sumatra*, presumably to further commercial relations between the *Malaya Peninsula and south India*.

The Chola Administration

King and The Ministers

- The king was the head of the state. He discharged his duties and responsibilities with the help of ministers and other high officers.
- The inscriptions of the Cholas prove that their system of administration was highly organised and efficient.
- Apart from the ruler (**Tiruvakya - Kelvi**) there was a ministerial council and an organised administrative staff.
- The ruler maintained close contact with the council of ministers and royal tours contributed to the efficiency of the administration.
- The officers were paid by land assignments. They were honoured and encouraged by conferring titles.
- The higher officials enjoyed the title of *Penundaram*, and the lower ones *Sirutaram*.
- The Cholas also constructed roads which helped in trade, commerce and communication.

Revenue

Revenue was derived mainly from land and Collected in kind, or in cash, or in both, by village assemblies. Land was possessed by individuals and communities. The state's share of land revenue was fixed at $1/3^{rd}$ of the produce after an elaborate land survey in the time of *Rajaraja I*. There were periodical revisions of the classifications of land and of the assessment of land revenue. Other sources of public income were *customs and tolls*, taxes on various kinds of professions, *mines, forests, salt pans*, etc. Failure to pay the land revenue involved sale of the land in question, including temple lands.

Irrigation

Agricultural property was ensured by the special attention given to irrigation by the government as well as local authorities. Village assemblies were responsible for maintaining tanks in good condition and for reclaiming forest and wastelands. The Cholas spent huge amounts on buildings canals, tanks, dams and wells. **Rajendra I** dug an artificial lake near his new capital, **Gangaikonda Cholapuram**.

Army

The army consisted of elephants, cavalry and infantry. Attention was given to training and discipline of the cantonments. It was composed chiefly of *Kaikkolas* or *Sengundar*.

The commanders enjoyed the rank of *nayaka senapati*, or *mahadandanayaka*. The Cholas under *Rajaraja* Controlled the *Coromandel* and *Malabar* coast and the *Bay of Bengal*.

Village Administration

- The village was the primary unit of society and Polity. The village assemblies held the society together through its unique feature of autonomy and self-sufficiency.
- From the *Uttaramerur inscriptions* we find reference to at least three types of assemblies which played a regular part in local administration, namely the *Ur*, *Sabha* or *Mahasabha* and *Nagaram*.

- The *Ur* was an assembly of common villages where the land was held by all classes of people who were, therefore, entitled to membership in the local assembly.
- The *Sabha* was an exclusively Brahmin assembly of the *Brahamadeya* villages where all the land belonged to the Brahmins.
- The *Nagaram* was an assembly of merchants and belonged to localities where traders and merchants were in a dominant position.
- The *Sabha*, generally comprised the elite or learned in the community, commanded the respect of all the other assemblies in settling crucial matters of common concern.
- *The Uttaramerur inscription belonged to the reign of the Chola monarch Parantaka I (10th century)*

Chola Temples

Under the Chola, temples became the centre of life. They were not only places of worship but also emerged as the *hub of economic, political and cultural activities*. The village assembly held its meetings in the temple mandapa or hall. Temples also grew as centres of craft especially the creation of bronze images which was the most distinctive. Many cultural activities like music and dance also prepared in the temples. The Chola records frequently refer to *Devadana gifts of land*. Temple architecture, particularly the *Dravida* or *south Indian style of architecture*, reached its peak under the Cholas. The chief feature of a Chola temple is the *Vimana* or the *tower*, which was later eclipsed by the richly ornamented *gopuram* or *gateway*. In the *Brihadeswara* or *Rajarajeswara* temple dedicated to Siva, the *Vimana* or tower is about 57 metres high upon a square, comprising thirteen successive stories. It is crowned by a single block of granite, 7.5 metres high and about 80 tonnes in weight. Similarly, *Rajendra I* erected a splendid temple at his new capital, *Gangaikonda Cholapuram*.

Some Chola temples at *Thanjavur* and *Kalohasti* contain beautiful royal portraits. The metal and stone images cast during the period are exquisite. The masterpiece of Chola sculpture is the famous *Nataraja* or the *Dancing Siva* image at the great temple of *Chidambaram*. This *Nataraja* has been described as the 'cultural epitome' of the Chola period. The Cholas also patronised paintings. The most important Chola paintings are those in the *Pradakshinapath* of the *Rajarajeswara temple*.

The Cheras

The **Chera** Dynasty was one of the important dynasties in India. The Cheras were able to establish their rule before the **Sangam Age** and they ruled till the twelfth century. During the Sangam Age, the Chera rulers were known by many titles including *Malaiyar*, *Villavar* and *Vanavar*. There were two important lines of the Cheras – first initiated from **Uthiyan Cheralathan** while the second line starts from **Irumporai**.

Based on historical evidences, it is believed that the Cheras developed friendly relations with the Cholas and concluded matrimonial alliances with them, but soon supported the Pandya rulers against Cholas. However, their allied forces were defeated by the army of the Chola king in the Battle of Venni. After this defeat, the Chera ruler **Uthiyan Cheralathan** committed suicide.

The Cheras were successful in developing trade relations with Rome. **Muziris**, a famous sea-port in the ancient India, was an essential part of their kingdom. Through this sea-port, *spices, timber, pearls, ivory and gems* were exported from India to the Middle East and southern Europe. Many historical evidences suggest extensive foreign trade from the coasts of *Karur, Malabar and Coimbatore*. There are also legends that the Romans constructed a temple of Augustus at the port city of Muziris.

The Cheras were tolerant to all religions and faiths. In their reign, immigrants belonging to *Jewish, Christian and Muslim* faiths established their communities as the **Juda Mappila**, the **Nasrani Mappila** and the **Muslim Mappila** respectively. The Chera king, **Nedunjeral Adan**, attacked Yavana ships and captured Yavana traders for ransom. Nedunjeral Adan was succeeded by his son, **Senguttuvan**, who is remembered for his great conquests. Senguttuvan was successful in defeating his enemies. **Gajabahu**, a famous emperor from Sri Lanka, also mentioned about the conquests of Senguttuvan.

The second Chera Dynasty, known as the **Kulasekharas**, ruled from the outskirts of Muziris, situated on the bank of river **Periyar**. During their rule, they were in constant conflict with their neighbours and fought many battles against them. Finally, in twelfth century AD, continuous Chola invasions marked an end to their dynasty.

The Hoysalas

Founded by 'Sala', Hoysala dynasty existed between 1110 A.D. and 1326 A.D. **Vinayaditya** (1047-98) ruled the area centered on **Dorasamudra** (modern Halebid) – the capital city. His grandson **Bittiga**, later called **Vishnuvardhana** (reigned 1110-42) made extensive conquests and built magnificent temples at **Dorasamudra** that were noted for their intricate and elaborate sculpture. Bittiga's grandson, **Vira Ballala II** (reigned 1173-1220) extended Hoysala control North of Mysore and made the dynasty the most powerful in South India. The Hoysalas later came into conflict with the empire of Vijayanagar and the Muslim sultans of Delhi. The last Hoysala ruler was overthrown in 1346. At its peak, the dynasty ruled over parts of the modern states of *Mysore, Andhra Pradesh, Kerala, and Tamil Nadu*.

Some of the most magnificent temples are attributed to the Hoysala dynasty. Developed on the architectural style of the Chalukyas, these structures have intricate details. **The Belur temple**, built in 1117 A.D. to commemorate a victory against the Cholas, has a single star shaped structure, whereas **the Halebid temple** (1121 A.D.) has a double sanctum like a twin temple, one beside the other, with the side wings joined to allow access to each other. In *Halebid* the temples are dedicated to *Vishnuvardhana* and his consort *Santaleswara*. **The Somnathapura temple**, built in 1268, has three star shaped sanctums each placed at three angles.

The Gangas

The Western Ganga Dynasty (350 – 1000 A.D.) was an important dynasty of India – known as *Western Gangas* to distinguish them from the *Eastern Gangas* who in later centuries

ruled over modern Orissa. The Western Ganga initially ruled from **Kolar** and later moved their capital to **Talakad** on the banks of the *Kaveri* river in modern *Mysore* district.

After the rise of the imperial *Chalukyas of Badami*, the Gangas accepted Chalukya overlordship and fought for the cause of their overlords against the *Pallavas of Kanchi*. The **Rashtrakutas of Manyakheta** replaced the Chalukyas in 753 A.D. as the dominant power in the Deccan. After a century of struggle for autonomy, the Western Gangas finally accepted Rashtrakuta overlordship and successfully fought alongside them against their foes, the *Cholas of Tanjavur*. The defeat of the Western Gangas by Cholas around AD 1000 resulted in the end of the Ganga influence over the region.

The Western Gangas made an important contribution to polity, culture and literature of the modern south Karnataka region. The Western Ganga kings showed their patronage towards Jainism resulting in the construction of monuments in places such as **Shravanabelagola** and **Kambadahalli**. The kings of that dynasty encouraged the fine arts due to which literature in Kannada and Sanskrit flourished.

The Yadavas

The **Yadava** dynasty, also known as the *Seuna Maratha dynasty*, was founded by **Seunachandra** in AD 850. The son of *Dridhaprahara*, at his zenith he ruled a vast kingdom stretching from the River Tungabhadra to the River Narmada, including modern Maharashtra, the north of Karnataka, and parts of Madhya Pradesh, with capital at **Devagiri** (now *Daulatabad*) in Maharashtra.

Originally a feudatory of the *Eastern Chalukyas of Kalyani*, the dynasty became paramount in the *Deccan* under **Bhillama** (A.D. 1187–91). Under Bhillama's grandson **Singhana** (A.D. 1210–47) the dynasty reached its height, as the Yadava campaigned against the *Hoysalas in the south*, the *Kakatiyas in the east*, and the *Paramaras and Chalukyas in the north*.

During the reign of the last Yadava king, **Ramachandra** (A.D. 1271–1309), a Muslim army commanded by the Delhi sultan Ala- al-Din Khalji invaded the kingdom in 1294 and imposed tributary status. In a further attempt, his son and successor died in battle, and the kingdom was annexed by the *Khalji empire* in 1317.

The Kakatiyas

The *Kakatiyas* ruled in Andhra Pradesh in India from A.D. 1083 to AD 1323. They were the first feudatories of the *Western Chalukyas of Kalyana*, ruling over a small territory near **Warangal**. Their rule is considered the most promising period of history of Telugu & Andhra Pradesh.

Rudra was a renowned ruler in Kakatiya Dynasty who ruled during AD 1158 to 1195. He stretched his empire till the *Godavari Delta*. To serve as a second capital, he constructed the fort at Warangal. **Ganapati** was the supreme king among all the rulers of Kakatiya dynasty. He played an important role in consolidation of *Telugu region* under one rule. He established a huge kingdom and promoted the trade practices in the kingdom. Ganapati did not have any son so his daughter

Rudramba ascended the throne. Some of the generals who did not want to be dominated by Rudramba formed a different rebellion. She suppressed all kind of criticisms and moved with great courage to blow *the Cholas and Yadavas* tremendously. The successor of *Rudramba* was **Prataparuda**. He ruled in the period AD 1295-1323. He divided his army into seventy five 'Nayakships'. Later the *Rayas of Vijayanagara* took over the Nayakships and made growth in great extent. During this period only the Muslims invaded the empire of Kakatiya Dynasty in Andhra Pradesh for the first time. The king of Delhi Sultanate **Ala-ud-din Khilji** sent his army in AD 1303. Another major invasion of Muslims took place in order to capture 'Tilling', **Ghiaz-ud-din Tughlaq** the ruler of Tughlaq Dynasty sent his huge army under the leadership of *Ulguh Khan* during AD 1321. **Prataparuda** was defeated and was taken as a prisoner. This marked an end to the Kakatiya Dynasty.

Pala Empire

8th century - 12th century-

The Pala Empire was a Buddhist imperial power in classical India during the 8th to 12th century CE. The empire is named after its ruling dynasty. All of whose rulers bore names ending with the suffix - Pala ("Protector"). The palas were often described by opponents as the *Lords of Gauda*. Their empire centered around the Present - day Bengal - Bihar region, and at times, included what are now Assam, Orissa and Parts of North India.

The Palas in comparison with other contemporary empires:-

Capital	Multiple
	Patliputra Gauer (I) Monghyr (Devapala) Somapura (Dharampala) Mahipal in Present day Murshidabad District
Languages	Sanskrit, Prakrit (including pali), Proto - Bengali.
Religion	Buddhism
Government	Monarchy
King - 8th Century	Gopala
- 12th Century	Govindapala
Historical era	Medieval India
- Established	8th Century
- Disestablished	12th cenetury

Today part of	Bangladesh India Nepal
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Sena Empire : AD 1070 - AD 1230

Capital	Nabadwip
Languages	Sanskrit, Bengali
Religion	Hinduism, Buddhism
Government	Monarchy
King	
- 1070 - 1096 AD	Hemanta Sen
- 1159 - 1179 AD	Ballal Sen
- 1225 - 1230 AD	Keshab Sen
Historical Era	Classical India
- Established	AD 1070
- Disestablished	AD 1230

The history of Bengal includes modern day Bangladesh and West Bengal, dates back four millennia. To some extent. The *Ganges* and the *Brahmaputra* rivers separated it from the mainland of India, though at times Bengal has played an important role in the history of India.

Gurjar Pratihara Dynasty

The *Pratiharas* are believed to be the clan of *Rajputs*. They set foot in India during the *Huns invasion* and settle around *Punjab Rajputana Region*. Soon they advanced to *Aravali* and *Ujjain*. The branch of the Pratiharas who ruled in the Gujarat were the *Gurjaras*. The inscription of the Pratiharas trace their origin to *Lakshmana*, the Anuja of Rama, who acted as Rama's door keeper or the Pratiharas. But in fact, when *Danti-Durga*, the Rashtrakuta king defeated the Gurjara king *Nagabhata -I*, the latter was made a Pratihara while Dantidurga performed the *Hiranyagarbha Dana ceremony at Ujjain*.

Points to remember

- During the period AD 700 - 1200 the *Gurjara - Pratiharas, Palas, Rashtrakutas and Chahamanas* came up in north India and the *Chola* kingdom in south India.
- The three kingdoms - *Gurjaras, Palas and Rashtrakutas* were in constant struggle to acquire control over Kannauj. This struggle was termed as *tripartite struggle*.
- Mahmud Ghazni* was the earliest Turkish invader in India.
- In south India, the *Cholas* emerged as the most powerful kingdom where the king was the head of the state.
- The Chola village assemblies - *Ur, Sabha and Nagaram* played an important role in village administration deciding upon its crucial matters.

Exercise -1

- The Sun Temple of Konark was built by Narasimhadeva I. To which dynasty did he belong to?
 - Somavamsi dynasty
 - Imperial Ganga dynasty
 - Suryavamsi Gajapati dynasty
 - Bhoi dynasty
- Which of the following is the earliest works in Tamil?
 - Pali
 - Mahabharata
 - Sangam Literature
 - Rama Sundaram
- Whose court was poet Ravikirti associated with?
 - Kumara Devi
 - Harshavardhana
 - Pulakeshin II
 - Xuan Zang
- Sangam literature is :
 - Pali literature dealing with the history of the Buddhist Samghas
 - Classical Sanskrit literature patronised by the Guptas
 - Sanskrit works of Puranic nature dealing with the sanctity of the place where there is confluence of rivers in Prayaga
 - Early Tamil literature attributed to the first three centuries of the Christian Era
- Who established an independent Rashtrakutas dynasty?
 - Danti-durg
 - Prithviraja
 - Rajendra Chola
 - None of these
- Which changes did take place in early medieval period?
 - Extension of agriculture
 - Migration of forest dwellers
 - Emergence of peasants
 - All of the above
- Which of the following statements about the Chalukyas is incorrect?
 - The Chalukyas were brahmanical hindus.
 - The army of the Chalukyas consisted of a small standing army, but helped by feudal lords.
 - The Chalukyas developed the Deccan or Vesara style in the building of structural temples
 - The Buddhists and Jains were not allowed to build temples.
- The Palas, Pratiharas and the Rashtrakutas fought for control over which citizenship?
 - Ujjain
 - Pataliputra
 - Kannauj
 - Kaushambi
- Who is considered as the greatest ruler of the Pratiharas?
 - Mahipala
 - Mahendrapala
 - Mihirabhoja
 - Nagbhatta II
- Which Pratihara King patronized the well known poet Rajasekhara?
 - Mihirabhoja
 - Vatsaraja
 - Mahipala
 - Nagabhatta II
- Which Rashtrakuta king composed the works 'Kavirajamarga', 'Ratnamalika' and 'Passanotaramalika'?
 - Amoghavarsha I
 - Krishna I
 - Indra III
 - Krishna III
- The Palas patronized which form of Buddhism?
 - Hinayana
 - Mahayana
 - Sarvastavadin
 - All of these
- Lingayats are,
 - Worshippers of Shiva
 - Opposed to caste system
 - Opposed to social evils as child marriage
 - All the above
- Which dynasty initiated the dravidian style of architecture?
 - Pallavas
 - Cholas
 - Vijayanagar
 - Chalukyas of Kalyani
- Which chola ruler completed the conquest of Sri Lanka?
 - Vijayalaya I
 - Raja Raja I
 - Rajendra I
 - Parantaka I
- The chola who launched and expedition into Bengal upto the Ganga river was,
 - Raja Raja I
 - Kulottanga I
 - Rajendra III
 - Rajendra I
- Who was the 'Mandala mudali' in the Chola administrative set up?
 - Provincial governor
 - District head
 - Head of Judiciary
 - Intelligence head
- Which of the following is true about Chola Society?
 - Four fold varna system was absent
 - Untouchability existed
 - Slavery was Prevalent
 - All of the above
- An enormous Nandi, the second largest in India is a feature of which Chola temple?
 - Nataraja temple at Chidambaram
 - Gangaikonda cholapuram temple
 - Lepakshi temple
 - Raja Rajeswara temple at Tanjore
- Which of the following characterised by the Rajputs?
 - They formed the intellectual elite of the Hindus.
 - Their institutions resembled the feudal system of medieval Europe and had all its defects.
 - They were divided into several classes, each under a hereditary chief, but had no hostility among themselves.
 - All the above
- Which of the following statement is false?
 - Rashtrakuta king who never invaded India Amoghavarsha.
 - Rashtrakuta king who constructed the Kailasha temple - Krishan I
 - Rashtrakuta king who defeated the Pratihara ruler Nagabhatta - Govinda III
 - Kavirajamarga was written by Indra III is Kannada.
- The medieval Indian writer who refers to the discovery of America is :
 - Malik Muhammad Jayasi
 - Amir Khusrau
 - Raskhan
 - Abul Fazl
- Which one of the following statement about Brihadeswara temple at Tanjavur, is not correct?
 - The temple is a splendid example of Chola architecture
 - It was built by emperor Rajaraja
 - The temple is constructed of granite
 - The temple is a monument dedicated to Lord Vishnu
- Consider the following passage and identify the three tribal principalities referred to there, in using the codes given below
In the early history of the far South in India, three tribal

principalities are mentioned in Ashokan inscriptions of the 3rd century BC and in Kharavela inscription of the 1st century BC.

- (a) Vakatakas, Cholas and Satvahanas
(b) Cholas, Pandyas and Cheras
(c) Ikshvakus, Vakatakas and Pandyas
(d) Pallavas, Cholas and Pandyas
25. Which one of the following was a temple built by the Chola Kings?

- (a) Brihadiswara Temple, Tanjavur
(b) Meenakshi Temple, Madurai
(c) Srirangam Temple, Thiruchirapalli
(d) Durga Temple, Aihole

26. In medieval India, the designations 'Mahattara' and 'Pattakila' were used for [CSAT 2014 - I]
(a) military officers
(b) village headmen
(c) specialists in Vedic rituals
(d) chiefs of craft guilds

Exercise -2

Statement Based MCQ

1. Consider the following statements on the Chalukyas
1. Pulakesin II defeated the Vishnukundins of Andhra delta and later allowed Vishnuvardhana to form a kingdom there.
 2. Pulakesin II performed a horse sacrifice.
 3. The Chalukyas became a sovereign power under Pulakesin I.
 4. From Vishnuvardhana's reign began the line of western Chalukyas.

Which of these statements are not correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 2 and 4
2. With reference to Yadava period, which of the following statement is not true?
1. The family of the famous astronomers and mathematicians belonged to the Yadava period.
 2. Anantadeva established a college of astronomy Khandesh during Simhara's rule.
- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2
3. Which of the following are true with regard to the Chola administration of Cholas?
1. Elections constituted an essential part of the local administration.
 2. Big towns had their own independent institutions known as Tar - Kurrams.
 3. Elections were held within the presists of the local temples.
 4. Very little autonomy was given to the local institutions.
- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 2 and 4
4. Which of the following is/are matched wrongly?
1. Narsimhavarman II - Kailashnatha temple at Kanchi.
 2. Nandivarman - Vaikunth Perumal temple at Kanchi.
 3. Mahendravarman I- Brihadeswara temple at Thanjavur.
 4. Rajaraja Chola - Rathas of Mahabalipuram.
- (a) 1 and 4 (b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 3 and 4 (d) 2 and 3
5. Arrange the following in chronological order :-
1. Lingaraja temple
 2. Brihadiswara temple
 3. Sun temple at Konark
 4. Hoyasaleswara temple
- (a) 1, 2, 3 and 4 (b) 2, 3, 1 and 4
(c) 4, 3, 2 and 1 (d) 2, 4, 1 and 3

6. Arrange the following rulers of Kashmir in a chronological order:

1. Avantivarman 2. Didda
3. Harsha 4. Jayasingh

Select the correct chronological order from the codes given below:

Codes:

- (a) 1, 2, 3, 4 (b) 2, 3, 4, 1
(c) 3, 4, 1, 2 (d) 4, 1, 2, 3

Matching Based MCQ

DIRECTIONS (Qs. 7 and 8): Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists.

7. **List I** **List II**
- | | |
|---------------|---------------|
| (A) Gupta | (1) Badami |
| (B) Chalukya | (2) Panamalai |
| (C) Chandella | (3) Khajuraho |
| (D) Pallava | (4) Deogarh |
- (a) A - 4; B - 1; C - 3; D - 2
(b) A - 4; B - 2; C - 3; D - 1
(c) A - 2; B - 3; C - 4; D - 1
(d) A - 3; B - 4; C - 1; D - 2
8. **List I** **List II**
(Kings) (Dynasties)
- | | |
|-----------------|---------------|
| (A) Harichandra | (1) Palas |
| (B) Go Pala | (2) Pratihars |
| (C) Samantasena | (3) Paramaras |
| (D) Upendra | (4) Sena |
- (a) A - 2; B - 1; C - 4; D - 3
(b) A - 1; B - 2; C - 3; D - 4
(c) A - 4; B - 3; C - 2; D - 1
(d) A - 3; B - 4; C - 2; D - 1

9. Consider the following pairs: [CSAT 2015-I]

Medieval Indian State	Present Region
1. Champaka	: Central India
2. Durgara	: Jammu
3. Kuluta	: Malabar

Which of the above pairs is / are correctly matched?

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 only
(c) 1 and 3 (d) 1 and 3 Only

Hints and Explanations

EXERCISE-1

1. (b) Konark Sun Temple (also known as the Black Pagoda) is in a small town in Puri (Odisha). It was built by Narasimhadeva of Imperial Ganga dynasty.
2. (c) Sangam Literature was made around 2,300 yrs ago.
3. (c) 4. (d) 5. (a) 6. (d) 7. (d)
8. (c) 9. (c) 10. (c) 11. (a) 12. (b)
13. (d) 14. (b) 15. (c) 16. (d) 17. (a)
18. (d) 19. (d) 20. (b)
21. (d) Kavirajamarga was written by Amoghavarsha I.
22. (d)
23. (d) The Brihadeshwara temple, called the Big Temple, is dedicated to Lord Siva. It was built by the great Chola King Raja Raja I (985-1012 A.D.). It is an outstanding example of Chola architecture. Recognizing its unique architectural excellence, UNESCO has declared it a World Heritage Monument.
24. (b) The Pillar Edicts are divided into:
Major Rock Edicts: 14 Edicts (termed 1st to 14th) and 2 separate ones found in Odisha
Minor Rock Edicts, the Queen's Edict, Barabar Caves inscriptions and the Kandahar bilingual inscription.
In these Edicts there were three South Indian states described as Cholas, Pandayas, Cheras.
25. (a) Brihadeshwara Temple (Raja Rajeswara Temple) was built by emperor Raja Raja Chola I in 1010 AD. Meenakshi Temple located on the southern bank of the Vaigai River (Madurai, Tamil Nadu). It is dedicated to Parvati known as Meenakshi. Srirangam temple is one of the most illustrious Vaishnava temples in South India located on an island on the

bank of Cauvery river. The Durga temple is located in Aihole, Karnataka. It was built by Chalukyas between the 7th and the 8th century.

26. (b) In medieval India, the designations 'Mahattara' and 'Pattakila' were used for village headmen.

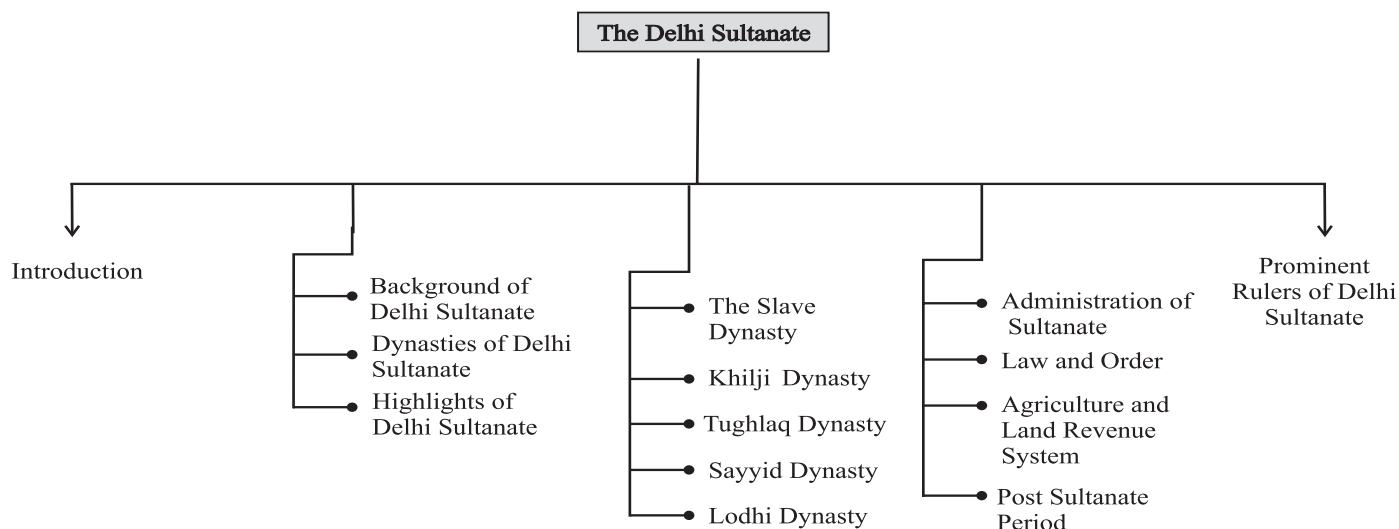
EXERCISE-2

1. (d) Pulakesin I performed the horse sacrifice like Vishnu-vardhana.
2. (b) 3. (b) 4. (c) 5. (d)
6. (a) The correct chronological order of the rulers of Kashmir is. Avantivarman, Didda, Harsha, Jayasinghe. Utpala dynasty founded by Avantivarman followed the Kakrotas. His successor Shankaravarman (885-902 CE) led a successful military campaign against Gurjaras in Punjab. Political instability in 10th century made the royal body guards (Tantrins) very powerful in Kashmir. Under the Tantrins, civil administration collapsed and chaos reigned in Kashmir till they were defeated by Chakravarman. Queen Didda, who descended from the Hindu Shahis of Kabul on her mother's side, took over as the ruler in second half of the 10th century. After her death in 1003 CE, the throne passed to Lohara dynasty.
7. (a) The Gupta had their capital at Deogarh, Chandella had their capital at Khajuraho, Chalukya's at Badani and Pallava's capital was at Kanchi.
8. (a)
9. (b) States such as Champaka (Chamba), Durgara (Jammu), Trigarta (Jalandhar), Kuluta (Kulu), Kumaon and Garhwal managed to remain outside the main areas of conflict in the northern plains.



Introduction

Delhi Sultanate was founded by Turkish '*Mamluks*' employed by rulers of Afghanistan. Early rulers had to defend north from attempted *Mongol invasions*. Their power derived from military, highways, trade routes and the ability to control provincial governors. They introduced *copper and silver coins*. In their reign, many refugees arrived from Persia after the Mongol invasions bringing many skills. Delhi was the capital of the Delhi Sultanate in the beginning of the thirteen century.



THE BACKGROUND OF DELHI SULTANATE

1. First Muslim Invasion - *Mohamamd Bin Qasim's invasion* (712 AD)
2. First Turk Invasion - *Mahmud Ghaznavi's invasion* (998-1030 AD).
3. Second Turk invasion - *Mohammad Ghori's invasion* (1175-1206) AD
4. The success of **Turks** in India.

Dynasties of Delhi Sultanate

Delhi Sultanate was ruled by five dynasties.

Dynasty	Period
The Slaves	1206 - 1290 AD
The Khilji	1290 - 1320 AD
The Tughlaqs	1320 - 1414 AD
The Sayyids	1414 - 1451 CE
The Lodhis	1415 - 1526 CE



The conquests of Muhammad of Ghur led to the establishment of Turkish rule. A new political power, the sultanate of Delhi came into being. The period of 1206 to 1526 A.D. in Indian history is known as Sultanate period. The rulers of this period were Turks.

Highlights of the Delhi Sultanate:

- Taxes were not standardized and widely fluctuated.
- Peasants paid 1/3 -1/2 of produce in taxes plus other types of taxes.
- Canals and irrigation facilities were developed to expand agriculture.
- **Ibn Battuta** was sent by the Sultan as a representative to China.
- *Sufi and Bhakti movements* which believed in fundamental unity of all religions became popular.
- Facilitated trade in the Indian Ocean, exports flourished
 - Cotton & silk textiles
 - Paper industry
 - Leather making
 - Metal crafts
 - Carpet weaving
- Protected India from being ravaged by the Mongols.
- Introduced new art and architectural styles into India.
- Ultimately failed due to constant rebellions of Muslim nobles and Hindu peasants.

THE SLAVE DYNASTY

Muhammad of Ghur left his Indian dominions in the care of his former slave *Qutub-ud-din Aibak*. On the death of Muhammad he tied up with *Ghazni* and founded a new dynasty called 'mameluks' or slave dynasty.

Slave Dynasty Timeline

Ruler	Reign
Qutbu-ud-din-Aibak	(1192–1210)
Aram Shah	(1210–1211)
Shams-ud-din-Iltutmish	(1211–1236)
Razia Sultana	(1236–1240)
Nasiruddin Mahmud	(1246–1266)
Ghiyasuddin Balban	(1266–1286)

Qutub-ud-din Aibak

He was born of Turkish parents in Turkiestan. *Aibak* received the title of *Sultan of Delhi* from *Ghiyas-ud-din Mahmud*, the successor of *Muhammad of Ghur*. He built two famous mosques, *Quwwat-ud-Islam* and *Adhai Din ka Jhonpara* at Delhi and Ajmer. He believed in matrimonial alliances. He was an efficient and brave commander. When he became the Governor of India, he conquered Meerut, Kalinjar, Mahoba, Koel, Ranthambhore, Kannauj etc. He was entitled as *Lakshbaksh* or 'giver of lakhs'. He started the construction of *Qutub Minar in Delhi*. He died as a result of fall from his horse while playing polo.

Aram Shah

After *Aibak's* death his son *Aram Shah* was enthroned at Lahore. But the nobles of his court decided to enthrone *Aibak's* son-in-law *Iltutmish* and after the conflict between both of them, *Iltutmish* conquered and became the successor of *Aibak*.

Iltutmish

The full name of *Iltutmish* was *Shams-ud-din Iltutmish*. He made himself secure as the sultan. He consolidated the Ghurid acquisition in India and proved it with a compact monarch. He completed the unfinished construction of *Qutub Minar*. He conquered Kannauj, Varanasi, Bahraich, Oudh, Gwalior, Bayana, Ajmer, Sambhal, Nagore etc. He was the first Turk Sultan to strike pure Arabian coins.

His governing class consisted of two groups. Turkish slave officers and *Tazik*. He organised the *iqtas*, army, currency to consolidate his sultanate. He reorganised the army of the sultanate and introduced the silver *tanka* and the copper *jital*. He also organised the team of 40 loyal nobles, *Turkhan-i-Chahalgani* to keep a watch over intriguers.

Razia Sultana

Iltutmish was succeeded by his daughter *Razia* but the nobles of his court disregarded his wishes and placed his son, *Rukn-ud-din Firoz shah* on the throne but he was not an efficient ruler. So *Razia* held the title of sultan. The intrigues of the Turkish chiefs called the forty or *chahalgani* increased against the monarchy. *Razia* was the only woman who ever sat on the throne of Delhi. She was murdered in 1240 A.D. near *Kaithal*.

Ghiyas-ud-din Balban

Balban who had all control over sovereignty sat on the throne of Delhi in 1266 A.D. and adopted the name of *Ghiyasuddin Balban*. For the defence from Mongols, Balban recognized the military department known as *Diwan-i-Ariz*. He introduced Pabos, touching the king's feet and *sijda* - bowing to the king in his court. He was the first ruler who believed in kingship. *Feroz Khilji* killed the successors of Balban and captured the Delhi sultanate.

Turkan-i-Chahalgani

The most important institution that developed under the slave Dynasty was the institution of *Turkan-i-Chahalgani*. It was also called *Chahalgan* or "*the forty*" *Chahalgans* were a group of highly placed and powerful officers, whom *Iltutmish* had organised as his personal supporters. However, during the days of civil war between the successors of *Iltutmish*, the *Chahalgan* started looking for personal gains and played on prince against the other. When Balban assumed charge as Sultan, he crushed their power and strengthened his rule.

KHILJI DYNASTY (1290 A.D. - 1320 A.D.)

They were originally Turkish but traditionally became Afghan. *Jalaluddin* was the founder of this dynasty. He defeated Mongols in 1292 A.D. He was succeeded by his nephew *Alauddin Khilji*. He ruled from 1296 to 1316 A.D.

- He inscribed himself as *Alexander II* on his coin and adopted the title of *Yasmin-ul-Khilafat-Nasiri-Anurul Muminin*.
- He conquered over North India, Chittor, Ranthambhore, Telangana, Hoysals, Pandyas and Devgiri.
- He was a great administrator who carried out many useful reforms.
- He introduced new market regulation to provide essential commodities at reasonable rates to raise resources for making cash payment to the army.
- He appointed *Diwan-i-Riyasat* and *Shahna-i-Mandi* to regulate the fixed price market.
- He declared all land in the area from Lahore to Karu to be state land.
- He constructed monuments like *Alai-Darwaza* and *Sirifort* in Delhi.
- He prohibited the use of wine and organisation of parties among soldiers.
- The most important contribution of *Alauddin Khilji* was the introduction of price controls covering almost the entire market so that the cost of living would not be high. Grain was rationed and the price was fixed. There was restriction on sale and purchase of high quality cloth.
- Though *Alauddin* was illiterate, he was a patron of learning and art. He died in 1316 A.D. and *Qutubuddin Mubarak Khilji* ascended his throne and after him *Nasiruddin Khusro* succeeded him.
- After *Alauddin's* death, kings followed a quick succession till *Giyasuddin Tughlaq* proclaimed himself the *Sultan of Delhi* in 1320 A.D.

Khilji Dynasty Timeline

Ruler	Reign
Jalal-ud-din Firuz Khilji	1290–1296
Alauddin Khilji	1296–1316
Qutb-ud-din Mubarak Shah	1316–1320

TUGHLAQ DYNASTY (1320 A.D.-1414 A.D.)

Giyasuddin Tughlaq was the founder of the new dynasty known as *Tughlaq dynasty*. Historians say that *Tughlaq* was the name of neither a race nor a family and that *Ghiyasud-din's* name was either *Ghazi Tughlaq* or *Ghazi Beg Tughlaq*. He extended his empire upto Madurai. As he was an Indian Muslim, the Turk nobles opposed him. He ruled upto 1325 A.D. He charged 1/5 of the produce and during famines exempted them from the taxes. He died in 1325 A.D.

Tughlaq Dynasty Timeline

Ruler	Reign
Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq	1321–1325
Mohammad bin Tughlaq	1325–1351
Firoz Shah Tughlaq	1351–1388
Ghiyas-ud-din Tughluq II	1388–1389
Nusrat Shah	1394–1399
Nasiruddin Mahmud Shah	1399–1413

Mohammad-bin-Tughlaq

He was the son of *Giyasuddin Tughlaq*. He has been referred to as an ill starred idealist whose experiments ended in failure. *Mohammad Tughlaq* organized agriculture department and called it as *Diwan-i-Amir Kohi*. He decided to shift his capital to *Devagiri* in the south for security reasons and named it as *Daulatabad*. He was a great patron of Philosophy, Arithmetic and Astrology. He was a lover of literature and poetry. *Ibanbatuta* was the *chief Qazi* of his empire. He died in 1351 A.D. during the invasion of Sindh.

Experiments of Mohammad Tughlaq

- Raising the taxes in *Doab*
- Transfer the capital from *Delhi* to *Daulatabad*
- Introduction of the token currency
- Expeditions into *Khurson* and *Qurachil*.

Firoz Shah Tughlaq

He ascended the throne at *Thatta* in 1351 A.D. He was *Muhammad's* cousin and chosen by the nobles as a sultan. He reduced taxation prescribed by the Quran. He established *Diwan-i-Khairat*, a charitable department. He established new towns like *Firozpur*, *Firozabad*, *Hissar-Firoza* and *Jaunpur*. His death was followed by a civil war among his descendants. The last ruler of *Tughlaq* dynasty was *Nasiruddin*.

The Sultanate after the Tughlaqs

After the Tughlaqs, the *Sayyid* and the *Lodi Dynasties* continued to rule from Delhi and Agra until 1526 but the control of the Delhi Sultans was only over a small region neighbouring Delhi. Regions like Jaunpur, Bengal, Malwas, Gujrat, Rajasthan and the entire South India had independent rulers.

THE SAYYID DYNASTY (1414 A.D. - 1451 A.D.)

Sayyid dynasty was short lived and was limited to Delhi. *Khizr Khan* was a Sayyid and his dynasty is called the Sayyid dynasty. The last ruler *Alauddin Shah* transferred the kingdom to *Bahlol Lodi*.

THE LODI DYNASTY (1451 A.D. - 1526 A.D.)

Ruler	Reign
Bahlol Lodi	1451-1489
Sikander Lodi	1489-1517
Ibrahim Lodi	1517-1526

Bahlol Lodi was the founder of *Lodi dynasty*. The most important Lodi Sultan was **Sikandar Lodi** who controlled the Ganga Valley. He shifted his capital from *Delhi to Agra*. He conquered Bihar and Tirhut. He was a bigot and demolished many Hindu temples. He introduced the measurement of land known as 'Gaz'. The eldest son of Sikandar Lodi was **Ibrahim Lodi** who ascended his throne. His relation with his nobles were not cordial. Ibrahim Lodi was defeated by **Babur** in the first *Battle of Panipat* in 1526 A.D. Thus the reign of Delhi Sultanate ended for 320 years.

Causes of the decline of the Delhi Sultanate

- Weak system of government.
- The invasion of Taimur.
- Lack of clear cut succession policy.
- Ibrahim Lodi was a foolish emperor.
- Greed for wealth and luxury among nobles.

ADMINISTRATION OF THE SULTANATE

The *iqtdari* was a type of land distribution and administration evolved during the Sultanate period. The *muqtis* had the right to collect and appropriate taxes. The sultan from *Ilutmish* started the practice of transferring *muqtis* from one *iqta* to another.

The sultans were the head of the state. He considered himself the deputy of the khalifa. He was the chief law giver and the Commander-in-chief. Other important officials were *Barid-i-mumalik*, *Wakil-i-dar*, *Amir-i-hazib*, *Sadr-i-Jahan*,

Amir-i-dad, *Amir-i-akhur*, *Shahna-i-pil*, *Shiqdar*, *Amur-i-Majlis*, *Majlis-i-an*. Each province was divided into a number of *shiqs* which were headed by *shiqdars* who maintained law and order. The village was the smallest unit of administration.

Law and Order

The head of the judicial department was the chief qazi who was responsible for the enforcement of Islamic law. According to Islam, the sources of justice are four-Quran, Hadis, Ijma and Qayas. Ijma was the collection of laws which were obtained from the Mujatahid. There were four types of courts at the provincial level.

- The court of Governor*
- Qazi-e-Suba's court*
- Court of Diwan-i-Suba*
- Court of Sadar-i-suba*

Agriculture and Land Revenue System

During the regime of Mohammad-bin-Tughlaq and Firoz Tughlaq, there was a marked development of gardens. These gardens led to the improvement of fruits, especially grapes for the preparation of wine. Canals were set up by Firoz. Items of import were horses, armoury, slaves, dry fruits etc. Iron, arms, cotton, grains, sugar, spices, herbs, fruits and indigo were exported.

There were five types of taxes.

- Ushra*
- Kharaj*
- Khams*
- Jazia*
- Zakat*

Ushra was the land tax taken from non-muslims on the total production from 5% to 10%. Khams was 1/5 of the total property. Zakat was 2.5% religious tax of the total income. Jazia was levied on non-muslims.

Batai was a method of fixing the land tax. It was of three types- *Khet Batai*, *Lank Batai*, *Ras Batai*.

Music

Rabab and *Sarangi* were introduced by the Turks. *Amir Khusr* is credited for introducing *Qawali*. The Indian classical work of *Rag Darpan* was translated into Persian.

POST-SULTANATE PERIOD

After the decline of Sultanate, many other kingdoms arose. Music was patronised, regional languages were stimulated and provincial style of architecture developed. Gujarat, Malwa and Rajasthan came into power. The Muslim rulers became friendly with the Rajputs. Gujarat style of architecture was extraordinary. Tomb of Shaikh Farid, Tanka mosque, Jama Mosque of Khambhat, Mosque of Muhafiz Khan, Sidi Saiyyad were built in early 16th century. Bengal, Kashmir, Mewar, Bahmani state's rulers were the patrons of art, science and education.

PROMINENT RULERS OF THE DELHI SULTANATE

Slave Dynasty	Khilji Dynasty	Tughlaq Dynasty	Sayyid Dynasty	Lodhi Dynasty
- Started by Qutab-ud-din Aibak. - Succeeded by Iltutmish, his son-in-law. - Efficient ruler, great builder, completed Qutab Minar started by Qutab-ud-din Aibak. - Iltutmish defeated Rajput rulers. - He also averted Mongol attack. Razia, his daughter, succeeded him. She was an efficient ruler but orthodox nobles did not accept her, killed in AD 1240. - Nasir-ud-din Muhammad next ruler. Youngest son of Iltutmish, very inefficient. - Reign of government in the hands of Balban, his father-in-law. - Balban was Prime Minister for 20 years. - Became king after Nasir-ud-din's death. - Very efficient ruler, controlled nobles and empire efficiently. - Peace and prosperity reigned during his rule.	Jalal-ud-din Khilji ascended the throne, after killing Balban's grandson. - He was murdered by his nephew Ala-ud-din Khilji. Ala-ud-din became king in AD 1296. Ala-ud-din was a great king who conquered Gujarat, Chittor, Malwa, Ujjain, Dhar, Mandu, Chanderi in the north. - He defeated the rulers of Devagiri, Warangal, Dwarsamudra, Madurai. - He converted the rajas to vassals and took annual tribute from them. - This was deliberate as Deccan was far away from his capital and thus, difficult to control. - Equipped his kingdom against the Mongols. - Controlled power of nobles. - Introduced revenue reforms such as price control of essential goods. - He was also a great builder and a patron of art and architecture.	- After Ala-ud-din's death the nobles raised Ghias-ud-din Tughlaq to the throne in AD 1320. - After his death Muhammad-Bin-Tughlaq ascended the throne. He was a man of vision but his reforms failed through want of adequate planning. - His three schemes – shifting of capital – token currency – taxation in the doab failed miserably. - Firoz Shad Tughlaq – not a good general – lost Bengal and Deccan – himself a scholar, patronised scholars – great builders, built many towns – improved irrigation, built canals and wells. Built many hospitals also. – banned corporal punishment. – Timur invaded India and plundered it. The weak Tughlaq dynasty came to its end.	- After Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq died Timur's deputy marched into India. He occupied the throne of Delhi. - The Sayyid dynasty was founded. - Weak rulers gave up throne of Delhi to Bahlol Lodhi.	Bahlol Lodhi, an Afghan noble, founded the Lodhi dynasty. Sikandar Lodhi the most efficient ruler. - Annexed the whole of the Gangetic plain - Ibrahim Lodhi could not get the support of his nobles. - Daulat Khan invited Babur to invade India. - Ibrahim Lodhi defeated by Babur in the first battle of Panipat 1526. - Arabs were great explorers and mariners of their time. - They used the compass and the astrolabes efficiently.

Points to remember

- Delhi became important under the **Delhi Sultanate**.
- The important dynasties of the Delhi Sultanate were the Slave Dynasty, Khilji Dynasty, Tughlaq Dynasty, Sayyid Dynasty and Lodhi Dynasty.
- The foundation of the Slave Dynasty was laid down by Qutab-ud-din Aibak. Dynasty introduced the market control and administrative measures in order to maintain a large standing army.
- Among the Tughlaqs, **Muhammad-Bin-Tughlaq** introduced three projects - shifting of capital from Delhi to Daulatabad, introduction of token currency, raising of land tax in the Doab region to fifty percent - all of which failed and weakened his position.
- After the Tughlaq dynasty, the disintegration of the Delhi Sultanate set in, though the Sayyids and Lodhis continued to rule till 1526.
- In the medieval period two new religious movements gained popularity: (i) *Sufism* (ii) *Bhakti*
- Sufism was Islamic mystic tradition while Bhakti was the devotion towards a God or his various forms.
- Sufism introduced many popular *orders or Silsilahs* of which the most widespread were the **Suhrawardi** and **Chishti** silsilahs.

Exercise -1

- Which Turkish general destroyed the universities of Nalanda and Vikramsila?
(a) Qutubuddin Aibek (b) Bakhtiyar Khalji
(c) Ali Mardan Khalji (d) Tajuddin Yalduz
- About whose kingdom is it said "the dominion of the lord of the universe extended from Delhi to Palam."?
(a) Qutubuddin Aibek
(b) Nasiruddin Mahmud Tughlaq
(c) Mohammad Gazni
(d) Alam Shah
- After consolidating his power, Balban assumed the grand title of :
(a) Tute-Hind (b) Kaisr-i-Hind
(c) Zil-i-Ilahi (d) Din-i-Ilahi
- Fawazil in the Sultanate period meant:
(a) extra payment to the nobles
(b) revenue assigned in lieu of salary
(c) excess amount paid to the exchequer by the Iqtadars
(d) illegal exactions extracted from the peasants
- 'The king was freed from his people and they from their king'. On whose death did Badauni comment this?
(a) Balban
(b) Ala-ud-din Khilji
(c) Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq
(d) Firoz Shah Tughlaq
- With reference to medieval Indian rulers, which one of the following statement is correct?
(a) Alauddin Khilji first set up a separate ariz's department.
(b) Balban introduced the branding of horses in his military.
(c) Muhammad Bin Tughlaq was succeeded by his uncle to the military.
(d) Firoz Tughlaq set up a separate department of slaves.
- Which one of the following is the correct chronological order of the Afghan rulers to the throne of Delhi?
(a) Sikandar Shah-Ibrahim Lodi-Bahlol Khan Lodi
(b) Sikandar Shah-Bahlol Khan Lodi-Ibrahim Lodi
(c) Bahlol Khan Lodi-Sikandar Shah-Ibrahim Lodi
(d) Bahlol Khan Lodi-Ibrahim Lodi-Sikandar Shah
- Who among the following Delhi Sultans was known for introducing market control mechanism ?
(a) Iltutmish (b) Balban
(c) Alauddin Khilji (d) Firoz Tughlaq
- Who wrote the book called Kitab-i-Nauras ?
(a) Amir Khusro (b) Badauni
(c) Ibrahim Adil Shah II (d) Ala-ud-din Bahmani
- During the reign of Alauddin Khilji, who were amils ?
(a) Local landlords at village level
(b) Government agents to collect land revenue
(c) Khurasani and Multani traders of foodgrains
(d) Banjaras who carried the food-grains from villages to towns.
- With reference to Delhi Sultanate, who was the founder of Sayyid Dynasty?
(a) Khizr Khan (b) Mubarak Shah
(c) Muhammad Shah (d) Alauddin Alam Shah
- What was Iqta in sultanate period?
(a) Territories of land (b) A tax
(c) A form of military (d) None of these
- In whose reign did the sultanate reach its farthest extent ?
(a) Qutub-ud-din Aibak (b) Raziya
(c) Ghiyasuddin Balban (d) Muhammad Tughlaq
- Which dynasty rules for the longest period of time in the Delhi sultanate?
(a) Slave dynasty (b) Khilji dynasty
(c) Tughlaq dynasty (d) Lodhi dynasty
- Who among the Sultans is credited with having introduced a purely Arabic currency of gold and silver?
(a) Iltutmish
(b) Balban
(c) Muhammed-bin-Tughluq
(d) Alauddin Khilji
- Which Sultan introduced the practices of Sijda, Paibos and Nawroz in the Delhi Sultanate?
(a) Balban (b) Razia Sultana
(c) Iltutmish (d) Firoz Shah Tughlaq
- Which of the following are true?
(a) Balban did not go for fresh conquests, rather he concentrated on consolidation of the infant state at Delhi.
(b) He set about a policy of liquidation of the challis or 40 nobles.
(c) Balban did not show any difference in matters of administration of justice between high and low.
(d) All of the above
- Which Sultan was the first to proclaim that the state in India of the Delhi Sultanate cannot be a truly Islamic state?
(a) Behram Shah
(b) Nasiruddin Mahmud Shah
(c) Jalaluddin Khilji
(d) Alauddin Khilji
- Who was the only converted Indian muslim to become the head of the Delhi Sultanate?
(a) Kaikubad
(b) Nasiruddin Khusrau Shah
(c) Masud Shah
(d) Qaimurs
- Which Jain saint was patronised by Mohammed-bin-Tughluq?
(a) Hemachandra Suri (b) Jinaprabha Suri
(c) Dasturji Mebarji (d) None

21. Which sultan had a dispute with Sufi Saint Nizamuddin Auliya?
 - (a) Jalaluddin Khilji
 - (b) Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq
 - (c) Feroz Shah Tughlaq
 - (d) Mohammad-bin-Tughlaq
22. The Bahmani Sultanate came into being during the reign of which Sultan?
 - (a) Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq
 - (b) Ibrahim Lodhi
 - (c) Mohammad-bin-Tughlaq
 - (d) Feroz Shah Tughlaq
23. Which of the dynasties ruled for the shortest period of time during of course of the Delhi Sultanate?
 - (a) Slave dynasty
 - (b) Khilji dynasty
 - (c) Sayyid dynasty
 - (d) Lodhi dynasty
24. Which Lodhi ruler was originally named as Nizam Khan?
 - (a) Bahlul Lodi
 - (b) Sikandar Lodhi
 - (c) Ibrahim Lodhi
 - (d) Dilawar Khan Lodhi
25. Who abolished Iqta system?
 - (a) Qutubuddin Aibak
 - (b) Iltutmish
 - (c) Balban
 - (d) Alauddin Khilji
26. Why did Mohammad-bin Tughlaq shift his capital from Delhi to Deogiri?
 - (a) Because he was fed up with Delhi.
 - (b) As a punishment for the people of Delhi.
 - (c) Because he wanted to extend his empire to the south.
 - (d) Because the new capital occupied a central and strategic location.
27. Who among the following Amirs was the one publicly flogged by the orders of Sultan Balban?
 - (a) Haibat Khan
 - (b) Imaduddin Raihan
 - (c) Sher Khan
 - (d) Malik Baqbaq
28. Who was the Governor of Kara-Manikpur to have revolted against Sultan Jalaluddin Firoz Khilji?
 - (a) Arkali Khan
 - (b) Almas Beg
 - (c) Jawna Khan
 - (d) Malik Chajju
29. Which sultan of Delhi made a rule that, in any given year, the land revenue can be increased only nominally, viz. one-tenth or one-eleventh of the fixed revenue?
 - (a) Balban
 - (b) Alauddin Khilji
 - (c) Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq
 - (d) Firozshah Tughlaq
30. Who of the following was responsible for the murder of his father?
 - (a) Balban
 - (b) Mohammad Bin Tughlaq
 - (c) Alauddin Khilji
 - (d) Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq
31. Who among the following foreign historians is considered an authority on the history of the Delhi Sultanate?
 - (a) Richard Fox
 - (b) Peter Jackson
 - (c) Aden Southall
 - (d) Chris Bayly
32. Which Sultan of Delhi categorized the Ulema into 'Ulma-i-Akhiral' and 'Ulma-i-Duniya' and praised the former?
 - (a) Qutubuddin Aibak
 - (b) Iltutmish
 - (c) Balban
 - (d) Alauddin Khilji
33. During the time of Alauddin's invasion, Warangal was ruled by
 - (a) Chalukya dynasty
 - (b) Chola dynasty
 - (c) Kakatiya dynasty
 - (d) Yadava dynasty
34. Shashgani was a small silver coin equal to
 - (a) 4 Jitals
 - (b) 6 Jitals
 - (c) 8 Jitals
 - (d) 10 Jitals
35. Who among the following Sultans received the title of 'Syed-us-Salatin' from the Caliph?
 - (a) Iltutmish
 - (b) Balban
 - (c) Alauddin Khilji
 - (d) Firoz Shah Tughlaq
36. The statement. "India is not Arabia, it is not practically feasible to convert it into Qarul Islam." is associated with
 - (a) Iltutmish
 - (b) Balban
 - (c) Alauddin Khilji
 - (d) Muhammad Bin Tughlaq
37. With which Sultan of Delhi do you associate the compilation of Kingship theory and principles of administration called 'Vassayya' ?
 - (a) Iltutmish
 - (b) Balban
 - (c) Alauddin Khilji
 - (d) Firoz Shah Tughlaq
38. Which one of the following works of Amir Khusror deals with the military expeditions of Alauddin Khilji?
 - (a) Nuh Siphar
 - (b) Khajain-ul-Futuh
 - (c) Miftah-ul-Futuh
 - (d) Quairanus Sadain
39. According to historian Ziauddin Barani, the ideal Sultan of Delhi was
 - (a) Balban
 - (b) Alauddin Khilji
 - (c) Firoz Shah Tughlaq
 - (d) Bahlol Lodi
40. Which one of the following is an octagonal tomb?
 - (a) Tomb of Sikandar Lodi
 - (b) Tomb of Balban
 - (c) Tomb of Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq
 - (d) Tomb of Firoz Shah Tughlaq
41. With which Sufi saint of Delhi is associated the famous saying 'Hanooz Dilli Door Ast' ?
 - (a) Nizamuddin Aulia
 - (b) Sheikh Salim Chisti
 - (c) Bhakhtiyaruddin Kaki
 - (d) Mohammad Ghaus
42. Who established Diwan-i-Mustakharaj?
 - (a) Qutubuddin Aibak
 - (b) Razia Sultana
 - (c) Balban
 - (d) Alauddin Khilji
43. Which type of work was looked after by the department of Diwan-i-Kohi under Muhammad Tughlaq?
 - (a) Agriculture
 - (b) Army
 - (c) Justice
 - (d) Royal correspondence

44. Who of the following Sultans of Delhi had abolished the tax on grain (also called Zakat on grain)?
 - (a) Alauddin Khilji
 - (b) Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq
 - (c) Firoz Shah Tughlaq
 - (d) Sikandar Lodi
45. What was Arghatta?
 - (a) A machine to break forts
 - (b) An irrigation canal
 - (c) A device to lift water
 - (d) A type of cloth
46. Which one of the following agrarian measures was NOT adopted by Ghiyasuddin Tughlaq?
 - (a) He discarded measurement in favour of sharing.
 - (b) The chiefs and headmen of villages were given back their perquisites.
 - (c) The basis of the demand by the Government was to be Hukm-i-hasil (in accordance with yield) with enough provision for crop failures.
 - (d) He made a large reduction in the scale of revenue fixed by Alauddin and brought it down to one-sixth of the gross produce.
47. Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched?
 - (a) Ahadi : Gentlemen trooper
 - (b) Qalb : King's personal troops
 - (c) Muqaddams : revenue collectors
 - (d) Charai : House Tax
48. Which one of the following statements cannot be attributed to Firoz Tughlaq?
 - (a) He restored the rent free lands (inam, Idrar) granted to theologians
 - (b) He abolished all taxes not sanctioned by Shara
 - (c) He raised the grants of teachers and stipends for students
 - (d) He forced Khuts, Muqaddams and Chaudharis to pay grazing tax and house tax
49. Give one reason why the description of the Qutb-ud-din Aibak's dynasty as a "slave dynasty" is regarded as inaccurate.
 - (a) Because except for Qutb-ud-din Aibak. Others rulers of the dynasty were not slaves
 - (b) Because only three kings of this dynasty were slaves and even these three were manumitted by their masters
 - (c) Because technically only Qutb-ud-din Aibak started his career as a slave and he too was manumitted upon obtaining a letter of investiture from the Abbasid Caliph
 - (d) Because all the rulers of this dynasty did not belong to one family
50. The chief achievement of Balban was
 - (a) the consolidation of Turkish power and putting down rebellions by reorganising his army
 - (b) suppression of ambitious nobles
 - (c) establishing rapport with the people
 - (d) administrative reforms
51. When Ala-ud-din Khilji forbade his nobles the use of wine, intimate relations and abundance of wealth, and confiscated their endowments and inams, he aimed at
 - (a) enhancing king's dignity
 - (b) preventing the treachery of nobles
 - (c) setting an example for his Hindu subjects
 - (d) gathering more wealth for himself
52. Which is not a correct pair?
 - (a) Khanqah — a house of mystics
 - (b) Khutba — sermon
 - (c) Madad-i-mash — grant of land or pension to scholars and saints by the Sultans
 - (d) Majlis — meeting place or council
53. Which of the following is wrongly matched?
 - (a) Qutab Minar — Aibak and Iltutmish
 - (b) Dhaj din ka Jhonpara — Ibrahim Lodi
 - (c) Alai Darwaja — Alauddin Khilji
 - (d) Red Palace — Balban
54. Who among the following Sultans of Delhi was the first to have paid to his soldiers in cash ?
 - (a) Iltutmish
 - (b) Alauddin Khilji
 - (c) Muhammad bin Tughlaq
 - (d) Feroz Tughlaq
55. During the reign of Alauddin Khilji, who were amils ?
 - (a) Local landlords at village level
 - (b) Government agents to collect land revenue
 - (c) Khurasani and Multani traders of foodgrains
 - (d) Banjaras who carried the food-grains from villages to towns.
56. Which Sultan declared himself as Sikandar-i-Sani, the second Alexander?
 - (a) Balban
 - (b) Kaiqubad
 - (c) Iltutmish
 - (d) Alauddin Khalji
57. Who among the following was the author of *Tarikh-i-Alai*, which contains the details of the first few years of Sultan Alauddin Khilji ?
 - (a) Ziauddin Barani
 - (b) Shams Siraj Afif
 - (c) Amir Khusrau
 - (d) Yahya Bin Ahmad
58. Muhammad bin Tughlaq's experiment of introducing token currency could not succeed on account of
 - (a) rejection of token coins by foreign merchants
 - (b) shortage of copper for minting token coins
 - (c) large-scale minting of spurious coins
 - (d) poor quality of token currency
59. What was the name of Jain saint with whom Muhammad Tughlaq held discussions?
 - (a) Rishabadeva
 - (b) Hemchandra
 - (c) Jinasena Suri
 - (d) Jinaprabha Suri
60. Which one of the following sultans is credited with the appointment of 'Amir - Sadah' in the provinces?
 - (a) Alauddin Khilji
 - (b) Muhammad Tughlaq
 - (c) Firoz Tughlaq
 - (d) Bahlol Lodi